

Week 01

DAY 01(Paper 01)

Introduction to Syllabus Paper 01

1. Major themes of the Qur'an [8] marks

Three groups of passages are set for close study. These relate to the themes of:

○ **Allah in Himself**

1. *Ayat al Kursi (2:255)*
2. *Anaam (6:101-103)*
3. *Fussilat (41:37)*
4. *Shura (42:4-5)*
5. *Ikhlas (112)*

○ **Allah's relationship with the created world**

1. *Fatiha (1)*
2. *Baqarah (2:21-22)*
3. *Alaq (96:1-5)*
4. *Zilzal (99)*
5. *Naas (114)*

○ **Allah's Messengers**

1. *Baqarah (2:30-37)*
2. *Anaam (6:75-79)*
3. *Maidah (5:110)*
4. *Duha (93)*
5. *Kauthar (108)*

2. The history and importance of the Qur'an [14] marks

Candidates should study:

- the revelation of the Qur'an to the Prophet between the *years 610 and 632*
- compilation of the Qur'an under *the Rightly Guided Caliphs*
- *the major themes* of the Qur'an
- the use of the *Qur'an in legal thinking*,
- its *relationship* with *the Hadiths*,
- *consensus (ijma')*

- *analogy (qiyas)*

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3. The life and importance of the Prophet Muhammad [14] marks

Candidates should study:

- Prophet's life from **his birth to his call to prophethood**
- Life **in Makka** and his experiences with his opponents
- Life **in Madina**,
- his conflicts with the Makkans and others
- his actions and character
- **relations with others including women and non-Muslims**
- **relations with other states**
- **Seal of the Prophets** and last Messenger of God.

In the examination either **one or two questions** will be set on this topic.

4. The first Islamic community [14] marks

Candidates should study:

- the **Prophet's wives**
- his **descendants**, including his children, grandchildren and the direct line recognised among Shi'a Muslims as **Imams**
- his **leading Companions**, including the **Ten Blessed Companions**, (the four Rightly-Guided Caliphs during his lifetime). (Note that the ***period of the Rightly-Guided Caliphs' rules after the time of the Prophet is included in the Syllabus under Paper 2.***)
- his **Scribes**,
- **the major characters** who surrounded him in his ministry,
- the **Emigrants and Helpers**
- **Position of women as wives, mothers and daughters**

In the examination either **one or two questions** will be set on this topic.

WEEK 01

DAY 02 (Paper 01)

Life and Importance of Prophet Muhammad (S.A.W.W)

Birth and Childhood

- Prophet Muhammad was born on **12th Rabi ul Awwal 570 AD**. His father **Abdullah** had died before his birth. His mother **Aamina**, named him Ahmed and his grandfather **Abdul Muttalib** named him Muhammad
- According to the custom of Arabia, new born were raised by wet nurses, away from the busy cities. Therefore, keeping with the local tradition, the infant Muhammad's (P.B.U.H) upbringing was entrusted to **Halima Saadia**, who belonged to the tribe of **Banu Sa'ad**. Great blessing and good fortune surrounded Halima and her family as long as Muhammad (P.B.U.H) stayed with her, they were never short of food; and their flock yielded milk in abundance. Muhammad (P.B.U.H) remained with Banu Sa'ad for five years, where he learned pure Arabic dialect he took pride in it, he said, **"Verily I am the most perfect Arab amongst you; my descent is from Quraish and my tongue is the tongue of the Banu Sa'ad.**
- After two years Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was brought back to his mother but there was an epidemic(plague) in Makkah so she sent him back with Halima.
- When Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was about five years old, the Angel Gabriel came with another angel. On this occasion, Prophet's chest was opened and a clot of blood was taken out of his heart and it was washed with Zam-Zam water. When Halima came to know about it, she got scared and returned him to his mother.
- When Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was six years old, his mother took him to Madinah to visit the grave of her husband. On their return journey she passed away at Abwa and was buried there.
- Umm Aimen, the slave girl brought Muhammad (P.B.U.H) to his grandfather Abdul Muttalib, who brought him up with love and affection. When Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was eight years old, Abdul Muttalib died, before his death he entrusted him to the care of his son Abu Talib. Abu Talib was very kind to Muhammad (P.B.U.H); he was loving and affectionate his nephew. Allah says regarding this, **"Did he not find you an orphan and give you shelter (and care)."** (Ad Dhuha 93:6) When he was a boy, Muhammad (P.B.U.H) looked after the flocks of Abu Talib.

Meeting with Bahira

- At the age of **twelve**, Muhammad (P.B.U.H) accompanied Abu Talib on a trade journey to Syria. On his way near Basra, he met a Christian monk named **Bahira**, who noticed the signs of prophethood in him. He asked Abu Talib to take special care of his nephew and protect him. He also warned him not to take the Prophet Muhammad to Syria as Jews would harm him. Therefore, Abu Talib sold his merchandise at Basra and came back to Makkah.

Harb ul Fijar

- Between the years **580-590**, a sacrilegious war broke out at the fair of **Ukaz** between the **Quraish and Hawazin** tribes, despite the fact that war was forbidden during the Hajj season. Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was **15 year old** when he went to the battlefield. However he did not participate in actual fighting, he helped by **picking up stray arrows** thrown by the enemy and giving them to his uncles. It lasted for many years.

Half al Fadul

- Seeing the injustice and ravages of war, some tribes decided to form an **alliance** to protect the rights of the oppressed and provide them with justice. For this purpose they assembled in the house of **Abdullah bin Jad'an**, they agreed that if they found anyone either a native of Makkah, or an outsider had been wronged they would help him against the aggressor till the stolen property was restored

to him. This alliance came to be called **Half-al-Fudul (truce of Fudul)**. According to some it was named after the names of the leading members of the alliance. Prophet Muhammad(P.B.U.H) was among those who attended the meeting with his uncle **Zubair bin Abdul Mutlib** and was so impressed by its noble objectives that he remained loyal to it. Later on he said," **I was present in the house of Abdullah bin Judan at so excellent a pact that I would not exchange my part in it for a herd of red camels; and if now in Islam. I were summoned unto it, I would gladly respond"**

Youth and Titles:

- Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.h) led a virtuous life. He was considerate, kind, forbearing, patient, noble hearted and a man of principles. He was honest and truthful and was known as "**Sadiq**" (the Truthful) and "**Ameen**" (the Trustworthy) for these characteristics. Hazrat **Sa'ad** his business partner said: "**I was partner of Mohammad (P.B.U.H) in business. I always found him very honest in his dealings; he never picked quarrels, nor made any false statement"**

On the occasion of the annual pilgrimage, Muhammad (P.B.U.H) used to supply water to the pilgrims and look after their comforts. He was always fair and honest in his dealings.

Marriage :

- **Khadijah bint Khuwalid**, a wealthy widow in Makkah, had heard about the honesty of Muhammad (P.B.U.H) and approached him for this purpose and sent her slave **Maysera** with him on a trade trip to Syria.
- Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) worked diligently and earned a great deal of profit. When they came back, Maysera praised him for his honesty, Khadijah was very much impressed, and she proposed marriage to him through her cousin Nafeesa, which he accepted after consultation with his uncle. At the time of marriage in 595AD, Muhammad (P.B.U.h) was **25**, while Khadijah was **40** years old. They were blessed with four daughters; Ruqayyah, zaynab, Umm Kulthoom, and Fatimah and two sons who died in infancy.

Fixing of the Black Stone

- When the Prophet was 35 year old, Quraish decided to repair Ka'bah, which had been damaged due to floods. When the question of placing the black stone arose, a dispute started as every tribe was eager to have the honour to install the black stone. The dispute was prevented by an elder who suggested that the arbitration of the first person who entered the mosque the next morning should be taken and all accepted the decision. Muhammad (P.B.U.H) happened to be the first person who came to Ka'bah, and he accepted to arbitrate. Muhammad (P.B.U.H) placed the black stone in a sheet and asked the leader of all tribes to lift it to the level where it was to be placed, and then he himself deposited it in its place. Thus, Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was able to prevent a crisis with wisdom and diplomacy, which could have led to bloodshed.

Meditation

- With age and growing understanding Hazrat Muhammad (P.B.U.H) became more and more fond of solitude. He started retiring for days with a supply of dates, oatmeal and water into a cave in a mountain (Jabal e Noor) outside Makkah, known as cave of Hira. There he pondered and mediated over the condition of his people. These spells of loneliness and mediation became more frequent as he approached the age of forty.

One day towards the end of **Ramadan** in **610 AD**, he was in the cave of Hira, when angel Jibrael appeared before him and revealed first five verses of Surah Alaq, thus he became a prophet at the age of 40.

3. (b) Why was his relationship with his wife Khadija important for him? [4]

- Khadija support of the Prophet financially and spiritually and being the first Muslim.
- Her support allowed him to spend time in seclusion.
- Seclusion prepared him for receiving revelations.
- Her maturity allowed her to console and believe in the Prophet when he received revelation
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WEEK 01

DAY 03(Paper 01)

Call to Prophethood / First Revelation

- With age and growing understanding Hazrat Muhammad (P.B.U.H) became more aware of the corrupt society around him and it disturbed him greatly. He could not believe the polytheistic ideas of the pagans of Makkah and often thought of God of his forefathers, Ibrahim and Ismail. He realized that there is a force of truth beyond this world which must have power and control over the whole universe. A few years before the conferment of prophethood, he became more and more fond of solitude. He started retiring for days with a supply of dates, oatmeal and water into a cave in a mountain (Jabal e Noor) outside Makkah, known as cave of Hira. There he pondered and mediated over the condition of his people. These spells of loneliness and mediation became more frequent as he approached the age of forty.
 - One day towards the end of **Ramadan(27th)** in **610 AD**, he was in the cave of Hira, when angel Jibrael appeared before him and asked him to read. This was so sudden and unexpected that startled by the strange voice, he answered' **"I cannot read"**. Then he felt that he was being hugged and squeezed so hard that he thought that he would die of suffocation. He was then released and the request to read was repeated. **"I cannot read"**, said Muhammad (P.B.U.H) again. The angel again hugged him asked him to read. Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was afraid of being squeezed a third time, so he asked: **"What shall I read?"**
 - The angel then recited the following verses.
"Read in the name of your Lord and Cherisher, Who created. Created man, out of a (mere) clot of congealed blood. Proclaim! And your Lord is most bountiful, He who taught by (the use of) pen. Taught man that which he knew not" (96:1-5)
Muhammad (P.B.U.H) recited these verses after the angel and the words were imprinted on his mind. This was the first revelation and the beginning of Prophethood of Hazrat Muhammad (P.B.U.H). He was then **forty years old**.
 - Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was greatly shaken by this experience and he ran out of the cave. Suddenly, he heard a voice and raising his head in the sky, he saw the same angel in the sky filling the whole horizon and saying: **"O Muhammad (P.B.U.H) , you are the messenger of Allah and I am Jibrael."** Whichever way he looked, he saw the same vision and heard the same voice. He stood there until the angel disappeared.
 - After the experience he came home and narrated the incident to Hazrat Khadija. She comforted him and assured him that no harm could come to a man of his nature and that Allah would protect him from all evils. Then she took him to her cousin Waraqa bin Naufal, who was a blind scholarly person and had embraced Christianity.
After hearing what had happened to her husband in the cave of Hira, he said that it was the angel Jibrael who had always brought revelations to previous messengers of God. He also informed her that his enemies would turn the new Prophet out of his city.
- (b)
- Yes, it was significant.
 - being unable to read or write it would not have been possible for the Prophet to have composed the Qur'an himself;

- the implication is that not being able to compose the Qur'an himself, it shows that the Qur'an is from God;
- the Arabs had a strong oral tradition which allowed the Qur'an to be preserved through memory alone;
- Since he could not read or write, therefore, he needed scribes for writing down the revelation and later they became witnesses of the divinity of Quran.
- God did not want anyone else to be the Prophet's (pbuh) teacher, as that would have meant someone was superior to him in his knowledge of God. It was a miracle of God.

Preaching by the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H)

After the prophet received his first revelation in the cave of Hira, he only told his wife Khadija and her cousin Waraqa bin Nawfal, about the event. Khadija was the first to accept the message. Waraqa confirmed the prophethood, and for some days there was a break in revelation which is known as **Fatrah tul wahi**.

1. Secret Preaching:

The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) passed this time in restlessness and anxiety, until one day, he saw angel Jibrael again, in the sky seated on a chair. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) became frightened and rushed home. He asked Khadija to cover him up. She covered him up, after which he received another revelation which said:

**“O you wrapped up (in a mantle)!
Arise and deliver your warning!
And glorify your Lord . (74: 1-3)**

In obedience to the command of Allah, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) invited his friends and relatives to the religion of Islam. He preached to them the oneness of Allah and warned them of the consequences of following their evil ways. But, he did not, at this stage, make any public announcement.

- The first person to believe in him was his wife, **Khadija**, who accepted his message without any hesitation.
- This was followed by the acceptance of Islam by ten years old, **Ali**, son of Abu Talib.
- The first freed slave to accept Islam was **Zaid bin Haris**.
- The first Person to become a Muslim outside the Prophet's immediate family was his close friend, Hazrat **Abu Bakr**, who invited many people to Islam and many prominent companions Muslim through him.
- **Khalid ibn Sa'id**, a friend of Hazrat Abu Bakr, was guided through a dream in which he saw himself being saved from fire by the Prophet. Hazrat Abu bakr R.A interpreted Khalid's dream and he accepted Islam.

Within a period of **three years**, while the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was preaching his message in secret, about forty righteous and God-fearing people accepted Islam. Among them were, **Talha, Zubair, Jaffar, Usman, Abdur Rahman bin Auf, Sa'ad bin Abi Waqas and Abdullah bin Masud**.

These early converts were the people who had witnessed the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) private and public life very closely and had arrived at the conclusion that such a gentle and honest person could not mislead the people. The house of **Zaid bin Arqam** became the first preaching centre of Islam, where the Prophet (pbuh) met these early converts and taught them the revelations he received. Muslims prayed twice in a day and would often go to the mountains outside Makkah to worship secretly.

- **None of the Holy Prophet's (P.B.U.H) uncles accepted Islam.** Abu Talib gave protection to the Holy Prophet . Abu Lahab believed that his nephew was self-deceived.

2. Preaching to Banu Hashim:

After the revelation of the verse, **“And warn your nearest relatives.” (26:214)**

- the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) called Hazrat Ali and asked him to prepare a meal and assemble the Banu Hashim. Hazrat Ali R.A did what he was told and most of the clan of Hashim came to the meal, about

forty of them. After the meal Abu Lahab said to everyone, **'Your host has placed a spell upon you'** and with that they dispersed before the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) could say more.

- The next day, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) asked Hazrat Ali R.A to do the same and invited his kinsmen for a meal; but this time he made sure he addressed them. **'O sons of Abd-ul-Mutalib ! Allah has commanded me to call you unto Him. Which of you, then, will help me in this, and be my brother and my successor?'**

When no one responded, the young Hazrat Ali R.A spoke up and said, **"O Prophet of Allah, I will be your helper in this. I will fight him who fights you"**.

- The men laughed at the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), but from among the women, the Holy Prophet's (P.B.U.H) aunt, **Safiyah**, accepted Islam as her son Zubair had done. **Umm-al-Fadl**, the wife of the Holy Prophet's (P.B.U.H) uncle Abbas, and her sisters **Maymunah, Salma, and Asma** also came into the faith.

3. Open Preaching:

Soon afterwards he received another revelation through which the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was given the order: **"Expound openly what you are commanded and turn away from those who join false gods with Allah."** (15:94)

- Following this command, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) assembled the people of Makkah at the **Safa hill** and said to them: **"O Quraish, if I were to tell you that a large army has gathered on the other side of his mountain and is ready to attack you, would you believe me?"** They all said that they would, since they had never heard him tell a lie. But when he asked them to believe in one Allah and his Prophethood, they became angry and some of them shouted: "You have gone mad".
- **Abu Lahab**, one of his uncles, said, **'may you perish forever, did you call us for such a thing?'**. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was shocked at the harsh response and the rejection by the Makkans. Allah comforted him by revealing the following verses regarding the punishment awaiting Abu Lahab: **'May the hand of Abu Lahab perish, doomed he is. His wealth and his properties shall not save him; he shall be thrown into a flaming fire of hell.'** (111:1-3)

After this, all of them dispersed.

The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) now started to address the people in public and private gatherings and on approach routes to Makkah which were used by pilgrims to the Holy city. His efforts were successful and people started embracing Islam. After this event the prophet and his followers had to face persecutions which continued until they migrated to Madina.

3.(b)

- yes, it was significant
- because the message was new and so the Prophet and his closest followers needed time to get used to it.
- Also, they did not know how the Quraysh would react so it was better to wait until they had some strength in numbers before openly preaching.
- It was also better to wait until they were guided by God to preach Islam openly as the Prophet (pbuh) always followed divine instructions.
- It symbolises the importance of Spiritual and Mental Jihad. While they were secretly preaching, they capitalised on their intellect, character and habits. It was the secret preaching due to which Muhammad (PBUH) garnered support that lifted Islam.

WEEK 01
DAY 04 (Paper 01)
Migration to Abyssinia

- The Persecution and hostilities of the Quraish started slowly but by the middle of **fifth year of prophethood/615 AD**, they became intense. Some of prophet's followers were persecuted to death e.g Sumayya and her husband Yasir.

It was at this time that **surah Zumar** was revealed: **"Good is for those who do good in this world, and Allah's earth is spacious. Only those who are patient shall receive their rewards in full, without reckoning."**(39:10)

After this revelation, the Prophet allowed the Muslim converts to migrate to Abyssinia, where the King **Ashamah**, who held the title of **Negus**(Najashi), was a just man.

- The first group of Muslims who migrated were a group of **12 men and 4 women**, including the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) daughter **Ruqayyah** and her husband **Hazrat Usman**. After a long journey on a boat, they reached the capital, Aksum, where they had the freedom to practice their religion.
- That same year in the month of **Ramadan**, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) was by the Ka'aba when he started to recite the verses of **Surah al-Najam**, as they were revealed to him, in the presence of many idolaters. The Impact of the word of Allah was such that, spellbound, they fell in prostration. News of this event was mis-reported in Abyssinia, and the migrants, led to believe that the whole of Makkah had accepted Islam, made their way back. On reaching back Makkah, they realized that the news was not true. The Quraish had heard reports about the good treatment to the migrants whilst in Abyssinia and, in their fury, they redoubled their persecutions.
- Seeing the plight of the Muslims, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) allowed them a second migration. This time the group leaving Makkah was large. There were **83 men and 19 women** who secretly made the journey led by the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) cousin **Jafar ibn Abu Talib**. They included Hazrat Sawdah and her husband Sakran, Zubair, Abu Ubaidah bin Jarrah, Abdur Rehman bin Auf etc.
- The leaders of the Quraish, rather than celebrating the departure of these Muslims from Makkah, were furious and determined that they should not be left in peace to settle and, perhaps, even increase their number by preaching Islam in Abyssinia. Hence, they planned to send a delegation of two men, **Amr bin Aas** and **Abdullah bin Rabiyya**, with some gifts to the king to request him to hand over the emigrants to them. The sole purpose of this two-man delegation was to slander the faith of Islam in the eyes of the Christian King Negus.
They appealed to the generals first and then to Negus himself, saying: **"Some foolish young men and women of our people have taken refuge in this kingdom. They have left their own religion, not for your, but for one they have invented, one that is unknown to us and to yourselves. We beg you to restore them (to their elders)"**
- Negus, being a just ruler, asked the Muslims to explain themselves before he reached a decision about whether or not he would return them to the Quraish. **Jafar ibn Abu Talib**, who was an eloquent speaker, stepped forward and answered:

- ✓ **"O King! We were ignorant people and we lived like wild animals. The strong among us lived by preying upon the weak. We obeyed no law and we acknowledged no authority save that of brute force. We worshipped idols made of stone or wood, and we knew nothing of human dignity.**
- ✓ **And then God, in His Mercy, sent to us His Messenger who was himself one of us. We knew about his truthfulness and his integrity. His character was exemplary, and he was the well-born of the Arabs.**
- ✓ **He invited us toward the worship of One God, and he forbade us to worship idols. He exhorted us to tell the truth, and to protect the weak, the poor, the humble, the widows and the orphans. He ordered us to show respect to women, and never to slander them. We obeyed him and followed his teachings.**
- ✓ **Most of the people in our country are still polytheists, and they resented our conversion to the new faith which is called Islam. They began to persecute us and it was in order to escape from persecution by them that we sought and found sanctuary in your kingdom."**
- When Negus asked for an example of the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) message, Jafar choose well and recited **Surah Maryam, verses 17-26**, about Hazrat Maryam the mother of the Prophet Isa had his miraculous birth without a father.
It is said that when Jafar finished, the recitation, Negus and his entire court had tears in their eyes. Negus said:
"By God this and Gospel are the lights of one candle".
Thereafter he returned the gifts, sent by the leaders of the Quraish and told them that even if they offered him a mountain of gold, he would not hand over the people who had sought his refuge.
- When the envoys of the Quraish came back to Makkah unsuccessful, it infuriated the Quraish and they intensified their persecutions of the believers remaining in Makkah. It was at this time that the Prophet's uncle Hazrat Hamza and Hazrat Umar ibn al-Khattab entered the fold of Islam.

4. (b) Why did the people of Makka pursue these Muslims? [4]

- The Makkans wanted to destroy the new faith, as it threatened their own religious and economic stability and therefore, did not want the Muslims to escape and for Islam to flourish.
- The Makkans had fears due to the increasing number of Muslims and the this migration encouraged those to accept Islam who previously feared persecutions.
- They wanted to bring emigrants back and persecute them in order to discourage others from accepting Islam.
- The success of this Migration was a threat to their political leadership in Arabia. This migration also threatened their economic prosperity.

4(b) What was the importance of making this migration at that time? [4]

- The migration to Abyssinia was a significant event which can be described at the first major political move taken by the Holy Prophet ^{pbuh}.
- The migration to Abyssinia made the feelings of unity among Muslims stronger;
- the emigration to Abyssinia gave the Muslims a chance to carry the message of Islam further and out of Arabia.
- The migration provided practical training during the Holy Prophet's ^{pbuh} lifetime for the establishment of a Muslim society in which the Prophet ^{pbuh} did not live.
- The Muslims came to know that there were places where they could seek shelter and protection from the persecution of the Quarish.
- It ultimately gave birth to the idea of a greater migration to Madina.

WEEK 02

DAY 01

Boycott of Banu Hashim

- After the acceptance of Islam by Hazrat Hamza and Hazrat Umar, the Quraish came under pressure from **Abu Jahl** to take action against the growing popularity of Islam and the courage the Muslims were now showing in the practise of their faith. In the **seventh year of prophethood** the Quraish mounted pressure on Abu Talib the chief of the Clan of Banu Hashim that he should abandon his nephew and surrender him to their custody. But when he refused, they decided to impose a ban on the entire clan of Banu Hashim which, with the exception of Abu Lahab, was committed to protecting Hazrat Muhammad (P.B.U.H) whether or not they believed him to be a Prophet.
- According to terms of ban, which was placed inside the Ka'ba, no one would marry a Hashimi woman or give his daughter in marriage to a Hashmi; no one was to sell or buy anything from them. This was to continue until the Banu Hashim themselves renounced Hazrat Muhammad (P.B.U.H) or until he renounced his claim to prophethood.
- The agreement was duly written and hung on Ka'bah. Members of Banu Hashim (Muslim as well as non-Muslim) were compelled to retire to a narrow gorge called Shib Abu talib in the outskirts of Makkah, which was the property of Abu Talib. The boycott lasted for **three years i.e 7th to 10th year of prophethood (616AD-619AD)** during which Banu Hashim suffered a lot. They lived in dire condition and face starvation. The pagans did not allow anyone to deliver food or other necessities to them. Crying of the children due to hunger and starvation could be heard outside the gorge. They were forced to eat grass and leaves of trees.
- Sometimes some relatives would flout the ban and smuggle food inside the gorge. For instance, **Hakim ibn Hazim** was once caught by Abu Jahl, trying to smuggle in a sack of wheat to his aunt Khadija R.A. The besieged could leave the gorge in the season of Hajj. The Boycott strengthened the faith of the Muslims. They were more determined than ever to see their mission successful.
- Finally, after Three years, the ban was lifted in the month of **Muharram** when **hashim bin Amr** one of the Quraish who used to smuggled food to the Banu Hashim, went to **Zuhayr**, one of the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) cousin, to protest about the ban and its effects on the besieged kinsmen. The two men won the support of others. They met at the Ka'aba and swore not to give up until the ban was torn up. Abu Jahl and one or two others, who opposed this action, now realised that would be futile to resist any longer. After much discussion they decided to lift the ban and when they went to take out the document, they found that the termite had already eaten it up and only the name of Allah was left on it.

The Year of Sorrow

The year **619 AD** was a year of deep grief for the Prophet (P.B.U.H). A few months after the lifting of ban, his beloved wife Hazrat Khadija R.A passed away. It was soon after Hazrat Khadija R.A passing away that Prophet's (P.B.U.H) uncle Abu fell ill. The clan leaders came to honour him and asked him if he could arrange a compromise between his nephew and themselves. The Quraish leaders, in their effort to reach a compromise with the Prophet (P.B.U.H), suggested that they should practise both religions. Before the Prophet could formulate a response, he received the Sura Kafirun as a divine answer. **"You have your religion and I have my religion."** [109:6] . The meeting failed and broke up. Soon afterwards, Abu Talib passed away. With his death, the leadership of the Banu Hashim passed over to Abu Lahab, who was one of the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) most violent opponents.

Visit to Taif

- After the death of Abu Talib, the Quraish increased their attacks against the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H). This new situation meant that he could no longer stay in Makkah with any hope of victory. Before things became too critical, he had to explore new avenues in his search for support. So, accompanied by his adopted son, Zaid bin Hartih, he set out for **Taif**, a town about 60 miles from Makkah, to preach Divine Message to its people.
- Taif was populated by **Banu Saqeef**, this **second largest tribe** in Arabia. As he began his journey, he was full of hope that if they responded favourably it would signify a new phase in the history of Islam. In Taif the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) approached **three chiefs** calling upon them to believe in Allah and support him in his efforts to establish Islam; but none gave him a favourable response and asked him to leave the town. Prophet (P.B.U.H) did not lose heart and started to preach Islam to common people of Taif which continued for ten days.
- When the chiefs came to know about this, they were infuriated and set upon him a crowd of teenagers and slaves, who not only abused him but also threw stones at him. He was so badly wounded that his shoes were filled with blood. Zaid tried hard to defend and protect him from the stones. In trying to shield the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), his head was badly wounded. The mob followed them until they were driven to the outskirts of the city.
- The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) then sought refuge in an orchard that belong to **two brothers** who although opposed to Islam and to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), felt sorry for him. They sent their **Christian slave Addas** with a bunch of grapes for him. After a dialogue with the Prophet (pbuh) Addas accepted Islam.
- At that time the Angel Gabriel appeared and addressed him saying: ***“Allah has heard what your people said to you, and how they have replied to you. Allah has sent the angel of the Mountains to you so that you may order him to do whatever you wish to these people.”***

The Angel of the Mountains then appeared and said, ***“O Muhammad! Order what you wish. If you like, I shall cause mountains surrounding Al-Ta’if, to fall upon them, and crush them into pieces.”***

The Prophet (peace and blessings of Allah be upon him) replied, ***“Why should I pray for their destruction, for I hope that there shall be among their children those who will worship Allah alone, and will worship none besides Him.”***

He prayed, ***“O Allah forgive them and guide them ... for they know me not.”***

Afterwards, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) set out on his journey back to Makkah.

- Thereafter, the Prophet (pbuh) and Zaid bin Harith offered prayer at Nakhla and during the prayer a group of Jinns joined the prayer after listening to the recitation of Quran. Before entering Makkah, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) tried to seek the protection of many influential men but was turned down. He finally sought protection from **Mut’im bin Adiy**, the chief of Nawfal. The next day, fully armed and accompanied by his sons and cousins, he escorted Prophet (P.B.U.H) to the Ka’aba and announced to protect him.

3 (b) How can Muslims apply in practice the lessons learnt from the Prophet’s behaviour in this situation? [4]

- The Prophet did not give up his faith in times of difficulty, despite few conversions and losing his wife and uncle, but rather he persevered.
- Muslims should learn to persevere in times of difficulty, when they have lost family members or they are living in difficult circumstances in their community;
- the Prophet did not curse or wish the worst for those people who had treated him so badly, but rather prayed for them.
- So Muslims now should not get angry and wish bad things towards those who insult them, but should try to do or say good things for them.

WEEK 02

DAY 02

Persecutions and Difficulties in Makkah

Prophet (P.B.U.H)

- The Prophet pbuh proclaimed the message of Islam openly on the mount of Safa after the divine command for open preaching of Islam in 613 AD, "Expound openly what you are commanded and turn away from those who join false gods with Allah." [15:94]

He was rejected by the gathering specially his uncle Abu Lahab cursed him. After this event he had to face stiff opposition and both physical and mental persecutions. The influential people of Makkah like Abu Jahl, Abu Lahab, Abu Sufyan etc became his enemies. The opposition increased gradually.

- The Quraish wanted to discredit Prophet (P.B.U.H) and his teachings in front of them and so came to the decision that they would call him a magician who was so powerful that he could separate son from father, brother from his brother, wife from her husband, and man from his clan.

The Quraish started to ridicule, degrade, and belittle the believers as well as the Prophet (P.B.U.H) himself to demoralize them. They said that the Prophet (P.B.U.H) was mad and that he practised witchcraft.

- His uncle Abu Lahab called him "abtar" at the death of his second son. At that time Allah consoled and comforted him with Surah al Kauthar and declared that his enemies were "abtar". "For he who hates you, he will be cut off." [108:3] .

After the revelation of Surah Lahab, Abu Lahab also forced his sons Utba and Utaiba to divorce the Prophet's daughter Ruqayya and Umm-e-Kalsoom. Abu Lahab's wife Umm-e-Jamil used to throw thorny bushes in the path which the Prophet pbuh was expected to take.

- They also persecuted him physically. Once Abu Jahl threw camel's intestines on him when he was prostrating in prayer, his daughter Hazrat Fatima removed it from him. Once Utba tried to strangle him when he was praying near the Kaabah. An old woman regularly pelted him with rubbish on his way to prayer.

- The pagans of Makkah also tried to bribe him by offering him wealth, leadership and even promised to marry him with the fairest girl if he abandoned the preaching of Islam. The prophet pbuh rejected all such offers and said, "O Uncle! Even if they place the sun in my right hand and the moon on my left, to force me to renounce my mission, I would not stop until Allah fulfills my mission or destroys me in the process." 'Hearing this, Abu Talib said to him, 'Go and preach what you please for, by Allah, I will not forsake you.'

- The Prophet pbuh and his family were boycotted for three years i.e., from 7th till 10th year of prophet hood and were forced to live in a narrow valley outside Makkah which is also known as Shib-e-Abu Talib. It was a time of difficulties and hardships but the Prophet pbuh remained steadfast.

- They also came up with another proposal that he should worship their gods and in return they would worship his God. Prophet told them that there would be no compromise as Allah guided him to declare, "You have your religion and I have my religion." [109:6]

- After Abu Talib's death, he visited Taif for preaching Islam but people of banu Saqeef persecuted him mercilessly. The makkans plotted to assassinate him, which forced him to migrate to Madina.

Followers / Early Converts:

- For the first few years the Prophet (pbuh) preached the message in secret. Initially only a handful of Muslims accepted Islam, the main ones being Khadija, Zaid, 'Ali and Abu Bakr, who in turn brought many people to Islam including, 'Uthman, Zubair ibn Awwam, and Talha. Other early converts were Bilal, Abu 'Ubaida, Abu Salamah. Prayer was established morning and evening. They would pray and practise their faith in secret, often praying in the mountains.

- The Prophet pbuh proclaimed the message of Islam openly on the mount of safa after the divine command for open preaching of Islam in 613 AD, "Expound openly what you are commanded and turn away from those who join false gods with Allah." [15:94]

He was rejected and after this event, period of persecutions and difficulties started for the prophet pbuh and his followers especially the poor and the weak.

- Another victim of the cruelty of Quraish was Ammar bin Yasir (R.A), a freed slave of Banu Makhzum, who had accepted Islam in its early days along with his parents. They were repeatedly made to lie on the burning sand and beaten. At times, Ammar was also thrown on burning embers.

- His parents Sumayya and Yasir were persecuted to death by Abu Jahl when they refused to abandon their faith. They were the first martyrs of Islam.

- Bilal bin Rabah (R.A) was the slave of Ummayah ibn Khalaf was severely beaten by his master. Sometimes, a rope was put around his neck and he was dragged by street boys around the streets and hiss of Makkah. He was deprived of food and drink, and one day during its hottest hour, he was bound and a heavy stone was put on his chest. He was then asked to renounce his faith, but he kept repeating 'One, One' to honour the oneness of Allah. Hazrat Abu Bakr was passing by and, moved by the sight, he purchased Bilal from his master and freed him.

Not only the poor and the weak but the rich and the noble Muslims were also persecuted.

- Once Abu Bakr(R.A) was pulled by his beard and was dragged through the streets of Makkah for protecting the Prophet pbuh.

- Usman(R.A) was wrapped in palm leaves and his uncle set fire around him so that he would be suffocated.

- Harith bin Abi Hala(R.A) was also killed by the Makkans when he was trying to protect the Prophet against his enemies.

- Zinra (R.A), a Roman slave girl was beaten and made blind by her master.

- Suhaib Rumi(R.A) was beaten so badly that he became unconscious,

- Khubaib -bin--Arat(R.A), a blacksmith was branded by his own tools; his body was burnt badly as they threw him on burning coal.

- Abdullah bin Masud(R.A) was persecuted mercilessly when he recited the Quran loudly near the Kaaba.

The poor and the weak Muslims were deprived of their possessions and their means of livelihood were taken away.

- Due to the severity of the persecutions, the Prophet (pbuh) told the believers to meet secretly at Dar al-Arqam, In 5th year of prophet hood/615AD the Prophet (S.A.W) permitted some of his followers specially the poor and the weak, to migrate to Abyssinia to the protection of the Christian king Negus. The Quraish followed them and demanded Negus to send them back. He called the emigrants and after listening to the speech of Jafar bin Abu Talib, he refused to send them back and the Makkans had to return unsuccessfully.

- The Prophet pbuh and his family Banu Hashim were boycotted for three years i.e., from 7th till 10th year of prophethood and were forced to live in a narrow valley outside Makkah which

is also known as Shib-e-Abu Talib. It was a time of difficulties and hardships but they remained steadfast. They were not allowed to worship at the Kaaba.

Isra wa Miraj (Night Journey and Ascension)

Intro:

- Isra and Miraj took place **on 27 Rajab, 11th** year of prophethood. By Allah's will, Holy Prophet (pbuh) was taken from the sacred mosque in Mecca to the farthest mosque, **Masjid al Aqsa** in Jerusalem In one night. On his way, he was shown some signs of Allah and he also performed prayer at some important places. The first part of the journey is referred as "**Isra,**" or the "**Nightly Journey.**" The Quran describes this event in these words,

***"Glory to Him who took his servant for a journey by night from the sacred mosque to the farthest mosque whose precincts We blessed. In order that We might show him some of our signs; for He is the one who hears and sees."** [17:1]*

Isra :

- According to a hadith, Prophet (pbuh) said, "while I was lying in al-Hateem, suddenly someone came to me and cut my body open Then he took out my heart. Then a gold tray full of beliefs was brought to me and my heart was washed and was filled and then returned to its original place. Then a white animal which was smaller than a mule and bigger than a donkey was brought to me(It was **Burraq**). I was carried on it and Jibrael set out with me".
- **It took him to Jerusalem**; Prophet (pbuh) tied the animal to the same ring on the door of Masjid Aqsa used by the other Prophets for their animals. The Prophet (pbuh) offered two Rakk'ahs prayer over there and **led all the Prophets** .Gabriel then brought **two vessels**; one was filled with wine and the other with milk. The Prophet (pbuh) chose the vessel filled with milk, and drank from it. Gabriel said, "**Praise be to Allah who guided you to Al-Fitra (the right path).**"

Miraj:

- The Prophet (pbuh) again rode the Buraq till he reached the lowest heaven. When Jibrael asked for the gate to be opened, it was asked, "Who is it?". Jibrael answered, "Jibrael". It was asked, "Who is accompanying you?" Jibrael replied, "Muhammad (pbuh)". It was asked, "Has Muhammad (pbuh) been called?". Jibrael replied in the affirmative. Then it was said, "He is welcomed. What an excellent visit his is."
- The gate was opened and on the first heaven Prophet (pbuh) saw prophet **Adam** sitting with a large group of people. Those on his left were the souls of his descendants who were the inhabitants of Hell, while those on his right were the inhabitants of Paradise. So when he looked at right side, he laughed and when he looked at his left side, he wept. The Prophet greeted Hazrat Adam. On second heaven he met prophet Yahya and prophet Isa. **On third heaven** Prophet Yusuf. **On the fourth** Prophet Idrees. On the **fifth**

prophet Haroon. On the **sixth** prophet Musa and on the **seventh** he met prophet Ibrahim.

Then came a point where angel Jibrael left the Prophet (pbuh), as he was not allowed to go beyond for his wings would burn. This point is called **Sidra-tul-Muntaha**.

- The Prophet (pbuh) went ahead alone and finally, he entered the presence of Allah himself. Here the **last verses of surah-tul-Baqarah** were revealed, and Allah promised that the **major sins of his followers would be forgiven, if they did not commit shirk**.
- It is narrated that during Mairaj the Prophet (P.B.U.H) had the opportunity to see Malik the keeper of Hell. He saw Paradise and Hell, and the two rivers of Paradise, Kauthar being one of them. **Fifty prayers** a day were made obligatory for the Muslims.

Return:

- On his return, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) informed Moses (P.B.U.H) about fifty prayers, **Moses** told him to have the prayers reduced, as his people would not be able to offer these. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) went back to Allah and the numbers were reduced by ten. Again, Moses (P.B.U.H) urged him to have the number reduced, which he did until it came down to five daily prayers. Moses again urged the Prophet (P.B.U.h) to go back and have the number further reduced but he refused saying **"I have asked my Lord till I am ashamed to face him"**. (Sahih Bukhari)
- When Prophet (pbuh) returned, the lock on his door was still moving as it was when he left his house. When Prophet (pbuh) narrated this event to Quraish, they made fun of him but when Prophet told them of trade caravan that he had seen on his way, his truthfulness was proved. Hazrat Abu Bakr believed and testified this experience and was given the title of **Siddique** i.e "testifier to the truth."

(b) What was the significance of this journey to the Prophet? [4]

- The Prophet (pbuh) had been through a period of difficulty and this event made him realise that God had not left him.
- It allowed him to see what he, and all Muslims, should be striving for which gave him renewed strength.
- He realised his status amongst prophets (as seal of the prophets), he led them in prayer, and realised the blessings God had given his community (by giving the five prayers), which gave him renewed hope in his message and he began to work towards better prospects for him and his community.
- It was one of the main miracles other than the Qur'an.

WEEK 02

DAY 03

Pledges of Aqabah and surrounding events

- Soon after Abu Talib's death conditions became unfavorable for the Prophet in Makkah because his worst enemy Abu Lahab became the chief of Quraish, which meant that the prophet had no clan protection. He decided to go to Taif to invite the people of Banu Saqeef tribe to Islam. He was accompanied by his freed slave and adopted son, Zaid bin Harith. He invited the 3 chiefs of the local tribes to Islam. They rejected his message and asked him to leave the town. He started preaching to the common people of the town. The chiefs became furious and asked their slaves and mischievous boys to drive him out of the town. They abused him and hurled stones at him. He was so severely injured that the blood trickled down his body and filled his shoes. He took refuge in an orchard. Angel Jibrail appeared with the angel of mountains and offered him to destroy the town but he forgave them and prayed for their guidance.
- The Holy Prophet returned from Taif to Makkah and resumed his preaching. He had started preaching to the pilgrims who came to Makkah each year. In the eleventh year of prophet hood (620A.D) six pilgrims from the tribe of khazraj in Yasrib Came to Makkah. They embraced the faith after hearing the teaching of Islam by the prophet. When they went back to Yasrib they introduced Islam to their friends and relatives. Thus the message of Islam reached Yasrib.
- Later in 12th year of prophet hood/ 621 AD twelve persons, two of whom belonged to the Aws clan, met the Holy Prophet and accepted the faith and pledged to abstain from all the un-Islamic practices i.e stealing, adultery, killing their children, slandering or disobeying the prophet etc and to lead a righteous life believing in one Allah. In this first Pledge of Aqabah they vowed: "We pledge our allegiance to the Messenger of Allah that we would associate nothing with Allah, that we would neither steal, nor commit fornication, nor slay our offspring, nor utter slanders; and that we would not disobey him in that which is right." These people promised to spread Islam in Yasrib and the Holy Prophet sent Musab bin Umair with them to preach Islam to the residents of the city. This pledge is also known as "pledge of women" (Bait e Nisa) because fighting was not mentioned in it.
- In 13th year of prophet hood (622A.D) a deputation consisting of 73 men and 2 women came from Yasrib to take the same Pledge. This is called the second Pledge of Aqabah. They promised to listen and obey the Prophet, to spend in plenty as well as in scarcity for the cause of Islam, to enjoin upon good and forbid evil, fear no one but Allah and to defend the Prophet against his enemies if he needed and to lay down their lives for the cause of Islam. They also invited the Prophet to Yasrib and pledged full support for him. Here, Bara, a chieftain of Yathrib, took the Prophet (P.B.U.H) and swore: "By Him who sent you with the truth, we will protect you as we protect them (our wives and children). So accept the pledge of our allegiance, O Messenger of Allah, for we are men of war, possessed arms that have been handed down from father to son." The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) replied: "I am yours and you are mine. Whom you war against, him I war against. Whom you make peace with, him I make peace with."
- When the unbelievers came to know of these developments they redoubled their persecution, so the Prophet allowed his companions to secretly migrate to Yasrib and family after family left in this manner. All the companions were able to migrate except Hazrat Abu Bakr and Hazrat Ali.
- Mut'im, the Nawfal chieftain who had become Hazrat Muhammad's protector from the time of the Taif incident, passed away soon after the second pledge of Aqabah; with his death, the Prophet (P.U.H.H) was once more vulnerable to the violence of the Quraish. Abu Jahal now perfected a plot to murder him. The Quraish held a meeting in the council hall, "Dar-un-Nadwa" where it was decided that one person from each tribe should be selected who would simultaneously attack the Prophet and kill him. Abu Lahab, now the chief

of the Banu Hashim, was not informed of this plan, but the understanding was that he, being a strong opponent of Islam and the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), would accept the blood money and settle the issue.

The prophet was informed of this plan of his enemies by Allah and was told to leave Makkah that same night: **“Remember how the unbelievers plotted against you, to keep you in bonds or slay thee, or get you out (of your home). They plot and plan, and Allah too plans, But the best of planners is Allah.”**

The Holy Prophet asked Ali to sleep in his bed, and then he quietly left the house unnoticed. Accompanied by Abu Bakr, he made his way to Yasrib.

3(b) In your view, why should Muslims provide a safe haven for others? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

- They should provide a safe haven for people who are fleeing persecution, such as those fleeing the war in Afghanistan / Syria etc. and their governments should provide shelter and basic facilities for them.
- It is from the teachings of Islam to care for others and to provide the basic needs of fellow human beings.
- Muslims could also provide a safe haven for those who have lost their families, especially children who are now orphaned, whether it be due to war or famine or natural disasters.
- Providing homes and shelter for them would allow them to start a new life much like Muslims of Makka started a new life due to the invitation of the Madinans.
- Also, the Prophet said that the person who looks after an orphan will be with him in paradise.

Migration to Madina

- Mut'im, the Nawfal chieftain who had become Hazrat Muhammad's (P.B.U.H) protector from the time of the Taif incident, passed away soon after the second pledge of Aqabah; with his death, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) was once more vulnerable to the violence of the Quraish. Abu Jahal now perfected a plot to murder him. The Quraish held a meeting in the council hall, **“Dar-un-Nadwa”** where it was decided that one person from each tribe should be selected who would simultaneously attack the Prophet (P.B.U.H) and kill him. Abu Lahab, now the chief of the Banu Hashim, was not informed of this plan, but the understanding was that he, being a strong opponent of Islam and the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), would accept the blood money and settle the issue.

The prophet was informed of this plan of his enemies by Allah and was told to leave Makkah that same night: **“Remember how the unbelievers plotted against you, to keep you in bonds or slay thee, or get you out (of your home). They plot and plan, and Allah too plans, But the best of planners is Allah.”** (Al-Anfal 8:30)

- The Prophet (P.B.U.H) escaped secretly at night leaving behind Ali to sleep in his bed and to return the valuables entrusted to him by people. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) came out of his house and threw dust at the assassins, and they could not see him as he recited the following verse. **“And We have put before them a barrier and behind them a barrier and covered them, so they do not see”**. [36:9]
- Prophet (P.B.U.H) and Hazrat Abu Bakr left Makkah during the night on a pair of camels and made their way to a cave in Mount Thaur. Hazrat Abu Bakr's son and his freed slave **Amr ibn Fuhayrah**, followed behind with a flock of sheep to cover up their tracks. Abu Bakr went with him; they took refuge in Cave Thaur; Abu Bakr went in to make sure it was clean and safe; At that time **Abu Bakr was bitten by a scorpion or a snake** as he had put his foot on one of the holes that was left unfilled, but he did not cry out as the prophet was sleeping in his lap.
- Next morning, when the chiefs of Makka found Ali in Hazrat Muhammad's (P.B.U.H) bed they were furious. Determined more than ever to find him, they offered a huge reward of one hundred red camels for his capture, dead or alive. Many young men of Quraish went out in search of Prophet (P.B.U.H) and came close to the cave. Some members of the quraish party climbed upto the cave and the foremost of them

turned around as he saw the cave entrance. His companion asked him why he did not go into the cave. He answered, "Its entrance is covered with cobwebs and there is a pair of wild pigeons on the threshold. Obviously, no one could have gone in without disturbing the pigeons and destroying the cobwebs". The Quraish were further convinced that the cave was empty when they saw its entrance covered with branches growing from a nearby tree. They agreed to leave and called one another to return to Makkah

- Hazrat Abu Bakr trembled with fear and expected them to break in the cave. He said to the holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), if any one of them looks down he will find us. To this the holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) answered, "**O Abu Bakr, how can you fear for two men whose constant companion is Allah Himself**"

This incident mentioned in Quran in the following words, "**For Allah did indeed help him, when the unbelievers drove him out: he had no more than one companion the two were in the cave and he said to his companion, have no fear, for Allah is with us**" (9:40).

During their brief stay at the cave, **Abdullah** son of Abu bakr brought the news of Quraish, while **Asma** daughter of Abu Bakr, brought them food, and **Amr Bin Fuhaira**, the freed slave of Abu Bakr, used to bring the milk sheep to provide them with fresh milk. After spending three days in the cave, they set out for Madinah.

- One of the Makkans **Suraqa bin Malik** almost caught up with them but could not get near because his horse kept stumbling and he finally abandoned his desire of capturing Muhammad(P.B.U.H).
- Prophet (pbuh) also stopped at the tents of **Aatikah bint Khalf** also known as **umm e Mu'abd**. Hazrat Abu Bakr (R.A) asked her as if she had some dates and mutton to sell. She replied, in negative. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) saw a weak goat standing in one corner of her tent and sought her permission to milk the goat. He touched the goat's udder with His blessed hands and immediately it filled with milk. All those present drank till their satisfaction. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) milked it a second time and all the pots of her house were filled with the milk.
- After under taking **six days of journey** the Prophet (P.B.U.H) arrived at Quba, a place near Yathrib on **23rd September 622 A.D.** He stayed at the place of fourteen days during which he built a mosque. That was the first mosque of Islam; the Prophet (P.B.U.H) himself participated in the building of the mosque at Quba. Ali R.A joined him in Quba. Eighty people from Banu Aslam also accepted Islam. On his way from Quba to Madinah, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) offered his first Friday congregational prayers at the **quarters of Banu Saleem**, and delivered his first Friday sermon.
- Meanwhile the people of Madinah waited for the Prophet (P.B.U.H) eagerly. In their delight, the girls of the Ansar sang to greet the Prophet. On the day the Messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) arrived, the people had just gone back into their houses. The first person to see him was a Jew, thus fulfilling the prophecy contained in the Torah. In Madinah, the people greeted the Messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) enthusiastically. Children were singing as he arrived. Everyone was eager that he should stay with him. They grabbed the halter of his camel **Qaswa**, but the Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, "**Let it go its own way, It is under orders.**" Eventually the camel stopped at the home of Banu Malik Ibn al-Najjar. By herself, she knelt at a place, which today marks the door of the Prophet's mosque. It belonged to two orphan boys, Sahil and Suhail, of the Banu Najjar. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) paid them the price of the land and built the mosque of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) (**Masjid-al-nabvi**). While the mosque was being built, he stayed at the house of **Abu Ayub al Ansari**.

5. (b) What was the significance of this journey for the Muslims? [4]

- The importance of migration can be judged from the fact that the Muslim calendar starts from this event and not from any other incident in the life of the Prophet (P.B.U.H).
- The migration not only completely altered the prevailing conditions of Arabia, but it changed the entire course of human history.
- The hijra reshaped the Arab peninsula socially and politically and also had an impact on worldwide civilization.
- Muslims before migration used to pray secretly for fear of the unbelievers. As they were weak and in minority. They became strong enough to stand against injustice and persecution.
- Prophet also got the chance to organize his followers into a disciplined community.

- Muslims became one nation and Madina became the place where Prophet's call received response and continued to grow and expand.

Muzammil Mehmood

WEEK 03

DAY 01 (Paper 01)

First Year after Hijra

- On the day the Messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) arrived at Madina, the people had just gone back into their houses. The first person to see him was a Jew, thus fulfilling the prophecy contained in the Torah. In Madinah, the people greeted the Messenger of Allah (P.B.U.H) enthusiastically. Children were singing as he arrived. Everyone was eager that he should stay with him. The Prophet grabbed the halter of his camel, but the Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **"Let it go its own way, it is under orders."** Eventually the camel stopped at the home of Banu Malik Ibn al-Najjar. By herself, she knelt at a place, which today marks the door of the Prophet's mosque. It belonged to two orphan boys, Sahil and Suhail, of the Banu Najjar. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) paid them the price of the land and built the mosque of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) (**Masjid-al-nabvi**). While the mosque was being built, he stayed at the house of **Abu Ayub al Ansari**.
- The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) himself worked hard with the companions to complete the building. This mosque was known as the "Mosque of the Prophet" or **Masjid-e-Nabawi**. It is referred to in the Quran in the following words:

"There is a mosque whose foundation was laid from the first day on piety; it is more worthy of thy standing forth (for prayer) therein. In it are men who love to be purified, and Allah loveth those who make themselves pure." (9:108)

- After the construction of Masjid e Nabwi Muslims felt the need to find a way to inform people to come to congregational prayer. The Prophet (pbuh) asked his companions for their advice. Some suggested that the Muslims, like the Jews, should **blow a horn** to announce the time for the prayer. Others said, the Muslims might ring bells as the Christians do in their churches. A few proposed that the Muslims, like the fire-worshippers, **kindle a fire** to call people to pray. Yet other suggested the beating of drums but the Prophet (pbuh) did not approve any of these because it resembled the unbelievers. **Hazrat Umar** suggested that people should be called to prayer in human voice. The Prophet (pbuh) waited to hear a better idea or to receive guidance from Allah.
One day, a companion, **'Abdullah ibn Zaid**, came and said, "O Messenger of Allah! I had a beautiful dream last night."
The Prophet (pbuh) asked, "What was the dream you saw?".
Zaid answered, "I have seen that a man wearing green garments taught me the words of the 'Adhan and advised me to call people to prayer with these words." He then recited the words for the 'Adhan.
The words were beautiful and full of meaning. The Prophet (pbuh) recognized that the dream of 'Abdullah bin Zaid was true. He asked 'Abdullah to teach the words of the 'Adhan **to Bilal**, who had a loud and beautiful voice. Thus he was appointed as the **Muezzin**.
- The Muslims in Madinah belonged to two categories. Those who had migrated to Madinah from Makkah were known as Muhajirin or emigrants. Those who belonged to Madinah and had given shelter to the emigrants and helped them were known as Ansar or the Helpers. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) established brotherhood between these two groups of Muslims. He told the Ansar that the Muhajirin were in need of help, and so he wanted to create

brotherhood between them. The Ansar willingly agreed to this. The Holy Quran mentioned this in these words: **“Those who believed and adopted exile, and fought for the faith, with their property and their persons, in the cause of Allah, as well as those who gave (them) asylum and aid, these are (all) friends and protector, one of another.”(8:72)**

- Even the enmity between the two tribes of Madinah, Aus and Khazraj was forgotten, as mentioned in the Holy Quran; **“....And remember with gratitude Allah’s favour on you; for he were enemies and He joined yours heart in love, so that by His grace, ye became brethren...”(3:103)**
- There were **three** main tribes of Jews; **Banu Qainuqa, Banu Nazir and Banu Quraiza**, settled in the suburbs of Madinah in their own strong fortresses. As soon as the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was settled in Madinah, he called together the Muslims and the Jewish tribes for consultation. After an exchange of views, an agreement was reached which granted
 - equal rights to the Jews with full liberty to follow their own faith without any interference by the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) or his followers.
 - It stated that the Muslims and Jews were allies and would help each other,
 - that neither party would commit aggression against the other,
 - and that in case of an attack on Madinah, both Muslims and Jews would defend it.
 - It also guaranteed protection of their life and property
 - the Treaty also established the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.,H) as the leader and the head of the State of Madinah.

The name of the town was changed from Yathrib to **Madina tul Nabi i.e City of the Prophet.**

5(b) **How can Muslims apply this model of brotherhood to help their communities?**

or

(b) What lessons can Muslims learn from the brotherhood that was created in Madina? [4]

- Islam establishes human brotherhood on the basis of faith. Allah describes the believers as being brother. **“The believers are but brothers” [49:10]**
- Brotherhood between Muhajirin and Ansar reminds the Muslims that the feeling of brotherhood is an essential prerequisite for unity. It guarantees the safety and the well-being of the society at large.
- Muslims can help by looking to see what they can offer others. Help can be in any form, e.g., financial assistance to poor, youth services, challenging social injustice etc.
- Muslims may live in areas where people from another country have come to settle, whether it be because they are fleeing from persecution for example Kashmir, Palestine etc or to seek work. Muslims can help them by finding out about them, asking if they need any help, providing food/clothing/information and /or by helping them to integrate.

Charter of Madina

- In 622 A.D. Prophet Muhammad (pbuh) migrated to Yathrib (Madinah) together with his followers after receiving an invitation from the Arab tribes of Yathrib. At that time, Yathrib was a pluralistic society composed of people of different religions with a large population of Jews. These tribes were engaged in bitter quarrels and often went to war over disputes that had been going on for generations. There were 2 tribes of Arabs divided **Aws and Khazraj** and Jewish tribes including **Banu Nadir, Banu Quraiza and Bani Qainuqa**. They had been waiting for the arrival of a prophet, but they

had expected him to come from the lineage of Ishaq. There were also some Christians living there.

- The continuous state of anarchy in Madinah eventually forced the residents to seek options for peace. They agreed to make a prominent tribal chief, **Abdullah ibn Ubay** bin Salool, their king so that peace and harmony could be achieved. Around this time, Prophet Muhammad (SAW) arrived in Madinah and the tide turned against Abdullah bin Ubay. Since the Prophet was viewed as a respectable, honest and trustworthy person, he was requested to head the soon to be city-state of Madinah.
- After assuming a central role in Madinah, the Prophet recognized a few pressing needs, which included: Determining the rights and responsibilities of the local population as well as the immigrants from Makkah. Making agreements with the non-Muslim population of Madinah, especially the Jews, to ensure peace and harmony. Creating a strategy and plan to defend the city against invasions. Making resources available for the immigrants to make a living.
- The strong need to create a centralized government in Madinah to end the prevailing anarchy culminated in the creation of the Charter of Madinah. It is divided into two parts; the first part deals with the rules and regulations for Muslim immigrants (Muhajirin) and Muslim natives (Ansar) and the second part deals with the rights and responsibilities of the Jews of Madinah. This charter contains 47 clauses, which laid the foundations of a sovereign nation-state comprising of Muslims, Jews and Pagans, having equal rights and responsibilities under a common citizenship.

➤ The salient features of this charter include:

- equal rights to the Jews with full liberty to follow their own faith without any interference by the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) or his followers.
- It stated that the Muslims and Jews were allies and would help each other,
- that neither party would commit aggression against the other,
- and that in case of an attack on Madinah, both Muslims and Jews would defend it.
- It also guaranteed protection of their life and property
- Treaty also established the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) as the leader and the head of the State of Madinah. In the event of a dispute among the signatories, Prophet Muhammad (SAW) was the final authority for settling the dispute
- A system of financial aid was developed within each tribe and between tribes. Communal funds were set up which were used in times of financial need such as to pay ransom or blood-money
- The Quraysh of Makkah were to be boycotted commercially by all signatories and nobody was to extend any support to them.

The constitution meant that the rights of all citizens were safeguarded, and initially the relations between the different groups remained sound. They engaged in commercial dealings with each other and gave and received help from each other.

WEEK 03
DAY 02 (Paper 01)
Battle of Badr

- The Battle of Badr was the first battle between Muslims of Madinah and Quraish of Mecca that took place in **624 A.D. / 2nd A.H.** After the migration of Madinah, the relations between them were not good as the Holy Prophet (PBUH) had captured their trade routes. The Muslims had heard of a **Meccan caravan** passing near Madinah, and they waited for it near the wells of Badr. As **Abu Sufyan**, who was leading the caravan feared that Muslims might intercept it, he sent a messenger to Makkah with an urgent plea for help.
- The Meccans immediately raised an army of about **1300 men under Abu Jahl to escort the caravan** safely back to Mecca. Meanwhile, Abu Sufyan reached Makkah safely from another route and asked the army to return. However, some of the leaders like Abu Jahl insisted on attacking the Muslims. Some of the Makkans left and the strength came down to **1000**.
 - When the Holy Prophet (PBUH) heard about the Meccan army advancing, he consulted his companions and decided to fight against the Makkani army. He immediately raised an army of Muslims. Quraish reached Badr first and encamped there. Muslims though encamped later were able to occupy the wells. Both armies were badly mismatched. There were **313 Muslims** who had to fight over 1000 Quraish. In addition to this, the Muslim army was ill-equipped having **2 horses and 70 camels**. On the other hand, the Quraish army was well-equipped having **200 horses and 700 camels**.
 - The Prophet (S.A.W) spent the night, praying to Allah for the victory; he prayed,
“O Allah! if this small band of men perish, there will be no one alive to worship you. And your faith will be destroyed forever.” (Sahih Bukhari)
Holy Prophet (PBUH)’s prayer for the Muslims was accepted by Allah that is mentioned in the Holy Quran which says,
“When you sought aid from your Lord, He answered you: I will surely assist you with a thousand of the angels ranks on ranks.” [8:9]
 - It rained the night before the battle. The ground on which Muslims stood was sandy so rain proved to be a mercy as it made the ground smooth and the sand firm. The Quran says, **“He sent down Water for you from heavens to confirm your feet.”**
 - The battle took place on **17th of Ramadan, 2AH / 624AD**. Both the armies arranged themselves in ranks on the Friday morning. Al Aswad bin Abu Asad was the first non-believer to step forward after the war of words but he was killed by Hamza. Then the duels took place in which Hamza killed Utba, Ali killed Waleed bin Utba. Then they both assisted Ubaidah bin Haris to kill his opponent Shaibah. Ubaidah was the first Martyr at this battle.
 - After this the general battle began. According to the Prophet’s (PBUH) instructions, Muslims first shot arrows at the Makkans men threw stones and lastly fought with swords in their hands. During the battle, Ali killed Abu Sufyan’s son Hanzala, Hazrat Bilal killed his

former master **Umayya bin Khalaf**. When the battle was heated, Prophet (PBUH) took a handful of dust and threw it at the faces of the pagans saying, "May your faces be disfigured." It caused a sandstorm, the Quran says, "**It was not you who slew them ; It was Allah: when you thrust (handful of dust) was not your act but Allah's... "** (CH 8:V17)

- The Makkans had to face heavy losses and they fled in confusion leaving behind **70 dead and 70 prisoners**. Their leader Abu Jahl was injured by two Muslim brothers **Ma'uz and Mu'az** and then was killed by Abdullah bin Masood. Abu Bakr, Abdur Rehman bin Auf, Talha etc had formed a defensive ring around The Prophet (PBUH) A large amount of spoils of war was also captured that was distributed among the Muslims. Among the prisoners were Prophet's uncle Abbas, Hazrat Ali's brother Aqeel and Prophet's son in law Abul Aas. **Only 14 Muslims got Martyred , 6 Muhajirin and 8 Ansar.**

- The Holy Prophet (PBUH) surprised everyone by **treating the captured Meccans honourably**. He freed most of the prisoners on simple terms and conditions. The ones who could pay were freed after they paid their ransom. The literate ones were freed after a certain period in which each one of them was required to teach 10 Muslim children. The poor and the old captives were freed without ransom.

3(b) Can the Prophet's conduct during this battle (Badr) contain lessons for military leaders today? Give reasons for your answer.

- Bravery and courage
- Depending upon God for victory and not numeric strength and material resources.
- Consultation about war strategies.
- Leading from the front.
- Not taking initiative in fighting.
- Kind treatment of prisoners

Battle of Uhad

- After the battle of Badr, Islam gained a firm footing at Madinah and the importance of the city began to increase. The Quraish considered the rise of Madinah as a threat to their political and commercial interest. Moreover, they could not forget their defeat in the battle of Badr. Several of their important leaders were killed in the battle, and they wanted to avenge their deaths. **Abu Sufyan, the commander of the Quraish army**, went to meet the Jews of Banu Nazir, who promised help. He also hired their poet **Kaab bin Ashraf** to write ridiculing poetry against the Prophet. He and other Jewish poets wrote poems to instigate the Quraish to fight against the Muslims. Another immediate reason of the battle was the capture of one of their trade caravans by the Prophet's adopted son, **Zaid bin Harith**. Meetings were held where it was decided to collect funds and raise a strong army for attacking Madinah and wiping out the Muslims. Some other tribes also invited to join in this war.

- Finally, a fully armed force of three thousand men left Makkah for Madinah with **200 horses and 3000 camels**. The Prophet was the news of Makkan army through one of his uncle Abbas bin Abdul Mutlaib.

- The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) consulted his companions about the best way to meet the enemy. The consensus of opinion was that the **Muslims should go out of Madinah to meet the enemy**. Although the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) had a different opinion, yet when the majority insisted on meeting the enemy outside Madinah, he agreed.

- **Three miles to the north of Madinah**, the Quraish camped near the hill of Uhad. On the way, **Abdullah bin Ubbay**, the leader of the **hypocrites**, **deserted** with three hundred of his men on the excuse that the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) had turned down his suggestion of fighting the enemy from inside the city. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) with the remaining **seven hundred men**, reached Uhad and also set up camp.
- He posted **fifty archers** under **Abdullah bin Jubair** to protect the pass in the Uhad mountain and defend the Muslims from any possible attack by the enemy from behind. They were given strict instructions not to leave their post under any circumstances.
- Several **Quraish women** accompanied the army of the pagans including Hinda, the daughter of Utba;; Umm-e-Hakeem, the granddaughter of Abu Jahl, **Muslim women** also took part for the first time. Among them were Aisha, Umm Salama and Umm Ammara.
- When the two armies came face to face, Abu Sufyan asked the Ansar to leave for he said his fight was not with them. The Muslims, however, stayed united and firm. When the two armies clashed, the Muslim archers fired a volley of arrows into the cavalry of the Makkans led by Khalid ibn al-Waleed, causing chaos in the ranks. Talha ibn Abi Talha, who was the standard-bearer of the Makkans, came forward and shouted for a man to meet him in single combat. Hazrat Ali R.A stepped forward and killed him with a blow. The Makkan standard was taken by Talha's brother who was struck down by Hazrat Hamza R.A.
- The battle was fiercely fought and the Makkans were being pushed back and killed. Abu Sufyan narrowly escaped an attack. The Muslim advance continued until the enemy lines were broken altogether and the way to their camp was thus laid open. **Khalid bin Walid** tried to break the Muslims from behind three times but the archers held him off. Muslims got an advantage and the Makkans started to flee from the battlefield in all directions.
- The archers posted to guard the rear of the Muslim army took his as signal to come down and collect the spoils of war. Khalid ibn al-Waleed, noticing this fatal error on the part of the archers, attacked the unprotected Muslims. panic now set in and despite the Prophet (P.B.U.H) calls, many of the Muslim warriors, who had fought bravely, rushed for safety to the upper slopes of Uhad. Many, however, stayed and fought; a group of nine Muslims made a protective shield around Prophet (P.B.U.H).
- The enemy tried to reach the spot where the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was. He was wounded in the head and face and lost his teeth. They killed the Muslim flag bearer **Musab bin Umair who resembled the Prophet**. The enemy raised the cry that the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was killed and the confusion increased.
- The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), however, stood firmly and called out to his companions to come back. **Ka'ab bin Malik** announced that the Prophet was still alive. When the Muslims saw their leader, they rejoined the battle. Soon, more support came to the Prophet (P.B.U.H) and a group of his companions moved him to a well-protected area at the foot of the mountain.
- Now the fighting was less one-sided. The Muslims who had rallied put up a determined fight. Both parties were, however, extremely exhausted. Soon the fighting died down and each army prepared to leave. Before leaving Abu Sufyan challenged for a battle next year at Badr and the Prophet accepted his challenge.
- In this encounter **63(70) Muslims** were killed and forty injured; while the enemy lost only 22 of their men. Wahshi al Harb killed Hazrat Hamzah with a spear. Hinda mutilated the corpse and chewed his liver in order to avenge the death of her father, Utba, killed in the Battle of Badr at the hands of Hamza.

The Holy Quran mentions this battle in these words:

“Allah did indeed fulfill His promise to you, when ye, with His permission, were about to annihilate your enemy, until ye flinched and fell to disputing about the order and disobeyed it after He brought in sight (of the booty) which ye covet. Among you are some that hanker after this world and some that desire the Hereafter---.” (3:152)

“Those of you who turned back on the day the two hosts met, --- it was Satan who caused them to fail,---.” (3:155)

(b) ‘Success for Muslims depends on their obedience to the Prophet.’ Discuss this statement in relation to Muslims today. [4]

- The defeat at Uhud occurred due to the fact that the archers did not obey the Prophet’s command, therefore, Muslims should obey the Prophet.
- The rules and guidance of Islam is based on the Qur’an and also the sunna and so to truly practise Islam the way of the Prophet has to be followed.
- In battle, Muslims should stick to the rules that the Prophet gave, like not harming the environment or women and children, and this can give Muslims success as they are following the commands of God, which they will be rewarded for.
- In their everyday lives Muslims can obey the Prophet’s commands as to how to live their lives, in terms of prayer, being good to people, etc., and this will make them successful in their lives as the guidance given is all for their betterment.

WEEK 03

DAY 03 (Paper 01)

Battle of Trench: 5A.H/627AD

- After the punishment and exile from Madinah by the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), the Jews wanted to take revenge from Muslims. A delegation of Jewish leaders therefore went to Quraish to incite them against the Muslims and promised them their full support. They gave the same promise to the tribe of Banu Ghatafan and Banu Sulaiyam. The upper hand of Quraish in the battle of Uhad motivated the Makkans and all other enemies.
- This time they assembled a large force of **10,000 soldiers** under the command of **Abu Sufyan**. Amongst the Army: 4,000 well-armed foot-soldiers, 3,000 horsemen in full armour, 1,500 camels loaded with provision, 1,000 camel-riding soldiers and several hundred well-armed soldiers of other tribes.
- At the same time horsemen from the **Banu Khuza'a** left to warn the Prophet of the invading army.
- As usual the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) consulted his companions, In the counsel, he appreciated the opinion of Hazrat **Salman Farsi (RA)** who suggested digging a trench around the city of Madinah in order to fortify it.
- On three sides of the city, there were rows of houses, orchards and oasis which served as fortification only one side was unprotected. A trench, **five yards deep and five yards broad** was dug. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) himself demarcated the site and worked like a labourer. 3,000 Muslims completed the trench in 20 days. In winter nights, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) and his companions worked sometimes without food for days.
- The Allied forces were confident of an easy and quick victory. They advanced determinedly upon the city. But they came to an abrupt halt when they found a deep and long trench between them and the city. The trench warfare was quite unfamiliar to the Makkans and their allies. The Muslims compelled them to stay at an adequate distance from the trench by hurling stone and arrows at them. Thus, began the siege of Madinah, which lasted for about **27 days**. There was little food and water; **Jabir** invited the Prophet (pbuh) to eat after slaughtering a sheep, and the prophet fed the whole army with this one animal; The Quraysh tried to cross the trench, a couple of riders managed to cross a part that was narrower; 'Ali fought them off; On this occasion, Amr bin Abd Wad, an undefeated warrior of Quraish, challenged the Muslims for a duel. Hazrat Ali accepted his challenge and killed him.
- **The hypocrites** in the Muslim army, finding the situation dangerous, asked permission from the Holy Prophet to return to their homes on the excuse that their homes were not safe in this connection the Quran says, "**Behold! A party among them said: "Ye men of Yathrib! ye cannot stand (the attack)! therefore go back!" And a band of them ask for leave of Muhammad, saying, "Truly our houses are bare and exposed," though they were not exposed they intended nothing but to run away.**"[33:13]
- At the first **Banu Quraiza** had refused to support the unbelievers. But later they also came out against the Muslims and broke their treaty with the holy Prophet. Thus there was a mighty attack on Muslims from all sides. For this reason, the battle is also called Battle of Ahzab or the battle of Allies. The Quran says, "**Behold! They came on you from above you and from below you, and behold! The eyes became dim and the hearts gaped up to the throats, and ye imagined various thoughts about Allah! In that situation were the Believers tried: they were shaken as by a tremendous shaking.**" (33:10-11).
- The Prophet (pbuh) used strategic skills to create mistrust between the alliances, sending Nuaym bin Mas'ud to sow seeds of mistrust between the allies.
- A month had passed since the siege began. The Arabs were not accustomed to such a long drawn war. Their supplies began to run short. Moreover, it was winter with rain and icy cold winds. Because of

the shortage of food, forage and bad weather, a large number of their camels and horses died. ALLAH sent a severe windstorm to the confederate forces, as well as His angels on a very cold day. The wind blew down their tents and their cooking gear and the angels threw fear and terror into their hearts. They hurriedly left, leaving behind all their possessions. - This encounter known as Battle of Tribes (ahzab) / Battle of Trench (khandaq) ended in disgrace for the Meccans and their strength was broken forever.

- This is referred in the Holy Quran that says, ***"... Remember Allah's blessing on you when hosts came down on you (to overwhelm you) : but we sent against them a hurricane and forces ye saw not, but Allah sees all that you do" [33:9]***

- Finally, **Banu Quraiza**, the last major tribe left in Madinah, showed treachery in the Battle of Ditch in **627 AD**. They broke the treaty with the Muslims, conspired with the Quraish and planned to attack the Muslims from rear. A siege was laid on their fortresses that lasted for **25 days**. After this siege, as a punishment of their treachery decided by **Saad bin Muaaz**, around 600 – 700 men from Banu Quraiza were executed and their wives and children were sold as slaves. The Quran refers to this incident in these words, ***"And those of the people of the book who aided them- Allah did take them down from their strongholds and cast terror into their hearts, (so that) some ye slew, and some you made prisoners . And He made you heirs of their lands, their houses and their goods----"***[33:26-27]

4(b) What can Muslims learn from the Prophet's involvement in the digging of the trench?

- The Prophet (pbuh) was the leader of the army and yet he took part in digging the trench, despite his severe hunger.
- This teaches Muslims that no matter what their position, whether heads of state or community leaders, they should take part in hard work required for the benefit of the community or others.
- It also provides a lesson in patience and perseverance, and that God will help if you don't give up.
- It also teaches humility, that you do not think yourself above certain types of work.

****Elaborate with present Day example***

TREATY OF HUDAIBIYA 6A.H/628 A.D

Background:

- The Prophet saw a dream to visit Kaabah and decided to perform Umra.

The Quran says, ***"Truly did Allah fulfil the vision for His Messenger: ye shall enter the Sacred Mosque, if Allah wills, with minds secure, and without fear."*** (48:27)

About 1400 unarmed Muslims, clad in two sheets of unsewn cloth, departed for Mecca in February, **628 A.D. / 6 A.H.**

- The Muslim had left Madina in a State of ihram, so were prohibited from fighting. As the Meccans refused to allow them to enter, they stayed at Hudabiyah close to Mecca.
- For negotiations with Quraish 2 messengers were sent one after the other but they were detained and finally **Hazrat Usman** was sent. When he did not return , a rumour broke out that he was killed.
- After hearing this, the Prophet called his companions to take a pledge on his hand to lay down their lives for the sake of Islam and avenge the blood of Hazrat Usman. The Quran says, ***"Allah indeed was pleased with the believers, when the swore allegiance to you under the tree and He knew what was in their hearts, so he sent down peace on them and rewarded them with clear victory."*** [48:18]

As this oath was taken for God's pleasure under a tree, it is known as '**Bait-e-Rizwan**'. Apprehended by this, the Quraish sent the messengers including Hazrat Usman back.

It also influenced the Quraish into negotiating a treaty. They sent **Sohail bin Amr** to negotiate a peace treaty.

(TERMS/CLAUSES)

1. -Muslims would return to Madinah that year without performing Umrah.
2. -They would be permitted to come for Pilgrimage next year but would stay only for three days in Makkah.
3. -If a Quraish from Makkah should join the Muslims without permission from his guardians, he would be sent back to Makkah. But if a Muslim from Madinah went to Makkah he would not be sent back.
4. -There would be no fighting for ten years.
5. Muslims would be allowed to visit Makkah and Makkans would be allowed to go to Syria through Muslim area and their trade caravans would not be attacked by the Muslims.
6. -Any of the Arab tribes might enter into treaty or alliance with either Muslims or Quraish.
7. It was also decided that they would not fight against the allies of each other.

After:

- Apparently, the terms of the treaty were against the interest of the Muslims, and many Muslims including Hazrat **Umar were unhappy** with these terms. Umar asked why the Muslims were demeaning their religion and was reassured by Abu Bakr and the Prophet.
- **Ali was chosen to write the treaty.** When the Prophet asked him to write in the name of Allah, the merciful, the compassionate or that the Prophet was the Messenger of Allah. Suhail objected and instead the Prophet erased it and had Ali write in your name O God and Muhammad son of Abdullah to which the Muslims protested.
- At that point Suhail bin Amr's sons **Abu Jandal** came to the Prophet asking to be freed. But the Prophet kept to the terms of the treaty and told him to be patient. Once they completed the document the Prophet asked the Muslims to sacrifice their animals and shave their heads.
- The Prophet said that Muslims had been victorious and was supported in this by new revelation "Verily we have granted thee a manifest victory" (48:1)
- **The Khuza'a tribe** made a pact with the Muslims and **the Banu Bakr made** a pact with the Quraish.

(b) From this event, what can Muslims learn about the importance of keeping their word? [4]

- The Prophet kept his word to the Quraysh for the duration of the treaty. Even before the treaty was finished being written, he sent Abu Jandal back to the Quraysh, on account of an agreement having been made verbally.
- This shows the importance of promising to do something, then fulfilling that action, even if it has not been put into writing.
- As all actions and agreements are recorded by angels, God knows what has been promised and by fulfilling promises, no matter how hard it is, then God will reward you accordingly.
- So, e.g. politicians should not go back on the things they promise when they want to be elected, or people should not take back something that they have promised to give a friend.

WEEK 04
DAY 01 (Paper 01)

7th Year after Hijrah

The Expedition of Khyber:

- Some ten weeks after the treaty of Hudaibiya, the malice of the Jews increased to a greater intensity. The treaty of Hudaibiya led them to think that the Muslims were weak. They imagined that their acceptance of such humiliating terms could be due to nothing but weakness. They, therefore, got in touch with all those who had agreed to help them in their fight against the Muslims, asking them to prepare to march toward Madinah.
 - When the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) came to know about the proposed plot of the Jews to attack Madinah, he launched into prompt and immediate action. This time, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) considered it more proper to go to Khyber swiftly, lest the Jews should seize the chance of advancing on Madinah. Thus, he set out with 1600 believers from Madinah in the month of Muharram of 7 A.H/628AD and reached Khyber, the strongest and most fortified settlement of the Jews, in three days.
 - The Jews were surprised when they saw the Muslims marching on toward Khyber, they immediately rushed to their fortresses. There were several fortified quarters and 7 big forts in Khyber. Qamus, (An-Nizar) was the strongest fort whose ruler was the all-Arab famous warrior Marhab, He was considered to be stronger than 1000 horsemen.
 - According to historians, there was a force of about 20,000 Jews in the forts. When the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) realized that the Jews were prepared to fight, he ordered an attack. The first battle took place on the fort called Na'im. A fierce battle took place and the fort was conquered. The Muslims captured other small fortresses as well, without much difficulty, but when they reached the famous and impregnable fort of Qamus they found it very difficult to conquer. The fight prolonged to 20 days. Each day they had to return without success.
 - When the Muslims complained to the prophet about their successive failures, he consoled them and told them that next day he give the flag and command to the person who was dear to Allah, and to whom Allah was dearer ,and that person would succeed in taking Al-Qamus. Next morning ,when all were assembled the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) beckoned 'Ali (R.A) and with his own hands put the amour on him, handed him the sword and staff ,and sent him forth as the commander of the Muslim troops for that day.
 - Seeing Muslims under the command of Hazrat 'Ali (R.A) , Marhab came out of the fort and invited Hazrat 'Ali (R.A) for a combat. The fight took place between Marhab and Hazrat' Ali (R.A) in which Hazrat , Ali (R.A) killed him in the first attack. Then a fierce battle started, and the Jews were forced to give in and the fort was captured by the Muslims. Ali is said to have moved a door by himself which would have taken many men to move.
 - With the fall of Qamus, the gardens of Khaybar now came under the control of the Muslims and they allowed their Jewish owners to continue working the land in exchange for an annual rent of half their harvest. The Jews realized that the end must come. They requested the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) to grant them peace on the condition that they would pay him half the produce of their lands. Their lives, property women and children were left untouched. Abdullah Ibn Umar reported "The Prophet (P.B.U.H) made a deal with people of Khaybar that they would have half the fruits and vegetation of the land they cultivated."
- Spoils of war fell into the hands of the Muslims. Besides vast stores of dates, oil, honey and barley, flocks of sheep and herds of camels, the spoils in treasure and jewels was very large.

(b) Explain why it was important for the Muslims of Madina to fight in it? [4]

- As peaceful settlements were not accepted, the Prophet had to carry out a military campaign to prevent further disruptions upon the Muslims from these parts, as they did not want to be continually fighting in minor skirmishes.
- It was therefore a matter of survival for the Muslim community.
- Had they not fought, it could have led to insecurity as they would not have known when the next attack would come from there.
- It was also important as God had promised them abundant spoils from this campaign (sura 48.20). The Quran says, "Allah has promised you abundant spoils which you shall acquire. He has instantly granted you this (victory) and has restrained the hands of people from you that it may be a Sign for the believers and He may guide you to a Straight Way."

Letters to King and Emperors:

Late in the six year A.H., on his return from Hudaibiyah, the Prophet Muhammad, decided to send messages to the kings beyond Arabia calling them to Islam. In order to authenticate the credentials of his envoys, a silver seal was made in which were graven the words: "Muhammad the Messenger of Allāh"

1. **Heraclius, the Emperor of Byzantine**

The Prophet (p.b.u.h) sent his envoy Dahyah Kalbi to Heraclius, the Byzantine Emperor, inviting him to Islam. Heraclius wanted to know more about the Prophet (p.b.u.h) and sent his people to find out all they could. Abu Sufyan happened to be in Ghazzah on a business trip and he was brought to the court. Heraclius asked him many questions about Prophet (p.b.u.h). Abu Sufyan testified to the morals and the character of the Prophet (p.b.u.h). When Heraclius heard Abu Sufyan's answers, he was certain that Muhammad (p.b.u.h) was a prophet of Allah; however, he did not accept Islam under the influence of his court. He was nevertheless courteous to the envoy and paid him due respect.

2. **Muqawqis of Egypt**

Hatib bin abi Baitah (r.a) was sent to Egypt. Muqawqis the king of Egypt was a Coptic Christian. When the king read the letter, he said that he knew that a prophet was to appear, but according to his knowledge that prophet would come in Syria. Muqawqis did not accept Islam, however he was courteous to the envoy, and sent gifts to the Prophet (p.b.u.h) among them were two Coptic Christian ladies named Mariyah and Sirin and a mare. The Prophet (p.b.u.h) gave Sirin to Hassan ibn Thabit and he took Mariyah as his wife, she was mother of his son Ibrahim.

3. **Chosroes, Emperor of Persia**

Abdullah bin Abi Hudaifah was sent to Chosroes (Khusrau Pervaz), the Emperor of Persia. When Chosroes saw the name of Allah and Muhammad (p.b.u.h) at the top of the letter, he was furious and tore the letter into pieces. When the messenger of Allah heard about the Chosroes' reaction, he predicted that soon his empire would be torn up. The Persian Empire was spread as far as Yemen, hence Chosroes commanded the governor of Yemen to arrest the Prophet (p.b.u.h) and bring him to his court. When his men came to arrest the Prophet (p.b.u.h), he told them that their king was already dead. They were so impressed by the prophecy that they accepted Islam.

4. **Negus, Emperor of Abyssinia**

Negus, the Emperor of Abyssinia was a Christian ruler. He had earlier given shelter to the Muslims when they migrated to Abyssinia to escape persecution at the hand of Quraish. Umro bin Umayyah was sent to Abyssinia to invite Negus to Islam. He accepted Islam and he showed great respect to the envoy. He also sent presents to the Prophet (p.b.u.h). Negus died during the lifetime of the Prophet (p.b.u.h) and he offered funeral prayers for Negus when he heard of his death.

5. **Abd and Jaifar, the rulers of Oman**

Abd and Jaifar, were joint Kings of Oman at that time. The letter was sent through 'Amr Ibn al-'Aas. This letter was sent asking the people of Oman to convert to Islam."

So in response to the letter, Oman was the first country to convert to Islam without any war. It is said that the Prophet (peace be upon him) made a prayer for the Omani people that they will never have enemies from outside."

6. **Munzir ibn Sawa, Governor of Bahrain**

The Prophet, despatched 'Al-'Ala' bin Al-Hadrami to the governor of Bahrain, carrying a letter inviting him to embrace Islam. In reply, Munzir bin Sawa accepted Islam and wrote the following letter: "Allâh's Messenger ! I received your injunctions. Prior to this, I read your letter, which you wrote to the people of Bahrain extending to them an invitation to Islam. Islam appealed to some of them and they entered the fold of Islam, while others did not find it appealing."

7. **Harith Ghassani, King of Damascus**

Hazrat Shuja bin Wahab was sent to Harith Ghassani, the king of Damascus was very angry at reading the letter. He ordered his armies to attack the Holy Prophet. Muslims were awaiting his onslaught, but the armies never appeared.

Battle of Mu'tah

- This battle took place in **Jumada Al-Ula 8 A.H. / September 629 A.D.** **Mu'tah** is a village that lies on the borders of geographical Syria.

The Prophet (pbuh) had sent **Al-Harith bin 'Umar Al-Azdi** to carry a letter to the ruler of Basra. On his way, he was killed by **Sharhabeel bin'Amr Al-Ghassani**, the governor of **Al-Balqa'** and a close ally to Caesar, the Byzantine Emperor. The Prophet (pbuh) was shocked on hearing the news and ordered that a large army of **3000 men** be mobilized and dispatched to the north to discipline the transgressors.

- **Zaid bin Haritha** was appointed to lead the army. **Ja'far bin Abi Talib** would replace him if he was killed, and **'Abdullah bin Rawaha** would succeed Ja'far in case the latter fell. A white banner was raised and handed over to Zaid. The Muslim army then marched northward to Syria. Heraclius had mobilized **a hundred thousand troops** together with **another hundred thousand** men from Arabian tribes allied to the Byzantines.

- **Zaid bin Haritha** assumed leadership and began to fight tenaciously and in matchless spirit of bravery until he fell, fatally stabbed. **Ja'far bin Abi Talib** then took the banner and did a miraculous job. In the thick of the battle, he kept on fighting until his right hand was cut off. He seized the banner with his left hand until this too was gone. He then clasped the banner with both arms until a Byzantine soldier struck and cut him into two parts. **'Abdullah bin Rawaha** then proceeded to hold up the banner and fight bravely until he too was killed.

- The honour was unanimously granted to **Khalid bin Al-Waleed**. He reshuffled the right and left flanks of the Muslim army and introduced forward a division from the rear in order to cast fear into the hearts of the Byzantine by deluding them that fresh reinforcements had arrived. The Muslims engaged with the enemies in sporadic skirmishes but gradually and judiciously retreating in a fully organized and well-planned withdrawal.

- The Byzantines, seeing this new strategy, believed that they were being entrapped and drawn in the heart of the desert. They stopped the pursuit, and consequently the Muslims managed to retreat to Madinah with the slightest losses. The Muslims sustained **twelve martyrs**. Even though the battle did not satisfy the Muslims' objective, namely avenging Al-Harith's murder, it resulted in a far-ranging impact and attached to the Muslims a great reputation in the battlefields.

Conquest of Makkah (630AD)

- After the treaty of Hudaibiyah, **Banu Bakr** entered into an alliance with the Quraish, while **Banu Khuza'a** made a pact with the Messenger of Allah.

Two year after Treaty of Hudaibiyah, Banu Bakr, the allies of the Quraish attacked the Banu Khuza'a, the allies of Muslims. Quraish helped the Banu Bakr by providing them weapons. Some Quraish leader also fought alongside Banu Bakr secretly at night. Banu Bakr Killed several men of Banu Khuza'a. The Chief of Banu Khuza'a with a party of forty men came to Madinah to seek help and protection. The Prophet (p.b.u.h) demanded from Quraish to accept any of the three alternatives:

- To pay Blood money to the families of the murdered men of Banu Khuza'a**
- To dissolve their alliance with Banu Bakr**
- To dissolve the treaty of Hudaibiyah**

The Quraish opted for the third alternative but soon realized that they were no match for the Prophet (p.b.u.h) and sent **Abu Sufyan** to settle the affairs.

- Abu Sufyan visited his daughter Umm-Habiba, one of the wives of the Prophet (p.b.u.h) but she refused to do anything for him. He then went to Abu Bakr, Umar, Uthman and Ali (R.A) one after another, but they too refused to mediate on his behalf. Then he went to the Mosque of the Prophet (p.b.u.h) and announced that the Quraish would guarantee peace and protection to all, but the Prophet (p.b.u.h) rejected his offer.

- The Prophet (p.b.u.h) prepared an army of **ten thousands Men**: he maintained complete secrecy, to prevent Quraish from making alliance with their neighbouring tribes. The Prophet (p.b.u.h) set out for Makkah on **10th Ramadan 8th A.H/630AD**. The Muslims camped outside Makkah. The Prophet (p.b.u.h) ordered his followers to light up torches outside their tents. The sight of fires magnified the size of the Muslims army, the Quraish were demoralized. **Abu Sufyan** ibn Harb to spy and was captured and brought to Allah's Apostle (p.b.u.h). At the point, he **embraced islam**.

- Before entering Makkah the Prophet (p.b.u.h) proclaimed that whoever remained in his own house would be safe, whoever was in Ka,bah would be safe even those who entered the house of Abu Sufyan would be safe. Thus, safety was guaranteed even to the worst enemy of islam.

On entering Makkah, the Prophet (p.b.u.h) told his army not to use arms against any one, unless they met with resistance or were attacked. He ordered them to avoid bloodshed: and commanded them not to harm the old, the women and the children.

- He divided his army into four columns; each column was assigned a specific part of Makkah to capture. The Muslims entered peacefully. The column of Khalid Bin Waleed was showered with arrows and fought back; **thirteen** men from the Quraish were killed while **two Muslims** embraced martyrdom.

- The Prophet (p.b.u.h) went to Ka,bah and performed Tawaf. He went inside and prayed. Then he purified it, there were about **360** idols in Ka,bah, he destroyed them, while doing he recited, **"And say the truth has come and falsehood has banished. Surely falsehood is bound to perish"** (Al-Isra 17:81)

- A general amnesty was proclaimed throughout Makkah. The Prophet (p.b.u.h) then assembled the Quraish near mount Safa and delivered a sermon.

At the end of the sermon, he asked them, **"O people of Quraish what do you think I will do with you?"** They replied, **(we think you will treat us) well, noble brother, son of noble brother,** He said **"I shall speak to you as Yusuf [Joseph] spoke to his brothers, "there is no reproach against you today; God will forgive. He is the most merciful and the most Compassionate."** (Yusuf 12:92)

And he added, **"no more responsibility burdens you today, Go, for you are free"**

- The Quraish were greatly impressed by the mercy and forgiveness of the Prophet (p.b.u.h) and accepted Islam. The Quran says regarding the Conquest of Makkah, **"When comes the help of Allah and victory and see people entering the religion of Allah in throngs"** (Al-Nasr 110:1-2). The Prophet (p.b.u.h) stayed at Makkah for about nineteen days during which is made arrangement for the administration of Makkah.

(b) Can Muslims today learn from the Prophet's treatment of his former enemies? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

- Yes, they can learn from his treatment of his former enemies because the Prophet (pbuh) forgave those who had shown a lot of enmity towards him, such as Abu Sufyan.
- In following this example, Muslims can forgive those in their life who call them names, abuse them, or try to stop them from doing good, especially if they are sorry for what they have done. A grudge should not be held against them.
- In Makka the Prophet (pbuh) forgave everyone except including those who had killed his family members such as Wahshi and Hind.
- Muslims should realise that forgiveness is always a better option than revenge. They should not take revenge despite having the power to do so.

WEEK 04

DAY 02 (Paper 01)

The Battle of Hunain

- The victory of Makkah which came forth as a consequence of a swift blow astonished both the Arabs and other tribes. The ruling of Ta'if, Banu Saqif and warrior tribes of Banu Hawazin were still enemies of Islam.
- **Malik bin Awf** the general leader decided to march and fight the Muslims. Alliance force of 20000 men was prepared and they camped in the hills of Awtas to the south east of Makkah. The Banu Hawazin and Banu Saqif encamped in the valley of Hunain and posted their archers covering the pass in the valley which the Holy Prophet and his forces must cross before they could reach the other side.
- The Muslim army was **twelve thousand** in number, including **two thousand newly converted Makkans**. Seeing how great number the Muslims set out on this expedition with extreme confidence that mounted to over confidence. Some of them said, "**We shall not be defeated.**" This statement was not liked by Allah.

It is said in the Holy Qur'an,

"Truly Allah has given you victory on many battle fields, and on the Day of Hunain (battle) when you rejoiced at your great number, but it availed you naught and the earth, vast as it is, was straitened for you, then you turned back in fight. Then Allah did send down His calmness and reassurance on the Messenger (Muhammad), and on the believers, and sent down forces (angels) which you saw not, and punished the disbelievers. Such is the recompense of disbelievers." (Surah-Al-Tauba 09 : Verses:25-26)

- As the Muslims advanced, they were met with showers of arrows from all sides, while the main portion of Hawazin's army attacked them from the front. The Muslims could not stand the fierce attack so they fell back. It caused a terrible disorder among the Muslim army. They fled from the battle field and a small band of followers firmly stuck up with the Holy Prophet.
- At that moment, the Holy Prophet said at the top of his voice, **"Truly saying, I am the Prophet; I am the (grand) son of Abdul-Muttalib."** (Al-Tabari)
These words had desired effects. Muslims uttered "Labbaik! Labbaik!" (Here we are at your service. Here we are). They threw jumped off their camels and horses and attacked the enemy in all fury. Both of the armies stood fast and fought fiercely. The Holy Prophet threw a handful of dust at the face of enemy saying,

"May your faces be disfigured."

Their eyes were thick with dust and the enemy began to retreat in utter confusion.

- They fled and left their women, children and cattle. because their leader Malik bin 'Awf had told everyone to take their families and belongings with them, the Muslims captured huge spoils of war which consisted of 24000 camels, 40000 sheep and 40000 Oqias (ounces) of silver. About **seventy men of Banu Saqif** were killed and **six thousand were prisoners**. The prisoners were sent to the valley of **Jirana** and the Prophet chased the fleeing enemy.
- After this event the Prophet(pbuh) laid siege to Taif and after some time people of Taif embraced Islam. Consequently the Prophet(pbuh) freed the prisoners and returned the spoils. Thus, his prayer for the people of Taif was granted by Allah.

Tabuk Expedition

- The Relationship between the Muslims and Christians were strained since the battle of Muta. The Byzantines were afraid of the growing power of Arabia and the spread of Islam. The emperor

Heraclius collected a large force to attack Madina. When the Prophet (P.B.U.H) learned about the preparation, he gave a call for jihad.

- The time of the expedition was unfavourable as there was drought and famine in Arabia. The summer was extremely hot. The date crop was ready to be harvested. The Arabs tribes were hesitant to fight the Byzantines whom they considered very powerful and it was a long journey through a barren desert.
- Besides, the **Hypocrites**, under the leadership of **Abdullah bin Ubay** spread discontentment and fear amongst the Muslims. They made excuses not to accompany the Messenger of Allah and said that they feared the enemy and the intense heat. Allah said of them, **"Those who were left behind rejoiced in staying behind the Messenger of Allah and were against struggling with their possessions and their selves in the way of Allah. They said go not forth in the heat, say the fire of hell is hotter, did they but understand"(9:81).**
- The Prophet (P.B.U.H) asked for donations and charity for the preparation of the expedition. The Muslims made great contribution, Abu Bakr R.A gave all his possessions, Umar gave half his property, while Uthman gave 900 camels and 100 horses, and a 1000 gold dinars. Women donated their ornaments. On this occasion, the Prophet (pbuh) appointed Hazrat Ali as his deputy in Madina and said, **"You are to me as Haroon was to Musa(A.S) except there will be no Prophet after me."**
- The Prophet (P.B.U.H) gathered an army of 30000 and marched to Tabuk in Rajab 9 A.H. After 7 days of journey, the Muslims reached Tabuk. When the Romans heard of Muslims advanced with such a huge force, they withdrew from border towns, and dispersed. the Prophet (P.B.U.H) did not pursue them in their own territory.
- He sent small expedition against various Christians and Jew Rulers in the neighbourhood. Many Christians tribes entered into alliance with the Muslim and came under their protections and agreed to pay Jizyah. In return, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) guaranteed them the security of their borders and territories as well as safety of their caravans and their ships traveling by land and sea. He returned to Madinah after staying in Tabuk for 20 days.
- The Conspiracy to kill Messenger (saw) by the hypocrites was always there, even on the way back from Tabuk. Abu Qatadah was there to protect him. There was a group of hypocrites ready to kill the Messenger (saw), they said let us kill him (saw). Twelve of them gathered and conspired to hit the Messenger's mule, near the valley, so that he would fall down and be killed. **Hudaifah bin Yaman and Abu Qatadah** saw that the Messenger (saw) was close to edge. Hudaifa went and held the reins of the Messenger's mule. The hypocrites went to make noise and unsettle the mule while **the Prophet (P.B.U.H)** was passing through the mountain road, Allah said, regarding this **"They swear by Allah that they said nothing (evil) but indeed they uttered disrespect and they did it after accepting Islam and they meditated a plot which they were unable to carry out."(9:74)**
- This was the last military expedition the prophet(pbuh) took part.

(b) The Battle of Tabuk became a mission of peace instead of war. What can Muslims learn from this? [4]

- The Prophet (pbuh) had set off to fight the Byzantines. They did not show, and so there was no war. The Prophet (pbuh) made treaties with people along the border. Some lessons Muslims can learn could be:
- Muslims should favour peace over fighting
- Muslims should fight in defence just as the Prophet (pbuh) did, preferring to make peace with those in neighbouring regions
- Showing unity could help remove the need to fight.

***Elaborate with present day example**

WEEK 05

DAY 01 (Paper 01)

Relations with Non - Muslims

When the Holy Prophet (PBUH) migrated to Madinah in **622AD**, he treated all parts of the Madinan society equally. After the construction of the Mosque, Masjid-e-Nabvi, he devised the covenant of Madinah as an agreement with three Jewish tribes in which privileges and responsibilities were given.

- The agreement stated that the law of Allah would be the law of land and granted complete religious freedom. Madinah would be a city of peace for both parties and both would enjoy the same security and equal rights. It further stated that the Muslims and the Jews would be allies and would not fight against each other. Moreover, in case of an attack on Madinah, both would assist each other to defend it. The Holy Prophet (PBUH) will decide all the disputes and his decision would be final.
- The Prophet (pbuh) engaged in commercial dealings with them and gave and received help from them. He sometimes borrowed money from Jews and also arranged for loans from them for some of his companions: one day a Jew caught hold of the cloth the Prophet (pbuh) was wearing and demanded that he repay the loan he had taken from him. 'Umar, got angry with the Jew and scolded him. The Prophet (pbuh) then ordered that the loan be repaid to the Jew, and because 'Umar had scolded him the Prophet (pbuh) insisted that he be given more money than what he had actually been owed.

However, the Jews gradually distanced themselves from the Holy Prophet (PBUH). They persistently mocked the revelations he received from God, and doubted his claim to Prophethood. They openly made fun of him especially when **the Qibla was changed** and tried to humiliate him in different ways.

- The relationship between the Jews and the Muslims deteriorated when a Muslim woman was subjected to public humiliation by a Jew **of Banu Qainuqa** who pinned her skirt in a public place. He was killed by a Muslim and other Jews killed that Muslim. When this news reached to the Holy Prophet (PBUH), he laid a siege to their fortress. This siege continued for **15 days** after which the Holy Prophet (PBUH) expelled them from Madinah in **624 A.D.**
- Another setback to the relationships between the two was when Kaab bin Ashraf was executed for violating the charter of Madinah. In 4 A.H **Banu Nadir** attempted to kill the Holy Prophet (PBUH) by throwing a huge mill stone on him when he went to take from the blood money for some purpose according to the treaty. They were asked to leave within **10 days**. However, they left after the siege of **14 days** with as much as they could carry in **626 AD**.
- Finally, **Banu Quraiza**, the last major tribe left in Madinah, showed treachery in the Battle of Ditch in **627 AD**. They broke the treaty with the Muslims, conspired with the Quraish and planned to attack the Muslims from rear. A siege was laid on their fortresses that lasted for **25 days**. After this siege, as a punishment of their treachery decided by **Saad bin Muaaz**, around 600 – 700 men from Banu Quraiza were executed and their wives and children were sold as slaves. The Quran refers to this incident in these words, **“And those of the people of the book who aided them- Allah did take them down from their strongholds and cast terror into their hearts, (so that) some ye slew, and some you made prisoners . And He made you heirs of their lands, their houses and their goods----”**[33:26-27]
- Apart from the Jews remained the Madinans who did not become sincere believers. Quran says, **“when it is said to rhem, come to what Allah has revealed and the messenger, you see that the Hypocrites avert their faces from you disgust.”**[4:61] They were the **hypocrites** whose leader was Abdullah Bin Ubbay. They showed their disloyalty most strongly by withdrawing when the Quraish's attack led to Battle of **Uhad in 625 AD**. Abdullah Bin Ubbay withdrew with 300 of his men saying that he did this as

the Prophet rejected his advice of fighting from inside the city. They deserted their posts in the Battle of **Trench in 627 AD** saying their homes were not safe. In addition to this, they provided secret information of the Muslims to the Makkans and the Jews. They did not make any financial contribution in **Tabuk expedition 631 AD**. After Abdullah bin Ubbay's death in 631 AD many of the hypocrites repented and became true Muslims.

- the Prophet (pbuh) sent letters to various non-Muslim rulers inviting them to Islam. The Christians of Najran visited the Prophet (pbuh) in Madina to talk to him and ask questions. They then signed a peace treaty. The Prophet (pbuh) allowed them to pray their prayers in the mosque.
- The relations between the Muslims and the Makkans were strained after migration and the Prophet decided to block the trade routes to Syria which led to the battle of Badr. After Badr, Uhud and Trench were fought. Treaty of Hudaibiya ended hostilities but the Makkans violated the treaty in 630 AD, which led to the conquest of Makkah. At that time the prophet treated his non-Muslim enemies with kindness, mercy and forgiveness and did not take revenge despite having the power to do so.

3 (b) How can Muslims now apply the lessons learnt from the Prophet's interaction with non-Muslims? [4]

- Non-Muslims were respected by the Prophet (pbuh) and invited to Islam. If they did not accept it they were left to live their lives freely under their own faith.
- Muslims now can learn from this by inviting non-Muslims to Islam by teaching them about the essentials of faith. If they do not want to accept Islam then they should not be harassed or hurt, but rather respected and looked after.
- Muslims who kill people from other faiths because they do not believe in Islam, are going against the example of the Prophet (pbuh).
- Muslims should also enter into agreements with non-Muslims to ensure both sides live amicably and do not have their freedoms taken away by the other side. This allows both parties to know where they stand and do not have to live in fear.

• Relations with other states

3 (a) Describe three examples from the life of the Prophet that show the relations between the early Muslim state and other states. [10]

The first Islamic state in Madinah was established in **622AD** and was governed by the Holy Prophet^{pbuh}. It was founded in a part of the city but it spread very fast and became the capital of a vast Muslim empire. The system of administration established by the Holy Prophet^{pbuh} lasted for centuries a source of inspiration for later generations.

Relations between two sovereign states are governed by an agreement if one exists between them. The Islamic state has been enjoined to follow the terms of the agreement. The best example was provided by the Holy Prophet^{pbuh} at the time of the **Treaty of Hudaibiya 6AH/628AD**. According to the treaty, the Holy Prophet^{pbuh} had agreed to return any Muslim who came to them and one such Muslim did arrive as the agreement was being written. The Holy Prophet^{pbuh} told him to go back to Makkah as he had already agreed to the treaty. This shows that all obligations undertaken by the Muslim state should be fulfilled and treaties concluded between the Islamic state and other states should be honoured. This is binding as long as the other party remains faithful to its obligations and honours its treaties. The following saying of the Holy Prophet^{pbuh} shows how honestly he kept his word with individuals and nations. He said: **"If anyone wrongs a man with whom a covenant has been made, or curtails any right of his, or imposes on him more than he can bear, or takes anything from him not in the agreement, then I shall be his adversary on the Day of Resurrection."** (Mishkat)

After the treaty of Hudaibiya, during the period of peace, the Holy Prophet^{pbuh} sent **letters to various emperors and kings in 7AH/629AD** inviting them to Islam. Special mention in this connection maybe made of Najashi of Abyssinia, who had given protection to Muslims to Makkah. The Christians of Najran also concluded a peace treaty with the Holy Prophet^{pbuh}. The Holy Prophet^{pbuh} received envoys from Egypt, Abyssinia, Byzantine and other neighbouring states and treated them as official representatives of their government. He was very strict in maintaining cordial political relations with neighbouring tribes and states and always received their envoys and deputations with great respect. He himself looked after them and served them during their stay in Madinah.

When the Holy Prophet^{pbuh} entered **Makkah after its conquest in 8 AH/ 630AD**, he asked its inhabitants what treatment they expected of him. He did not order them to be killed, confiscate their property or take them as slaves. The Holy Prophet^{pbuh} said: **"Today, there is no blame on you, there will be no retribution; go, all of you are free."** The effect of this pardon was so great that the entire population of Makkah embraced Islam. The Holy Prophet^{pbuh} words converted them from deadly foes into devoted and sincere followers.

The example of the Holy Prophet^{pbuh} throws light on his desire to have good and friendly relationships based on equity and justice with other states and to live in peace as good neighbours.

Final Year of Prophet's(pbuh) Life

The Holy Prophet (pbuh) performed his farewell pilgrimage in **10 A.H/631 A.D.** The news was sent to the desert tribes, and multitudes flocked to the oasis from all directions, eager to accompany Allah's Prophet (P.B.U.H) at every step of this event. The actions of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) during this farewell pilgrimage, established the rituals of the Hajj forever. He delivered his last sermon at the plain of Arafat on **Jabal-al-Rahma** (The Mount of Mercy) on **9th of zilhaji**. He addressed about **1,14,000** companions. The subjects dealt with in this Farewell Sermon lay down the essence of what the holy Prophet (pbuh) had communicated and taught during his lifetime. It explains the basic duties of Islam and one of the most important teachings is that the Holy Prophet (pbuh) says he leaves the Quran and his Ahadith as the foundation upon which Muslims should lead their lives.

The Holy Prophet (pbuh) told about **his impending death** and asked everyone to listen attentively. He warned the Muslim Ummah against the evil practices of pagan hood, declaring Satan as the open enemy of the believers. He told about the **sanctity of life and property.**²

The Holy Prophet (pbuh) emphasized upon **fulfilling the rights of Allah** by worshipping Him alone and by performing the pillars of Islam.

" Behold, worship your Lord; after praying 5 times a day; observe fast in the month of Ramadan; pay Zakat on your property; and perform pilgrimage to the House of Allah."

The Holy Prophet (pbuh) taught about the **equality of all mankind**. He said,

"All mankind is from Adam and an Arab has no superiority over a non-Arab, nor has a non-Arab over the Arab. Similarly, no white has superiority over the black; nor have a black over white; except by piety and good action.....you are all the children of Adam, and Adam was made of mud."

Prophet (pbuh) also said that every Muslim is a brother to another Muslim and that the Muslims constitute one brotherhood. **"Learn that every Muslim is a brother to every Muslim and that the Muslims constitute one brotherhood."**

He declared that the taking of interest (riba) was completely forbidden.

He emphasized on the **rights of women** especially as **wives** and also introduced the rights of the **slaves**. He laid special emphasis on their good treatment.

"O people! You have rights over your wives and your wives have rights over you. Treat your wives with kindness. Verily, you have taken them on the security of Allah and made them lawful unto you by the words of Allah. And feed your slaves as you feed yourselves and cloth them as you cloth yourselves. If they commit a fault which you are unwilling to forgive, then sell them."

The holy Prophet (pbuh) also reminded the Muslims about their obligation of transmitting his teachings to future generations **“Let him who is present tell it to him who is absent.”**

The religion and his prophet hood were completed after the last sermon as he said

“O people! No prophet or apostle will come after me and no new faith will be born.”

- On this occasion, he received the last revelation, **“This day have I perfected your religion for you, completed My favor upon you, and have chosen for you Islam as your religion.” (5:3)**

He concluded his sermon with an earnest question: **“O people, have I faithfully delivered unto you my message?”** The words ‘Allah humman’am reverberated throughout the valley. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) raised his right hand and said: **“O Allah, bear witness!”**

- **On his return to Madinah**, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) organized the provinces and tribal communities. He appointed officers to collect Zakat from the newly converted tribes and people of the Peninsula. Meanwhile many more deputations arrived at Madina to accept Islam. the Prophet (P.B.U.H) also ordered Usama ibn Zaid ibn Haritha to lead an expedition to Syria.
- **Two month after** his return to Madina the Prophet (P.B.U.H) fell ill with headache and fever. He remained sick for about two weeks. At first, he performed all his duties as usual and led the prayers. On the **fifth day** of his illness, he retired to the apartment of Hazrat Aisha with the consent of his other wives.. When he became too weak, he **appointed Hazrat Abu Bakr to lead** the prayers.
- **On the last day** of his life the Prophet (P.B.U.H) came in the mosque supported by his attendants, and joined the congregational prayer behind Hazrat Abu Bakr when Abu Bakr heard him coming , he tried to retreat but Allah’ Apostle asked him to carry on. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) sat on his left side. After the prayer, He begged forgiveness from his hearers, and exhorted them to follow the path of Allah, he said, **“There is a slave amongst the slaves of Allah unto whom Allah has offered the choice between this world and that which is with Him, and the slave has chosen that which is with Allah.”** Hazrat Abu Bakr R.A wept because he knew that the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was speaking himself and his imminent death.
- Then he advised the Muslims to be careful about the rights of Ansar and to treat them well. He ordered to shut all the doors that opened to the mosque except door of Abu Bakr House he said **“be watchful about your five daily prayers and rights of your women and servants.”** He warned the Muslims not to worship his grave. He had some cash with Hazrat Aisha which he gave away as alms. Aisha said, **“His last act was cleanings of his mouth with a brush made of a soft branch of a tree and his last words were, “now, none but he the companions on high is needed.”** the Prophet (P.B.U.H) died on Monday June 8th 632AD, 12th Rabi ul Awal 11 AH. Everyone was stunned with grief.

The Prophet (P.B.U.H) was buried in the same place where he had died; in the house of Aisha, his funeral prayer was performed in batches his family members including Hazrat Ali and Abbas bin Abdul Mutlib lowered him in his grave.

(OPTIONAL) Hazrat Umar was so shocked that he drew out his sword and declared that he would kill anyone who said the Prophet had died. When Abu Bakr learned about the death of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) after ascertaining the fact, he said, **“O People! Lo as for him who worshipped Mohammad, Muhammad is died but as for him who worshiped Allah, Allah is alive and dies not. Then he recited the following words of Quran, “ Muhammad is no more than an apostle.. Many were the apostle that passed away before him. If he died or were slain will you then turn back on your heels? A –Imran(3:144)” .**

4. (b) The Farewell Sermon given by the Prophet contains teachings for Muslims of all times. Explain how two of these teachings can be applied today. [4]

The last sermon is considered a summary of the main elements of faith, as it includes the five pillars, equality of humankind, ethics and morality. It can be used in many modern day issues such as racism, inequality of women, the financial structure (dealing in interest), adultery, responsibility of actions (particularly in crimes), treating other Muslims as brothers, treating slaves/servants well, and worshipping God. Present day examples should be given

Qualities (Model of Excellence):

▶ O/N 2012

- ▶ **3 (a)** Describe **three qualities** of the Prophet Muhammad that make him a model for humankind. [10]

▶ M/J 2014

- ▶ **3 (a)** The Prophet Muhammad is said to have been **patient** and **trustworthy**. Write about events in his life that illustrate these qualities. [10]

▶ O/N 2015

- ▶ **3 (a)** The Qur'an says the Prophet is of "great moral character" (68.4). Identify events from his life that show **a range of his moral characteristics**. [10]

▶ M/J 2016

- ▶ **3 (a)** The Prophet was described as **humble** and **just**. Giving examples from his life, write about events that describe these qualities. [10]

▶ M/J 2017

- ▶ **4(a)** Write about events from the Prophet's (pbuh) life that show his qualities of **generosity, honesty** and **simplicity** in action. [10]

▶ O/N 2018

- ▶ **3(a)** Giving at least four examples from his life, write about the ways in which the Prophet Muhammad showed **generosity** and **humility**. [10]

O/N 2019

- ▶ **3(a)** The Prophet (pbuh) was **generous** and **forgiving**. Write about events from his life that demonstrate these qualities in action. [10]

Intro:

The Prophet (P.B.U.H) is an excellent model for the Muslims to follow in all walks of life. He had an ideal character and conduct. Allah testified to his character. **"And you stand on an exalted standard of character" (Al Quran 68:4).** Again Allah says **"you have indeed in the Apostle of Allah a beautiful pattern of conduct.** The Prophet (P.B.U.H) manners were ideal, he said, **"Allah sent me to complete the excellent virtues and to perfect the good manners."** Aisha R.A was asked about the habits of Prophet (P.B.U.H) she replied, **"His habits were in accordance with teachings of Quran."**

Muslims should take the life of Prophet (P.B.U.H) as a model for themselves in every sphere of life and should mould their character and personality according to it.

1. Patience and perseverance

Prophet (P.B.U.H) passed through a period of great distress and hardships at Makkah. He bore all the difficulties with patience and never complained about them. In spite of the ill treatment of his enemies, he always treated them kindly and never cursed them. He endured the persecutions of the Quraish until he was forced to leave Makkah,

- When the Prophet's opponents greatly increased their persecution, his companions asked him to curse them. At this the Prophet replied: **"I have not been sent to lay a curse upon men but to be a blessing to them"**

His opponents continued to treat him and his companions unjustly and cruelly, but he always prayed for them.

- In the early Makkan period when the enemies of the new religion far exceeded the Prophet's companions in number, it often happened that when the Prophet would stand to pray, his foes would come near him and whistle and clap in order to disturb him, but the Prophet would not even once show his anger at such acts. He always opted for the policy of tolerance and avoidance of confrontation.

- In one instance when the Prophet was praying at the Ka'bah while his enemies were watching his every move and action, one of his adversaries put on his back the intestine of a slaughtered camel during his prostration. The Prophet did not react and stayed in that position. His daughter, Fatimah, rushed to take the filth off his back and cleaned him up.

- The Prophet (P.B.U.H) went to Taif to invite them to Islam, but Banu Saqeef refused to listen to him, they abused him and pelted him with stones. He took shelter in the shade of a wall of a garden outside Taif and prayed to Allah, at that time the angel Jibrail said, "Allah has heard the way your people have responded. He has, therefore, sent this angel in charge of the mountains. You may command him as you please. Then the angel of the mountains greeted and submitted, If u like I would overturn the mountains from either side upon these people. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) replied, no but I expect that Allah will create from their children those will worship none but Allah, the one."

later, they attacked Madinah, and fought many battles with him but he bore all their aggression with patience. His conduct was exemplary which finally made him victorious.

2. Honesty and Trustworthiness :

Prophet (P.B.U.H) was honest and truthful. He was a poor orphan who started trade with his uncle, but in short period; he became well known and respected. He was known as **Al-Sadiq (the truthful) and Al-Amin (the trust worthy)**.

- When the dispute arose among the various tribes of Makkah as to who should lay the Black Stone, they decided the one who entered Ka'bah the next morning would place it. They were very pleased when Muhammad (P.B.U.H) happened to enter the Ka'bah the next morning as they trusted him for his honesty.
- When Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was elevated to Prophet Hood the Quraish abused him, called him mad, bewitched etc, but never called him a liar. Abu Jahl his bitterest enemy often said, **"Muhammad, I do not say that you are a liar, but what you say I do not think right."** (Ibn Ishaque)
- When Allah commanded the Prophet (P.B.U.H) to invite his people to Islam. He called the Quraish at the mount Safa and said, **"If I were to tell you that any enemy was advancing to attack you from the back of the hill, would you believe me?"** They said, yes, we have always known you to be truthful. However, when he invited them to Islam, they turned away.
- Khadijah married him because of his high morals and honesty. Khadijah was a wealthy widow, who used to send her merchandise to other countries. When she heard about Muhammad's (P.B.U.H) truthfulness and trustworthiness, she sent for him and proposed that he should take her goods. He came back with double the profits that she normally used to get. She was so impressed by his high character that she proposed marriage to him.
- People of Makkah used to keep their belongings with him for safe keeping. At the time of migration, though his life was in danger he entrusted the belongings of people to Ali (R.A.) before leaving Makkah.

3. Humility and Simplicity:

Hazrat Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was a simple man. He was unceremonious and informal his habits. He ate whatever was available, wore coarse cloths. His bed consisted of a blanket and a pillow of date fiber covered with leather. He ate bread made from coarse flour, and spent days on dates only. He sat on floor, bare ground or a mat, without any hesitation even when he was the ruler of Madinah.

It is reported **"Allah's messenger Muhammad (P.B.U.H) used to patch his sandals, sew his garment and conduct himself at home as anyone of you does in his house."**

- His companions used to stand up to show respect to him when he appeared in their midst but he forbade them saying, **"Don't stand up for me as the unbelievers do to show respect to others."**

He lived humbly all his life and never boasted of his social or political status even after his success at Madina.

There are many incidents of his humility reported by his companions and recorded in history books. Anas said that Allah's messenger used to visit the sick, accompany funeral and accept the invitation of slaves.

- It is reported by Anas that when Allah's messenger performed pilgrimage he kept on reporting.

"O Allah! make this pilgrimage, a pilgrimage without pretence and fame."

His companions had a great deal of love and respect for him. However they did not stand up when he entered a room, as he disliked it. He did not wish to be treated as a ruler.

- Someone asked Hazrat Aisha about the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) life at home. She replied that he did household work. He mended clothes and shoes, milked the goats and swept the house. He shared and ate his meals with the slaves and the poor. He sat with the needy and the destitute in such a way that no one could tell the difference between him and poor people. When he went to an assembly, he sat wherever he found place.
- When he was entering Makkah as a conqueror, he was not proud or boastful like a worldly conqueror. An expression of humility and gentleness was on his face and he lowered his head in such a way that it touched the saddle of his camel.
 - It is reported by Hazrat Umar that he heard the holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) say: **“Do not praise me as the Christians praise the son of Mary. I am a servant of God, call me a servant and messenger of God.”** Another one of his companions reported him as saying, **“Allah has revealed to me that you must be humble, so that no one boasts that he is better than other.”**

The Prophet (P.B.U.H) always lived in a humble way and taught his followers to do the same. He lived the life of an ordinary human being and showed by his own example, how to live humbly, even in greatness

4. Justice and equality:

Prophet (P.B.U.H) was a just man; he never considered himself above anyone. He sat among people like ordinary man; worked like that ordinary labourer with his companions in the construction of Mosque of Madinah. He also participated in digging the trench around Madinah with other Muslims at the time of battle of Allies.

- Once the Muslims were on journey everyone took charge of doing a certain duty. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) took charge of collecting wood from jungle.
- Abbas the Prophet (P.B.U.H) uncle and Aaszaib's husband were taken prisoners during the battle of Badr. They were treated the same way, the other prisoners were treated. The companions asked the holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) to free them without taking ransom, but he refused to treat them differently.
- The Prophet (P.B.U.H) treated people with fairness and never discriminated between Muslims and non-Muslims in matter of justice. The Jews used to come to him to have their disputes settled. A Muslim went to Khyber and was killed by the Jews his son complained to the Prophet (P.B.U.H) he said, **“If you swear as to who has committed the murder, you will have the right to take your right from the murderer. They said, How should we swear if we did not witness the murder or see the murderer?”** The Jews were the only people who lived in Khyber and there was no doubt to the fact that they had killed the man, but since there was no eyewitness, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) did not ask them anything; and paid the blood money from the state treasury.
- Once a woman from an influential tribe of Makkah stole; the Prophet (P.B.U.H) ordered her hand to be cut. Usama bin Zaid approached the Prophet (P.B.U.H) on behalf of the woman. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **“the people before you were destroyed because they used to inflict the legal punishments on the poor and forgive the rich. By God! if my daughter Fatimah did that, I would cut off her hand”**.
- In administering justice, he made no distinction between believers and nonbelievers, friends and foes, high and low. Once a Muslim and a Jew had a business dispute, when the matter was brought to the Prophet (pbuh) he decided in favour of the Jew.

5. Generosity

Generosity means giving freely without expecting anything in return. The Holy Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) liked generosity as one of the quality of believers and has encouraged Muslims to show a generous attitude towards every needy person. The generosity and kindness of the heart of the holy Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was a household word.

- During the month of Ramzan, he would give away so lavishly as to leave hardly anything for himself. He never kept money with him overnight. If he had anything left, before nightfall he would give it to the needy and destitute. If he came across someone who was starving, he would give him his meal and remain hungry himself.
- Once a man who had embraced Islam asked the Holy Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) for some goats and sheep. It so happened that at this time the holy Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) had recently been given great abundance of these animals. He gave the man so many that they filled the space between the hills.

- The Holy Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was once given 70,000 dirhams, which he began to distribute among the beggars soon the whole amount was exhausted. After all the beggars had departed and old man came and asked for alms. The Holy Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) had nothing left to give but he did not want to send the man away empty-handed. He therefore, borrowed something from another and gave it to him.

- When Prophet (pbuh) returned a debt he gave more than he owed. When a Jewish man came to demand back the money the Prophet owed him, he grabbed the Prophet by the collar. 'Umar got angry at the Jew, but the Prophet smiled. He asked for the debt to be repaid and extra given due to the harsh treatment by 'Umar. Even when he asked for water from a woman to drink, he gave the water skins back with more water in them as well as some food.

- He was also generous with his prayers, praying for those who hurt him rather than asking for their destruction, e.g. at Ta'if and Uhud.

6. Mercy and Forgiveness

- Forgiveness is to not have anger, or to show kindness to someone who has wronged you. Prophet (P.B.U.H) never took revenge from anyone and always forgave even his bitterest enemies. Hazrat Aisha said that Prophet (P.B.U.H) never returned evil for evil, but would always forgive and pardon. The Quraish rebuked him, taunted and mocked at him, beat him and abused him. They even tried to kill him. When the persecution and aggression of the Quraish became unbearable, his companions requested him to curse them but the Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **"O Allah! Forgive my people for they know not."**
- After the Holy Prophet's (P.B.U.H) migration to Madinah the Quraish waged many wars against him. In the Battle of Uhad, when his head and face were injured his companion asked him to curse them, but he said that he was not sent to curse people but to invite them to path of Allah.
- When Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) conquered Makkah, he did not take revenge, but forgave everyone. Even Abu Sufyan was forgiven and anyone who took refuge in his house was also forgiven, Similarly, the Abyssinian slave **Wahshi al Harb** who had killed Hazrat Hamza in the Battle of Uhad, **Hinda**, who had torn out his liver and **Ikrimah ibn Abu Jahl** were forgiven.
- The people of Taif, who threw stones at the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) when he visited that town in order to invite them to Islam, and the Jews of Madinah who were always engaged in hostile activities against the Muslims, were also forgiven by him.
- **Abdullah bin Ubbay**, the leader of hypocrites, worked all his life against the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) and Islam. He was continuously involved in intrigues with the chiefs of Makkah to wage war against the Muslim. In the Battle of Uhad, he deserted with three hundred of his supporters, thus weakening the Muslim army. Yet, after his death, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) prayed to Allah to forgive him.

The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was an example of forgiveness and kindness, as mentioned in the Holy Quran: **"Hold to forgiveness; command what is right (7:199)"**

7. Fulfilment of Promises

The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) fulfilled his promises. He was always held in such trust that people left their valuable with him for safe keeping.

- When the king of Rome received a letter from the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) inviting him to Islam, he called the Arab traders who were than visiting his country. He asked some questions about the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) from their leader Abu Sufyan, who was at that time, one of the bitterest enemies of Islam. One of the questions was whether the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) had ever broken his promise. Abu Sufyan replied that he had never broken his promise.
- One of the conditions of the Treaty of Hudaibiya was that if any Muslim from Makkah went to Madina, he would be returned. When the Treaty of Hudaibiya was being written. Abu Jandal, bound in chains, escaped from Makkah and came to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) asking for refuge. The Muslims were shocked to see him in this condition, but the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) said to him **"O Abu Jandal! be patient, we cannot break the Treaty. Allah will very soon find a way for you"**. He was returned to people of Makkah.
- Two companions of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) while coming from Makkah were caught by the unbelievers. They were released on the condition that they would not fight on the side of the Muslims

in the battle of Badr. They came to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) and informed him about the incident. The Muslims were very few in number and needed more men to fight against the unbelievers; but the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) said **“Both of you must go back; we will keep the promise under all circumstances.”**

By always keeping his promises and contracts the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) set an example for all mankind.

Seal of Prophets

The long line of the prophets started with Adam and finished with Muhammad (S.A.W). The life and teachings of the prophets before Muhammad (S.A.W) have been altered, adulterated or lost by their followers, besides their teachings were incomplete and did not provide complete code of life necessary for a successful prosperous life. These messengers were appointed for particular people or country, and a particular period of time. And their message was only for those people and not a universal message. Muhammad (S.A.W) is the last all of the prophets. Allah says **“Muhammad is not the father of any of your men, but he is the messenger of Allah, and the seal of the prophets”** (Al-Ahzab 33:40) The prophet (S.A.W) said, **“There will no prophet after me.”** (Agreed) In other tradition, he said **“My relation to the long lines of the prophets can be understood by the parable of a building. The building was most beautifully built. Everything was complete there in except the place of one brick. I have filled the place and now the building has been complete.”** (Bukhari, Muslim)

The prophethood of Muhammad (S.A.W) is distinguished in many ways:-

The religion of Islam brought by the prophet (S.A.W) is a perfect religion and deals with all the aspects of human life i.e. Political, economic, ethical, legal and social aspects, it is perfect in all respect, Allah says, **“This day I have perfected your religion for you, completed my favours upon you and have chosen for you islam as your religion.”** (Al-Maidah 5:3)

It is a universal message for a entire mankind. Muhammad (S.A.W) was not sent down for any particular country or nation but to the whole world, Allah says, **“And we have not sent you (Muhammad!) save as a bringer of good tidings and a warner to all the mankind.”** (Saba 34:28) Again he says **“we sent you not (O Muhammad) but as the mercy of the world.”** (AL-Anbiya 21:107) The prophet (S.A.W) said **“Every prophet who preceded me was sent especially to his own people, but I have been sent as a prophet to all mankind.”** (Sahih Bukhari)

The prophethood of the prophet Muhammad (S.A.W) is eternal.

The message of Muhammad (S.A.W) has been preserved in the Qur'an. It is unchanged, Allah promised to safeguard it, Allah says, **“we have without doubt sent down the reminder, And we will certainly guard it.”**

The details of life and sayings of Muhammad (S.A.W) are also recorded and preserved.

WEEK 05

DAY 02 (Paper 01)

Revelation of Quran (610AD – 632AD)

- As Prophet (pbuh) approached the age of 40, he started retiring into a cave a nearby mountain known as Hira. One day angel Jibrail appeared before him and asked him to read. This was repeated thrice after which the Angel recited the following five verses of **Sura Alaq also known as Sura Iqra**,
"Proclaim in the name of your Lord and Cherisher who created, created man out of a clot of congealed blood. Proclaim and your Lord is the most bountiful. He who taught by the pen. Taught man that which he knew not." (96:1-5)

This was the first revelation and the beginning of Prophet hood of Hazrat Muhammad (pbuh). From this time onwards, that is **610 A.D**, he continued to receive revelations throughout the rest of his life for a period of **22 years 5 months and 14 days**.

- After the first revelation, sura al-'Alaq, revelation stopped for a period which caused the Prophet to worry. This interval is known as **"fatrah tul wahi"**. Once they started again they came strongly and frequently.
They were not within his control (sura 75:16–19), he had no idea when they were coming and they were safeguarded by God.
The Quran says, **"Move not your tongue with it, (O Muhammad), to hasten with recitation of the Quran. Indeed upon us is its collection and its recitation. So when we have recited it (through Jabriel), then follow its recitation. Then upon us is its clarification (to you)"** (Al Qiyamah 75:16-19)
- When a revelation came, the Holy Prophet (pbuh) experienced different **sensations**. He heard **ringing** sounds, he **perspired in the cold**; he **became so heavy** that the animal he was riding on and his companions could feel the weight of his body. A few times the Prophet saw the Angel in his original form, e.g. on the night journey (sura najm). The most difficult was when they came as the ringing of a bell, and this would weigh down on him, so much so that his camel could not withstand the weight. He also received revelation in dreams. He also received revelation directly from God during the night journey (Last 2 verses of surah Baqarah).
- When a companion once asked of Prophet (pbuh) how a revelation comes to him, he replied,
"It comes to me sometimes as the ringing of a bell and this is hardest on me, then he leaves me and I remember from him what he says and sometimes the Angel comes in the shape of a man and he talks to me and I remember what he says."
Hazrat Aisha reports, **"I saw revelations coming down upon him in the severest cold and when that condition was over, perspiration ran down his forehead."**
A companion relates that once he was sitting with his leg under the leg of the Prophet. A revelation came at that moment and he felt his leg would crush under the weight.
- Zayd bin Thabit, one of the chief scribes relates: **"When the revelation came to him he felt intense heat and drops of perspiration used to roll down his body like pearls. When this state was over I used to fetch a shoulder bone or a piece of something else. He used to go on dictating and I used to write it down. When I finished writing the sheer weight of transcription gave me the feeling that my leg would break and I would not be able to walk anymore"**
- He received revelations as divine instructions on all important occasions of his life. Revelations received in **Makkah** during **610 to 622** are known as **Makkan surahs**. These are generally brief and are related to articles of faith. e.g oneness of Allah, life after death etc. they also talk about the opposition of the unbelievers and the language used is stronger. Throughout all the years of persecutions and hardships in Makah, Prophet (pbuh) received revelations which not only consoled and comforted him but also his followers e.g. **Sura al Duha and Surah al Kauther** etc.

- In 622 A.D Prophet and his followers **migrated to Madina** when he was instructed through revelation. During migration he was reassured of divine help when Abu Bakr was worried in the cave of Thaur(Saur). **“For Allah did indeed help him, when the unbelievers drove him out: he had no more than one companion the two were in the cave and he said to his companion, have no fear, for Allah is with us” (9:40).**
- The surahs received during **622AD to 632AD** are known as **Madni surahs**. This includes verses which were revealed during the battles, as well as those revealed in Makah and Arafat during and after the farewell Pilgrimage. They contain social, economic, political, criminal as well as spiritual laws that are important for the organization and development of Islamic State. These surahs are generally lengthy.
- In 624 A.D Prophet (pbuh) received a revelation in which the **permission of fighting** was given in these words, **“Fight in the cause of Allah against those who fight you.” (2:190)**

He continued to receive revelations till his **farewell pilgrimage in 631A.D**. The last revelation received by him was in the plain of Arafat after he performed Hajj and delivered the sermon:

“This day have I perfected your religion for you, completed My favor upon you, and have chosen for you Islam as your religion.” (5:3)

The Quran was revealed in portions but it did not remain long in that condition as it was simultaneously recorded by the Scribes.

2.(b) What was the significance of the Prophet being given the revelation by word rather than in writing? [4]

- the Arabs at the time had an oral tradition and it was in keeping with that. As people committed things to memory it was a more reliable way of ensuring the Qur'an's preservation.
- Had it been delivered in a book, it would have been harder to check if any changes had been made.
- If the Prophet had been given it in written form, he would not have been able to read or write it, and because of this the oral revelation allowed the message to be memorised by him and committed to heart, again ensuring there were no errors.
- It is significant because the Qur'an is primarily a book of worship, in a vocative tone, rather than a legal written guide.

Preservation of Quran during Prophet's lifetime:

- The Holy Quran started to be revealed in **610 AD** and continued for a period of **22 years 5 months and 14 days**. The Quran was revealed in portions but it did not remain long in that condition. Though it could not be completed until the last verse was revealed, it was never without some form of arrangement and every verse and chapter was given its place in the Book.
- Whenever, a revelation was received by the Prophet (P.B.U.H) he would summon one of his literate companions and dictate the text to him. He would then ask him to read what he had written. This was to ensure perfect accuracy. He would also ask them to memorize the verses in order to recite them in their daily prayers. Zaid bin Thabit says, **“The Prophet(pbuh) used to go on dictating and I used to write it down. When I finished writing, he would say, 'Read!' and I would read it back to him. If there was an omission or error he used to correct it and then let it be brought before the people.”**
- The Quran was written on thin and flat tablets of stone, wood, branches of palm trees, bones of camels and goats and on piece of leather etc.
- The verse and chapters of the holy Quran were not compiled in the order of revelation, for example, the first five verses of Surah Alaq are the first in order of revelation, but they are placed in the 96th chapter whereas, the chapters which appear at the beginning of the Quran were revealed at Madinah after the Prophet (P.B.U.H) migration. The arrangement of different verses and chapters of the Quran was done under the guidance of Hazrat Jibrail. According to Hazrat Usman every portion of Quran was written down and given its specified place at the command of the Prophet (P.B.U.H). It was

customary with the messenger of Allah that when verses of different chapters were revealed to him or when any chapter was revealed, he would call one of his scribes and say to him “write this verse in the chapter where such and such verse occur” (Ahmad)

- The Quran did exist in the written form but no complete copy of it existed at the time, nor could such a copy be made while the Prophet (P.B.U.H) was alive and still receiving revelations. The whole Quran in one arrangement was safely preserved in the memories of the reciters. It was the practice of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) to recite loudly the text of the Quran, revealed so far every year, during the month of Ramazan. Those companions who had written it down would bring out their manuscripts and compare it with the version of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) so that they could check the text and order of the chapter. In the last year of his life, a few months before his death, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) read out the complete text of the Quran twice. In this way, the Divine Message was recorded in scriptural form and learnt by heart to be preserved for the coming generations.

Compilation of Quran

Hazrat Abu Bakr (R.A)

- During the time of the Prophet (pbuh) the Qur'an was written on pieces of animal skin and on parts of bone but was mainly memorised by the companions. At the time of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) death no official copy of the Quran existed.
- After becoming caliph, Hazrat Abu Bakr waged a war against the false prophet **Musailima** and many companions who had committed the Holy Quran to memory were martyred in that battle known as the **battle of Yamama**. **Hazrat Umar** suggested to Hazrat Abu Bakr that the Quran should be compiled. Hazrat Abu Bakr, however, hesitated and said that he would not do the job left unfinished by the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H). According to Hazrat Abu Bakr, **“Umar went on persuading me to accept his suggestion till I was convinced that he was right so I accepted his suggestion.”**
- Hazrat Abu Bakr asked **Zaid bin Sabit**, one of scribes of Divine revelation to collect the Quranic verses from every part of the Islamic empire and compile them in book form. He was also reluctant but Abu Bakr persuaded him. Zaid later remarked, **“It would have been easier to carry a mountain on my shoulders, than to compile the Quran.”**

A commission was appointed headed by Zaid Bin Sabit and its members comprised at least **twenty or twenty five** companions who had committed the Quran to memory. Zaid Bin sabit traced out and collected the chapters of the Quran from every person who had it in their possession. He collected it from palm leaves, stones, and pieces of wood and people who had committed it to memory.

- He applied the following careful methods for accepting any verse or surah.

He was not content just finding a written piece of the Quran. He also verified it from those people who had heard it from the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H). Though he himself was a hafiz of Quran, he always tried to find a verse in writing before including it in his manuscript. He only accepted those verses which were in the dialect of Quraish. He did not accept any part without two witnesses to it. The verses were written in the order that the Prophet (pbuh) had given, but the surahs were written on separate sheets.

So that version of the Quran he recorded was the one heard from and written under the supervision of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H).

- The script prepared by Zaid Bin Sabit was named **“Mushaf”** by **Abdullah bin Masood**. It remained with Abu Bakr and after his death was transferred to the custody of Hazrat Umar, the second Khalifa, who gave it to **Hazrat Hafsa**, a widow of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H). This copy of the Quran came to be known as **Mushaf al –Hafsa** i.e Hafsa's copy of Holy Book.

Hazrat Usman (R.A)

- During 'Uthman's time as caliph, Islam had spread to other areas. **Hazrat Huzaifa bin Yamaan** reported to Hazrat 'Usman that people in different areas, in particular in **Armenia and Azerbaijan**, were reciting the Qur'an in a **different dialect**. He requested him to take immediate action for the removal of these differences; otherwise it might create a rift among the Muslims.
- Accordingly, Hazrat Usman acquired the copy of the Quran prepared by Zaid Bin Sabit from Hazrat Hafsa. He appointed Zaid Bin Sabit along with three other knowledgeable Muslims, **Abdur Rehman bin Harris, Abdullah bin Zubair** and **Saad bin Aas**, who assisted to make copies of the Quran from the original text. They were told to follow the dialect of the Quraish in case of differences over the language, as the Quran had been revealed in that dialect.
- The Quran was read out loudly from the beginning to the end in the Prophet (P.B.U.H) mosque from these copies of the Quran, so that not a shadow of doubt remained in the mind of anyone that changes had been introduced in the Quran.
- These copies were then dispatched to the capital city of every Province of the Islamic State with instructions that in future copies should be made only from the official authentic text. Hazrat Usman also ordered that if anyone had a copy with a different text, it was to be destroyed by fire. Hazrat Usman also sent teachers to these areas to teach the correct dialect to the inhabitants of these areas.
- Hazrat Usman is Known as **Jami-al-Quran**. These means that he brought the Muslims around to a uniform reading of the Quran.

2(b) Why did these caliphs think it was important to make a compilation of the Qur'an? [4]

- Abu Bakr came to see at the suggestion of Umar that the Qur'an could not be kept in memories alone.
- Although the Prophet had not made a written compilation, Abu Bakr realised that this would have to be done if the authentic Qur'an was to be preserved for the guidance of the future generations otherwise it would be lost or corrupted like the previous divine books.
- 'Uthman realised that the original message might be lost.
- If different versions were allowed to exist the original meaning might no longer survive.
- Muslims would not have a single source of guidance.
- Rival interpretations might break the unity of the community.
- Only the original revelation given to the Prophet could preserve unity

Q2. (b) What is the significance to Muslims today of having the Quran in the form of a Book? [4]

- Having the Qur'an in book form ensures a standard copy which lessens the likelihood of it being reproduced with mistakes.
- If the Qur'an had not been collected into book form, parts may have been lost.
- It also suggests unity between Muslims, e.g. they use the same book, they read it in its original language even if that language is not their own
- The practical benefits include that copies can be carried by individuals, and referred to with ease.
- Even those who do not speak Arabic can read it and get the rewards.
- The availability of the written form of the Qur'an digitally, gives easy access to Muslims.

Week 05
DAY 03 (Paper 01)
Quran as a source of Islamic Law
Legal Thinking/ Guidance

Islam is built on the foundation of faith. Allah's will is the primary source of law in a Muslim society. The Quran is the most fundamental and reliable source of legal thinking in Islam, as it says, **"Verily this Quran guides to which is most right" (17:9)**

It contains a set of legal commands which are the basis of Islamic law and which concern the life of human being in every detail. **"Blessed is He Who sent down the Criterion to His servant, that it may be an admonition to all creatures" (25:1)**

It deals with the institutions such as marriage or divorce. Emphasis is laid on behavior towards women, orphans, relatives, slaves, and dependants. It also provides guidance about laws of inheritance.

The following examples illustrate the role of Quran as a source of guidance and legal thinking in Islam.

1. In matters of religion the Quran talks about the pillars of Islam for example, it says, **"And establish regular prayer and give the charity tax, and bow down your heads with those who bow down." [2:43]**
2. The Quran lays down rules related to **Muslims social life**. It lays down commands to decide the matters with justice, not to offer bribe and to give full weight and measures. **"Give full measure when you measure and weigh with the balance that is straight" (17:35)**
3. There are **penal laws** concerning false accusations, blood money and retaliation. The Quran lays down a simple rule as a punishment for crimes. It says, **"We ordained therein for them, Life for life, eye for eye, nose for nose, ear for ear, tooth for tooth and wounds equal for equal." (5:45)**
4. The Quran also commands Muslims to **stay away from un-Islamic practices** i.e drinking wine, playing games of chance, charging interest etc. **"O you who believe! Intoxicants and gambling, sacrificing of stones and arrows are all Satan's handiwork, show restraint to them so that you may prosper" (5:90)**
5. Contracts are safeguarded by the command to put them in writing, to fulfill one's undertaking to return a trust or deposit and not eat up the property of orphans. **"Those who unjustly eat up the property of orphans, eat up a fire into their own bodies" (4:10)**
6. Quran also explain us the difference between Haram and Halal and forbids the Muslims from eating anything on which Allah's name has not been pronounced. The Quran says, **"Lawful unto you are all four footed animals with the exception named". (5:1)**

All **other sources of Islamic law**, which is Hadith, ijma and Qiyas depend upon it for their acceptance and justification. They can only be used when Quran is silent on an issue and they

never contradict it. However, the Quran does not sometime give the practical guidance which can be obtained from the Sunnah. Thus the Quran and Sunnah are called the primary source of law.

Relationship between Quran and Hadith

Paper 01

M/J 2009

2 (a) How are the Qur'an and Hadiths used together in Islamic legal thinking? [10]

O/N 2010

2 (a) Describe how the two main sources of Islamic legal thinking are related. [10]

O/N 2012

2 (a) Write about the way in which the two primary sources of Islamic legal thinking are used. [10]

M/J 2014(12)

2 (a) The Sunna is often used with the Qur'an as a primary source of Islamic law. Describe the ways in which they are used together. [10]

O/N 2017(11)

2(a) Write about the function of the Qur'an and Sunna as the two primary sources of Islamic law. [10]

Paper 02

O/N 2015 (21)

2. (a) Describe how the Prophet's Hadiths can be used together with the Qur'an to help Muslims understand and practise their faith. [10]

O/N 2016 (21)

2 (a) Describe the relationship of Hadiths with the Qur'an, giving examples of how Hadiths are used in understanding God's words. [10]

M/J 2018 (21)

2(a) Outline the relationship between the Hadith and the Qur'an as sources of Islamic law. Give examples to support your answer. [10]

M/J 2020 (22)

2(a) Outline the relationship between the Qur'an and Hadith when formulating Islamic law. [10]

Answer:

From the earliest times, Muslims usually refer to the practice of the Prophet when they wanted to know exactly how to reach a decision. The ahadith were always regarded as important source of teaching alongside the Quran. Allah says,

"So take what the Messenger gives you, and refrain from what he prohibits you." [59:7]

The Prophet (pbuh) said:

"Behold I have been given the Book and a similar thing (Sunnah) along with that."

Particularly among legal experts they became acknowledged as a source which was second only to the Quran itself. In fact, it was agreed that the divine revelation from Allah and the words and actions of the Prophet Muhammad were so closely related, that what the Quran stated in general terms could be further explained by referring to the Holy Prophet's ahadith.

1. As all Muslims know, the Quran teaches that Muslims must pay **Zakat**, the charity tax. This is usually mentioned in the Quran together with Salat, as an activity of sincere believers.

“And be steadfast in prayer, give the charity tax, and bow down your heads with those who bow down.” [2:43]

In this example Muslims are encouraged to give Zakat, but they are not told exactly what they should give, or how they should give it. These details are found in the Hadith of the Holy Prophet:

“Abu Sa’id al-Khudri narrated that the Messenger of Allah said: No charity tax is due on property mounting to less than five Uqiya (of silver), and no charity tax is due on fewer than five camels, and there is no charity tax on fewer than five Wasq(of wheatgrain).”

[the two words Uqiya and Wasq refer to the measures of weight]

Ahadith such as this helped legal experts to give advice to Muslims about how the teachings in the Quran about Zakat should be obeyed. They also formed the basis of the rules about Zakat in the religious law of Islam.

2. In penal law related to theft the Qur’an says,

‘As for the thief both male and female cut off their hands’.(5:38) But it is not explained, how much of the hand needs to be cut off? Which hand, the left or the right is to be cut off? The Prophet (pbuh) explained the verse on theft saying, **“the right hand up to the wrist is to be cut off.”**

3. The hours of fasting in the month of Ramadan are mentioned in the Quran in these words, **“And eat and drink until the white thread becomes distinct to you from black thread of dawn.”**

When companions were unable to understand this verse, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) interpreted by saying that **“the white thread refers to day and black thread refers to the night.”**

4. The Quran has many teachings about financial dealings. **Riba**, the taking of interest for making a loan to someone is entirely prohibited in Quran:

“They say, trade is like interest, and Allah has allowed trade and forbidden interest.” [2:275]

In this injunction and elsewhere in the revelation it is not clearly mentioned that what kind of business transactions are regarded as Riba. The Sunnah explains it clearly:

“We asked the Messenger of Allah about the money exchange, he replied: if it is from hand to hand , there is no harm in it; otherwise it is not permissible.”

The remarks of the Prophet about the wickedness of Riba (interest) were used by the legal experts together with the Quran to build a wider picture of what is accepted as trading practice in Islam and what is condemned.

5. Hadith makes certain exceptions to the general rules as laid down by the Holy Quran. The Quran made a declaration in general that one may inherit his property to his parents or children.

“It is prescribed, when death approaches any of you, if he leaves any goods, that he should make a bequest to parents and next of kin.” [2:180]

Hadith has created the exception in the rule by declaring that there will be no transfer of inheritance between Muslims and non-muslims.

“A Muslim may not inherit from a non-muslims, nor a non-muslim may inherit from a Muslim.”

These examples show that Hadiths contain tafsir(interpretation) which are invaluable guides to key verses in the Quran, and help Muslims understand the words of their creator better, thus enables them to live their lives in accordance with the tenets of Islam.

2 (b) What does the Prophet’s first experience of revelation tell us about the nature of prophethood in Islam. [4]

- The Prophet’s first experience of revelation in the cave of Hira helps us to understand the concept of prophet hood in Islam.
- It shows that Allah chose prophets according to His own will which means that it was predestined and could not be attained by personal efforts.
- It was given without warning and often through miraculous events at the time of calling which caused confusion and fear. For example, Prophet Muhammad got afraid when he was squeezed by angel Jibrael. Similarly , Hazrat Musa got confused when God addressed him for the first time.
- This fear and confusion shows that the prophets were chosen from mankind.
- This event also shows that Jibrael acted as a link between God and Prophets.

2.(b) How are Muslims obeying God when they obey the Prophet? [4]

- By following the Prophet’s (pbuh) example, for instance in how to perform salat, Muslims are not only following his instruction but also fulfilling their obligation to God by completing the second Pillar of Islam.
- So in this way they are obeying both the Prophet (pbuh) and God.
- Similarly in social life we can fulfill the rights of fellow beings by implementing the hadiths of the prophet (pbuh).
- For example the Quran emphasizes to take care of the orphans and warns those who repulse the orphans. This commands can be obeyed by the implementation of the this hadith. The Prophet (pbuh) said, ***“I and the man who brings up an orphan will be in paradise like this’ and he pointed with his two fingers, the index finger and middle figure.”***

Week 05

DAY 04(Paper 01)

Ijma

O/N 2015

Paper 02

- ▶ **2 (a) Outline the role of the Ijma (consensus) in formulating Islamic law. [10]**

Paper 02

▶ **M/J 2017**

- ▶ **2(a) 'My community will never agree upon an error'.**

The Prophet's Hadith encourages the use of consensus of opinion (ijma'). Outline:

- (i) . what consensus of opinion (ijma') is, and how many kinds of ijma' there are;
- (ii)• who is qualified to practise it;
- (iii)• **give** examples of how the Prophet and the Rightly Guided Caliphs practised ijma'. **[10]**

ANSWER:

Meaning and Justification:

According to the principles of Islamic law, ijma is the third source. The word ijma means "consensus" or "unanimous agreement". It is related to the same verb as jum'a, Friday, and jami, mosque. It should be referred to only when there is no clear teaching in the Quran or Sunna.

The use of ijma in legal thinking is based on a number of verses in the Quran, for example

- **"Thus have We made of you a community justly balanced, that you might be witnesses over the nation, and the Messenger a witness over yourselves." [2:143]**
- **"You are the best of people evolved for mankind, enjoining what is right forbidding what is wrong and believing in Allah." [3:110]**

These and other verses like them indicate that the community has been given authority because it is upright and follows the guidance of Allah and the example of the Prophet (pbuh).

The Holy Prophet (pbuh) also referred to the importance of following the community, when he said, **"My community will never agree upon an error."** The Holy Prophet to have said, **"Gather together the righteous from among my community and decide the matter by their counsel and do not decide it by any man's opinion."** Therefore, from very early times it has been accepted that the agreed view of the community is binding upon Muslims in legal and more general matters.

Kinds of Ijma:

There are two broad kinds of Ijma. **The first** is the general agreement of all Muslims in matters of belief, for example, that the Quran is the most authentic revealed book and that the Prophet (pbuh) was the best of all creation. This kind of Ijma is the acknowledgment of the beliefs that characterize Islam and are shared by all believers. **The second** particularly concerns legal matters and can be defined as the agreement of a group of Muslims about an issue on which the Quran and Holy Prophet's Sunnah have not spoken the final word.

Who is qualified to practice this?

Legal experts have differed over who makes up this 'group of Muslims' whose Ijma should be accepted. Some said that they should be the companions of the Prophet (pbuh); others that they should be the people of

Madina; yet others that they should be the Rightly Guided Caliphs. Shi'i Muslims claim that they should be the descendents of the Holy Prophet (Imams), while others said that they should be the legal scholars of any generation.

Examples from Quran [Paper 01]

- Regarding inheritance the Quran says,
 - **"It is prescribed, when death approaches any of you, if he leaves any goods, that he should make a bequest to parents and next of kin."** [2:180]
 - If a father has died before his son, and the son also dies, then **the grandfather shares in the son's estate, together with other relatives.** It allows for grandfather to take the father's place in inheriting from the son, even though it is not stated in so many words in the Quran.
- **Marriage between a man and any of his grandmothers or granddaughters** is forbidden. This is based on the teachings in the Quran which begins, **"Prohibited to you are: your mothers, daughters, sisters; father's sisters, mother's sisters. Brother's daughters, sister's daughter; foster mothers, foster sisters; your wives' mothers, your step daughters under your guardianship, born of your wives."** [4:23]

The principles follows the spirit of this full list, and adds two categories about which it is silent but which clearly conform to all the one mentioned here.

Examples From Hadith [Paper 01,02]

The Prophet (P.B.U.H) always practised consensus of opinion (ijma) by consulting his companions on important matters. For example, in the battle of Uhud he consulted his companions and accepted their suggestion of fighting outside Madina although he himself had a different opinion.

- Similarly, he practised ijma before the battle of Trench and accepted the suggestion of Salman Farsi.

Examples of Caliphs [Paper 02]

Compilation of the Qur'an.

The Qur'an was revealed in a span of 23 years. It was not compiled in a book form during the life of Prophet (p.b.u.h.). After his death, Hazrat Abu Bakr on suggestion of Umar (R.A) and by Ijm'a of the Companions, Quran was compiled in a book form when many Companions of the Prophet (p.b.u.h.) were killed in the battle of Yamamah.

Tarawih Prayers in congregation

The Prophet (p.b.u.h.) prayed tarawih only three or four times in congregation in his lifetime. It was later during the reign of the Caliph Umar (R.A) that the system of congregation of Tarawih was added after Isha prayers.

Two Adhan of Jum'ah.

During the time of Prophet (p.b.u.h.) there was only one Adhan for Jumu'ah prayers but during the reign of the Caliph Uthman, Madinah expanded considerably and the Adhan could not be heard because of noise in the markets, therefore, it was decided after Ijm'a of the companions that another call should be given.

Conclusion

These examples show that ijma can be regarded as a continuation of the divine teaching for legal and practical purposes. It was always safeguarded by the agreement of leading Muslims or of experts who could say whether or not a principle was in harmony with the Quran and Sunnah.

Qiyas [Analogy]

Meaning

Qiyas actually comes from a verb that means to measure one thing by comparing with another thing that is similar to it.

"Qiyas is the legal method of deducing one principle from another by comparing them together." This is the fourth basis of legal method, according to Sunni Islam, coming after the Quran, Sunna and Ijma. Shi'i Muslims do not accept it because it involves a lot of individual opinions and causes unease some Muslims.

Justification from Quran

Qiyas is often also seen in the Quran. The great expert al-Shafi'i for example, cited the verse:

"Turn then your face in the direction of the Holy Mosque; and wheresoever you are, turn your faces in that direction." (al-Baqara 2:150)

And he argued that you should face the Ka'ba when you can see it, but face in its direction when you cannot see it, using reason to determine by the sun, stars, etc. where its direction lies.

Justification from Hadith

for exercising Qiyas is usually based on the following Ahadith:

When the Prophet (pbuh) sent Mu'adh Ibn Jabal as judge to the Yemen, he asked him,

'How will you reach a judgment when a question arises?'

Mu'adh replied, 'according to the Word of Allah.'

"And if you find nothing therein?" the Prophet asked him.

"According to the Sunnah of the Prophet," he answered.

"And if you find nothing therein?"

"Then I will exert myself to form my own judgement", Mu'az replied.

The Holy Prophet's response was: "Praise be to Allah who has guided the messenger of His Prophet to that which pleases His Prophet." (Abu Daud/Timizi)

Method

This example takes us into the method used in Qiyas, the drawing of comparisons or analogies between two principles. The experts identified these elements as being necessary to a sound analogy:

- The fundamental teaching (asl, root)
- The new matter in question (far', branch)
- The linking cause that connects them ('illa).
- By relating these together it is possible to arrive at the new judgement, the hukm.

Examples

Quran

This may be illustrated by the following examples:

1. Asl: the Quran forbids sales transactions after the call to prayer on Friday; The Holy Quran relate "O ye who believe! when the call is proclaimed to prayer on Friday (the day of assembly) hasten earnestly to the remembrance of Allah, and leave off business (and traffic) that is the best for you if ye but knew!" [62:9]

by analogy, therefore, all kinds of transaction (far')

have been forbidden; (Hukm)

'illa: every kind of transaction is forbidden because like sales, they distract Muslims from Friday prayers.

2. Ali (R.A) applied Qiyas, when he suggested punishment of 80 lashes to the drunkard, "Umar ibn al-Khattab asked advice about a man drinking wine. Ali ibn Abi Talib said to him, "We think that you flog him for it with eighty lashes. Because when he drinks, he becomes intoxicated, and when he becomes intoxicated, he talks confusedly, and when he talks confusedly, he lies." (80 lashes is the same amount as for slandering) Umar gave eighty lashes for drinking wine. (Muatta) This is based on "And those who launch a charge against chaste woman and produce not four witnesses (to support their allegation) flog them with eighty stripes." (An-Nur 24:4)

It is important to say that the asl must always be a principle from the Quran (as in this example), the Sunnah or Consensus.

This is how Qiyas has been recognized as the fourth basis of establishing the sacred law of Islam. It is generally accepted only when no clear guidance is given by the Quran, Sunnah or Consensus of the community.

Hadith

3. Asl: The Fundamental teaching is described by the Prophet (S.A.W), "Every intoxicant is Khamr so every intoxicant is haram." (Sunnan Abu Daud)

Far; the (subsidiary) : L.S.D cocaine opium and all other drugs

'illa (the cause) connecting them is intoxication

Hukm (Law): all these drugs are declared haram (forbidden)

4. Another example is that Wudu is not valid even if the smallest portion of the body, which has to be washed remains dry. According to a tradition reported by A'isha (R.A) if flour is dried on the nails and water has not reached any portion of that nail, Wudu would not be considered to have taken place, so applying this in the case of nail polish, the Wudu is not considered to have taken place as the nails remain dry.

2(b) Why some legal Scholars reject the use of analogy (qiyas)?

- Qiyas is the fourth source of Islamic law according to Sunni Muslims coming after Quran, Hadith and Ijma. It involves the comparison of an existing accepted situation with a new one.
- Some Muslims especially Shia reject it because it involves a lot of individual opinion.
- Its decision may differ from one person to another and therefore, cause unease for some Muslims
- e.g in the Quranic command about polygamy the qiyas of one person will be different from other due to which a specific number cannot be decided for anyone.
- It does not have the same broad support of the community through communal agreement as other three sources have.

Qur'an with the other three sources

O/N 2014

2 (a) Write about how the Qur'an is used with the other three sources in Islamic law. [10]

Answer:

- **The Quran** is the only revealed Book of God which is protected by God Himself. It is the fountain head not only of Islamic religion but also of Islamic law. It is not in the form of any definite codes, but in all matters with which it deals, it is the primary and final authority.

Allah says in the Holy Quran that,

"(It is) an exposition of that which is decreed for mankind." [10:37]

The Holy Quran lays down the basic law, and Muslims are enjoined to decide all the disputes in accordance with the law as laid therein. Some verses of the Holy Quran on this point are,

"We have sent down to you the Book of Truth, so that you may judge between men according to law as laid down by God." [4:105]

All other sources of law depend upon it for their authenticity and none of them ever contradict it.

- **Sunnah** of the Prophet is the second primary source of Islamic law. From the earliest times, Muslims usually refer to the practice of the Prophet when they wanted to know exactly how to reach a decision. The ahadith were always regarded as important source of teaching alongside the Quran.

Qur'an says,

"So take what the Messenger gives you, and refrain from what he prohibits you." [59:7]

The Prophet (pbuh) declared:

"Behold I have been given the Book and a similar thing (Sunnah) along with that."

Particularly among legal experts they became acknowledged as a source which was second only to the Quran itself.

As all Muslims know, the Quran teaches that Muslims must pay Zakat, the charity tax. This is usually mentioned in the Quran together with Salat, as an activity of sincere believers.

"And be steadfast in prayer, give the charity tax, and bow down your heads with those who bow down." [2:43]

In this example Muslims are encouraged to give Zakat, but they are not told exactly what they should give, or how they should give it. These details are found in the Hadith of the Holy Prophet:

the Messenger of Allah said: "No charity tax is due on property mounting to less than five Uqiya, and no charity tax is due on fewer than five camels, and there is no charity tax on fewer than five Wasq." Ahadith such as this helped legal experts to give advice to Muslims about how the teachings in the Quran Zakat should be obeyed.

When neither of the primary sources offer answers, then *ijma'* and *qiyas* can be used. These are used mainly for issues that did not arise at the time of the Prophet.

- According to Islamic law, **ijma** is the third source. The word *ijma* means "consensus" or "unanimous agreement". It should be referred to only when there is no clear teaching in the Quran or Sunna.

"You are the best of people evolved for mankind, enjoining what is right forbidding what is wrong and believing in Allah." [3:110]

Ijma is used to interpret and explain the teachings of Quran when Hadith is also silent on that issue, for example;

If a father has died before his son, when the son himself dies the grandfather shares in the son's estate, together with other relatives.

It is based on the Quranic injunction:

"It is prescribed, when death approaches any of you, if he leaves any goods, that he should make a bequest to parents and next of kin." [2:180]

It allows for grandfather to take the father's place in inheriting from the son, even though it is not stated in so many words in the Quran.

This example shows that *ijma* can be regarded as a continuation of the divine teaching for legal and practical purposes. Some issues they have to deal with have been, at the time of the caliphs, the compiling of the Qur'an during Hazrat Abu Bakr's caliphate and more recently, the permissibility of IVF for married Muslim couples who do not have children.

- **Qiyas** actually comes from a verb that means to measure one thing by comparing with another thing that is similar to it.

This is the fourth basis of legal method, according to Sunni Islam, coming after the Quran, Sunna and *Ijma*. This may be illustrated by the following example:

Asl: the Quran forbids sales transactions after the call to prayer on Friday; The Holy Quran relate "O ye who believe! when the call is proclaimed to prayer on Friday (the day of assembly) hasten earnestly to the remembrance of Allah, and leave off business (and traffic) that is the best for you if ye but knew!" [62:9] by analogy, therefore, all kinds of transaction (*far'*)

have been forbidden; (*Hukm*)

'illa: every kind of transaction is forbidden because like sales, they distract Muslims from Friday prayers.

It is important to say that the *asl* must always be a principle from the Quran (as in this example), the Sunnah or Consensus. It shows that the secondary sources do not contradict the primary sources but rather use the primary sources as a basis for their answers.

2 (b) How important is the use of *ijma'* or *qiyas* in Islamic law in present day situations? Give reasons for your answers. [4]

- New rulings can be formed for any new circumstance, based on their basic similarity with the basic laws of the Qur'an and sunna. In this way the divine laws revealed in the Qur'an and sunna remain unchanged without becoming outdated.
- The fundamental laws were made by God who created man and knows what's best for him at all times. For changing aspects of human life, the Qur'an and sunna provide basic principles which may be applied by analogy whenever the need arises
- such as smoking, using the internet, drugs, etc. It is important otherwise Muslims would not know how to react to these new issues

WEEK 06
DAY 01 (Paper 01)
Imamat (Spiritual Leadership)

Hasan Ibn Ali(RA)

- He was the first son of Hazrat Fatima(RA) and Hazrat Ali (RA). He was born in Medina in 3AH/625 AD.
- He was given his name by the Holy Prophet pbuh himself. There are stories of the Prophet pbuh allowing him and his brother to climb on his back while he was prostrating prayer, and interrupting his sermon to come down from the Minbar(pulpit) to pick him up when he tripped over. These show the love Hazrat Muhammad pbuh felt and the pride he took in his grandchildren. Prophet (pbuh) once said, "O Allah ! I love him, so I beg you to love him."
- In the years following the death of the Holy Prophet pbuh we hear of Hasan and Husayn being sent by their father to take water to Hazrat Usman when he was besieged by his opponents, before his assassination in 35AH/656AD. And during Hazrat Ali's caliphate, Hasan was sent to Kufa to seek reinforcement during the struggle with Talha, Zubair and Hazrat Aisha. He was among his father's force in the battle of Siffin.
- After the assassination of Hazrat Ali in 40 AH/ 661AD, his supporters proclaimed Hasan as the Caliph. But Muawiya, the Governor of Syria rejected this and moved forces against him. Hasan reacted slowly to this threat, may be because he was reluctant to fight against fellow Muslims, and his own forces hesitated. His position became increasingly weaker, through desertions to Muawiya's side, and Hasan finally renounced the Caliphate after less than a year in the office.
- He settled in Medina, where he died in about 50AH/670AD, at a relatively young age. Many say that he was poisoned by Jauda, one of his wives, who was enticed by Muawiya's promises money and marriage to his son. Hasan was buried in Medina. Shi'i Muslims regard Hasan as a second Imam, following Hazrat Ali Ibn e Abi Talib. So they accept that he was sinless and perfect in his actions. They also credit him with miracles.

Husayn Ibn Ali(RA)

- He was the second son of Hazrat Fatima(RA) and Hazrat Ali (RA). He was born in Medina in 4AH/626 AD. Like his brother, he was named by the Prophet (pbuh). He was a source of great joy to his grandfather, who was remembered as taking him on his knee and carrying him on his back. Prophet (pbuh) said, "Hussain is from me and I am from Hussain, may Allah love him who loves Hussain."
- Husayn was of course a loyal supporter of his father Hazrat Ali and after Hazrat Ali's assassination, he was reluctant to accept Hasan's renunciation of the Caliphate, though he knew that Muawiya was too strong to resist. He made his rejection of the Umayyads clear, when as one of five senior Muslims he refused Muawiya's request to acknowledge Yazid, his son, as a successor to the Caliphate. When Muawiya died, Husayn refused to recognize Yazid as caliph .
- Supporters of his cause invited him to Kufa to lead an uprising against the Umayyads, and he cautiously sent his cousin Muslim Ibn Aqeel to find out the situation. Muslim bin Aqeel detected widespread support among the Kufans and wrote to encourage Husayn to come. But immediately after Muslim sent the letter, he was captured by the Umayyad Governor of Basra and killed. Strict measures were taken against Husayn's supporters in Kufa, who were terrified.
- Husayn meanwhile left Medina for Mecca in Rajab 60AH/680 AD. But suspecting trouble during the Hajj, he set out from Mecca with members of his family and close supporters. This was on 8 Zulhijj60AH/10 September 680 AD. Leading Muslims advised him against this, and people he met on his journey counselled caution. But he was not to be turned aside from his aim. His will was strengthened when he heard that troops had been sent against him, and that his messengers to Kufa had been killed.

• On **2nd Muharram 61AH/ 2nd October 680 AD** Imam Husayn pitched his camp at Karbala, in the desert near Kufa and on 7th Muharram, the water supply to his camp was cut off. Imam Hussain and his supporters had to endure the pangs of hunger and thirst. Negotiations between the two sides were unsuccessful.

• Finally, on **10th Muharram** the battle began between the small but loyal band of Imam Hussain's supporters and the thousands strong Umayyads army. At first, there were minor skirmishes, but as the day wore on many faithful followers of Imam Hussain fought one by one and were killed, and their camp was set on fire.

• Only women and children, and the Imam Hussain's eldest son Ali who was very ill, were now left alive. Imam Hussain finally fought alone and was surrounded by the army of Yazid; he put up a brave resistance but was finally struck down. His head was severed from his body and, along with the heads of his companions, was taken to Yazid's court in Damascus. The surviving son Ali and the women and children were taken captive.

The beloved grandson of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) was brutally martyred for standing up against the rule of injustice and despotism. Muslims all over the world have held Imam Hussain in high regard. Shia Muslims hold him in special reverence as the third imam and because of his decision to lay down his life fighting for what he believed to be just and resisting the ungodly rule of Yazid.

5. (b) Explain how al-Husyan's death remains important to Muslims today? [4]

• The tragedy of the Death of Imam Hussain carries a lesson for the Muslim World. He could have saved himself, his friends and relatives by giving allegiance to Yazid but he stood firm to his principle and ultimately sacrificed himself. He won an everlasting victory over the forces of evil.

• It is a legacy left by him that Muslims should never submit to any authority which goes against the Divine Law and thrusts itself upon the people by force. If the authority is aggressive and evil, sacrifice on the part of the followers of truth becomes more essential.

• Numerical minority or the lack of resources should not stop them from continuing their struggle against evil.

• Despite being helplessly besieged by the enemy along with members of his family. Imam Hussain did not give up his principles of truth and did not surrender to unjust rule. So Muslims are encouraged to speak out against injustice and be upholder of truth whatever the circumstances.

(b) Explain why they each died in the way they did. [4]

Al-Hasan died because of the constant threat from the Umayyads to secure power, and they always viewed al-Hasan as an obstacle due to his support and his being the grandson of the Prophet. His poisoning reflects the treachery of the Umayyads.

Al-Husayn died because he resisted the Umayyads as he saw them as corrupt. He did not accept Yazid bin Muawiyya as the caliph because his succession to caliphate was against the Islamic principles as it changed the caliphate into monarchy. He never gave up on his principles even for his own safety and ultimately sacrificed himself, and so he was seen as an upholder of right against wrong.

Scribes of Divine Revelation:

- Scribes of the Prophet (pbuh") were among the closest companions, They not only kept a record of revelations but also wrote letters and treaties as commanded by the Prophet(pbuh). They were the four rightly guided Caliphs, **Abu Bakr, Umar, Usman, and Ali**, who accompanied the Prophet (pbuh) from his childhood and was a memorizer of Quran. He also wrote the terms of Treaty of al-Hudaibiya.
- The Qur'an was written in its entirety during the Prophet's time even though it was not compiled in one text. There were various scribes who had different roles as companions, who wrote the verses down on a number of materials. These included **animals skin, shoulder bones of camels, palm leaves, stone tablets and pieces of wood etc.**
- Some of them were **official scribes** who wrote letters for him (for example **Ubayy ibn Ka'ab**) whilst some became scribes because they kept their own personal copies of the revelations (for example **'Abdullah ibn 'Amr ibn al-'As**. He sought the Messenger's specific permission asking, 'May I write

down everything I hear from you in the states of contentment and anger?' He replied, '**Yes, for I speak nothing but the truth.**'. A number of companions had their own personal copies of the words of the revelations, which were later used to verify the one copy in the time of Abu Bakr. Companions who kept a private record of the text of the Qur'an satisfied themselves as to the purity of their record by reading it out to the Prophet.

- The Prophet used to instruct the scribes about the sequence in which a revealed message was to be placed in a particular Sura (chapter). In this manner, the Prophet arranged the text of the Qur'an in a systematic order till the end of the chain of revelations. Zayd ibn Thabit reported, "**We used to record the Qur'an from parchments in the presence of the Messenger of God.**" There was always a scribe on hand to write down the revelation or to insert new ones revealed to Holy Prophet under Divine guidance through angel Jibrael during **610AD to 632AD**. This is mentioned in Quran, **"(written) by the hands of the scribes honourable, pious and just."**(80:15-16)
- Zayd bin Thabit, one of the chief scribes relates: "**I used to write down the revelation for the Holy Prophet, may the peace and blessings of Allah be upon him. When the revelation came to him he felt intense heat and drops of perspiration used to roll down his body like pearls. When this state was over I used to fetch a shoulder bone or a piece of something else. He used to go on dictating and I used to write it down. When I finished writing the sheer weight of transcription gave me the feeling that my leg would break and I would not be able to walk anymore. When I finished writing, he would say, 'Read!' and I would read it back to him. If there was an omission or error he used to correct it and then let it be brought before the people.**"
Some companions, who did not write down the revelations, had memorized them instead and their versions were used to verify the written copies after the Prophet's death.

5.(b) Explain the importance of the principles employed by the compilers of the Qur'an at the time of the Caliphs. [4]

After the Prophet's death there was deemed a need to compile the Qur'an into a book form. Various principles were employed, all of them to ensure authenticity to the original message.

- The Qur'an was compiled in **the dialect of Quraysh** because it was the original dialect –other dialects could have been fabricated or distorted.
- Zayd bin Thabit gathered **written materials** from various companions, and checked all these versions with those who had committed the Qur'an to memory –
- this was to ensure that **none** of the written copies had anything **added or omitted** and so that the Qur'an remained authentic to the way the Prophet had received it.
- **The order of the suras** was not compiled in the order that the Prophet had received revelation, but generally in order of descending length – this was due to the belief that the order of the suras was divinely ordained and the main scribes would have known this.

1. Abdullah bin Masood

- Abdullah bin masood was one of the most favourite companions of Holy Prophet^{PBUH} and was well-known for his love for and adherence to the Messenger of Allah.
- He is known as **Sahabi bin Sahabiya** because his brother and mother belonged to the earlier companions of the Prophet^{PBUH}. He is regarded as one of the first converts to Islam who faced tortures of the Quraish with patience. After embracing Islam, he gave up all other business and would always remain present in the service of the Holy Prophet^{PBUH}.
- He learnt Quran with great fondness and attention and is said to be the first one to recite the Quran openly in Makkah. He migrated twice to Abyssinia and later to Madina.
- He took part in the battle of Badr where he killed the Prophet's^{PBUH} greatest enemy, Abu Jahl. He also took part in battle of Uhad.
- He knew the Quran very well, because of his close association with the Holy Prophet^{PBUH}. He was one of the companions named by the Prophet^{PBUH} as one from whom the others should learn the Quran.

(Bukhari) The Holy Prophet^{PBUH} also said: “ **If anyone likes to recite the Quran as fresh as it had descended then he must recite it on the reading of Abdullah bin Masud.**” (Ahmad)

- After the Prophet^{PBUH} death, he was regarded as an expert on interpretation of the Quran.

Hazrat Umar sent him to Kufa as an administrator of the public treasury and as a teacher of religion. Hazrat Umar greatly appreciated his deep knowledge of the Quran and Sunnah and often consulted him on these matters.

- He is said to be the authority on some eight hundred Hadiths.

2. Ubbay bin Ka'ab

- Ubbay bin Ka'ab was one of the main scribes in Madinah who wrote down the revelations of the Holy Quran. He was one of the distinguished companions of the Holy Prophet^{PBUH} and a person of high esteem in the early Muslim community.
- He belonged to the Khazraj tribe and had pledged allegiance to the Holy Prophet^{PBUH} at Aqabah, as such, he was one of the first persons from Yasrib to accept Islam.
- He served as a scribe to the Holy Prophet^{PBUH} and wrote letters for him. **The last verse of the Holy Quran revealed in 10 A.H. is said to be written down by him.**
- His recitation of the Quran was so beautiful and his understanding so profound that the Holy Prophet^{PBUH} encouraged his companions to learn the Quran from him.
- At the time of the Holy Prophet^{PBUH} death, he was one of those who knew the Holy Quran by heart and is said to have possessed his own copy of the sacred text.
- He was constant in his worship and would often be found in the mosque, busy in prayers or teaching. He was a member of the consultative body to which, Hazrat Abu Bakr as Khalifa, referred many problems.

He died in 29 A.H during the Khilafat of Hazrat Usman

3. Zaid bin Sabit/ Thabit:

- Zaid bin Sabit was one of the main scribes of the Holy Prophet^{PBUH}. He belonged to the Khazraj tribe. He had accepted Islam before the Holy Prophet^{PBUH} migration to Madinah. He was eleven years old when he accepted Islam.
- After migration the Prophet appointed Zaid bin Sabit to write down the revelations received by him.
- The Holy Prophet^{PBUH} did not allow Zaid bin Sabit to take part in the Battle of Badr as he was only thirteen years old at that time. He took part in the Battle of Trench and the Tabuk Expedition.
- Zaid bin Sabit was a very learned person who could speak many languages. The Holy Prophet^{PBUH} chose him to learn Hebrew so that he could correspond with the Jews.
- He had a good memory and memorized the Quran during Prophet's lifetime.
- Zaid bin Sabit was the first Ansar to swear allegiance to Hazrat Abu Bakr as the Khalifa. He took part in the battle of Yamama and fought against Musailma, the false prophet, during the Khilafat of Hazrat Abu Bakr.
- When most of the people who had committed the Quran to memory were martyred in the battle of Yamama, Hazrat Abu Bakr entrusted Zaid bin Sabit with the task of collecting the verses of the Quran and compiling them in book form. After hard work and consultation with various companions of the Holy Prophet^{PBUH}, he produced a compilation.
- During the Khilafat of Hazrat Umar, Zaid bin Sabit was appointed as the Qazi of Madinah. Hazrat Umar would often appoint him his deputy at Madinah when he went to perform hajj or Umrah.
- During the Khilafat of Hazrat Usman, he was made responsible for the public treasury. He was also a member of the committee which was formed to prepare copies from the original copy of the Quran.
- Zaid bin Sabit was very knowledgeable about the commands of distribution of inheritance. The Holy Prophet^{PBUH} said that he was the most aware of these issues. (Tirmizi).

Week 06

DAY 02 (Paper 01)

Ten blessed Companions

1. Hazrat Abu Bakr (R.A)

- He was a close friend of the Prophet pbuh from childhood. His pre-Islamic name was Abdul Ka'bah which was later changed into Abdullah by Prophet Mohammad (PBUH). He was called Abu Bakr by Arabs which means the father of baby camels; this is because he was fond of young camels
- He was the first free adult male out of Prophet's immediate family to accept Islam. He accepted Islam without any hesitation. The Prophet pbuh is reported to have said, "Whenever I offered Islam to anyone, he always showed some reluctance.....Abu Bakr was the only person who accepted Islam without any reluctance.....".
- He had to face persecutions for his faith. Once he was pulled by his beard and was dragged through the streets of Makkah when he stopped the Makkans from attacking the Prophet.
- He also brought other prominent Makkans to Islam. For example, Usman, Talha, Zubair and many other companions accepted Islam as a result of his efforts.
- He bought slaves who were Muslims and set them free. For example, he gave one of his pagan slaves and bought Hazrat Bilal and set him free.
- He showed the strength of his faith by readily accepting the truth of the Prophet's account of the Miraj (the Night Journey). For his demonstration of belief, the Prophet pbuh gave him the tilte "Al Siddiq" i.e., "Testifier to the Truth".
- Abu Bakr's closeness to the Prophet was sealed by his daughter Aisha's marriage to the Prophet soon after the death of Hazrat Khadija. He accompanied the Prophet pbuh on the Hijra in 622 AD. During the journey he stayed with the Prophet in the cave of Thaur and was reassured by the Prophet and is referred to in the Quran as "Second of the Two" (9:40).
- After migration , he made a living by farming. He took part in all important battles against the Makkans and the Jews . He fought all the battles during the time of Holy Prophet (PBUH). In battle of Badr he didn't fight but body guarded Prophet (PBUH) camp. In Uhad he showed willingness to fight against his own son AbdurRehman bin Abu Bakr in a duel. He also participated in digging & fighting of battle of trench.
- He again showed his unstinting support for the Prophet by supporting his decision of signing the Treaty of Hudaibiya in 6 AH/628 AD and pacified Hazrat Umar, who was unhappy at the terms of the treaty.
- During the battle of Hunain he remained firm and didn't retreat. He made huge financial contributions to the expedition of Tabuk. He placed all his wealth in donation.
- He led the first pilgrimage to Makkah. He also led the prayers during the Prophet's last illness. Prophet said at the time of his death, " If I were able to choose a friend on earth, I would choose Abu Bakr."
- At the time of Prophet's (pbuh) death, he addressed the Muslim community and made everyone realize that Islam was to continue after the Prophet's (pbuh) death.

2. Hazrat Umar Ibn Khattab (R.A)

- Umar R.A was born in **590 A.D.** He was a learned, educated and the intelligent person. He was a strong spirited person and a wealthy merchant. In the **sixth year** of Islam the Prophet (P.B.U.H) prayed to Allah to strengthen Islam either by Umar bin Khattab or Amr bin Hisham. It so happened that Umar decided to kill the Prophet (P.B.U.H) while he was on his way with a sword in his hand, he met **Naim bin Abdullah**. Umar told him that he was on his way to kill the Prophet (P.B.U.H). Naim told him that he better took care of his own family first as his sister and brother in law had both converted to Islam. Hearing this Umar immediately went to his Sister **Fatima's** house and found she

and her husband **Saeed bin Zaid** were reciting the Quran. Umar beat them severally so much so that his sister bled profusely. When Umar calmed down, he asked her what she was reciting. She recited **Surah Taha** that she was reading. When he heard the recitation he was deeply moved and went to the Prophet (P.B.U.H) and accepted Islam.

- Conversion of Umar R.A strengthened Islam. His conversion gave courage to the Muslims. It boosted the morale of Muslims so much that they started praying openly at Ka'bah. Abdullah ibn Masud reported **"We have been powerful since Umar embraced Islam."** The Prophet (P.B.U.H) gave him the title of **Al Farooqi**. i.e the one who makes a distinction between the right and wrong.
- When the Muslims were ordered to migrate to Madinah, most of them left Makkah secretly but Umar R.A **migrated openly**.
- He participated in all battles Badr, Uhah, Trench, Khyber and Hunain. At the time of battle of **Badr** he shared camel with Abu Bakr and abdurRehman bin Auf. During the battle of **Uhah** he was among those encircled the Prophet (P.B.U.H) to protect him from Quraish. He also dug the **trench** around Madinah with other companions at the time of battle of trench.
- His ties with Prophet (PBUH) were strengthened when Prophet (PBUH) **married his daughter Hazrat Hafsa**.
- He took the **pledge of Rizwan** at the hand of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) to avenge the blood of Usman. He was **unhappy** about the terms of the **treaty of Hudaibiyah** and showed his dissatisfaction for which he later always repented. He was present at that time of signing of treaty.
- At the time of conquest of Makkah Abu Sufyan was taken a prisoner when he came to spy on Muslim. Umar R.A asked the Prophet (P.B.U.H) permission to kill him.
- During the Expedition of **Tabuk** he gave half of his wealth in the way of Allah. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) had a deep love for Umar R.A he said **"Were a Prophet to come after me he would have been Umar but I am the seal of prophets"**. On the Prophet's death in his grief, he said he would kill anyone who said that the Prophet had died then Abu Bakr made him realize that Islam was to continue after Prophet's death.

3. Hazrat Usman ibn Affan R.A

- He belonged to the Umayyad clan of the Quraish and was among the few people in Makkah who could read and write. He came from noble stock and a well-established family, and was very successful trader.
- He accepted Islam in its early days at the invitation of Hazrat Abu Bakr R.A and was the first Umayyad to accept Islam.
- Despite his status and wealth suffered persecution at the hands of his uncle who tied him with ropes, wrapped him in a blanket and lit fire around him so that he would be suffocated but he did not leave Islam.
- Hazrat Usman R.A married the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) daughter Hazrat Ruqayya R.A and migrated with her first to Abyssinia and later to Madina.
- He did not participate in the first battle of Islam, Battle of Badr, on account of her ill health. She passed away shortly afterwards and the same year the Prophet (P.B.U.H) married his other daughter Umm Kulthoom R.A to him and gave him the title of Zunn-Nurain, the one with two lights.
- At Hudaibiya, Prophet (P.B.U.H) asked him to go and inform the Makkans of his intention to make a pilgrimage to the Ka'aba. When the rumor of his assassination erupted, the Prophet took the oath of revenge which is known as **"Bait-e-Rizwan"**.
- At the time of Conquest of Makkah, Hazrat Usman R.A rode alongside the Prophet (P.B.U.H) and at the Farewell Pilgrimage he was given the duty of escorting the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) wives.
- Hazrat Usman R.A was very generous man and for his generosity was given the title of al-Ghani. 'The Generous One'. He spent freely from his wealth in the cause of Islam. For a vast sum of money, he bought, from a Jew, a well in Madina for the free use of Muslims emigrants, when they had problems in getting drinking water. He also bore one third of the expenses for the army during the Tabuk

expedition, and bought the land for the expansion of the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) mosque when the community of the Muslims grew. He was a very modest man there are many Ahadith where the Prophet (P.B.U.H) praised his modesty.

- He was chosen to escort the Prophet's wives at the farewell pilgrimage. The Prophet pbuh said, ***"For every apostle of Allah, there was a constant companion and my companion in Paradise will be Usman."***

4. Hazrat Ali bin Abu Talib (R.A)

- He was the son of the Holy Prophet's paternal uncle Abu Talib. After marrying Hazrat Khadija, Hazrat Muhammad took Hazrat Ali into his house to relieve Abu Talib of some of his burdens, since he was very poor. Hazrat Ali became one of the first to accept Islam, at this time he was only ten years old.
- Hazrat Ali is remembered as the one whom the Prophet Muhammad had asked to sleep in his bed on the night of the Hijra. By doing this, he fooled the Quraish assassins into thinking the Holy Prophet was still in Makka, thus allowing him and Hazrat Abu Bakr to get away. And, as the Prophet had requested, he was also able to return all the items which the Prophet had been holding in trust for their owners. Hazrat Ali joined his cousin and Hazrat Abu Bakr at Quba outside Madina.
- A sign of Hazrat Ali closeness to the Prophet is that when the Emigrants from Makka were paired with Helpers from Madina, he was paired with the Prophets himself. Hazrat Muhammad said to him; **'You are my brother in this world and the next'**.
- In the **second year of the Hijra**, he married the Holy Prophet youngest daughter **Hazrat Fatima**.
- **In the battles** fought by the Muslims, Hazrat Ali distinguished himself as a fierce warrior. He shared a camel with the Prophet on the way to **Badr**, and was chosen as one of the scouts to discover the enemy's movements. Before the battle, he one of three Muslims who engaged in single combat, and he was chosen to carry the Muslim banner into the fighting, where he killed many Quraish.
- At **Uhad**, the Prophet Muhammad again gave him the Muslim banner, after the original bearer had been killed, and he was one of the Muslims who defended the Holy Prophet after he was wounded. At the battle of **al-Khandaq**, he defeated his foe in single combat, and he was among the leaders in the siege of the Jewish tribe of Banu Qurayza. He courageously used a door as a shield at Khaybar. At the Muslim entry into **Makka**, he once again carried the Muslim banner. He defended the Holy Prophet at **Hunayn**. He was also sent as commander of the Muslim forces in the expeditions to Fadak and the Yemen.
- For his exceptional bravery, the Prophet(pbuh) gave him the title of "Asad ullah" i.e the lion of Allah.
- Hazrat Ali distinguished himself in other ways, too. He was the **scribe** who wrote the **treaty of al-Hudaybiya**, and was one of the witnesses to it. During the pilgrimage led by Hazrat Abu Bakr RA, he was sent by the Holy Prophet to read out new teachings which had been revealed. These can be found at the beginning of Surat-al-Tawba.
- Later, when he was left behind **to take charge of Madina during the expedition to Tabuk**, and he went to complain that he was not going with the fighting men, the Prophet indicated that Hazrat Ali was his closest assistant: **'Are you not content to be with respect to me as Harun was to Musa, except that after me there shall be no other Prophet?'**
- When the Prophet Muhammad S.A.W was returning to Madina after his farewell pilgrimage, an incident took place at **Ghadir Khumm**, which illustrates his high regard for Hazrat Ali. In front of his followers, the Prophet took Hazrat Ali hand and declared, **'Of whomsoever I am lord, this Ali is also his lord. O Allah! Be the supporter of whoever supports Ali and the enemy of whoever opposes him.'** (This has been recorded by a number of Sunni authors and compilers of Hadith, including Ahmed ibn Hanbal in his Musnad.)
- Various sayings of the Holy Prophet have also been understood as tokens of the closeness between the two. Particularly remembered among these are: **'I am from Ali and Ali is from me.'**

5. Talha ibn Ubaidullah

- He was among the first Muslims who accepted Islam at the hands of Hazrat Abu Bakr in Makka.

- He endured persecution at the hands of Quraysh, in particular when he and Hazrat Abu Bakr were one day set upon and left tied up together on the ground.
- He travelled north to Madina, following the Prophet Muhammad and accompanied the last Muslims, including the Prophet's wife Hazrat Sawada and his two unmarried daughters, Umm Kulthum and Fatima.
- Before the Battle of Badr, the Holy Prophet sent him and Saeed ibn Zayd to discover the Whereabouts of the Makkan caravan, led by Abu Sufyan. And at the Battle of Uhud, he was wounded in the hand when he deflected a sword from piercing the Holy Prophet's head. The fingers of that hand remained useless throughout the rest of his life. He remained at the Prophet's side for the remainder of the battle. For his bravery, he earned the title of **'Living Martyr'**. The Prophet^{pbuh} is reported to have said: **"Whoever is pleased to see a martyr on the surface of the earth, let him look at Talha bin Ubaydullah."**
- Prophet^{pbuh} gave him the title of **'Fayyaz'** i.e. generous at the time of the Tabuk Expedition.
- After the death of Hazrat Muhammad, he supported Hazrat 'Ali for the caliphate, but was eventually persuaded to swear allegiance to Hazrat Abu Bakr.
- Later, he objected to Hazrat Ali delay in punishing Hazrat Uthman murderers, and together with Zubayr ibn al-Awwam he raised an army. He and Zubayr were killed in **35AH/656AD**, in the clash between the two sides in the Battle of the Camel.

6. Zubayr ibn al-Awwam

- He was a cousin of the Prophet Muhammad and nephew of Hazrat Khadija.
- He was one of the Muslims who accepted Islam after Hazrat Abu Bakr (some people say he was the fourth or fifth person to do so).
- Following this, he found the treatment of the Quraysh so brutal that he went on the migration to Abyssinia. He later returned with the group that came back to Makka.
- After the migration to Madina, he played a prominent part in the battles of Badr and Uhud, and also in the expedition to Khaybar, and he was among the leaders of the Muslims force at the entry into Makka.
- The Holy Prophet^{pbuh} had given him the title of **'Disciple of the Messenger of Allah'**. About Talha and Zubair, the Holy Prophet^{pbuh} is reported to have said: **"Talha and Zubair are my neighbours in Paradise."**
- After the Holy Prophet's death he supported his cousin Hazrat Ali as caliph, even though he had married Hazrat Abu Bakr's daughter.
- But later, together with Talha, he led an army against Hazrat Ali when the caliph hesitated in punishing the Murderers of Hazrat Uthman. Zubayr was killed in the battle of the camel.

7. Sa'ad ibn abi waqqas

- He was one of those who accepted Islam at the hands of Hazrat Abu Bakr.
- In the early years of Islam, he was among some Muslims who went to pray outside Makka in order to avoid the Quraysh. They were interrupted by some people of the town, and when he two groups came to blows, Sa'ad wounded an opponent and drew the first blood in the time of Islam.
- He migrated to Madina with other Muslims in 622AD.
- After the Hijra, he took part in early expeditions and fought at the Battle of Badr. At the battle of Uhud, he was one of the defenders of the wounded Prophet. As the Prophet was recovering from the blows struck at him, he handed Sa'ad arrows to shoot.
- The Prophet (Pbuh) gave him the title of **"The Best Archer."**
- In the years following Hazrat Muhammad death, he advised the successive Caliphs. During the time of Hazrat 'Umar he commanded the Muslims forces that defeated the Persians at the Battle of al-Qadisiyya, and in the time of Hazrat Uthman he was made governor of kufa. He died near Madina in **50AH/670AD** or soon afterwards.

8. Abd ar- Rahman ibn 'Awf

- He was among the first Makkans to become a Muslim. Like a number of others, he accepted Islam at the hands of Hazrat Abu Bakr.
- He experienced the hardships of the early years in Makka and was among those who took refuge from the harassment of the Quraysh in Abyssinia. He returned with the group that came back to Makka, and made the Hijra to Madina with the other Muslims.
- In Madina, 'Abd al-Rahman R.A set about making a living for himself. He sold cheese and butter in the market, and as time went on, he became wealthy enough to send out trading caravans.
- He fought in the Battle of Badr when he had taken turns with Hazrat Abu Bakr R.A and Hazrat 'Umar R.A in riding the same camel (a sign of how poor the Muslims were in the early years at Madina). And he also took part in the Battle of Uhud, where he was severely wounded and remained lame afterwards.
- During the march against Tabuk, when the Holy Prophet PBUH was delayed for the dawn prayer, it was agreed that 'Abd al-Rahman R.A should lead, and when the Prophet PBUH came, he was content to take his place behind his trusted Companion.
- Following the death of Hazrat Muhammad PBUH 'Abd al-Rahman R.A took a prominent part in the decision to elect Hazrat Abu Bakr R.A to the caliphate. A few years later he was one of the six members of the council who elected Hazrat 'Uthman R.A to the caliphate. He died in 31AH/652AD, during the caliphate of Hazrat 'Ali R.A.

9. Abu 'Ubayda ibn al-Jarrah

- He was another among the early Makkan converts to Islam.
- He took part in the migration to Abyssinia and Madina.
- He fought among the Muslims in the battles against the Quraysh. At Uhud, he stood close to the Prophet Muhammad PBUH. He was among the leading Muslims who went on the raid, following this battle, that took some revenge for what had been inflicted upon the Muslims.
- When the Muslims victoriously entered Makka, he was given command of one of the four squadrons into which the forces were divided.
- A sign of the Holy Prophet's PBUH confidence in him as a Muslim is that when the Christian delegation from Najran visited the Prophet PBUH in Madina and were impressed by what they heard, he sent Abu 'Ubayda R.A with them to act as a judge in disputes between them.
- He also took part in the expedition which the Prophet PBUH sent to Syria, just before his death.
- In the days following the Holy Prophet's PBUH death, Abu 'Ubayda R.A took a leading part in ensuring the election of Hazrat Abu Bakr R.A as Caliph. A mark of his standing is that Hazrat Abu Bakr R.A remarked that Abu 'Ubayda R.A was as worthy as he was himself of being caliph. During the caliphate of Hazrat 'Umar R.A, he was put in charge of the Muslim Forces that captured Palestine and Syria. He died in Syria in 18AH/639AD.

10. Sa'eed Ibn Zayd (R.A)

- Sa'eed ibn Zayd (R.A) was one of the early converts of Islam. His father Zayd was monotheist and followed the religion of the Prophet Ibrahim. He was Umar's (R.A) cousin and was married to his sister Fatima, Umar (R.A) accepted Islam when he heard them reciting Surah Taha.
- He was a devoted companion of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) and great warrior. He took part in all the major campaigns and battles fought during the lifetime of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) except Badr as he and Talha were out of Madinah to spy on the Quraish caravan when they returned to Madinah, The Prophet (P.B.U.H) had already set out for Badr: however they were given a share in the booty.
- He was present during the treaty of Hudaibiyah and participated in the conquest of Makkah.
- He played an important role in the Muslim community after the death of Prophet (P.B.U.H). He was known for his courage and bravery. He participated in many campaigns; he was the commander of the infantry of the Muslims army during reign of Umar. He was made the governor of Damascus, but he resigned from the post of his love for Jihad. Later, he fought as an ordinary soldier in all the battles that were waged for the cause of Islam. He died in the 55AH and was buried in Madinah.

Week 06

DAY 03 (Paper 01)

Position of Women in Islam

As Wives:

- Both the Quran and Sunnah have laid great emphasis on men to be kind and gentle with their wives. Wives are equal to their husbands. They are partners with their husbands in family life. They are primarily responsible for the home.
- They have financial independence The Holy Quran says, **“Men are the protectors and maintainers of women because Allah has given the one more (strength) than the other and because they support them from their means.” [4:34]** This verse makes it clear that husbands have to provide sustenance to their wives, clothe them and house them.
- Abu Hurairah relates that the Holy Prophet pbuh said, **“The best amongst you is he who is most kind to his wife.”(Tirmizi).**
- In case of more than one wife, man is enjoined to treat all of them equally. He said on the occasion of Farewell pilgrimage, **“O people! You have rights over your wives and your wives have right over you. Treat your wives with kindness.”**
- Similarly she is given right to seek divorce (Khula).
- It is the duty of the husband to pay dower (Mehr) to his wife at the time of marriage. Allah says, **“And give the women (on marriage) their dower as a free gift.” (an-Nisa 4:4)**
- Woman can keep her property acquired before marriage and she has no legal obligation to spend on her family out of her personal wealth. It is the duty of a man to fulfill her material and financial needs.
- Both husband and wife must decide family matters with mutual consultation.
- The Prophet (p.b.u.h) loved his wives. Khadijah was his first wife; His love for her was so great that he did not marry again during her lifetime. He never rebuked his wives for any of their shortcomings. During his last illness, when he became very sick he ask his wives for permission before staying in 'Aishah (R.A) house. He helped his wives in their daily chores.

As Mothers:

- A woman's position as a mother is unique in Muslim society. They have the main responsibility for bringing up children. They are the first teachers of faith and proper conduct.
- The Holy Quran and the Holy Prophet pbuh have given special importance to the mother and stressed upon the children to be more considerate, submissive, grateful and obedient to her in comparison to the father. They deserve respect from their children because of what they have done for them.
- Abu Hurairah relates that once a person asked the Holy Prophet :**“O Messenger of Allah, who is the most deserving person to get good treatment from me?”** He replied, **“Your mother.”** When he asked this question this for the fourth time, the Holy Prophet said: **“Your father.”** This hadith indicates that the status of the mother is greater than that of the father (agreed upon).
- A companion of the Holy Prophet once asked his permission to take part in Jihad. The Prophet asked him if his mother was alive. On getting the answer in affirmative, the Prophet asked him to go home and serve her as **“heaven was under her feet”(Ahmad, Nasai).** This means that to respect, obey and serve the mother is the key to heaven. In doing so, we shall be able to please Allah and the Holy Prophet.
- The Prophet (pbuh) did not spend a lot of time with his mother yet he had great love for her and always remembered her. In the last year of his life, on his way perform the farewell pilgrimage, the Prophet (pbuh) stopped at Abwa at the grave of his mother and wept there by remembering her.

As daughters:

- According to the teachings of Islam, daughters are to be treated with love and care. They should always be allowed freedom in legitimate choices.
- They have a right to their parents' legacy. In this connection, the holy Prophet is reported to have said, **"If one brings up three daughters, teaches them good manners, and treats them kindly, till they no longer need his help, Allah will make paradise obligatory for him."** A companion asked, "what if he has two?". He replied, "and he too." The reporter of this hadith said that if people had inquired about one, the Prophet would have said the same thing .
- Daughters should be cared for as carefully as sons. Abdullah Ibn Abbas related that the Holy Prophet said, **"If anyone has a baby daughter and does not bury her alive, nor ignores her, nor prefers his sons to her, Allah will bring him into paradise."**
- Prophet pbuh had great affection for his daughters, especially his love for **Hazrat Fatima** is a model of fatherly love for daughters. He is reported to have said, "Fatima is a part of me, whoever hurts her hurts me, whoever holds malice against her, holds malice against me". When she visited him in his last illness, he gave her his own chair to sit.

(b) What do these teachings tell us about the relationship between men and women? [4]

- The Islamic society is governed by a sense of both individual and collective responsibility to Allah who has defined the limits for human behavior. There are certain principles to govern the interaction of sexes. Free social mixing between men and women is not permitted unless it is for some serious reason or purpose.
- When mixing does take place, both men and women are to exercise proper decorum in the way they speak and behave.
- Women are advised not to display themselves in public and not entertain or talk unnecessarily to men who are not their close relatives.
- A Muslim man and woman are not permitted to be alone together unless they are close relatives (Mahram).
- Both Muslim men and women should observe modesty. The Quran says, **"Say to the believing men that they should lower their gaze and guard their modesty.....and say to the believing women that they should lower their gaze and guard their modesty...."** (24:30-31)
- In marriage, husbands and wives must try their best to live with love and affection and show respect and kindness to each other even in disputes. Where family matters are concerned, decisions must be taken with mutual consultation and not force.

Prophet's (pbuh) Wives [Mothers of the Believers]

Hazrat Khadijah (R.A)

- She was the daughter of Khuwalid Ibn Assad who belonged to a wealthy family of the Quraish. Her father was a successful merchant and had left her a great wealth. She was twice married and widowed and had three children from her previous husbands, Harith, Hind and Hinda. She used to send her merchandise for trading to other countries. She was known as **"Tahira"** i.e **the pure one** due to the chastity of her character.
- Prophet Muhammad (p.b.u.h) was recommended to her for his honesty and trustworthiness. He took her merchandise to Syria and brought back huge profits. **Maisara**, her slave, who accompanied him in his trip, spoke very highly of Muhammad (p.b.u.h). She was so impressed by him that she proposed marriage through her friend **Nafeesa**, which he accepted after consulting his uncle, Abu Talib. At the time of the marriage in 595AD, Khadijah (R.A.) was forty years old while Muhammad (p.b.u.h) was twenty-five.
- The marriage was successful. They had six children, two sons and four daughters; both the sons died in infancy. The elder was Qasim by whom the Prophet had his Kuniya; he was called Abul Qasim, (the

father of Qasim). The younger son was Abdullah, who was known as at-Tayyib and at-Tahir. The daughters were Zaynab, Ruqayyah, Umm Kulthoom and Fatima (R.A.).

- The marriage freed Muhammad (p.b.u.h) from his financial worries as Khadijah (R.A.) placed her wealth at his disposal. She brought wealth, prestige and influence to Muhammad (p.b.u.h).
- Khadijah (R.A.) was very devoted and loving wife. She stood by him at the time of hardship and trial. After the first revelation when he came back home shaken from the experience, she comforted him saying that Allah would not disgrace him as helped the widows and looked after the orphans and the needy. She took him to her cousin Waraqa bin Naufil who further assured him that he was ordained by Allah to be a Messenger.
- She was the first person to accept Islam, she was the only wife of Muhammad (p.b.u.h) who suffered the persecution of the early days of Islam and suffered the most at the time of boycott. She died in the 10th year of prophet-hood. This year was declared as the Year of Grief in the Islamic history.

Prophet (pbuh) said, **“The Noblest women of the world are Maryam and Khadijah.”**

- One day, Khadijah’s sister Halah came to visit the Muhammad (p.b.u.h), when he heard the familiar voice, he said, “this must be Halah; her voice is just like that of Khadijah.” A’ishah said, “How is it that you always think of the old woman, who is no more living, when Allah has given you much better wives.” “Never better”, he replied. “She was the wife who believed in me when other rejected me. When people refused to believe me, she affirmed my truthfulness. When I stood forsaken, she spent her wealth to lighten the burden of my sorrow.” (*Bukhari*)
- Jibr’il is said to have sent greetings of peace to her, through the Prophet, from God and himself; Khadija was Muhammad’s first wife and he chose not to marry any other woman during her lifetime.

Hazrat Sawda bint Zama’a (R.A)

- She was one of the first women to migrate to Abyssinia; her husband Sakran bin Amr had died and she lived with her elderly father; she was middle-aged and had children from her previous marriage;
- she was the Prophet’s second wife and people were surprised he wanted to marry someone who was widowed and older; they married one month after Khadija passed away and help was needed to look after the Prophet’s children;
- She migrated to Madinah with Hazrat Fatima and Hazrat Umm Kulthum after the Prophet’s migration.
- Her house was the first to be built in Madina; she welcomed other wives into the household;
- She was close to Aisha and in the end gave up her time with the Prophet to Aisha;
- She was known for her generosity; The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) referred to her as the most charitable and generous of his wives.
- On the eve of last Pilgrimage, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) enjoined his wives to remain in retirement after his death. Hazrat Sawdah followed this directive so much so that she never left her house even for Hajj and Umrah.
- She died in the 22nd year of the Hijrat towards the end of the Khilafat of Hazrat Umar R.A. She was buried in Jannat-al-Baqi.

Hazrat Aisha R.A,

- She was Prophet Muhammad’s pbuh third wife (though some think he married her before Hazrat Sawdah), was the favourite of his later years. She was the daughter of his Companion Hazrat Abu Bakr and one of his reasons for marrying her may have been to strengthen ties with his close friend.
- Hazrat Aisha would have known the Holy Prophet pbuh from her childhood as a daily visitor to her father’s house. According to most authorities, she was six years old when she was married to him, though the couple did not become man and wife until she was older. (some authorities say that she was older than this when she married the Holy prophet pbuh). According to the historian, Hazrat Aisha R.A became a Muslim along with her parents within the first two years of prophethood.

- Her marriage to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was solemnized in Madina in the second year of Hijra and she continued her youthful ways even afterwards. Her young friends would often visit her in her apartment, a practice that the Prophet (P.B.U.H) encouraged.
- She accompanied the Prophet (pbuh) on different expeditions and battles. For example in the battle of Uhad she, along with other Muslim women, gave water to Muslim soldiers and nursed the injured.
- Hazrat Aisha R.A was a person of high character. A scandal once surrounded her when she was mistakenly left behind during a caravan rest stop on an expedition with the Prophet (P.B.U.H). She returned to Madina escorted by a companion of the Prophet Sawan bin Muattal who had found her waiting alone in the desert. Amid the ensuing gossip, a **Quranic revelation (Al-Nur, 24:11-13)** cleared her reputation and proclaimed her innocence. This Surah also established the punishment for false accusations of adultery.
- Verses about the practice of **Tayammum (dry ablution)** (Al-Nisa 4:43) were also revealed on her account.
- The Prophet (P.B.U.H) had a strong bond with his young wife and amongst the 'Mothers of the Believers' she is ranked as one of the most learned. She memorized the Quran during Prophet's (pbuh) lifetime.
- The Holy Prophet's continuing love and special affection for Hazrat Aisha are clear from his desire to be taken to her apartment when he was dying. She nursed him there in his last days and it was there that he was buried.
- **After Prophet's (P.B.U.H) death** she remained a leading figure in the Islamic community. Such was her knowledge that even the companions would come to her to seek guidance in religious matters. She narrated some 2210 Ahadith from the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) and was also a critic of badly remembered ones.
- she was critical of the third Caliph, Hazrat Uthman but opposed his violent death. During the caliphate of Hazrat Ali R.A , together with the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) companions Zubayr and Talha R.A, Hazrat Aisha R.A mobilized opposition to Hazrat Ali R.A for not calling Hazrat Uthman's killers to accountability. This culminated in **the Battle of Camel 656AD** in which she played a central role but her side lost.
- Thereafter, she did not participate in politics at all. Hazrat Aisha outlived the Prophet (P.B.U.H) by 47 years and was one of the principal links back to the Prophet (P.B.U.H) era of decades onwards as the world of Islam grew and expanded. She is buried in Jannat al-Baqi in Madina.

Hazrat Hafsa bint Umar (R.A)

- she was the daughter of 'Umar ibn al-Khattab. She was born five year before prophethood. She was first married to Khunais bin Huzafa.
- Hafsa became a Muslim along with her parents and her husband. He was among those who had migrated to Abyssinia. Later, both Hafsa and her Husband migrated to Madinah.
- Khunais took part in the battle of Badr in which he was martyred, leaving no children. After the prescribed period of Iddat(waiting) was over, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) expressed his desire to marry Hazrat Hafsa with a view to strengthening his ties with Hazrat Umar and his tribe.
- Like Aisha, she memorised the Qur'an by heart; she lived with the Prophet for eight years;
- She was quick tempered like her father, and revelation came after the honey incident where she told the Prophet his mouth didn't smell good after eating honey. The Prophet said that he would never eat honey again. Allah sent the revelation(66:01) and commanded the Prophet not to make anything unlawful to him which Allah has made lawful. After this Hafsa went to the Prophet and sought forgiveness.
- After his death when the Qur'an was compiled, a copy was kept with her for safekeeping, known as the mushaf. 'Uthman took the **Mushaf** from her for standardising the Qur'an.
- She was also a narrator of hadith. She died when she was around 60 years old.

Hazrat Umm Salama (R.A)

- She was one of the earliest converts to Islam. She and her husband were among the first to emigrate to Abyssinia.
- When her husband died after becoming injured at Uhud. First, Abu Bakr proposed her, then 'Umar. She said nobody was better than her husband so she didn't want to marry again and then the proposal came from the Prophet She accepted the Prophet's proposal and they were married in 4AH.
- She memorised the Qur'an by heart during Prophet's lifetime.
- She took part in many expeditions; at Hudaibiyah the Prophet told the companions to offer sacrifice, they didn't do it, then Umm Salama told the Prophet to do the sacrifice himself then the companions will follow him.
- Among the wives of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) Hazrat Umm-e-Salama was second only to Hazrat Aisha in learning. She was very keen to learn traditions. She has quoted a number of traditions on the authority of her first husband Abu Salamah, Hazrat Fatima R.A and the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) himself. Besides, several authors have quoted traditions on her authority. She is the narrator of 378 Ahadis.

Hazrat Maria Qibtiya

- She was sent to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) as a gift from the ruler of Egypt, in the year 628. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) had sent a letter of invitation to him and in order to show his respect, the ruler sent a package of gifts to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) which included two Greek-Egyptian female slaves(who happened to be sisters, Maria and Serena). Both accepted Islam on their Journey to Madina after being explained the teachings of the faith by their escort Hatib.
- Hazrat Maria joined the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) household as his wife and bore him a son, Ibrahim who tragically died as an infant, Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) later freed her.
- Hazrat Maria was included in the pension payment that were given to the Holy Prophet's(P.B.U.H) wives after his demise, moreover, all source affirm that she was included in the ranks of ' Mother of the Believers'
- Hazrat Maria passed away five years after Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H).

General Reading

Hazrat Zainab bint Khuzaymah was born in Makkah and was the step sister of both umm-al-Fadhl, the wife of Prophet (P.B.U.H) uncle Abbas, and of the Mother of the faithful, Hazrat Maymunah. They were from same mother, but had different father. Hazrat Zainab was fortunate, in that she embraced Islam in the early days of the faith. Her husband died in the battle of Uhud, and she began to live in poverty. Prophet (P.B.U.H) that proposed marriage to her to ease her burden, and in lieu of her husband services to Islam. Hazrat Zainab was an extremely generous person known to help the needy and destitute, and for her generosity and kindness to the poor, she earned the title of Umm-al-Masakeen, 'Mother of the Poor'. She died soon after her marriage to the Prophet (P.B.U.H). He led her funeral prayer and lowered her body into the grave. She is too buried in Jannat al Baqi.

Hazrat Juwayriyyah bint al-Haritha was the daughter of the chief of the Banu Mustaliq and was taken captive after her tribe had been defeated by the Muslims in 5 A.H. Juwayriyyah whose real name was Barra was among the prisoners and she was allotted to one of the companion name Thabit ibn Qays as part of his share of the spoils but she wanted to pay him a ransom for her freedom to which he agreed. Some month later, she approached Prophet (P.B.U.H) and declared her conversation to Islam; at the same time she told him of her predicament of not being able to buy her freedom. He agreed to have her set free also proposed marriage to her, which she readily accepted. They were married in 628. As a result of her marriage to the Prophet (P.B.U.H) the Muslims liberated all the captives of the Banu Mustaliq. Hence she was a source of blessing to her tribe as well. Her father and tribes and tribesmen also accepted Islam soon after their release from captivity,

Hazrat Juwayriyyah led a pious and simple life and spent her time in lengthy prayers and regular fasting. Hazrat Aisha taught her the reading of Quran and she spent a lot of her time in its recitation. Hazrat Juwayriyyah died 28 years after Prophet (P.B.U.H) and is buried in Jannat al Baqi.

Hazrat Zainab bint Jahsh was a cousin of Prophet (P.B.U.H) and the Prophet (P.B.U.H) himself had arranged her marriage to Zayd bin Harithah, his adopted son and former slave. Hazrat Zainab at first refused to proposal saying that she was the widow of a Quraish, implying that her social standing was higher than that of Zayd. It was perhaps the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) intention to demonstrate by this union that near Allah the standing of a person was not because of lineage but piety, and it may have been the reason why he wanted to arrange this union.

It was after Prophet (P.B.U.H) announced a new verse of the Holy Quran stating **"It is not fitting for a believer man or woman when a matter has been decided by Allah and His Messenger, to have any option about their decision: if anyone disobeys Allah and His Messengers he is clearly on wrong path."** (33:36) that Hazrat Zainab agree to marry Zayd. The marriage however fell apart and the Prophet (P.B.U.H) himself married her after the revelation of Quranic injunction to do so on completion of the mandatory period of iddat. Hazrat Zainab used to boast on the other wives of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) saying **"You were given in marriage by your families while I was married (to the Prophet (P.B.U.H) by Allah from over seven heavens"**

Hazrat Zainab was known for her wisdom and given the title of Umm al-Hikma (Mother of wisdom) she was also known as 'one with the long arm' on account her generosity and charitable nature. She was extremely pious and God-fearing and the Prophet (P.B.U.H) had predicted that she would be the first wife to die after him. She died during the Caliphate of Hazrat Umar and was buried in Jannat al Baqi

Hazrat Ramla bint Abu Sufyan was the daughter of Abu Sufyan the chief of the Umayyad clan and the leader of the whole Quraish tribe and one of the most powerful opponents of Prophet (P.B.U.H). Her first husband was Ubaydullah ibn Jahsh a brother of Hazrat Zainab bint jahsh. Ubaydullah ibn jahsh and Ramla were among the first people to accept to accept Islam. In 616, in order to escape the hostilities of the Quraish they both emigrated to Abyssinia where she gave birth to her daughter Habibah and came to be known Umm Habibah. When Ubaydullah died while still in Abyssinia, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) sent her a proposal of marriage which she gladly accepted.

The wedding ceremony took place in Abyssinia even though the Prophet (P.B.U.H) was not present. The Negus a huge feast after the ceremony and arranged to send all thirty of the remaining immigrant Muslims back to Arabia. They travelled to Madina in to boats, Shurahbil ibn Hasana accompanied Hazrat Ramlah on this journey. hazrat Ramlah held the Prophet (P.B.U.H) in high regard. When her father came to seek her help re-negotiating the Treaty of Hudabiya she refused to let him sit on the Prophet's bedding as he was at that time still a polytheist. She was a simple and pious lady and it is said that she narrated some sixty- five hadiths

Hazrat Safiyah bint Huyyay ibn Akhtab Was the daughter of Huyyay ibn Akhtab, the Jewish instigator of the pagan siege of Madina. After the Muslims Survived that assault, they marched northwards towards Khaybar, a Jewish settlement from where the plot was hatched. After some fighting , the Jews were subdued and Hazrat Safiyah was taken captive and given to a Muslim named Dahia as part of his share of Spoils. Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) purchased her freedom from Dahia and proposed marriage to her, which she accepted and converted to Islam .The wedding took place in 628 and this cemented the relations between Jews and Muslims. Hazrat Safiyah though young in years, was fiercely loyal to Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), She was also very intelligent and Charitable. She accompanied the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) to Makkah on his Farewell Pilgrimage. She outlived Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) by 38 years and died at the age of 60 in the month of Ramadan. She too is buried in Jannat al-Baqi

Hazrat Maymunah bint al-Harith Was widow and sister- in-law of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) uncle Abbas. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) married her in the year 629, and She was his last Wife. She died in 681 and was also the last of his Wives to follow Him, Hazrat Maymunah is also buried in Jannat al-Baqi.

Hazrat Rayhana bint Amir Rayhana bint Amir was A Jewish women from the Banu Nadir married to man from the Banu Qurayazah. She was also taken captive from the campaign against Banu Qurayazah and

given to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) .He freed her but initially she refused to marry him and lived quietly in her own apartments. She did not accept Islam until a few years later and was never included among the 'Mother of the Faithfull '. Some accounts say that the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) married her, but these were untested claims. She died shortly after Holly Prophet (P.B.U.H) farewell Pilgrimage .

(b) Taking two aspects of their relationship, explain how the marriage of the Prophet and Khadija sets a good example for Muslim marriages today? [4]

- They had a love and respect for each other that people could learn from today; she had her own business which the Prophet never stopped her from, and she supported the Prophet through all his difficulties. Following their example, Muslim couples today should support each other in times of difficulty and distress.
- She reassured her husband when he told her about the revelation and never stopped believing he was telling the truth because she knew his character. In times of difficulty people should be patient with each other and try to reassure their partners.

(b) How can Hazrat Aisha be seen as a role model for Muslims now? [4]

- Her role as a teacher of sunna should inspire Muslims to learn and teach their religion.
- She memorized the Qur'an which Muslims should also aspire to do.
- She is especially a role model for women as she was more learned than many of the men of her time.
- She was patient in times of difficulty and generous with wealth when she had it.
- she took part in public life which should encourage Muslim women today to take an active part in nation building after acquiring education and necessary skills e.g. medicine, teaching, research, nursing etc. women can play a vital role in society and should not be deprived of education.

(b) "The best of you is the one best to his wife." Explain what the Prophet meant by this statement and how it is relevant to Muslims now. [4]

- The Prophet encourages men to look after their wives and that those with good character treat their wife better than they treat others. Prophet (pbuh) treated all of his wives with love, respect, compassion and kindness.
- Muslims should not compete in jobs or wealth but rather in how well they treat their wife and family. Those who treat their wife well are those who should have most respect.
- Now many Muslims do not treat their wives well, they treat them like slaves, or they beat them, but this is not what the example of the Prophet teaches Muslim men about their relationship with their wives.

Week 06

DAY 04 (Paper 01)

Aaminah:

- A year before “the year of the elephant,” ‘Abdullah ibn Abdul Muttalib was married to Aminah daughter of Wahb.
- When the time came close to the birth of the Prophet (s.a.w.), Amina saw a dream that she gave birth to a boy and with this boy a magnificent emergence of light spread out and enveloped the earth until it reached Busra in al-Sham. She also saw herself in the dream saying **‘I seek for him, refuge in Allah the One from the evil of every envier’**. Aminah, named him Ahmad [meaning one who renders praise (to God)].
- Soon after he was given to Halima saadia for nursing. When he was two Halima brought him back but requested Aaminah to keep him for more time, to which she agreed.
- When Muhammad s.a.w. was **6 years** old, his mother decided to visit the grave of her husband, Abdullah, in Yathrib. Both Barakah and Abdal-Muttalib tried to dissuade her. Aminah however was determined. The caravan took ten days to reach Yathrib. Muhammad s.a.w. was left with his maternal uncles of the Banu Najjar in Madinah(Yathrib), while Aminah went to visit the grave of Abdullah. Each day for a few weeks she stayed at the grave.
- On the way back to Makkah, Aminah became seriously ill with fever. Halfway between Yathrib and Makkah, at a place called al-Abwa, they stopped where she died and was buried.
- The Prophet (pbuh) did not spend a lot of time with his mother yet he had great love for her and always remembered her. In the last year of his life, on his way perform the farewell pilgrimage, the Prophet (pbuh) stopped at Abwa at the grave of his mother and wept there by remembering her.

Halima Sadia :

- She was an Arab Beduin woman. She was a Wet-nurse and raised up the [prophet Muhammad](#) when he was a child and took care of him for the first 5 years of his life.
- There were many signs about how Halimah’s life was changed to a better days. Her goats used to come home full, and over flowing with milk, while the rest of the Bedouins' goats used to come home [scraggy](#) and [empty](#). Halimah knew that she had a blessed child with all the miracles and blessings.
- After two years, [Muhammad](#) was returned to his mother Amina. She told Amina about the great blessings that she had received when [Muhammad](#) was in her care, but soon, Amina was [persuaded](#) by Halima and her husband (Al-Harith) to return the child back with them for another two years to protect him from a spreading disease in [Makkah](#).
- After two years, a strange incident happened to the prophet. He was playing with his foster brother at the back of their homes, when two Angels appeared to them as two men wearing white clothes. The Angels laid down the prophet and opened his chest, took out his heart, split it and removed a blood clot and washed it and his chest until they became purified . Then, they returned the heart back to Muhammad's body before going away. His foster brother ran to Halimah and told her that Muhammad has been murdered. She rushed out and found Muhammad standing with a pale white face. She checked all over his body and found that he was fine and then she took him back to their home. Due to that incident, she was afraid.
- Later and very shortly, she returned Muhammed to his mother. Then, [Muhammad](#) was returned to the care of his mother Amina and continued to live with her until she died..
- Years after Muhammad's mother died and he got married to Khadijah, Halimah came to him complaining of her poverty. He asked Khadijah to give her 40 sheep. After Muhammad got his first revelation, Halimah and her husband came to the Islamic prophet and embraced Islam. When she

came to Muhammad on the day of Hunayn, he took off his robe and put it on the ground for her to sit. She died in **8 A.H.** and her grave lies in [JannatulBaqi](#), Madinah. The Prophet (pbuh) was known to call Halima '**my mother**'.

Abu Talib

- Abu Talib was paternal uncle of the Holy Prophet who brought him up after the death of his parents and his grandfather by the time he was eight years old. He took him into his family and treated him like his own son, giving him extra kindness.
- When the Holy Prophet started to preach Islam, his relatives turned against him. But Abu Talib, who had taken care of him since he was a child, said to him: **'Go ahead with what you have been bidden and I pledge to continue to give you my support and protection'**.
- Abu Talib continued to maintain his positive attitude as his nephew Hazrat Muhammad did not mean any harm and did not call anything wrong. The chiefs of Makkah did not take any action against the Holy Prophet in the early stages. When he started to criticize their idol worship, they decided that the matter was too serious to ignore. Yet they could not do much about it because Abu Talib protected his nephew against all threats and let everyone know of his readiness to fight for him.
- As the Holy Prophet continued to preach his mission, oppositions increased. Therefore, a delegation composed of the most influential people of Makkah came to Abu Talib and asked him to stop his nephew from preaching his religion or to hand him over to them. Abu Talib who continued to follow the religion of his people, did not let his nephew down. He called the Holy Prophet and told him what had taken place. He explained to the Holy Prophet the difficulty of the situation and said: **"Save me as well as yourself and do not cause me to carry a burden I cannot bear."**

But the Holy Prophet was firm as ever and said, **"O my uncle if they place the sun of my right hand and the moon on my left hand and ask me to renounce my work, I will not stop until Allah fulfils it for me, or destroys me in the process"**

Abu Talib was deeply moved and said: **"you may go and do whatever you like. I will never withdraw my protection from you and will never let you down"**

- Abu Talib communicated his resolution to the people of his tribe and asked them to protect the Prophet against the Quraish. He was the Holy Prophet's protector as long as he lived. He died 10th year of prophethood. His death was such a great loss to the Holy Prophet that he called the year of his death the '**year of Grief**'. After Abu Talib's death, Quraish started abusing the Holy Prophet verbally and physically.

Muhajirin and Ansar

- Among the numerous blessings of the Holy Prophet's (p.b.u.h) **Hijrat**, one of the most important and unique blessing was that of **Mawakhat** i.e the creation of brotherhood between Muhajirin and Ansar.
- **Muhajirir** or the emigrants is the name often applied in the Quran to those followers of Holy Prophet Muhammad (p.b.u.h) who had immigrated from Makkah to Madinah with him. They were tortured and persecuted by the unbelievers but they remained steadfast. They sacrificed their lives as well as their wealth for the sake of Islam. Some of them even left their families behind when they migrated to Madinah. They did not even claim their belonging after the conquest of Makkah, in accordance with the orders of the Holy Prophet (p.b.u.h). The term Muhajir is not applied to the Prophet (p.b.u.h) himself, but only to those who migrated with, before or after him and later made up a large portion of the population to Madinah. The Prophet (p.b.u.h) described them as favourites of Allah who will receive a splendid reward as the Quran says:
"Those who believed, emigrated and fought in the cause of Allah with their wealth and their lives are greater in rank in the sight of Allah. And it is those who are the attainers [of success]." [9:20]
- The Muslims of Madinah, who received and helped the prophet (p.b.u.h) after his migration from Makkah, were called **Ansar** or the helpers. They were also called **Ansar-un-Nabi**, or Helpers of the

Prophet. They were given this title to distinguish them from the Muhajirin, who were mainly dependent upon their help and support after migration of Madinah.

They were good natured, soft spoken and pious people who were devoted to the holy Prophet (p.b.u.h). This is confirmed by the Holy Quran in the following words:

“But those who before them had homes (in Madinah) and had adopted the faith, showed their affection to those, who came to them for refuge and entertain no desire in their hearts for things given to the emigrants, but gave them preference over themselves even though they themselves were poor.” [59:9]

- The holy Prophet (p.b.u.h) assembled them at the **house of Anas** five months after migrating to Medina and told them that the Muhajirin had left all their belongings in Makkah and were now penniless and shelter less. He, therefore wanted to create the relationship of Brotherhood between the Muhajirin and Ansar. He appointed ninety Muslims, **the forty-five** of whom were from the Ansar and the other forty-five from the migrants, as brothers.

According to this foundation of brotherhood established, leaders of each family in Medina would provide a Muslim family from Mecca with **accommodation** and **share their belongings** with them, and they would **work together**.

- The Prophet did not choose two Muslims to become brothers randomly. Contrarily, he investigated them carefully and appointed the best matches as brothers. For instance, there was an exact harmony between **Salman al Farisi and Abu’d-Dardaa; Ammar and Khuzaima; Mus’ab and Abu Ayyub**, in terms of character, likes, and feelings. On this occasion, the Prophet (pbuh) too Hazrat Ali as his brother and said, **“You are my brother in this world and in the hereafter.”**
- The emigrants tried their best so as not to be a burden on anyone. The most remarkable example of this is **Abdur Rahman bin Awf’s answer to Saad bin Rabi’s** proposal.

“I am the richest of all Muslims of Medina in terms of money. I saved half of my wealth for you!” said Sa’d bin Rabi to Abdur Rahman bin Awf, who were appointed as brothers.

Great Companion Abdur Rahman bin Awf’s answer was as noteworthy as the proposal: **“May God make your wealth auspicious for you! I do not need it. The greatest favour you can do me is to show me the way to the market where you do business.”**

The next morning, Abdur Rahman bin Awf, who was taken to Qaynuqa’s market, bought some goods such as oil and cheese and started the trade business. After a while, he earned a fair income and then became one of the well-known tradesmen of Medina. Many other Muslims of Mecca found appropriate jobs for themselves and lived happily by their own work, like Hazrat Abdur Rahman bin Awf e.g. Abu Bakr made a living by farming.

- The Ansar wanted to share their date palms with the Muhajirin but the Muhajirin refused, so the Ansar offered them to work in their orchards and in return they were given dates. In this way the Madinans gave protection and material assistance to their Makkah brothers and the Makkans came with their faith to share and spread in Madina.

5(b) How can Muslims apply this model of brotherhood to help their communities?

- Islam establishes human brotherhood on the basis of faith. Allah describes the believers as being brother. **“The believers are but brothers” [49:10]**
- Brotherhood between Muhajirin and Ansar reminds the Muslims that the feeling of brotherhood is an essential prerequisite for unity. It guarantees the safety and the well-being of the society at large.
- Muslims can help by looking to see what they can offer others. Help can be in any form, e.g., financial assistance to poor, youth services, challenging social injustice etc.
- Muslims may live in areas where people from another country have come to settle, whether it be because they are fleeing from persecution or to seek work. Muslims can help them by finding out about them, asking if they need any help, providing food/clothing/information and /or by helping them to integrate.

Prophet's (pbuh) Daughters

1. Hazrat Zainab

- She was eldest daughter. She was born in 5th year of marriage when the Prophet (P.B.U.H) was 30.
- She was married to Abul Aas bin Rabi, Khadija's nephew. When Hazrat Zainab became a Muslim and her husband did not, it caused problems.
- Abul Aas fought on the side of Quraish in the battle of Badr, and he was taken as prisoner and brought before the Prophet. Hazrat Zainab sent a necklace, which her mother had given her, for his release. When the Prophet (P.B.U.H) saw the necklace, he recognized it and his eyes were filled with tears. He consulted his companions and returned the necklace and freed Abul Aas on condition that he sent Zainab to Madina.
- Later Abul Aas came to Madina. However, they were separated when a Divine Revelation prohibited Muslim women to marry non-Muslims. Later, Abul Aas accepted Islam, and they were rejoined.
- Zainab died in 8 A.H as a result of sword wound inflicted by Habbar bin Aswad at the time she was migrating to Madina. She had a son Ali and a daughter Umamah.

2. Hazrat Ruqayyah (R.A)

- She was three years younger than Zainab.
- She was first married to Utba, son of Abu Lahab before prophethood. However, Abu Lahab became a bitter enemy of the Prophet after his prophethood.
- After the revelation of Surah Lahab Abu Lahab asked his son to divorce Ruqayyah which he did.
- She then was married to Hazrat Usman and migrated with him to Abyssinia Where she gave birth to a son Abdullah who died when he was six year old. They came back to Makkh in the tenth year of prophethood. A few years later she migrated to Madina with her husband.
- She Died in 2 A.H, just at the time when Muslims were returning from the Battle of Badr. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) performed her funeral prayer. Due to her illness, Hazrat Usman did not participate in the Battle of Badr.

3. Hazrat Umm e Kulthum (R.A)

- Hazrat Umm Kulthum was the third daughter of Prophet (P.B.U.H).
- She was first married to Utaibah another son of Abu Lahab. When the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) declared his mission, Abu Lahab became his enemy.
- After the revelation of surah Lahab and asked his son to divorce Umm e Kulthum, which he did.
- She migrated to Madina with her step mother HazratSawdah.
- After the death of her sister Ruqayyah she was married to Hazrat Usman, hence he came to be known as Zul-Noorain. She did not have any child.
- She died in 9 A.H in the month of Shabaan while her father and husband were away on the Tabuk expedition.

4. Hazrat Fatima(R.A)

- She was the youngest daughter born to Prophet (P.B.U.H) and Hazrat Khadija five years before prophethood. She was much loved by her father and among all her sisters resembled him the most.
- She used to hear him recite the Quran and had memorized the entire Holy Book. She also acquired much knowledge and wisdom by spending time in the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) company. After the death of her mother Hazrat Khadija she tried to look after the comfort and needs of her father at home. Whenever the Prophet (P.B.U.H), came home injured from the streets of Makkah she would tend to his wounds.
- Once she saw Abu Jahl putting the guts of a dead animal on her father's back when he was praying and was in prostration, she ran to him to remove the filth from its back whilst he stayed in his

position. When the Prophet (P.B.U.H) saw her crying he said, **“Don’t cry, my daughter for indeed Allah will make your father victorious”**.

- Prophet (P.B.U.H) migrated to Madina before her because he knew that if he allowed her to go before him the Quraish would have known about his plans to migrate , and if he took her with him it would have posed a big danger to her. So, she stayed back and followed later him to Madina with Hazrat Saudah.
- In Madina many sought Hazrat Fatima hand in marriage but the Prophet (P.B.U.H) politely declined all and gave her in marriage to Hazrat Ali. In 624AD they were married and lived simple yet happy life together, experiencing the poverty faced by the most of the immigrants. A Year later Hazrat Fatima gave her birth to her first son who the Prophet (P.B.U.H) named al-Hassan, the beautiful one and the following years in 626 she gave birth to another son who the Prophet (P.B.U.H) named al-Hussain the little beautiful one. She also had two daughters Zainab and umm kulthoom.
- Prophet (P.B.U.H) had a special affection for his youngest daughter on one occasion he said to her **“You are the highest of the women of the people of paradise except for Maryam daughter of Imran .”**
- In his last illness he foretold that Hazrat Fatima would be the first of his family to follow him and she died in 632, within 6 months of her father death. Muslim hold Hazrat Fatima in high respect and she regarded as the perfect role model for Muslims women. She also remembered by her title **‘Al Zahra’**, ‘the shining one’. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) showed his affection for her and would visit her before he left on a journey and upon returning.

5.(b) Can Muslims learn from the Prophet’s bond with Fatima? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

There is no greater father daughter relationship example than that of prophet and Fatima. We can model our life after them. The holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) had special affection for Hazrat Fatima. He always stood up when she came to him. Prophet’s great respect and dignity to her teaches us what good treatment to our daughters looks like. Distance and dismissive behavior is against Islamic tradition. Once Prophet (P.B.U.H) said **“Fatima is a part of me, whoever hurts her, hurts me and whoever holds malice against her hold malice against me”**. Father who have a healthy connection with their daughters will find that what hurts their daughter will hurts them.

Once Prophet (P.B.U.H) summoned Hazrat Fatima and told her that she would be the first one to join him in paradise. This is an extra ordinary example of father daughter relationship which should be followed today. Prophet (P.B.U.H) never mourned that he had daughters and no sons (as his three sons died in infancy) so Muslim should not think that sons are better than daughters. Daughters can learn from Hazrat Fatima loyalty and respect for her father.

WEEK 07
DAY 01(Paper 02)

Paper Pattern 2058/02

Marks: 50

Time: 1 hour 30 minutes

Q1. Hadiths [8]

(a) [4]

(b) [4]

Q2. History and Importance of Hadith [14]

(a) [10]

(b) [4]

Q3,4,5: [14] Marks each

▶ **Rightly Guided Caliphs**

▶ **Pillars, Articles, Jihad**

(a) [10]

(b) [4]

Introduction to Syllabus

1. Major teachings in the Hadiths of the Prophet

Two groups of passages are set for close study. These relate to:

- **Individual conduct**
- **Life in the community.**

2. The history and importance of the Hadiths

Candidates should study:

- The history of the compilation of the Hadiths;
- The earliest collections;
- The main musnad and musannaf collections;
- The main compilers and their activities;
- The methods based on examination of the chain of transmitters (isnad) and the text (matn) of a Hadith to test the reliability of the Hadith;
- The main features of the six collections of Sunni Hadiths and the four collections of Shi'a Hadiths;
- The major themes of the Hadiths as these are contained both in the passages set for special study and in other similar passages;
- Their use in legal thinking, and their relationship with the Qur'an, consensus (ijma') and analogy (qiyas);

- Their significance in thought and action in Islam.

3. The period of rule of the Rightly Guided Caliphs and their importance as leaders

Candidates should study:

- The main events of the rules of the four Caliphs;
- Their policies in maintaining and expanding the state;
- Their approaches to leading the community;
- Their main achievements;
- The main difficulties they encountered;
- Their significance as examples of leadership;
- The importance of their rules as models for government today;
- Their importance as examples for Muslim communities in their relations with other states.

4. The Articles of Faith and the Pillars of Islam

Candidates should study:

- The Six Articles of Faith:
- God, including what Muslims believe about him;
- Angels, their nature and duties;
- Books, their contents and purpose;
- Prophets, their character and function;
- God's predestination and decree, its meaning and significance;
- Resurrection and the last day, the main events and its significance.

The Five Pillars of Islam:

- The declaration of faith, shahada, including the significance of what it contains;
- Prayer, salat, including preparations, its performance and importance, congregational prayers on Fridays and festivals, times of prayer, the place of prayer, private prayer, delayed prayer;
- Alms-giving, zakat, how it is performed and its significance in the community;
- Fasting, sawm, including the way it is observed, its significance and those exempted;
- Pilgrimage, hajj, including the main observances involved and their significance.

Jihad in its range of meanings, physical, mental and spiritual.

1 Choose **any two** of the following Hadiths, and:

- ▶ (a) Describe their teachings about what Muslims believe; [4]
- ▶ (b) Explain how Muslims can put these teachings into action. [4]

(i) **‘الدِّينُ النَّصِيحَةُ.’ قُلْنَا: لِمَنْ؟ قَالَ: ‘لِلَّهِ وَلِكِتَابِهِ، وَلِرَسُولِهِ، وَلِأَنْمَةِ الْمُسْلِمِينَ وَعَامَّتِهِمْ.’**

(i) **‘Religion is sincerity.’ We said: ‘To whom?’ The Prophet said: ‘To Allah, his Book, his Messenger, the leaders of the Muslims and to their common people.’**

(a) **Main Teachings : [2] marks**

- The key words in this Hadith Nasihah which means sincere advice.
- Islam is based on sincerity which means to follow the faith of Islam fully and with dedication. Prophet said, **“Indeed sincerity leads to piety and indeed piety leads to paradise.”**
- Sincerity to Allah means that Muslims should have firm belief in the Oneness of Allah and to reject shirk. Sincerity to His Book means believing that the Quran is the sacred word of Allah. Being sincere to Prophet (P.B.U.H) is acknowledging him as the last Prophet (P.B.U.H) of Allah.
- Sincerity to the leaders of the Muslims means following their leadership and not creating disorder. Sincerity to common people means to help others in difficulties and not to cause discomfort to anyone.

(b) **Action: [2] marks**

- Muslims can put into practice the teachings of this Hadith by showing sincerity towards Allah by implementing His Sharia (Law) in their lives and by fulfilling the obligations of Islam such as being punctual in their prayers, fasting in Ramadan and paying Zakat etc.
- Sincerity to the Quran can be shown by acting on and respecting its content by explaining the Quran to other, helping by obeying the Prophet (P.B.U.H) and following his example of mercy, justice, honesty, religious tolerance and more of his noble traits.
- A practical example of the implementation of the Hadith is the example of the companions of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) standing by him through all the hardships inflicted by the Makkans.
- Sincerity to Common people can be practiced by helping and guiding them, showing them kindness and respect and living in harmony with each other for example friends at school or colleagues at work.

2. **لَا يُؤْمِنُ أَحَدُكُمْ حَتَّى يُحِبَّ لِأَخِيهِ مَا يُحِبُّ لِنَفْسِهِ.**

None of you believes until he wants for his brother what he wants for himself.

(a) **Main Teachings : [2] marks**

- This hadith teaches to have concern for others around us. Concern for others’ welfare is a cardinal part of Muslim’s faith. It can be regarded as a sign of sincerity to the teachings of Islam.

- The Prophet stressed upon brotherhood and instructed Muslims to show care and concern for others, especially the less fortunate ones. It keeps the jealousy away and promotes goodwill, brotherhood and peace.
- It also teaches all Muslims to be a source of good for one another. Both God and His Prophet (pbuh) have commanded Muslims to work for the welfare of others.
- The bond of brotherhood between Muslims is established by God Himself. Quran says, **“Believers are a single brotherhood.”(49:10)**

(b) Action: [2] marks

- The teaching of this hadith can be applied practically by wanting the best for others, wishing well for everyone and being happy for others in their joyous times and genuinely sorry for them when something bad befalls them.
- The application of this hadith is not confined to choosing the same material things that one chooses for oneself but rather genuinely responding to the needs of others. For instance, if one wishes good health for one's own family the same should be wished for others.
- A Muslim should never take pleasure in another's misfortune rather he/she should be always willing to come to the aid of all fellow Muslims and humanity at large.
- When Prophet (pbuh) established brotherhood, the Ansaar preferred their Muhajirin brothers over themselves. An example of the implementation of this Hadith in present time could be of countries giving refuge to people who have left their country on account of political strife, discrimination or war etc. On a personal level Muslim could contribute towards the fund being raised for the refugees or give their zakat to Muslim charities to help them and others in need.

Stages of Compilation of Hadith

1. Companions of the Prophet (pbuh)

Prophet's (pbuh) lifetime:

After the migration to Madina the Holy Prophet (pbuh) encouraged his companions for the preservation of Hadith. On the occasion of farewell pilgrimage he said, **“He who is present here should carry this message to him who is absent.”** Thus the companions of the Holy Prophet (pbuh) considered it their duty to preach hadiths to those who had not seen or heard him.

The Prophet (pbuh) had entrusted some of his companions with the task of writing down agreements, letters and other official documents. For example, **Suraqa bin Malik** was given a pledge of protection in writing by the Prophet (pbuh) at the time of migration to Madina.

Treaty of Hudaibiya was drawn up between the Muslims and the Makkans. Hazrat Ali wrote down the terms of the treaty.

Abu Shah, a man from Yemen, was given the permission by the Prophet (pbuh) to write down the sermon he delivered after the conquest of Makkah.

Prophet (pbuh) also sent **letters to different kings and emperors** inviting them to Islam for example Najashi of Abyssinia, Hraclius, the Byzantine emperor etc.

Hazrat Ali wrote down instructions given by the Prophet (pbuh) from time to time. He also maintained a booklet of the orders and instructions issued from time to time by the Holy Prophet (pbuh) which came to be known as **Sahifa e Ali (Booklet of Ali)**.

After Prophet's (pbuh) Death:

- After Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) death, the need to preserve is a Hadith was stronger and urgent because these were the most authoritative interpretation of the Quran. Hadiths also served as a source of guidance for the young Islamic community, struggling to determine how to live according to Allah's will, with the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) no longer amongst them.
- The Prophet Muhammad's (P.B.U.H) companions had the responsibility of teaching new generation of Muslims and new converts about the life and faith of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) they had never known.
- **Companions who spent the most time** with a Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) like his best friend Hazrat Abu Bakr, his cousin and son in law Hazrat Ali and his trusted advisor Hazrat Umar are sources for only a small numbers of Hadiths.

Hazrat Abu Bakr narrated **142** hadith. **Hazrat Ali** narrated about **536** , **Hazrat Umar** it is believed narrated **537** Hadiths.

It appears that these Companions preserved the spirit of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) teachings in their actions and method of reasoning rather than by his Hadith directly.

- It was often the most junior among the companion who became the **most prolific collectors and transmitters** of Hadith.

Abu Huraira who knew the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) for only three years, is the single largest source of Hadiths, with close to **5374** narrations. Although he did not write them down in his early career, by the time of his death he had boxes full of the sahfahs (collections of Hadith) he had compiled through Hammam ibn Munabbih and known as **Sahifah Sahiha**.

'Abdullah ibn Umar' was 23 year old when Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) died and he is the second largest source of Hadith narrating **2630** of the Prophet Muhammad's (P.B.U.H) sayings. He maintained a booklet of Prophet's sayings and actions, which was known as **"Sahifa al Sadiqah"**

Abdullah ibn Abbas was in his early teens when the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) passed away and he is the fifth largest source for Hadith with **1660** hadiths to his credit. Though these narrators knew the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) for only a short time they amassed their vast volumes of Hadiths by seeking them out from the most senior companions.

Ans ibn Malik who had entered the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) household at the age of ten as a servant is the third largest source of Hadith and is known to have transmitted **2286** Hadiths.

Abdullah ibn Masud was one of the earliest companions and remained close to the Prophet (pbuh) throughout his life. After Prophet's (pbuh) death, he went to Kufa and narrated the Hadiths to new converts. He is said to have reported **848** Hadiths.

- **Wives** who had spent much time with Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) are known as authentic sources of Hadith.

Hazrat Aisha who narrated **2210** sayings of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) is regarded as the fourth source of Hadith but was also a critic of incorrectly quoted ones. She did not accept any hadith until she was fully satisfied as to its meaning and authenticity.

Some other wives of the Prophet were also looked upon as vital custodians of hadiths and were approached for instructions by other companions. The names of

Hazrat Umm-e-Salamah (378) Hadiths) **Hazrat Hafsa (65)** Hadiths) , **Hazrat Umm-e-Habibah** and **Hazrat Maimunah** are among the earliest and most distinguished transmitters.

2. Successors of the Companions(Tabe'een)

- The generation who learned from the companions became known as the **Successors (al-Tabe'een)**. They recorded the Hadiths that their teachers narrated to them about the Holy Prophet's (P.B.U.H) words, deeds, and rulings in collections called Suhuf.
In addition to Compiling their own collections from the lessons of the companions these successors also passed on the collections (Suhuf) of companions. These collections were passed down from teachers to students and from fathers to sons. **An example** of Sahifa that has survived intact today is that of the successor **Hammam ibn Munabbih**, which contains **138 Hadiths through Abu Huraira**.
- The Hadith had to be heard in order to avoid serious misunderstandings of the Holy Prophet's (P.B.U.H) words. Initially the vast majority of Hadith that the successor heard from the companions were not written down but were transmitted orally. This was because **diacritical marks** were not used in the Arabic Script in those days. Hence many words were written identically and could only be distinguished from each other by context when spoken.
This was the reason why the Muhadditheen (scholars) doubted the authenticity of Hadith transmitted from a narrator who had not heard it being read out by a teacher.
- The Umayyad caliph **Umar Bin Abdul Aziz** ordered the governor of Madina to record all the Hadiths of Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) concerning administrative and taxation matters. Apart from the Hadith the verdicts and saying of the companions and of the Holy Prophet's (P.B.U.H) family were also compiled. Later the well-known Hadith transmitter and successor **al-Zuhri** considered **writing down the Hadith as absolutely essential for accurate transmission**.
- **The most authoritative collection** of Hadiths was **al-Muwatta** compiled by **imam Malik Ibn Anas** which can be termed as a legal text book for in it he employed Hadiths together with the Quran to establish points of legal teachings. Legal decision drawn by him were based on deductions from the Quran, Hadith and Ijma. It contained **1720** Hadiths
- However, in the late second/early third century A.H, there was a shift towards **musnad** collections. In these, all the hadiths narrated from a certain Companion would fall into one chapter, and all those from another would fall in the next chapter, etc. The musnad compilations were divided into chapters whose headings were identified by the name of a particular companion, such as, hadiths of Hazrat Abu Bakr R.A, hadiths of Hazrat Ali R.A, or hadiths of Abu Huraira etc. The **most famous musnad is that of Ahmed Ibn Hanbal**, which consists of **27647 hadiths**.

WEEK 07

DAY 02(Paper 02)

3. مَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَلْيَقُلْ خَيْرًا أَوْ لِيَصْمُتْ، وَمَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَلْيُكْرِمْ جَارَهُ، وَمَنْ كَانَ يُؤْمِنُ بِاللَّهِ وَالْيَوْمِ الْآخِرِ فَلْيُكْرِمْ ضَيْفَهُ.

Let him who believes in Allah and the Last Day either speak good or keep silent, and let him who believes in Allah and the Last Day be generous to his neighbour, and let him who believes in Allah and the Last Day be generous to his guest.

a) Main teachings: [2] Marks

- The teaching of this Hadith focuses on the manners of social conduct being a part of Muslim community. Actions of controlling one's speech, being kindly to neighbours and showing hospitality to guests.
- The emphasis is on the words 'let him who believes in Allah and the Last day' before every action signifying that noble and good actions are an outcome of one's belief.
- Islam is religion of peace and it teaches believers that one should try and maintain peace harmony and goodwill in the community and the wider world and be a source of benefit to others by showing kindness generosity and mercy to others at all times.
- One's speech can do much good as well as much harm. The Quran says, **'Not a word does he utter but there is a watcher by him who records it'. (50:18)** Prophet links faith directly with speech by saying " Muslim is he, from whose tongue and hands other Muslims are safe"

(b) Action: [2] marks

- The hadith above emphasizes the importance of rights of others on a believer and a Muslim's duties towards other people by making sure that they use their speech responsibly.
- They must **not use it to backbite or slander** anyone or to curse any individual. Muslims today can follow his examples and remain calm when in a difficult situation and use their speech to resolve issues and conflicts for example mediating between class fellows or people at work place to resolve a dispute. Similarly, rights of neighbours may be looked after by sharing food and not causing discomfort for them.
- It is a sunnah of the Prophet to accompany the guest to the door when he leaves. The Prophet's companion Abu Talha and his wife welcomed a hungry immigrant into their home and even though they had barely enough food for their children. They offered him whatever they had. In recognition of the act of theirs, the following verse was revealed, **"They give preference to other first. Whoever is saved from the greed of his own soul will be successful."** (59:9)

(iv) أَنْ رَجُلًا سَأَلَ رَسُولَ اللَّهِ (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ) فَقَالَ: أَرَأَيْتَ إِذَا صَلَّيْتُ الْمَكْتُوبَاتِ، وَصُومْتُ رَمَضَانَ، وَأَحْلَلْتُ الْحَلَالَ، وَحَرَّمْتُ الْحَرَامَ، وَلَمْ أَرِزْ عَلَى ذَلِكَ شَيْئًا، أَذْخُلُ الْجَنَّةَ؟ قَالَ: نَعَمْ.

A man asked the Messenger of Allah (may Allah bless him and give him peace): Do you think that if I perform the obligatory prayers, fast in Ramadan, treat as lawful that which is lawful and treat as forbidden that which is forbidden, and do nothing further, I shall enter paradise? He said: Yes.

(a) Main Teachings : [2] marks

- This hadith teaches that Islam is a very simple religion and to gain Allah's pleasure and reach paradise one has to simply follow the basic principles of Islam.
- Allah has laid down clear rules about what is lawful and unlawful and He expects man to be obedient to Him. By following these rules Muslims can gain Allah's pleasure and thus paradise and this is what

the Prophet confirmed. He said, **“Avoid What I have forbidden you to do, and do your utmost what I have ordered you to do.”**

- Fulfilling the rights of Allah by performing prayer and observing fast and to have the knowledge of religion to differentiate between Halal (lawful) and Haram (unlawful) is obligatory on every Muslim.
- Zakat and Hajj are two pillars that are compulsory only on those Muslims who have the means of fulfilling them, hence have not been mentioned in the hadith.

(b) Action: [2] marks

- Muslims can act upon the teachings of this hadith by obeying Allah wholeheartedly and by practicing the pillars of Islam e.g. by performing 5 daily prayers in congregation within the prescribed time which will develop piety and bring them closer to Allah.
- Being regular and punctual in one's prayers and performing them sincerely and on time regulates our lives. Fasting in the month of Ramzan makes us conscious of the hardships of the poor and develops sympathy.
- Muslims must be conscious of what is allowed and not allowed in Islam at all times e.g. they should be fair in trading, not take riba etc. Similarly, Cheating, smuggling, adulteration, drinking wine, lying and oppression are obstacles to a peaceful society and success in the hereafter.
- Other acts of worship like waking up to say tahajud prayers following the Prophet (P.B.U.H) Sunna and fasting in addition to Ramzan on Mondays and Thursdays etc, bring Muslims closer to Allah and earn them greater rewards. During Prophet's life time when azaan was announced all worldly activities were suspended.

Successors of the Successors (Taba'eTabe'een)

- From the early third to the early fourth century A.H, a large number of scholars compiled hadiths. This period that followed the Successors of the companions is considered **the golden age of Hadith compilation**. Hundreds of thousands of hadiths were compiled by **the Successors of the Successors** in the form of **Sunan / Sahih/ Musannaf books**.
- A **sunan was organized topic wise** and thus could easily be used as a large reference and it focused on Hadith Nabvi (Prophetic Hadith) with full isnad. The scholars who compiled the sunnan, devoted great efforts in ensuring the authenticity of its contents and only used Hadiths that were proven authentic.
This emphasis on authenticity led many of the collections produced in the sunan movement to be called sahih books by the authors or the Muslims readers.
- Foremost amongst the Muhadditheen (scholars) were **Abu Abdullah Muhammad ibn Ismail al-Bukhari** (d.870) and his student **Muslim ibn al-Hajjaj** (d.875). Their books were the first of 'sahih movement'.
The Sahihayn (the two sahihs) of Bukhari and Muslim became the most famous books of Hadith in sunni Islam.

1. Sahih of Bukhari:

- It was compiled by Muhammad bin Ismail al-Bukhari.
- He **devoted 16 years** to sifting the Hadiths that he included in his **Sahih (Bukhari)** from a pool of **600000** hadiths.
- It contains **97 chapters** according to topics. There are **7397** full Hadiths with full isnad in Sahih of Bukhari however, these would only **be 2762** if the repetitions are excluded.
- Sunni Muslims regard it as the most authentic collection of Hadith.

2. Sahih of Muslim:

- *It was compiled by Muslim ibn al-Hajjaj.*

- He traveled widely to gather his collection of ahadith and Out of 300,000 hadith 9200 were accepted as authentic. There are a total of 2,200 hadiths without repetition.
- It contains 54 chapters and does not have legal commentary like Bukhari.
- Muslims kept all narrations of a certain hadith in the same section but without the commentary reports from companions and later figures.

Other participants in the Sahih movement also focused on hadith with strong and reliable isnad but they also included some weaker hadiths because they were widely used among jurists or because the authors. Four of these books attained great renown:

3. Sunan of Abu Daud:

- He was a close student of Ahmad Ibn Hanbal.
- He collected 500,000 hadith in 20 years research, but included only 4,800 in this collection.
- He made a series of journeys to meet most of the foremost traditionists of his time and acquired from them the most reliable hadiths, quoting sources through which it reached him.
- He collected hadiths which no one had ever assembled together.

4. Jami of Tirmizi:

- He was a disciple of Bukhari.
- It contains **3,956 Ahadith**, and has been divided into 50 chapters according to topics.
- His method was that of placing the heading first, then mentioning one or two Ahadith which were related to the heading.
- His book bears the distinction of being one of the oldest texts dealing with the difference of opinion amongst the various law schools. It also includes detailed discussion of their authenticity

5. Sunan of al-Nasai:

- He was a student of Bukhari
- It has about **5,270** hadiths, including repeated narrations. It contains 52 chapters.
- It contains the fewest da'eef (weak) hadiths among the six books after Sahih al-Bukhari & Sahih Muslim
- There is not a single mawdhoo (fabricated) hadith in it.

6. Sunan of ibn Majah:

- It was compiled by Ibn Mājah.
- It is widely considered to be the sixth of the six collection of Ḥadīth .
- It consists of **4341** ahadith in 37 chapters.
- It includes **1339** additional ahādīth, which are not found in the other five major books of Ḥadīth.

These four books together with the Sahihayn of Bukhari and Muslim have come to be known as **the SihahSitta. 'The Six Sound Collections'**. With their compilation the Shaiḥ/ Sunan movement and the Hadith tradition reached its climax.

Shia Collections

Like Sunni Muslims Shia Muslims also accepted Hadiths as source of understanding the Quran and as guidance in everyday matters. They however, only consider those Hadiths as most reliable that based on the authority of Hazrat Ali and the twelve imams, who are the descendants of Hazrat Fatima and Hazrat Ali. The prominent Shia collections are:

1. **Al-Kafi fi ilm al-din** (The sufficient book) is a Shia collection of Hadith compiled by the **Abu Jafar Muhammad ibn Yaqub al-Kulayni**. It has three sections Usul al Kafi which is related to history morals and ethics prayers and worship and the Quran, Furu al-Kafi which is about with practical and legal issues and Raudat al-Kafi which includes various Hadiths transmitted from the imams. Altogether al-Kafi comprises over 16000 Hadiths.
2. **Man la yahduruhu al-Faqih** is a Shia Hadith collection by the famous scholar Abu Jafar Muhammad ibn Ali ibn Babuyah al Qummi commonly known as ibn Babuyah or Al shaykh al-Saduq. This collection has just over 9000 Hadiths.

3. **Tahzib al-Ahkam** has been compiled by the shia scholar Abu Jafar Muhammad ibn Hassan Tusi commonly known as sheikh Tusi. This work comprises close to 13600 Hadiths.
4. **Al-Istibsar** is a Hadith collection also by sheikh Tusi. It includes the same topics as Tahzib al-Ahkam but in a shorter form.

All of these four collections were compiled during the period from the mid-fourth to mid-fifth centuries Hijri.

Need to compile Hadiths

- In the century following the time of the Rightly guided caliphs, the Muslim community passed through a period of unrest and civil wars. As a result some Hadiths were forged by different parties, who tried to manipulate the authority of the Sunnah. The major concern of the Muslim scholars was to distinguish authentic hadiths from the forgeries.
- The four Rightly Guided Caliphs were close Companions of the Prophet (pbuh). They followed his Sunna closely and after the end of their caliphate it became important to compile the Prophetic Hadiths so that future generations and new converts could use the Prophet's example to clarify and resolve questions and disputes
- After the end of the era of the Rightly Guided Caliphs in 661, there was much turmoil. There was an urgent need to provide religious and political guidance to the growing Muslim nation.
- Another reason why Hadiths were compiled was the need to provide religious and political guidance to the growing Muslim nation.
- The Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) the final authority on secular and spiritual matters was no longer present to clarify adjudicates or resolve questions and disputes.
- The new generations of Muslims and the ever-increasing converts of the Islamic world needed correct guidance on true Islamic way of life based on the exemplary model of Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H).
- From the middle of the latter half of first Hijri century, most of the Prophet Muhammad's (P.B.U.H) companions who had direct and first hand knowledge of the Prophetic tradition were themselves passing away due to age or wars, and a need was felt to preserve the Hadiths of the Prophet (pbuh) even more with their demise.
- Islamic jurisprudence especially Ijma and Qiyas was developing rapidly and needed a compiled collection of authentic Hadiths as source material.
- In order to eliminate genuine errors in Hadiths on account of verbal narrations, faulty memories, forgetfulness, etc., Hadiths needed to be compiled.
- Some political leaders used to fabricate Hadith to enhance and justify their own position.
- Some overzealous teachers perhaps with good intention made up Hadiths to advance moral and religious teachings in the name of Islam.
- Some heretics under the guise of scholars falsely attributed sayings to the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) with the sole intention of undermining Islam.
- Finally the collection of the Prophetic tradition by Hadith scholar can be justified by the Quran itself, **"You have indeed in the Messenger of Allah a beautiful pattern of conduct." (33:21)**
- For all these reasons, it was felt that it was crucial to preserve and compile the Hadiths of the Prophet (pbuh) for all generations to follow Qur'an and it was with the help of the Hadith movement that the Prophet's Hadiths were preserved and spread for all time. This important and formidable work took several generations to complete but was performed in earnest and with great care by dedicated men and women of strong faith and indomitable spirit.

WEEK 07

DAY 03(Paper 02)

5 كُلُّ سُلَامَى مِنَ النَّاسِ عَلَيْهِ صَدَقَةٌ كُلَّ يَوْمٍ تَطْلُعُ فِيهِ الشَّمْسُ: تَعْدِلُ بَيْنَ اثْنَيْنِ صَدَقَةٌ؛ وَتُعِينُ الرَّجُلَ فِي دَابَّتِهِ فَتَحْمِلُهُ عَلَيْهَا أَوْ تَرْفَعُ لَهُ عَلَيْهَا مَتَاعَهُ صَدَقَةٌ؛ وَالْكَلِمَةُ الطَّيِّبَةُ صَدَقَةٌ؛ وَبِكُلِّ خُطْوَةٍ تَمْشِيهَا إِلَى الصَّلَاةِ صَدَقَةٌ؛ وَتَمْيِطُ الْأَذَى عَنِ الطَّرِيقِ صَدَقَةٌ.

Every person's every joint must perform a charity every day the sun comes up: to act justly between two people is a charity; to help a man with his mount, lifting him onto it or hoisting up his belongings onto it is a charity; every step you take to prayers is a charity; and removing a harmful thing from the road is a charity.

(a) **Main Teachings : [2] marks**

- In this Hadith the Prophet has given Muslims a few examples of act of charity that they should perform on a daily basis.
- Charity here does not refer only to the act of giving money in the Allah's way but in fact it is used comprehensively to include any act or gesture that would help the community and would increase awareness of Allah and His bounties.
- Islam teaches Muslims to reflect upon even the smallest of Allah's favors which are often taken for granted such as the smooth and proper functioning of our joints and organs in the body. In return it asks believers to be humble and thankful to Allah by being kind helpful and charitable towards others in the society regardless of their faith and culture. Prophet (pbuh) said, **"The best amongst people is the one who is a source of benefit for the people."**
- worship of Allah is not restricted to acts like salat or sawm but it includes every day acts of kindness to help and support the community such as those listed in the Hadith.

(b) **Action : [2] marks**

- Muslims today must perform all their actions with the intention of benefiting others as it one of the fundamental principles of Islam. Social responsibility is the essence of this Hadith and Muslims can practise it by greeting others with a smile, giving correct advice when asked, feeding the hungry etc.
- In social life, a positive role can be played in different ways e.g by Settling disputes with justice, helping people mount on their conveyance or carrying their belonging, removing any hindrance from the road.
- Even the smallest deeds of righteousness must be given importance as they may carry the greatest reward; e.g helping the blind to cross the road.
- Prophet (pbuh) was kind and helpful even to his enemies as he helped and served the old woman who regularly pelted him with rubbish on his way to prayer. He used to share his meals with guests, supported orphans and helped poor.

6 مَنْ رَأَى مِنْكُمْ مُنْكَرًا فَلْيُغَيِّرْهُ بِيَدِهِ، فَإِنْ لَمْ يَسْتَطِعْ فَبِلِسَانِهِ، فَإِنْ لَمْ يَسْتَطِعْ فَبِقَلْبِهِ، وَذَلِكَ أَضْعَفُ الْإِيمَانِ.

Whosoever of you sees an evil action, let him change it with his hand, and if he is not able to do so then with his tongue, and if he is not able to do so then with his heart, and that is the weakest of faith.

(a) **Main Teachings : [2] marks**

- The teaching of this Hadith clearly states that removing or wanting **to remove evil** wherever one may find it is a **fundamental characteristic of a true believer**. The Hadith refers to the obligation on Muslims, at the various levels of authority, to tackle evil in order to remove it.
- It teaches not only to abstain from evil but also to prevent others from unrighteous deeds. It is **unworthy of a believer to ignore any evil practice** in his presence. Quran says, **“You are the best of the people evolved for mankind, enjoining what is right, forbidding what is wrong and believing in Allah.” (3:110)**
- It emphasizes that virtue and righteousness should be encouraged whereas evil should be discouraged at every level. Moral health of the community should not deteriorate and whenever there is any sign of decadence in any quarter, it should be checked.
- This is obligatory for all but especially for those who have authority and for organisations that have the power to bring about the necessary change such as the ruler or governor of a place the police or the local judiciary the media. Distancing oneself from evil and being quiet **“is the weakest response.”**

.(b)Action: [2] marks

- Every Muslim can implement the teachings of this Hadith in their lives. The scale of their influence may vary but everyone is required to play their part in bringing about a positive change.
- Correcting social evils like preventing or reporting electricity theft or tackling corruption in an institution by taking strong action against any member of the workforce found to be taking bribes etc.
- If wrongdoings are ignored and allowed to continue, no matter how minor they may appear to be, they can become grave problems for the community.
- Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, “The best type of jihad is speaking a true word in front of a tyrant ruler.” Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) prevented Meccans from idol worship and other social evils and even faced persecutions for that. He advised his followers to not only help to one who is a victim of injustice but also to stop the one who is unjust.

Hadith as a source of Guidance / Islamic law

- ❖ **Hadiths** play a very important role in the lives of Muslims and are a source of guidance to them in all aspects of life. What the Prophet (pbuh) said, did and what he approved of is second in importance to the Qur'an; God has Himself told Muslims in the Qur'an
‘Obey Allah and obey the Prophet’ [64:12];
He who obeys the Prophet, obeys Allah.” [4:80]
 Prophet (pbuh) said, **‘I leave with you two things. If you hold fast to them both you will never be misguided: the Book of Allah and my sunna.’ “**
 and
“Behold I have been given the Book and a similar thing (Sunnah) along with that.”
 - ❖ Hadiths are important to explain the teachings of the Qur'an; details of hajj, zakat, fasting are all given to Muslims from the hadith and sunna of the Prophet (pbuh); the Prophet (pbuh) laid down principles (shariah) regarding every aspect of life: buying, selling, contracts, inheritance which are all part of his sunna; in the Farewell Address he clearly stated: **‘He who is present here shall carry this message to the one who is absent.’** Muslims turn to his actions in the hope that their actions will please the Almighty and be acceptable to Him.
- The following instances will illustrate how these two parts i.e., quran and Hadith interplay and function for the purpose of legislation.

EXAMPLES OF RELATIONSHIP BETWEEN QURAN AND HADITH FROM PAPER 01

- ❖ Hadith is a very significant and important source of Islamic law without which the Holy Quran cannot be understood at all. In words of the Quran, the relationship of Quran and Hadith is that of Book and Light.

The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was the first legislator of Islam. He interpreted the law of the Quran, and commented on it and its manner of application to the practical problems and various situations of life. The secondary sources of Islamic law i.e Ijma and Qiyas depend upon Hadith for their acceptance and justification. They can only be practiced when hadith is silent or does not provide clear guidance. The secondary sources never contradict the teachings of Hadith.

2.(b) What was the significance of the Prophet not allowing the writing down of Hadiths in the early days of his prophethood? [4]

- The Prophet prevented the companions from writing down the Hadiths during the early days of prophethood as he wanted to establish Islam and make sure his sayings were not mixed up with the words of the Qur'an which was still being revealed.
- As revelation was sent down scribes like Abdullah bin Masood (ra) wrote them down. As the revelations were written down on all manner of things for example leaves, skin, etc. From this they were learned, studied and memorised.
- Suppose hadith's were being written down, learned, studied and memorised at the same time as the Qur'an, the possibility of the mixing of Hadith's with ayats of the Qur'an was there and so doing the aforementioned in relation to Hadith was forbidden.
- when the Prophet was certain that his companions would be able to distinguish between the Hadiths and the words of the Qur'an, he encouraged them to write down the Hadiths to pass them down to others.

2(b) What in your opinion is the importance of classifying Hadiths? [4]

- The Qur'an gives instructions to Muslims about how to live and practice their faith, it does not give details showing how to implement the teachings given. This implementation of Qur'anic instructions is found in the Hadiths of the Prophet.
- If the Hadiths were not classified there would be a danger of Muslims not knowing the correct way of putting into practice their faith.
- in legal matters it is vital to only use only the most accurate Hadiths but when e.g. one is looking for moral teachings, a Hadith whose *isnad* is not strong by having a gap or say the narrator having a weak memory, a weak Hadith could be used and therefore the classification of Hadiths is important.
- Muslims by following the guidance given in the classified Hadiths can follow the perfect example of the Prophet Muhammad.

WEEK 07

DAY 04(Paper 02)

7. قِيلَ: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ أَيُّ النَّاسِ أَفْضَلُ؟ فَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ):
'مُؤْمِنٌ يُجَاهِدُ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ بِنَفْسِهِ وَمَالِهِ.'

It was said: O Messenger of Allah, who is the most excellent of men? The Messenger of Allah (may Allah bless him and give him peace) said: 'The believer who strives hard in the way of Allah with his person and his property.'

(a) **Main Teachings : [2] marks**

- In this Hadith it has been made clear that a person who is ready to sacrifice his person and property and even his life for the sake of Islam is the best of believers and has an exalted position.
- It also refers to two main kinds of Jihad or struggle in the way of Allah i.e spiritual (Nafs) and financial (Maal). It instructs Muslims to safeguard their faith and to spend their wealth to improve social conditions and to remove injustice and transgression.
- The teaching of this Hadith instructs Muslims to establish a society based on justice and righteousness. The words 'striving hard' with one person may also mean to spread the word of Allah by preaching, one's personal fight against evil etc.
- In some cases , it may also include armed struggle to safeguard Islam. Allah more than compensates a believer for what he spends in His way as the Quran says, **"There is no (amount of money) that you spend in His cause without Him replacing it for He's the best of all providers"** (34:39)

(b) **Action: [2] marks**

- A person may strive in Allah's way by spending time in the worship of Allah or by doing social work in the community. A true believer after completing his fard obligations Should strive in the way of Allah by going on to read his tahajud prayer or tarawih prayers or finance those less fortunate than himself to perform hajj etc.
- An individual can strive in different ways to support Islam and the community such as through one's wealth and resources by supporting schools and educations to remove ignorance, by donating for health facilities for the poor by providing them livelihood and by repair and maintenance as well as construction of mosques.
- One may raise awareness about the peaceful teachings of Islam by carrying out welfare projects locally and internationally or by helping the poor communities affected by conflicts.
- The Prophet exerted himself in Allah's way both spiritually and physically and encouraged his companions to do so. The best example is the Tabuk expedition when his companions made financial contributions in the cause of Allah.

8. قَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ): 'مَا تَعُدُّهُنَّ الشَّهِيدَ فِيكُمْ؟' قَالُوا: يَا رَسُولَ اللَّهِ مَنْ قُتِلَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ فَهُوَ شَهِيدٌ. قَالَ: 'إِنْ شَهِدَاءَ أُمَّتِي إِذَا لَقِيتَ! مَنْ قُتِلَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ فَهُوَ شَهِيدٌ، وَمَنْ مَاتَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ فَهُوَ شَهِيدٌ، وَمَنْ مَاتَ فِي الطَّاعُونَ فَهُوَ شَهِيدٌ، وَمَنْ مَاتَ فِي الْبَطْنِ فَهُوَ شَهِيدٌ.'

The Messenger of Allah (may Allah bless him and give him peace) said: 'Whom do you count to be a martyr among you?' They said: O Messenger of Allah, whoever is killed in the way of Allah is a martyr. He said: 'In that case the martyrs of my community will be very few! He who is killed in the way of Allah is a martyr, he who dies a natural death in the way of Allah is a martyr, he who dies in the plague in the way of Allah is a martyr, he who dies of cholera in the way of Allah is a martyr.'

(a) **Main Teachings : [2] marks**

- The popular understanding of the term martyr is one who lays down his life for the sake of Allah on the battlefield. This Hadith broadens the concept of martyrdom and lays stress on the importance of living righteous lives so that whenever death comes to a believer he/she will attain the status of a martyr.

- God rewards His believers for every act of piety and has given the status of a martyr to not only those who fight in Allah's way in the battlefield but to all those Muslims who die practicing their faith and believing in the oneness and supremacy of God the Quran says, **“And say not of those who are slain in the way of Allah: “they are dead”. Rather, they are living, but you perceive it not.” (2:154).**
- Jihad is of many kinds; physical, mental and spiritual and all forms of jihad which entail striving in the way of God are rewarded by Him. It encourages those Muslims who are unable to take part in Physical Jihad due to some disease or some valid reason.
- The core teachings of the Hadith however, is that Allah loves His creation and that He is willing to reward each and everyone as long as they are obedient to Him and remain true to their faith.

(b)Action: [2] marks

- A Muslim who wants to attain the status of a martyr must always be engaged in performing righteous deeds that would earn him Allah's pleasure. After belief in Allah's oneness and fulfillments of the religious obligations a Muslim should engage in Jihad fi sabil Allah (Struggle in the way of Allah) be it of the self of the tongue by the hand or by other means of support as striving in Allah's way will enable a Muslims to achieve the status of a martyr.
- Muslims should never hesitate to participate in any struggle waged to eradicate aggression and injustice for example raising voice against a tyrant ruler.
- It must be understood that martyr in the battlefield are thought to attain the highest level of Paradise. A companion was martyred on the day (of the battle) of Badr. His mother came to the Prophet and asked if her son was in Paradise. Prophet replied that her son was in the (most superior) Paradise of Al-Firdaus.
- Some examples of how to achieve this status are:
By working honestly and helping those in need, By supporting the vulnerable and showing kindness to all creatures of Allah, By looking after the environment, By defending the teachings of Islam and spreading the word of Allah and if need be laying down one's life in the way of Allah. The focus of every word and action of a Muslim should be to earn Allah's pleasure and to remember Him at all times.

Methods to check the authenticity of Hadith

O/N 2009

2 (a) Describe the methods employed by the compilers of the major books of Hadith to ensure the Hadiths they collected were authentic. [10]

M/J 2010

2 (a) How did the compilers of Hadiths (muhaddithun) judge between acceptable and unacceptable Hadiths? [10]

O/N 2013

2 (a) Write about the structure of a Hadith and describe the main methods used by the compilers of Hadiths to establish their genuineness. [10]

M/J 2014

2 (a) What rules did the writers of the six authentic books (Sihah Sitta) apply to ensure the authenticity of Hadiths? [10]

M/J 2015

2 (a) Write an account of the parts that make up a Hadith, and describe the checks made by the collectors of the Hadiths to ensure the accuracy of their collections. [10]

M/J 2016

2 (a) Write a detailed account of the parts of a Hadith and say how these parts help in determining the different categories of Hadiths, namely: sahih; hasan; da'if and mawdu'. [10]

M/J 2017

2(a) Write a descriptive account of the terms isnad and matn of a Hadith and the role they play in establishing the genuineness of a Hadith. [10]

O/N 2018

2(a) What measures were taken in early Islamic times to check the reliability of Hadiths? [10]

M/J 2019

2(a) Give a detailed account of the checks made on the text and narrators of Hadiths. (10)

Answer (Learn and write):

Intro:

Up to the beginning of the 3rd century of Islam, the compilers of Hadith did not classify Hadiths according to their authenticity. Famous scholar Muhammad bin Ismail al-Bukhari was the first person to conceive the idea of compiling authentic hadith by checking the reliability of the Isnad and Matn of every Hadith. Following his footsteps, other scholars also compiled authentic books which later came to be known as Sihah al Sitta or the six authentic books.

For checking the authenticity, these scholars divided every hadith in two parts i.e Isnad (chain of transmitters) and Matn (Text).

Isnad:

The first part of the Hadith is the chain of names. These are the authorities who are called narrators or Muhaddisin. It is called "Sanad" plural "Isnad" which means support as it is the authority for the genuineness of a Hadith. The authorities can be as many as one, two, three, four, five, or six depending on how far was the compilers time from the Holy Prophet (PBUH).

The list of narrators of the sayings and actions of the Prophet (pbuh) is called the sanad and could be explained by the following Hadith:

Muhammad ibn Al-Muthanna reported from **Abdul Wahhab**, from **Ayyub**, from **Abu Qilaabah**, from **Malik** that the Prophet (pbuh) said '**Pray as you see me praying.**' (**Agreed**). In this Hadith as in other Hadiths the list of narrators constitutes the sanad. The shorter the sanad the higher the chances of it being accurate.

Methods

The following methods were used by the scholars to be certain of the authenticity of Isnad of every hadith. The first transmitter in the chain must be a companion of the Holy Prophet (PBUH). This means that he could have heard the Holy Prophet (PBUH) speak, and could have seen him performing various actions. Also, to establish the genuineness of a Hadith the sanad needs to be unbroken leading back to the Prophet (pbuh).

- Each transmitter in the chain who is known as rawi must be a strong Muslim i.e honest and upright. This means that he should report exactly what he has learnt from his teacher, and not use his own words thus transferring a genuine Hadith. If any of the narrators was found guilty of falsehood or unreliable character then the hadith was not accepted as authentic. For example once Imam Malik bin Anas went to Egypt to collect the hadith. But when he observed that the narrator was deceitful in his daily living, he did not ask him about the hadith.
- He must be of an age in which he can understand the Hadith he is delivering. This is because he should understand what he reports and know how a change of words can change the ideas in it. Therefore, the hadiths narrated by children were not accepted as authentic.
- He must have a good memory which is to ensure that he delivers the exact words of the Holy Prophet (PBUH). He should report what agrees with the reports of others who are known to have good memories. If any of the narrators was found to have a defective memory, then the hadith was not accepted as authentic.
- The dates of birth and death of each transmitter in the chain was checked to ensure that they met each other. Thus, there must be no gaps or weaknesses in the chain to ensure that a Hadith is authentic. If the chain of narrators was broken, then the hadith was not accepted as authentic.
- Hadiths narrated by non muslims were not accepted as authentic.

Matn

The second part of the hadith is Matn which are the words of the Holy Prophet pbuh. Matn is the text of the hadith for example "Pray as you see me offering prayers." The Matn as a report or an act or statement of the Holy Prophet pbuh helps to build the picture of his teachings and thus, a base for Islamic rites and beliefs.

Methods:

The following methods were used by the scholars to be certain of the authenticity of Isnad of every hadith.

- The Matn is accepted as authentic if it is not contrary to the previous hadiths which were accepted as correct by the authorities, nor contradict the Quran or the main principles of Islam.
- It should not be against the common sense, laws of nature and historical facts.
- It should not level accusations to the Prophet's family and companions.
- The Matn should not be accepted if the narrator himself confesses that the hadith is fabricated.
- It should not contain such an event that if occurred would have been reported by other companions but was only reported by him. For example, one person attributed a hadith to Abu Bakr (R.A), that he would kiss his thumbs when Prophet's name was mentioned in Azaan. The scholars did not accept it as authentic because it was a public action and if Abu Bakr would have done it in Prophet's (pbuh) approval, other companions would also have reported and performed it
- It should not promise high rewards for insignificant deeds or order punishments for small errors.
- It should be in the Arabic dialect of the prophet and should not contain expressions uncharacteristic to the Prophet for example cursing and abusing.

Thus the major collectors of hadith used strict and careful methods to ensure that hadiths which they accepted were authentic. On the basis of these methods they categorized the hadiths into different types according to their authenticity e.g Sahih or most authentic, Hasan or approved, Daif or weak and Maudoo or Fabricated.

Musannaf and Musnad collections

The collection Hadiths became very important after the Prophet's (pbuh) death. Two techniques were mainly adopted resulting in two types of collections i.e Musannaf and Musnad.

The first organized compilations of Hadiths that had developed during the first two centuries of Islam are called **Musannaf hadith collections**. They are defined by their arrangement of content according to topic e.g Zakat, Prayer, purity, inheritance etc and constitute a major category within the class of all such works. *Musannaf* is from the [Arabic verb sannafa](#), meaning to arrange by chapter, and so has the literal meaning of something that is sectionally arranged.

The **Muwatta by Imam Malik** is an early example of an earliest Musannaf collection. He was the founder of Maliki school of law. His collection contains **1720** hadiths. Another compilation of this category is **Musannaf of Abdul Razzaq al Sanani** which contains 11000 hadiths. **Six authoritative collections of sunni hadith (Sihah al Sitta)** belong to this category of hadith collections.

the Musannaf collections served an important function in law and Hadith literature. Later scholars referred to Musannaf collections to know legal opinions of the Companions and Successors and Hadith critics used them as evidence when establishing the authenticity of a Hadith.

The late second/early third century AH saw a shift towards **Musnad collections** which were arranged according to isnads. In these collections the hadiths are arranged according to the names of companions and the content of hadiths is not taken into consideration. These collections begin with the companions who were closest to the Prophet (pbuh), the four Caliphs, Ten Blessed Companions, wives of the Prophet (pbuh), other leading companions from Muhajirin and Ansar. Under the name of each companion there are hadith narrated by that companion. In this way, every single hadith can be traced back to the Prophet (pbuh). Therefore, the titles of chapters in Musnad collections are : Musnad of Abu Bakr, Musnad of Ali, Musnad of Abu Hurairah, Musnad of Aisha etc

The most famous collection of this type is of **Ahmed bin Hanbal's "Musnad"**. He was the founder of Hanbali school of law. He compiled his book by examining 750,000 Hadiths. He selected only 27647 Hadiths out of which 10,000 Hadiths are repeated as more than one companions reported them. A musnad is valuable to scholars who want to check the authenticity of hadith. It is of little value for ordinary Muslims, who want to know answers to specific questions on a single topic. Similarly, for the practice of Ijma and Qiyas, the musnad collections are of no use.

Types of Hadith

Different types of traditions/ hadiths came into existence according to rank and degree of reliability. Thus ahadith have been divided by Muslim scholars into four main types:

1. **The Sahih Hadith (Most authentic)** is a term used to describe any Hadith, the accuracy of which is absolutely beyond question. Hence, these hadiths are classified as 'sound' and 'trustworthy' meaning that they are of the highest level of authenticity and reliability. Isnad (chain of transmitters) of Sahih hadith is full and unbroken; each transmitter in the chain is a practicing Muslim and has a good character and sound memory. Matn (text) does not contradict Quran, other authentic hadiths and main principles of Islam. It does not contain expressions uncharacteristic of the Prophet pbuh and does not have any defects. Ahadith reported by Bukhari and Muslim are universally accepted as sahih.
2. **Hasan (Approved)** are Hadiths whose text is absolutely true but the isnad may not pass the strict test established by the Hadith compilers e.g. a name in the chain may be missing but there is no reason to believe that the Hadith is not authentic. Similarly, a hadith may be called Hasan if one of its narrators have been found defective in memory in comparison with narrators of Sahih Hadith
Hasan is divided in two categories:
 - i. one with an isnad containing a reporter who is "screened", i.e. no prominent person reported from him
 - ii. one with an isnad containing a reporter who is known to be truthful and reliable, but is a degree less in his preservation/memory of hadith in comparison to the reporters of Sahih ahadith.
3. **Daif (Weak)**. is a term used to describe any Hadith whose truthfulness in both text (matn) and transmission (isnad) is not absolutely beyond question; and so, its authenticity is not proven. However, it is important to note that not all Ahadith classified as 'weak' are rejected. Abu Dawud included da'if traditions in his Musnad when he could find no other Hadith to explain questions relating to 'morals' or 'religious' devotion.
 A Hadith could be weak for many reasons. For example, one of its narrators could be mastur; i.e he may not be well known for his piety and reliability, but the compiler has no evidence that would question the narrator's character; or a narrator may have less than perfect memory but his truthfulness was never questioned.
 The weakness in a Hadith could also be due to the interruption in the isnad; that is, a break in the chain of transmission. Since there was nothing to suggest that the missing narrator was less than truthful or reliable, such weak Ahadith were included in Musnad collections in areas of moral guidance and religious teachings.
4. **Maudoo Hadith (Fabricated)** Sometimes hadiths were fabricated, sayings and actions were attributed to the Prophet (S.A.W) which he had not said, or done and cannot be used to prove any point of law. For example **"Common people follow the religion of their rulers."**

Types of Hadith according to Acceptance :

1. **Mutawatir**. It is a Hadith reported by a large number of people in different times whose agreement on a lie became inconceivable, making it authentic e.g Last sermon of the Prophet(pbuh).
2. **Ahad (Single or isolated)**. These were the Ahadith whose chain of narrators were broken or traditions that were less widely accepted, they were therefore less authentic if the narrators were truthful and honest, they were accepted otherwise rejected.

2(b) In your opinion what were the main reasons for Hadith collections? [4]

- The Prophet (pbuh) was the final authority on all secular and spiritual matters and with his death a template was needed to clarify, adjudicate or resolve questions and disputes as he would have done.
- Another reason could be that the Prophet's Companions, who had first-hand knowledge of his Sunnah, were themselves dying and hence a need was felt to preserve the Hadiths for future generations.
- Muslims rely on Hadiths in the observance of many pillars of Islam it is important that they have authentic Hadiths to follow otherwise they could conduct the practice of the pillars incorrectly.
- As Hadiths elaborate the Qur'an the teaching of Islam would not be correct if weak or false Hadiths were to be used to understand the Qur'an.
- New converts to Islam needed authentic guidance which could be available in the authentic collections of Hadith.

2 (b) Why do you think the chain of narrators (isnad) of a Hadith is given so much importance in establishing its genuineness? [4]

- Musnad collections were compiled on the basis of the chain of narrators (isnads). It helped to document that a Hadith had truly come from the Prophet (pbuh).
- Since they helped establish religious practice and Islamic law as well as day to day conduct of an individual, it was important that only the genuine ones were documented for use etc .
- As Hadiths elaborate the Qur'an the teaching of Islam would not be correct if weak or false Hadiths from unreliable narrators were to be used to understand the Qur'an.
- A musnad is valuable to scholars who want to check the authenticity of hadith as every hadith is traced back to the prophet through a chain of reliable transmitters , who were not only honest and upright but also had an excellent memory.

2.(b) In your opinion, can Islam be practised without the Hadiths? [4]

- say no to the question
- Hadiths play a very important role in the lives of Muslims and are a source of guidance to them in all aspects of life. What the Prophet (pbuh) said, did and what he approved of is second in importance to the Qur'an; Qur'an says, "He who obeys the Prophet, obeys Allah." Prophet (pbuh) said, "Behold I have been given the Book and a similar thing (Sunnah) along with that."
- Hadiths are important to explain the teachings of the Qur'an; details of hajj, zakat, fasting are all given to Muslims from the hadith and sunna of the Prophet (pbuh); the Prophet (pbuh) laid down principles (shariah) regarding every aspect of life: buying, selling, contracts, inheritance which are all part of his sunna; e.g. the instruction for prayer is given in the Qur'an but its performance is taught by the Prophet (pbuh) and without his Hadiths, Muslims would not be able to offer their five daily prayers as they are supposed to do.

2(b) In your opinion, from the two Hadith collections above, which is the more useful to Muslims? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

- In my opinion musannaf collections are more useful especially for ordinary Muslims who are not well versed in their knowledge of religion.
- These collections are based on themes/topics which help the study of a particular topic and its practical application. They enable Muslims to know the Prophet's (pbuh) teachings about some particular point of belief or action.
- For new converts to Islam who want to know about Islam, Musannaf collections are more useful as compared to Musnad collections.
- Similarly, for the practice of Ijma and Qiyas, the musannaf collections are used by the scholars.

Surahs 01-08

1. Choose **any two** of the following passages from the Qur'an, and:

(a) *briefly describe the main theme(s) in each passage.* [4]

(b) *briefly explain the importance of the themes in the daily living of Muslims.* [4]

1. Sura 2.255

اللَّهُ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ الْحَيُّ الْقَيُّومُ لَا تَأْخُذُهُ سِنَةٌ وَلَا نَوْمٌ لَهُ مَا فِي السَّمَاوَاتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ مَنْ ذَا الَّذِي يَشْفَعُ عِنْدَهُ إِلَّا بِإِذْنِهِ يَعْلَمُ مَا بَيْنَ أَيْدِيهِمْ وَمَا خَلْفَهُمْ وَلَا يُحِيطُونَ بِشَيْءٍ مِنْ عِلْمِهِ إِلَّا بِمَا شَاءَ وَسِعَ كُرْسِيُّهُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ وَلَا يَئُودُهُ حِفْظُهُمَا وَهُوَ الْعَلِيُّ الْعَظِيمُ

Allah. There is no god but He, the living, the self-subsisting, eternal. No slumber can seize Him nor sleep. His are all things in the heavens and on earth. Who is there can intercede in His presence except as He permits? He knows what is before or after or behind them. Nor shall they compass any of His knowledge except as He wills. His Throne extends over the heavens and the earth, and He feels no fatigue in guarding and preserving them for He is the Most High, the Supreme.

(a) Main Theme:

- The main theme of the passage is Allah in Himself. It is taken from **surah Baqarah**, a **madni surah**. It is also known as the **verse of throne (ayat al kursi)**.
- It begins with the expression of the shahada (declaration of oneness of God) and elaborates that the God is beyond human comprehension and He is free from all limitations and weaknesses .
- He is unlike other beings because He knows everything and can do everything and enjoys autonomy in exercising His authority. surah al Anaam says, “ **To Him is due the primal origin of the heavens and the earth.....**” [6:101]
- Throne (Kursi) is a symbol of authority which means that He is the King ruling over all that exists. No one shares His attributes and kingdom. His powers never weaken or waver.

(b) Importance:

- This verse is declared by the Prophet (pbuh) as one of the **treasures of Paradise**.
- It makes Muslims realize they must emphatically reject any idea or notion that there can be any partner of God which **eliminates the possibility of shirk** in practical lives.
- It allows Muslims to **understand their Lord** by explaining that certain things that affect humans do not affect Him e.g sleep, slumber, fatigue etc.
- Understanding God's power gives **conviction of heart** in worshipping Him alone and Muslims do not look towards others for the fulfillment of their needs.
- It is **recited** by Muslims **for seeking Allah's protection** in their daily lives against all evils.

(6:101-103)

بَدِيعُ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ أَتَى يَكُونُ لَهُ وَلَدٌ وَلَمْ تَكُنْ لَهُ صَاحِبَةٌ وَخَلَقَ كُلَّ شَيْءٍ وَهُوَ بِكُلِّ شَيْءٍ عَلِيمٌ
 تِلْكَمُ اللَّهُ رَبُّكُمْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا هُوَ خَالِقُ كُلِّ شَيْءٍ فَاعْبُدُوهُ وَهُوَ عَلَى كُلِّ شَيْءٍ وَكِيلٌ
 لَا تُنْزِكُ الْأَبْصَارُ وَهُوَ يُنْزِكُ الْأَبْصَارَ وَهُوَ الْلطِيفُ الْخَبِيرُ

101. To Him is due the primal origin of the heavens and the earth: how can He have a son when He has no consort? 102. He created all things, and He has full knowledge of all things. That is Allah, your Lord! there is no god but He, the Creator of all things: then worship Him: and He has power to dispose of all affairs. 103. No vision can grasp Him, but His grasp is over all vision: He is above all comprehension, yet is acquainted with all things.

(a) Main theme: [2] Marks

- These verses of Surah al Anaam, a makkan surah, discuss the fundamental Quranic theme of **Allah in Himself**.
- It gives the **message of Tauhid** by expressing that **God does not have partners** and the entire universe is the creation of His will and design.
- He is **free from all physical relations** especially wife and children. The Quran says, “**He begets not nor is He begotten.**” [Ch112:V3]
- God is **beyond human comprehension**. Although humans cannot understand Him, He understands everything in creation.
- God is **the most powerful** He is the one who has the power to help humans, and **He hears and sees all** that they do, therefore they should worship Him and pray to Him to reward their actions.

(b) Importance: [2] Marks

- These teachings emphasise the **importance of tawhid** for Muslims for their **spiritual purification**. It also **protects them from shirk** in daily living.
- Mankind is asked to **worship Him** as only He can fulfill their needs, so Muslims should be careful to **pray and fast**, etc., to fulfill their **obligation** to Him.
- When Muslims believe in Allah as Al-Knowing-Well Aware, they **refrain from committing sins** even secretly and become fair in dealings with people.
- In a world where there are lots of distractions, this surah reminds Muslims that they should **always remember their Creator** as He is the ultimate authority over their affairs .

3. Sura 41.37

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ اللَّيْلُ وَالنَّهَارُ وَالشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ لَا تَسْجُدُوا لِلشَّمْسِ وَلَا لِلْقَمَرِ وَاسْجُدُوا لِلَّهِ الَّذِي خَلَقَهُنَّ إِن كُنتُمْ إِيَّاهُ تَعْبُدُونَ

37. Among His signs are the night and the day, and the sun and the moon. Adore not the sun and the moon, but adore Allah, who created them, if it is Him you wish to serve.

(a) Main Theme: [2 marks]

- This verse of Surah **Fussilat** also known as **Ha Mim** was revealed during the early years in Makkah. It discusses the theme of Allah in Himself.
- Fussilat means “clearly spelt out message of Quran.” It is directing attention to the **concept of Tawhid (Oneness of God) by saying that** God creates and controls everything; in this verse specifically the sun and the moon.
- **celestial bodies** and the cycle of nature on earth are the **signs of God’s power** for mankind and help them to identify our true Lord and His presence. The Quran says, *“Behold! in the creation of the heavens and the earth and the alternation of Night and Day – there are indeed signs for men of wisdom.” (3:190)*
- The order of the sun and the moon shows that *God alone should be praised and worshipped* and nothing should be associated with Him. It is a **negation of paganism**; the sun and moon are not to be worshipped.

(b) Importance [2 marks]

- This passage is important in daily lives of Muslims because it **creates a strong link with God** so Muslims do not look up to anything/anyone else, famous people, money, etc., and they worship only Him.
- It **stops them from committing shirk** by making them realise that all created things are not permanent.
- God’s signs invite Muslims **to observe their environment** and ponder over His signs. It creates awe and wonder to help get closer to Him.
- Muslims in their daily lives learn from this passage that God administers all affairs. Thus, they consider themselves **humble servants of God** and turn to Him for salvation through prayer, fasting and other acts of worship.

4. Sura 42.4-5

لَهُ مَا فِي السَّمَاوَاتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَهُوَ الْعَلِيُّ الْعَظِيمُ

تَكَادُ السَّمَاوَاتُ يَنْفَطِرْنَ مِنْ فَوْقِهِنَّ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ يُسَبِّحُونَ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّهِمْ وَيَسْتَغْفِرُونَ لِمَنْ فِي الْأَرْضِ أَلَا إِنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ

4. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and on earth: and He is most high, most great. 5. The heavens are almost rent asunder from above them, and the angels celebrate the praises of their Lord, and pray for forgiveness for beings on earth: Behold! Verily Allah is He, the oft-forgiving, the most merciful.

(a) Main theme: [2] marks

- These verses of the surah ash-Shura, a makkan surah, represent the theme of God in Himself.
- These verses **confirm God's power, majesty and His ultimate** authority over all that exists in this Universe.
- His majesty is so much that **the heavens tremble and are almost ready to tear out** by His glory. Everything in the Universe acknowledges His power and supremacy by praising Him. The Quran says, "**His are all things in the heavens and on earth.**" (2:255)
- It further discusses that angels always glorify God's **attributes of forgiveness** and mercifulness for those who repent and request Him for their forgiveness

(b) Importance [2 marks]

- The importance here is that **God tells humankind of His power and control** over all things, so they should remember that they do not have any power in comparison which in turn **protects them from arrogance.**
- In their daily lives Muslims need to show **humbleness like Angels** who despite having magnificent power to dispose different affairs but they fear God and seek His mercy day and night.
- Muslims should **not be pessimist** in difficulties, even when Muslims have committed wrong actions. They **must keep trust in God** who would help them in all their problems.
- **As God is merciful** to humankind, they in turn should **be grateful** through acts of worship like prayer, fasting etc and also try to be **forgiving** of others, even if they have been hurt or injured.

قُلْ هُوَ اللَّهُ أَحَدٌ

اللَّهُ الصَّمَدُ

لَمْ يَلِدْ وَلَمْ يُولَدْ

وَلَمْ يَكُنْ لَهُ كُفُوًا أَحَدٌ

1. Say: He is Allah, the one and only; 2. Allah, the eternal, absolute; 3. He does not beget, nor is He begotten; 4. And there is none like Him.

(a) Main Theme : [2] marks

- Surah al Ikhlas was revealed in Makkah when the Quraish asked the Prophet, "Tell us of the **ancestry of your Lord**" thereupon this surah was revealed.
- It presents the fundamental Quranic theme of Allah in Himself. It explains the **concept of Tauhid** for the **purity of faith (ikhlas)**.
- **God is independent** of all but all are dependent upon Him and He needs nothing for His sustenance. *"Allah, there is no god but He, the living, the self-subsisting, the eternal."*(Ch 2:V255).
- He is free from all limitations of time and space. **He has no partners or family**, does not have anyone to share His authority nor any children.
- It tells about **God's uniqueness** in his personality attributes and actions and sums up the whole argument by warning against the tendency of comparing Him with anyone or anything. It is one of the surahs of protection (Quls).

(b) Importance : [2] marks

- This passage is important for Muslims because it **protects from different forms of Shirk** so that people do not take other people or created things as their Lord, so they should not replace God with things like famous people/saints, or place anyone or anything alongside Him.
- This surah is often **recited** by Muslims in their **daily prayers** after surah Fatiha.
- The passage is the **source of contentment and spiritual strength** for Muslims in their daily lives as Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) told that this sura is **equivalent to one third of Quran**.
- In daily lives of Muslims this sura **helps** them to have **clarity of faith** and allows them to develop a relationship with God through acts of worship like prayer, fasting etc .

6. Sura 1

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ رَبِّ الْعَالَمِينَ

الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

مَالِكِ يَوْمِ الدِّينِ

إِيَّاكَ نَعْبُدُ وَإِيَّاكَ نَسْتَعِينُ

اهْدِنَا الصِّرَاطَ الْمُسْتَقِيمَ

صِرَاطَ الَّذِينَ أَنْعَمْتَ عَلَيْهِمْ غَيْرِ الْمَغْضُوبِ عَلَيْهِمْ وَلَا الضَّالِّينَ

1. In the name of Allah, most gracious, most merciful. 2. Praise be to Allah, the cherisher and sustainer of the worlds; 3. Most gracious, most merciful; 4. Master of the day of judgment. 5. You we worship, and your aid we seek. 6. Show us the straight way, 7. The way of those to whom You have given your grace, not those who earn your anger, nor those who go astray.

(a) Main theme: [2] Marks

- This early Makkan surah is known as Fatiha because it is the opening chapter of Quran. It discusses fundamental Quranic theme of God's relationship with the created world.
- God is the **Lord of all that exists**, Even the things which humans cannot see.
- *Surah* includes **affirmation of Tawhid** in all its various categories: i.e unity of Allah's Lordship, Worship, Names and Attributes. God is the **Most Merciful** and he presides over judgment and forgives His creatures.
- **The straight way "Sirat-ul-Mustaqeem"** is the path based on righteousness. Allah leads humans on the path of his obedience which is given in the Quran and in Sunnah of the Holy Prophet. Quran says, **"verily! Right guidance is the guidance of Allah."** (3:37) If humans follow their own way, they may go astray.

(b) Importance: [2] Marks

- *Al-Fatihah* is actually a **prayer**. Through this **humans communicate with God** and He is replying to each verse.
- The recitation in five daily prayers commence with it. Prophet pbuh said '**No prayer is accepted without Fatiha**'. Recitation of **Tasmiah** brings Allah to mind before every action.
- Muslims use this to ask for guidance (given in the Qur'an and sunna), for mercy and help, even outside the prayer. Submitting to God **brings humbleness into lives**.
- The passage **reminds Muslims about Judgment** on the final day by Allah. This grows awareness for the preparation of the final day to face Allah. Muslims pray to be guided on the straight path by implementing the teachings of the Quran and Hadith in their lives.

7. Sura 2.21-22

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ اعْبُدُوا رَبَّكُمُ الَّذِي خَلَقَكُمْ وَالَّذِينَ مِنْ قَبْلِكُمْ لَعَلَّكُمْ تَتَّقُونَ

الَّذِي جَعَلَ لَكُمُ الْأَرْضَ فِرَاشًا وَالسَّمَاءَ بِنَاءً وَأَنْزَلَ مِنَ السَّمَاءِ مَاءً فَأَخْرَجَ بِهِ مِنَ الثَّمَرَاتِ رِزْقًا لَكُمْ فَلَا تَجْعَلُوا لِلَّهِ أَنْدَادًا وَأَنْتُمْ تَعْلَمُونَ

21. O people! Adore your Guardian-Lord, who created you and those who came before you, so that you may have the chance to learn righteousness; 22. Who has made the earth your couch, and the heavens your canopy; and sent down rain from the heavens; and by it brought forth fruits for your sustenance; then do not set up rivals to Allah, when you know.

a) Main Theme : (2 MARKS)

- These verses from **Surah al Baqarah, a Madni surah**, discuss the theme of God's relationship with the created world.
- These are based on the **concept of piety** which is achieved by the constant remembrance of Allah..
- God is the **creator of all mankind** and the purpose of creation is obedience to his commands. He not only has created humans but also made arrangements for their sustenance.
- **Allah's bounties** of fertile earth, shade and water from sky are recounted to emphasize that God alone should be praised and worshipped. Quran says, "**praise be to Allah, cherisher and sustainer of the worlds.**"
- It also suggests that mankind should not commit the **greatest sin of Shirk** i.e associating partners with Allah.

(b) Importance: (2 MARKS)

- Through these verses **humans understand the relationship with God** is that of the Lord and the slaves who should pray to him alone for all their needs.
- The physical life is symbolized by the Earth and spiritual life is symbolized by the sky to emphasize that both **physical and spiritual life depend upon Allah**.
- These verses also inculcate **a sense of gratitude to God** for his countless bounties. Muslims realize that only He deserves all our praise and worship and we should show gratitude for his favours through obedience and acts of worship i.e salat, fasting or pilgrimage etc.
- Through this passage **Muslims reflect upon the natural world** and the benefits it holds for them. They can also see this from the guidance that came before them from prophets in form of divine books.

8. Sura 96.1-5

اقْرَأْ بِاسْمِ رَبِّكَ الَّذِي خَلَقَ
 خَلَقَ الْإِنْسَانَ مِنْ عَلَقٍ
 اقْرَأْ وَرَبُّكَ الْأَكْرَمُ
 الَّذِي عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ
 عَلَّمَ الْإِنْسَانَ مَا لَمْ يَعْلَمْ

1. Read! in the name of your Lord, who created, 2. Created man out of a clot of congealed blood: 3. Proclaim! And your Lord is most bountiful, 4. He who taught by the pen, 5. Taught man what he did not know.

(a) Main theme: [2 marks]

- These verses of **Surah al Alaq**, a makkansurah, present the fundamental Quranic theme of Allah's relationship with the created world. This passage was the first revelation to the Holy Prophet (pbuh). It mentions **God power to create and ensure the survival growth of mankind**.
- it gives the **message to acquire knowledge** by reading and writing. Humans and animals have the same origin "clot of congealed blood" but Allah has blessed humans with a high destiny by giving them the ability to use the Pen.
- It dignifies **God as the greatest teacher** who taught all forms of knowledge to the humans and made them superior to other creatures. Quran says, " **and He taught Adam the names of all things.**" This is even more noticeable and important in the spiritual world.
- **Iqra** is command to read the signs the Created places in creation to understand His mercy, Wisdom and power.

(b) Importance: [2 marks]

- These teachings also help Muslims **to see God's power**, which is seen in the way He is able to create humans. After creation, He shows care for his creatures by sending revealed scriptures so they are not left on their own.
- **Knowledge is a link between man and God**. pen implies reading, writing, books, study, research etc. Seeking knowledge is encouraged and so humankind should try their best to learn throughout their lives, especially religious knowledge so they can get to know their Lord.
- Knowledge of each subject e.g religion, science etc has its own value and **acquiring knowledge is rewarded** like performing additional prayers or fasting.
- It also helps Muslims understand how prophethood and Islam started and they should reflect upon what God has sent down for them to help them live their lives. So they should be grateful to God and do their best for **spreading knowledge and eliminating illiteracy and ignorance**.

Surahs 09-15

1. Choose **any two** of the following passages from the Qur'an, and:

(a) *briefly describe the main theme(s) in each passage.* [4]

(b) *briefly explain the importance of the themes in the daily living of Muslims.* [4]

9. Sura 99

إِذَا زُلْزِلَتِ الْأَرْضُ زِلْزَالَهَا
وَأُخْرِجَتِ الْأَرْضُ أَثْقَالَهَا
وَقَالَ الْإِنْسَانُ مَا لَهَا
يَوْمَئِذٍ تُحَدِّثُ أَخْبَارَهَا
بَلْئِنْ رَّبِّكَ أَوْحَىٰ لَهَا
يَوْمَئِذٍ يَصْنُرُ النَّاسُ أَشْتَاتًا لِّيُرَوْا أَعْمَالَهُمْ
فَمَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ خَيْرًا يَرَهُ
وَمَنْ يَعْمَلْ مِثْقَالَ ذَرَّةٍ شَرًّا يَرَهُ

1. When the earth is shaken to her utmost convulsion, 2. And the earth throws up her burdens, 3. And man cries out: 'What is the matter with her?', 4. On that day will she declare her tidings: 5. For that your Lord will have given her inspiration. 6. On that day will men proceed in companies sorted out, to be shown their deeds. 7. Then shall anyone who has done an atom's weight of good see it! 8. And anyone who has done an atom's weight of evil shall see it.

(a) Main Theme: [2 marks]

- Surah Zilzal, a madni surah, presents the fundamental quranic theme of God's relationship with the created world.
- It depicts the last day and the end of time when everything known will be destroyed by a tremendous and more far-reaching convulsion than any earthquake we know. The Quran says, "When the earth is flattened out and throws out whatever it contains and gets empty." [Ch 84: V 3-4]
- On the day of resurrection the dead will be raised from their graves and the justice will be done in the light of the truth. In this world good and evil are mixed together. But on that day each grade of good and evil will be sorted out.
- people will be responsible for their actions on earth and given their accounts; God will give people their accounts, which will take them to Heaven or Hell.

(b) Importance: [2 marks]

- This Surah is a warning for people to give up their lives of sin, and and be obedient to Allah. The last day creates a fear of accountability, reminding Muslims to stay on the straight path. It reminds them of resurrection and the last day which is an article of faith in Islam.

- Good deeds will be rewarded **encouraging Muslims to do good at all times**, e.g. praying, being honest and helping others. It keeps them away from sins e.g. lying, cheating, gossiping, not fasting etc.
- It helps Muslims **understand the temporary nature of the world** which stops them being distracted by worldly things, fashion or money, etc .

11. 2.30-37

وَإِذْ قَالَ رَبُّكَ لِلْمَلَائِكَةِ إِنِّي جَاعِلٌ فِي الْأَرْضِ خَلِيفَةً قَالُوا أَتَجْعَلُ فِيهَا مَن يُفْسِدُ فِيهَا وَيَسْفِكُ الدِّمَاءَ وَنَحْنُ نُسَبِّحُ بِحَمْدِكَ وَنُقَدِّسُ لَكَ قَالَ إِنِّي أَعْلَمُ مَا لَا تَعْلَمُونَ

وَعَلَّمَ آدَمَ الْأَسْمَاءَ كُلَّهَا ثُمَّ عَرَضَهُمْ عَلَى الْمَلَائِكَةِ فَقَالَ أَنْبِئُونِي بِأَسْمَاءِ هَؤُلَاءِ إِنْ كُنْتُمْ صَادِقِينَ

قَالُوا سُبْحَانَكَ لَا عِلْمَ لَنَا إِلَّا مَا عَلَّمْتَنَا إِنَّكَ أَنْتَ الْعَلِيمُ الْحَكِيمُ

قَالَ يَا آدَمُ أَنْبِئْهُمْ بِأَسْمَائِهِمْ فَلَمَّا أَنْبَأَهُمْ بِأَسْمَائِهِمْ قَالَ أَلَمْ أَقُلْ لَكُمْ إِنِّي أَعْلَمُ الْغَيْبَ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَأَعْلَمُ مَا تُبْنُونَ وَمَا كُنْتُمْ تُكْتُمُونَ

وَإِذْ قُلْنَا لِلْمَلَائِكَةِ اسْجُدُوا لِآدَمَ فَسَجَدُوا إِلَّا إِبْلِيسَ أَبَى وَاسْتَكْبَرَ وَكَانَ مِنَ الْكَافِرِينَ

وَقُلْنَا يَا آدَمُ اسْكُنْ أَنْتَ وَزَوْجُكَ الْجَنَّةَ وَكُلَا مِنْهَا رَغَدًا حَيْثُ شِئْتُمَا وَلَا تَقْرَبَا هَذِهِ الشَّجَرَةَ فَتَكُونَا مِنَ الظَّالِمِينَ

فَازْلَجَهُمَا الشَّيْطَانُ عَنَّا فَأَخْرَجَهُمَا مِمَّا كَانَا فِيهِ وَقُلْنَا اهْبِطُوا بَعْضُكُمْ لِبَعْضٍ عَدُوٌّ وَلَكُمْ فِي الْأَرْضِ مُسْتَقَرٌّ وَمَتَاعٌ إِلَى حِينٍ

فَتَلَقَّى آدَمُ مِنْ رَبِّهِ كَلِمَاتٍ فَتَابَ عَلَيْهِ إِنَّهُ هُوَ التَّوَّابُ الرَّحِيمُ

30. Behold, your Lord said to the angels: 'I will create a vicegerent on earth.' They said: 'Will You place there one who will make mischief there and shed blood?- whilst we celebrate your praises and glorify your holy (name)?' He said: 'I know what you do not know.' 31. And He taught Adam the names of all things; then He placed them before the angels, and said: 'Tell me the names of these if you are right.' 32. They said: 'Glory to You, of knowledge we have none, save what You have taught us: In truth it is You who are perfect in knowledge and wisdom.' 33. He said: 'Adam! Tell them their names.' When he had told them, Allah said: 'Did I not tell you that I know the secrets of heaven and earth, and I know what you reveal and what you conceal?' 34. And behold, We said to the angels: 'Bow down to Adam'. And they bowed down. Not so Iblis: he refused and was haughty: he was of those who reject faith. 35. We said: 'Adam! You and your wife dwell in the Garden; and eat of the bountiful things in it as You wish. But do not approach this tree, or you will run into harm and transgression.' 36. Then Satan made them slip from there, and got them out of what they had been in. We said: 'Go down, with enmity between yourselves. On earth will be your dwelling-place and your means of livelihood, for a time.' 37. Then Adam learnt from his Lord words of inspiration, and his Lord turned towards him; for He is often-returning, most merciful.

(a) Main theme:[2 marks]

- These verses of Surah al Baqarah, a madni surah, discuss the theme of Allah's Messengers.

- **God created Adam**, as well as everything else (angels, jinns etc.), and granted him a high position due to **superior knowledge**. God gives knowledge to whom he wants and he gives the special status of prophethood to whom he wishes.
- **Superiority of Adam** was duly **acknowledged by all angels** except Iblis (Satan) who showed arrogance because he was a jinn. Satan's act of disobedience was a result of jealousy.
- When **Satan misled Adam**, his disobedience resulted in his **expulsion from paradise** along with his wife Eve. God did not leave him as Adam was taught these **words of repentance**, "Our Lord! We have wronged ourselves; so if You do not forgive us and have mercy on us, then surely, we are of the losers." [Aa'raf 7:23]

(b) Importance : [2 marks]

- These verses are important for Muslims because they highlight man's position as **God's vicegerent**. Adam was the first Prophet of God His status as representative on earth.
- This gives Muslims a **sense of their connection to God** as Adam is called the father of humankind and everyone is descended from him. It also strengthens belief in Prophets.
- God showed Adam's importance by making the angels bow to him and forgiving him when he disobeyed. It shows that **God is forgiving to mankind**. This should make humankind understand their status, they should seek forgiveness from God and worship Him.
- It also shows **God's care and direct relationship** with every individual.

وَكَذَلِكَ نُرِي إِبْرَاهِيمَ مَلَكُوتَ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضِ وَلِيَكُونَ مِنَ الْمُوقِنِينَ
 فَلَمَّا جَنَّ عَلَيْهِ اللَّيْلُ رَأَى كَوْكَبًا قَالَ هَذَا رَبِّي فَلَمَّا أَفَلَ قَالَ لَا أُحِبُّ الْآفِلِينَ
 فَلَمَّا رَأَى الْقَمَرَ بَازِغًا قَالَ هَذَا رَبِّي فَلَمَّا أَفَلَ قَالَ لَنْ لَمْ يَهْدِنِي رَبِّي لَأَكُونَنَّ مِنَ الْقَوْمِ الضَّالِّينَ
 فَلَمَّا رَأَى الشَّمْسَ بَازِغَةً قَالَ هَذَا رَبِّي هَذَا أَكْبَرُ فَلَمَّا أَفَلَتْ قَالَ يَا قَوْمِ إِنِّي بَرِيءٌ مِّمَّا تُشْرِكُونَ
 إِنِّي وَجَّهْتُ وَجْهِيَ لِلَّذِي فَطَرَ السَّمَاوَاتِ وَالْأَرْضَ حَنِيفًا وَمَا أَنَا مِنَ الْمُشْرِكِينَ

75. So also did We show Abraham the power and the laws of the heavens and the earth, so that he might have certainty. 76. When the night covered him over, he saw a star: He said: 'This is my Lord.' But when it set, he said: 'I do not love things that set.' 77. When he saw the moon rising in splendour, he said: 'This is my Lord.' But when the moon set, he said: 'Unless my Lord guides me, I will surely be among those who go astray.' 78. When he saw the sun rising in splendour, he said: 'This is my Lord; this is the greatest.' But when the sun set, he said: 'O my people! I am indeed free from your giving partners to Allah.' 79. 'For me, I have set my face firmly and truly towards Him who created the heavens and the earth, and never shall I give partners to Allah.'

(a) Main theme: [2] marks

- These verses of Surah al Anaam, a makkan surah, discuss the theme of God's Messengers.
- Hazrat Ibrahim understood the concept of Oneness of God after observing stars, moon and the sun which shows that God uses His signs to guide his prophets.
- God's power is shown through His ability to control the sun and the moon, and that the sign of His power is that He does not fade or die away, whilst things in creation do.

- He is free from all limitations and weaknesses and celestial bodies merely reflect His glory and are only His creatures. Ibrahim declared truth to his people and rejected polytheism (Shirk) “**How should I fear (the beings) you associate with Allah when you fear not to give partners to Allah..**” (6:81)

(b)Importance in Muslims life : [2 marks]

- These verses are important for Muslims because they strengthen their belief in His Oneness by showing that created things i.e sun, moon, stars are not permanent which protects them from committing shirk in their lives.
- Muslims should worship God alone which was preached by all the prophets. According to some commentators the whole thrust of Abraham's reasoning in **verses 76-78** is directed against the superstitious beliefs.
- Muslims look to one God for their answers, rather than looking to created things for guidance. The story of Abraham is highly instructive for all men in quest of truth.
- Since Prophets have asked God for guidance so Muslims should take this guidance too. God has created such beautiful heavenly bodies so surely He alone deserves worship through prayer, fasting etc.

13. Sura 5.110

إِذْ قَالَ اللَّهُ يَا عِيسَى ابْنَ مَرْيَمَ اذْكُرْ نِعْمَتِي عَلَيْكَ وَعَلَىٰ وَالِدَتِكَ إِذْ أُتِدَّتْكَ بِرُوحِ الْقُدُسِ تُكَلِّمُ النَّاسَ فِي الْمَهْدِ وَكَهْلًا
وَإِذْ عَلَّمْتُكَ الْكِتَابَ وَالْحِكْمَةَ وَالتَّوْرَةَ وَالْإِنْجِيلَ وَإِذْ تَخْلُقُ مِنَ الطِّينِ كَهَيْئَةِ الطَّيْرِ بِإِذْنِي فَتَنفُخُ فِيهَا فَتَكُونُ طَيْرًا
بِإِذْنِي وَتُبْرِئُ الْأَكْمَةَ وَالْأَبْرَصَ بِإِذْنِي وَإِذْ تُخْرِجُ الْمَوْتَىٰ بِإِذْنِي وَإِذْ كَفَفْتُ بَنِي إِسْرَءِيلَ عَنْكَ إِذْ جِئْتَهُم بِالْبَيِّنَاتِ
فَقَالَ الَّذِينَ كَفَرُوا مِنْهُمْ إِن هَذَا إِلَّا سِحْرٌ مُّبِينٌ

Then will Allah say: 'Jesus son of Mary! Recount my favour to you and to your mother. Behold! I strengthened you with the holy spirit, so that you spoke to the people in childhood and in maturity. Behold! I taught you the Book and Wisdom, the Law and the Gospel. And behold! You make out of clay, as it were, the figure of a bird, by my leave, and you breathe into it and it becomes a bird by my leave, and you heal those born blind, and the lepers, by my leave. And behold! You bring forth the dead by my leave. And behold! I restrained the Children of Israel from you when you showed them the clear signs, and the unbelievers among them said: 'This is nothing but evident magic.'

(a)Main theme: [2marks]

- This verse of **Surah Maidah**, a **madni surah**, discusses the theme of **God's messengers**.
- God will address Hazrat Isa (A.S) on the day of judgement recalling His favours upon Hazrat Isa and his mother Maryam (A.S) to make non-believers realize their ingratitude towards the divine message.
- Hazrat Isa was human and a Prophet and not begotten son of God. His birth and life were to be a sign to men and to turn them back to Allah. The birth of 'Isa was a Miracle. He was born to Maryam without a father and he spoke as an infant and defended his mother. Quran says, “**He shall speak to the people in childhood and in maturity.**” [3:46]
- God gives miracles to His prophets to help them, in this case Jesus got the holy spirit, the Book and the wisdom ,the Law and the Gospel; humans can do great things but only with God's permission; God gives humankind signs through prophets of His existence, which separates those who believe and those who don't.

(b)Importance of theme: [2marks]

- These teachings reaffirm Muslims the prophethood of Hazrat Isa (A.S) and the power of God. Humans are capable of great feats but it is God who gives permission for these; moon landings, space travel etc.
- The words “**By My leave**” are repeated with each miracle to emphasize that everything takes place according to the will of God so we should look to Him for the fulfillment of our needs.
- Muslims should use these as signs of God's grace, and believe in His power. They should therefore remember Him often, by praying, supplicating or doing good deeds, etc. to ensure they are counted as believers.

- The miracles mentioned in these verses strengthen a Muslim's belief in all the messengers as they show that all of them were sent by Allah of His own accord.

14. Sura 93

وَالضُّحَى
وَاللَّيْلِ إِذَا سَجَى
مَا وَدَّعَكَ رَبُّكَ وَمَا قَلَى
وَلَلْآخِرَةُ خَيْرٌ لَّكَ مِنَ الْأُولَى
وَلَسَوْفَ يُعْطِيكَ رَبُّكَ فَتَرْضَى
أَلَمْ يَجِدْكَ يَتِيمًا فَآوَى
وَوَجَدَكَ ضَالًّا فَهَدَى
وَوَجَدَكَ عَائِلًا فَأَغْنَى
فَأَمَّا الْيَتِيمَ فَلَا تَقْهَرْ
وَأَمَّا السَّائِلَ فَلَا تَنْهَرْ
وَأَمَّا بِنِعْمَةِ رَبِّكَ فَحَدِّثْ

1. By the glorious morning light, 2. And by the night when it is still, 3. Your Lord has not forsaken you, nor is he displeased. 4. And truly the Hereafter will be better for you than the present. 5. And soon your Lord will give you so that you will be pleased. 6. Did He not find you an orphan and give you shelter? 7. And He found you wandering, and He gave you guidance. 8. And He found you in need, and made you independent. 9. Therefore, do not treat the orphan with harshness, 10. Nor drive the beggar away; 11. But tell about the bounty of your Lord!

(a) Main theme: [2 marks]

- Surah Duha, a makkan surah, contains the theme God's messengers. It was revealed when the pagans mocked at him due to an interval in the revelations.
- God gave reassurance to the Prophet (pbuh) that He is always with him even when He seemed not to be. His assurance of this was proved by His past actions of giving him shelter through Abu Talib, guidance through divine revelations and financial independence through marriage with Khadija.
- A person may think that God has deserted them, or He doesn't seem to be there, but He is always present and with them.
- Since God helped the Prophet (pbuh), he should assist those who seek help from him and should continue to live as God taught him. Allah says, "And feed with food the needy, the orphan and the prisoner for the love of Him." [76:8]

(b) Importance in Muslims life : [2 marks]

- This Surah gives a message of hope and consolation. God gave blessings to the Prophet Muhammad, despite people saying that he had been forgotten by God. Muslims today should also retain their faith in

difficult times. Muslims should look at their lives to see their blessings and not think they have been given nothing. It should motivate them to keep their trust upon Allah in straitened circumstances and hold themselves wisely with patience

- They should not constantly want more than what they have, instead they should be grateful to God through prayers and worship and make people aware of the ways in which God helps them.
- It gives message of being kind and helpful to others in need, like orphans and beggars etc. It also strengthens belief in prophets which is an article of faith.

15. Sura 108

إِنَّا أَعْطَيْنَاكَ الْكَوْثَرَ

فَصَلِّ لِرَبِّكَ وَانْحَرْ

إِنَّ شَانِئَكَ هُوَ الْأَبْتَرُ

1. To you have We granted abundance. 2. So pray to your Lord and sacrifice. 3. For he who hates you, he will be cut off.

(a) Main Theme: [2 marks]

- **Surah al Kauthar** was revealed to the Prophet in **Makkah** at the death of his son when he was aggrieved due to the mockery of pagans especially Abu Lahab who called him "**Abtar**" (cut off) which meant that his message would be lost after his death. It presents the theme of God's messengers. This is the shortest surah of Quran.
- God gave **reassurance to the Prophet** (pbuh) of his help and gave glad tidings of **abundance of favors** in this world as well as in the hereafter.
- It is interpreted as **fountain in heaven**, which will quench the highest spiritual thirst of a man, his **spiritual progeny** (Muslims) and his **daughter Fatima**.
- Prophet (pbuh) is **instructed to remain loyal** to his faith by establishing regular prayer and by making sacrifice and reminded him that "**rejected were the messengers before you; with patience and constancy they bore their rejection**" (6:34).
- It also tells us of **God's wrath** for Prophet's enemies and foretold about their destruction specially Abu Lahab.

(b) Importance : [2 marks]

- This surah is important for Muslims it **gives them hope in times of need** and teaches them to have faith in God's support in difficulties. Future hope is also given with the promise of the Kawthar in paradise.
- **God intervenes when one is in difficulty**, so Muslims should look to Him for help and support and not feel disheartened in times of difficulty, e.g. during illness or oppression.
- Muslims should **remain steadfast despite the difficulties** or mockeries that they face and be grateful for what He has given them, remembering that real rewards are in the life hereafter therefore, justice should be left to God.
- Muslims are also taught that they must **love, respect and obey the Prophet** (P.B.U.H) as Allah also loved him and this will ensure their entrance in paradise.

Hazrat Abu Bakr's(R.A) Caliphate

Election:

While the final rites of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) were in progress, it was brought to the attention of Hazrat Umar that a meeting had been called by Ansar at the **Saqifa Banu Saïda** to elect a successor (caliph) to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H). **Hazrat Umar** hurried to the place accompanied by **Hazrat Abu Bakr** and **Hazrat Abu Ubaidah bin Jarrah**. The Ansar had almost declared the leader of the Khazraj tribe, **Saad bin Ubada** as the caliph.

Hazrat Abu Bakr at this point made a persuasive speech on why a Qurasih should now lead the Muslims. He reminded them a Hadith of the Prophet (pbuh) in which he commanded that according to Arab tradition, the next leader after him should be chosen from Quraish .

On hearing this convincing argument, another leader of the Ansar **Khubaib bin Mundhar** put forward the proposal for **two state solution**, one led by a Muhajir(Quraish) and one by an Ansar. Hazrat Umar rejected this suggestion by saying that for the solidarity of the Islamic state , there should be only one caliph.

At this point hazrat Abu Ubaidah bin Jarrah said,

“O Ansar! you were the first to uphold Islam. Do not be the first to sow the seeds of dissention in it.” On hearing this, the Ansar quickly withdrew their claim.

Hazrat Abu Bakr put forward the names of Hazrat Umar and Hazrat Abu Ubaydah bin Jarrah as caliph but Hazrat Umar nominated Hazrat Abu Bakr as the political leader of a unified Muslims state based in Madina. Taking Hazrat Abu Bakr's hand Hazrat Umar took the pledge of loyalty to him. After Hazrat Umar and **Hazrat Zaid ibn Sabit (from Ansar)** took the oath of loyalty, people from all sides rushed to pledge their loyalty to Hazrat Abu Bakr as the Holy Prophet's (P.B.U.H) vicegerent.

The next day at **Masjid al Nabvi** a general oath of loyalty was taken by the Muslims. Hazrat Abu Bakr thus became the first Caliph of Islam.

When Abu Bakr was elected he said **“ O people! I have been selected as your Leader, although I am not better than anyone of you. If I am right, obey me. If I am misguided, set me right. The weakest among you is powerful in my eyes, until I do not get him his due. The most powerful among you is the weakest in my eyes, until I do not make him pay due rights to others. I ask you to obey me as long as I obey Allah and His Messenger. If I disobey Allah and His Messenger, you are free to disobey me”**.

He adopted the title of **“the successor of the messenger of Allah.”**

Expedition to Syria

After assuming the Khilafat the first issue that Hazrat Abu Bakr R.A had to decide was whether or not the expedition to Syria, should be sent. The Holy Prophet (P.B.H.H) had directed to send this expedition under the command of Usamah. The circumstances had changed following the death of Holy Prophet (P.B.H.H).

At that critical stage in history most of tribes had apostatized from Islam, that is, they had abandoned their belief in Islam. Madinah was surrounded by hostile tribes. It was suggested to Hazrat Abu Bakr R.A that it was not advisable to send the army outside the country. Hazrat Abu Bakr said that according to the wish of Holy Prophet (P.B.H.H), the army should be sent to Syria.

He said **“Who am I to withhold the army that the Prophet (P.B.U.H) had ordered to proceed? Come what may, let Madinah stand for fall; the Khilafat live or perish, the command of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) shall be carried out”**.

Abu Bakr then directed the army to depart on this mission. He bade farewell to the army and addressed them in the following terms:

“Do not kill children, women and old men. Do not cut down any trees wherein there is food for men and beasts. Do not molest the monks in the churches”.

Towards the close of June 632 A.D, three weeks after the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) demise the army of Usamah left. After ten days march the Muslim army attacked the border tribes. The Byzantine forces avoided this confrontation, as they were no match for the Muslims. They were defeated and offered allegiance to the authorities at Madinah. The expedition proved to be a great success. It secured the safety of the frontier with the Byzantines and averted the threat of any attack from them. It

made the hostile tribes release that the Muslims were strong enough to meet any emergencies. Victorious, Usamah's army returned to Madinah. It demonstrated the strength and unity of the Muslims even in the absence of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) thus paving the way for the subsequent conquests of the Syrian and Egyptian regions both of which were conquered during Usamah's lifetime.

Refusal to pay Zakat

At that time, many tribes such as **Banu Asad, Banu Ghatafan, Banu Abbas, Banu Murrah** and other surrounded in Madina. After the conquest of Makkah when other tribes in Arabia accepted Islam, These tribes also offered allegiance to Islam. This allegiance was based on diplomacy rather than on faith and conviction of heart. They regarded Islam as a matter of personal allegiance to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) which ended with his death.

These tribes sent a deputation to Hazrat Abu Bakr with the proposal that with the passing away of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), their agreement with Islam had ended and it was necessary that the authorities at Madina should make a fresh agreement with them. They said that they would remain on friendly terms with the authorities at Madinah provided they were relieved of the obligation to pay Zakat.

Abu Bakr was very strict on this point. He argued that Zakat being a fundamental injunction of Islam had to be paid. Addressing the delegates, he said, **"If with reference to Zakat, you withhold even as much as a string to tie a camel, as the Khalifa of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), it will be my duty to fight for it, whatever the consequences"**.

When Hazrat Abu Bakr rejected the demand of the tribes to exempt them from the payment of Zakat they decided to forego Islam rather than yield to the authority at Madinah. They decided to launch an attack on Madinah when the main Muslim army was away in Syria.

These tribes one night launched an attack on Madina and met with some initial success but the Muslims under the command of Hazrat Abu Bakr rallied and in a counter attack repulsed the tribes. Driven away from Madina the tribes gathered at **Dhu Qissa** which was at little distance from Madina.

Hazrat Abu Bakr marched there as the head of a Muslim force and launched an attack against them. After some resistance the tribes broke rank and retreated to **Abraq**. When the main Muslim army under Usama returned from the Syrian front successfully, Hazrat Abu bakr marched at its head and proceeded to Abraq. The tribes were routed, and their lands were confiscated by the Muslims. This was a significant moment in the caliphate of Hazrat Abu Bakr as after this victory the tribes sent their delegates to Madina and not only offered allegiance to the caliph but expressed their willingness to pay Zakat as well.

Apostasy Movement

The short Khilafat of Abu Bakr was mostly occupied with the so called **Ridda (Apostasy) Wars**. After the death of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) some people rebelled against the authorities at Madina and renounced or apostatized Islam.

Abu Bakr faced the situation calmly. Without any delay, He launched a campaign against this movement. He collected the troops at Madina and divided them into **eleven battalions**. He placed each of the Battalion under the command of an experienced commander and sent each into eleven different part of Arabia to fight against the false prophets and the tribes that were helping them in these wars against the Muslims.

He instructed the commander; first two invite the revolting tribes to Islam. But if they failed to comply, they were to be attacked. Some of the tribes submitted to Islam without fighting, while others remained adamant. So wars were waged against them. Within a year, the control of Islam was established throughout the peninsula.

False Prophets:

After becoming caliph he had to deal with many difficulties but the most important was the rise of the false prophets which resulted in apostasy movement and caused a threat to Islam.

- (i) **Al-Aswad al-'Ansi:** His name was **Abhal ibn kaab** al-Ansi He was the leader of the 'Ansi tribe in **Yemen**. His **dark complexion** earned him the title al-Aswad i.e. the black man, and he was also known as the veiled prophet as he covered his face to hide his ugliness and to create a mystery about himself. Before claiming prophethood al Aswad al-Ansi had tried his hand at soothsaying and magic and claimed he had knowledge of the unknown. In

the later years of the Prophet's (S.A.W) life, al-Aswad claimed to have received divine guidance and inspiration, and he used tricks to convince the people of his 'miracles'. After collecting a large army, he rose in open opposition to Islam and **invaded Najran and most of Yemen**. killing Shahr the ruler of Yemen he forcibly married his widow and declared himself ruler of Yemen and the leader of the Ans tribe. An expedition was organized and led by **Firuz-al-Dhalaymi**, a Persian Muslim, who succeeded in killing al-Aswad a day before Prophet's death. However, learning of the Prophet's demise, al-Aswad's followers regrouped and revolted under a man called **Qais ibn 'Abd Yaghus**; they were defeated by **Firuz** and subsequently surrendered along with their leader.

(ii) **Tulayha ibn Khuwaylid ibn Nawfal al-Asadi:** He was the wealthy leader of the Bani Asad and Ghatafan tribes in north Arabia, and was a renowned warrior who initially opposed the Muslims. In 630 he converted to Islam, but shortly afterwards he rebelled and proclaimed himself as a prophet. Many tribes accepted his 'prophethood' and combined to raise a strong force against Islam. Khalid ibn al-Walid was sent to quell this revolt and at the **Battle of Buzakha** in September 632, Tulayha was defeated and escaped to Syria while most of his followers submitted and accepted Islam. Later, when Syria was conquered by the Muslim, he converted to Islam once again, and subsequently fought alongside the Muslims in the battles of Jalula, Qadisiyah, and Nihawand against the Persians.

(iii) **Sajah bint-al Harith:** She was an Arab Christian from the tribe of Taghlib and first enjoyed their protection; following a split within the **Banu Tamim**, she had the protection of the **Banu Hanifa**. Sajah had a following as a **sooth-sayer**, and after the death of Hazrat Muhammad (S.A.W), when many of her tribesmen rejected Islam, she declared herself as a prophetess. She collected a force of 4000 to march on Madina, but learning of Tulayha's defeat by Khalid ibn al-Walid, Sajah dropped her plans. She then sought the help of Musailimah, another self-proclaimed prophet, and reached an agreement with him to face Khalid. Subsequently, Sajah married Musailimah and accepted his prophethood. Meanwhile, Khalid ibn al-Walid crushed Sajah's forces and then moved against Musailimah who was killed in the Battle of Yamama. After Musailimah's death, Sajah became a Muslim.

(iv) **Musailimah al-Kadhdab (The Liar):** Known as Musailimah ibn Habib al-Hanafi, he belonged to the large and influential tribe, Banu Hanifa, in the Yamama region to the east of the Arabian Peninsula. Musailimah was also wealthy and powerful and he used his influence to misguide people and declared himself a prophet during Hazrat Muhammad (S.A.W) lifetime. In fact he had visited the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) in Madina and spent time in his company.

Upon his return from Madina, Musailimah declared his prophethood and claimed to have received divine revelation. He founded a new creed in which he reduced the number of daily prayers, relieved his followers from the practicing of fasting and giving zakat and made drinking and adultery permissible. He even wrote to the Holy Prophet (S.A.W) declaring himself a 'messenger of Allah' and that he had been given a share with him in prophethood. Of course, his claims were firmly and clearly rejected by Hazrat Muhammad (S.A.W), who addressed him as an 'arch-lair'.

After the death of the Holy Prophet (S.A.W) Musailimah challenged Hazrat Abu Bakr's caliphate. The **battle of Yamama in December 632**, was the significant event that decided Musailimah's fate. He was in command of an army of **40000**. Hazrat Abu Bakr had first sent Ikrimah and Shurabil ibn Hasanah and then sent a large force under the command of Khalid ibn al-Walid to Yamama. The Muslims, numbering **13000**, fought a long drawn out battle with many casualties as Musailimah's forces put up a strong resistance. Eventually, Musailimah was killed by **Washi al-Harb**---who had killed Hazrat Hamza in the battle of Uhud before his conversion to Islam. Musailimah's army scattered and many were killed as they fled. Many prominent Muslims and huffaz---those who had memorized the Qu'ran---also lost their lives in this battle.

Battle of Yamama

After Prophet's (pbuh) death, several false prophets arose in different parts of the Islamic state. **Musailimah ibn Habib al-Hanafi** was the most dangerous one. He belonged to the large and influential tribe, Banu Hanifa, in the Yamama region to the east of the Arabian Peninsula. Abu Bakr appointed **Ikrimah** as the commander of one of the corps. Ikrimah's orders were to

advance and make contact with the forces of Musaylimah at Yamamah, but not to get involved in battle with him. Khalid ibn al-Walid was chosen to command the forces apposing Musaylima after he dealt with other smaller apostates. Ikrimah advanced with his corps and established a camp somewhere in the region of Yamamah.

The next development that Ikrimah heard of was that **Shurahbil bin Hasanah** was marching to join him. Shurahbil too had been given a corps by the Caliph with orders to follow Ikrimah, and await further instructions. In a few days Shurahbil would be with him. Ikrimah could wait no longer, and he set his corps in motion. This happened at the end of October 632 (end of Rajab, 11 Hijri). He was defeated by Musaylimah. Shurahbil remained in the region of Yamamah. To ensure that he did not fall into the error of Ikrimah, Abu Bakr wrote to him: **"Stay where you are and await further instructions."**

A few days before Khalid's arrival Shurahbil had given in to the same temptation as Ikrimah; he had advanced and clashed with Musaylimah, but was defeated. Khalid got news that Musaylimah was encamped in the plain of Aqraba with an army of 40,000 warriors. The two successful actions fought by them against Ikrimah and Shurahbil had increased their confidence in themselves and created an aura of invincibility around Musaylimah.

Khalid marched south from Bhtaha to the valley of Yamama with the force of 13000 men and was met by Musaylimah on the plain of Aqraba. After a fierce fight the Muslims forces had to retreat and there was much jubilation in Musaylimah's camp. Though Khalid had been forced to withdraw, he refused to admit defeat. He regrouped the army under tribal commanders. He created a reserved force of the one thousand cavalry and kept them under his personal command.

The next day the two armies faced each other in headlong attack.

While the front rank of two armies grappled with each other in single combat, Khalid led the cavalry reserve to the mounds where Musaylimah was camped. The boldness of Khalid's move took the opposition completely by surprise. Musaylimah's bodyguards fought bravely but they could not hold guard for long. As Khalid increased his pressure Musaylimah lost his nerve and retreated into a neighboring fortified garden.

With the withdrawal of Musaylimah, his army lost the will to fight and they too found safety in seeking refuge in the garden. The garden was surrounded by a huge wall and the fugitives closed the gate thus shutting access to the pursuing Muslims. The Muslims were anxious to get into the garden and finish the job.

Soon a Muslim soldier **Al Baraa ibn Malik** asked his fellow men to let him climb the wall so that he could open the gate by killing the guards there. The soldier jumped in to the garden and opened the gate. The Muslims entered the garden and the last phase of the Battle of Yamamah had begun.

The Muslim army engaged in a fierce battle with Musaylimah's troops. So bloody was the battle of Garden that in Arab annals it came to be known as The Battle of Death.

When Musaylimah was finally killed by **Wahshi al Harb** who had killed Hazrat Hamza in the battle of Uhud the Banu Hanifa surrendered and accepted the offered terms and were readmitted to the fold of Islam. Many prominent Muslims and Huffaz also lost their lives in this battle. Hazrat Abu Bakr after defeating the false Prophets turned his attention to the uprising in Bahrain, Oman, Mahrah and Hadramaut.

Compilation of Quran

During the time of the Prophet (pbuh) the Qur'an was written on pieces of animal skin and on parts of bone but was mainly memorised by the companions. At the time of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) death no official copy of the Quran existed.

- After becoming caliph, Hazrat Abu Bakr waged a war against the false prophet **Musaylima** and many companions who had committed the Holy Quran to memory were martyred in that battle known as the **battle of Yamamah**.

- **Hazrat Umar** suggested to Hazrat Abu Bakr that the Quran should be compiled. Hazrat Abu Bakr, however, hesitated and said that he would not do the job left unfinished by the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H). According to Hazrat Abu Bakr, **"Umar went on persuading me to accept his suggestion till I was convinced that he was right so I accepted his suggestion."**

- Hazrat Abu Bakr asked **Zaid bin Sabit**, one of scribes of Divine revelation to collect the Quranic verses from every part of the Islamic empire and compile them in book form. He was also reluctant but Abu Bakr persuaded him. Zaid later remarked, **"It would have been easier to carry a mountain on my shoulders, than to compile the Quran."**

- A commission was appointed headed by Zaid Bin Sabit and its members comprised at least **twenty or twenty five** companions who had committed the Quran to memory. Zaid Bin Sabit traced out and collected the chapters of the Quran from

every person who had it in their possession. He collected it from palm leaves, stones, and pieces of wood and people who had committed it to memory.

- Zaid Bin Sabit was not content just finding a written piece of the Quran.
- He also verified it from those people who had heard it from the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H).
- Though he himself was a hafiz of Quran, he always tried to find a verse in writing before including it in his manuscript,
- He did not accept any part without two witnesses to it.
- The verses were written in the order that the Prophet (pbuh) had given, but the surahs were written on separate sheets.

so that version of the Quran he recorded was the one heard from and written under the supervision of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H).

The script prepared by Zaid Bin Sabit was named “**Mushaf**” by **Abdullah bin Masood**. It remained with Abu Bakr and after his death

Administration:

Hazrat Abu Bakr laid the foundation of a truly democratic state following the teachings of the Quran and the traditions of the Prophet (P.B.U.H).

- Abu Bakr conducted affairs of the Government by consultation. He used to **consult eminent companions** in all important matters.
- For the purpose of administration, Arabia was divided into **provinces each under a governor**, who was required to lead the prayers, superintended the army, collect taxes, administer justice, and maintain law and order. He was aided by an **Amil** who collected revenues and a **Qazi** who administered justice.
- There was no regular police department at that time, but whenever any crime came into his notice, he took strict action against in the light of Quran and the Hadith.
- Abu Bakr selected all his officers, commanders and governors on their **merit** and not because of family or tribal consideration.
- He set up a strict standard of accounting of public money. He also gave proper shape to the public treasury, the Bait-ul-Maal.
- He established **military cantonments** and maintained a reserve force. He dispatched **expeditionary forces** to Iran, Syria and Palestine. As a result, vast territories were added to Muslim Empire.
- He safeguarded and protected the **rights of non-Muslim** subjects who were granted religious and cultural freedom. They were allowed to manage their affairs themselves.
- By his efficient administration he preserved the integrity of Islam by suppressing rebellions and making sure that the Pillar of **zakat was enforced**.
- Hazrat Abu Bakr's caliphate was also significant for the preservation of the Quran.

Main events/ Achievements of Caliphate:

Abu Bakr was elected as the first caliph of the Islamic state after a meeting in **Saqifa Bani saida** and with the general bayyat of Muslims in Masjid e Nabwi in 11A.H/632A.D. He addressed the community and pledged that the state will be governed according to Islamic principles.

He continued Prophet's intention of sending expeditions to North and sent **Usama bin Zayd** to Syria in **632AD** despite all the opposition and threats. It shows that he was obedient to the Prophet's command and he continued the policy of the expansion of the Islamic state. Later another force under **Khalid bin Walid** advanced into Iraq and then turned west into Palestine to defeat the Byzantines at the **battle of Ajnadain 13 AH/634AD**. In this way Abu Bakr began Muslim advance into Syria and Iraq.

He fought against **tribes who withheld zakat and apostatized Islam**. At that time many hostile tribes such as **Banu Asad, Banu Ghatafan, Banu Murrah and Banu Abbas** sent their delegates to Madina and demanded that they should be exempted from the payment of Zakat. Abu Bakr remained firm and rejected their demand. These tribes attacked Madina in **632 AD** but eventually they were defeated and agreed to pay Zakat.

Under the influence of the false prophets many tribes renounced Islam. Abu Bakr collected the army in Madina and divided it into **eleven battalions** and sent them to different parts of Arabia in order to crush the apostasy movement. Within a year the control of Islam was reestablished.

After Prophet's death several false prophets arose in different parts of the Islamic state.

- Of these **Aswad al Ansi** from Ansi tribe, was first to rise in Yemen. He was killed during Prophet's lifetime. Later, his followers grouped and revolted under a man called **Qais bin Abd Yaghus**, but eventually they were defeated.
- **Tulayha** from the tribes of Banu Asad and Banu Ghatafan in Northern Arabia. In 630 AD he converted to Islam but shortly afterwards he rebelled and proclaimed himself as a prophet. Khalid bin Waleed defeated him at the battle of Buzaka in September 632 AD.
- **Sajjah** from Banu Tamim tribe in Iraq she claimed to be a prophetess and collected a force of 4,000 to march on Madina. Khalid bin Waleed crushed her forces. She then joined Musailma and after his death accepted Islam.
- And the most dangerous one **Musailma** from Banu Hanifa tribe in central Arabia. he was in command of an army of 40,000. In December 632 AD Abu Bakr first sent Ikrmah and Shurabil. when they were defeated then he sent Khalid bin Waleed with an army of 13,000 men . A hot contest followed in which Muslims were victorious. It came to be known as the battle of Garden of Death. This battle led to the compilation of Quran.

Hazrat Abu Bakr laid the foundation of a truly democratic state following the teachings of the Quran and the traditions of the Prophet (P.B.U.H).

Abu Bakr conducted affairs of the Government by consultation. He used to **consult eminent companions** in all important matters.

For the purpose of administration, Arabia was divided into **provinces each under a governor**, who was required to lead the prayers, superintended the army, collect taxes, administer justice, and maintain law and order. He was aided by an **Amil** who collected revenues and a **Qazi** who administered justice.

There was no regular police department at that time, but whenever any crime came into his notice, he took strict action against in the light of Quran and the Hadith.

Abu Bakr selected all his officers, commanders and governors on their **merit** and not because of family or tribal consideration.

He set up a strict standard of accounting of public money. He also gave proper shape to the public treasury, the Bait-ul-Maal.

He safeguarded and protected the **rights of non-Muslim** subjects who were granted religious and cultural freedom. They were allowed to manage their affairs themselves.

By his efficient administration he preserved the integrity of Islam by suppressing rebellions and making sure that the Pillar of **zakat was enforced**.

He arranged for a compilation of Quran at the suggestion of **Hazrat Umar** when many memorisers of Quran were martyred in **the battle of Yamama against Musailima** and appointed **Zaid bin Sabit** along with **20 to 25 scribes** to accomplish this task. First copy was named Mushaf by Abdullah bin Masood.

He died in 13 AH/634 AD.

► Questions from Past Papers

► O/N 2009

3. (a) Describe Abu Bakr's activities against the false prophets and apostate tribes. [10]

► O/N2011

3. (a) Describe the main events of the caliphate of Hazrat Abu Bakr. [10]

► O/N 2012

4. (a) Write about the election of Abu Bakr as caliph and how he dealt with the false prophets during his reign. [10]

► **M/J 2014**

3. (a) Write a detailed account of the four false prophets, and how the caliph Abu Bakr defeated them. [10]

► **O/N 2014**

3 (a) Write an account of the Battle of Yamama fought during the caliphate of Abu Bakr. [10]

► **M/J 2015**

5(a) Write about any two major events that took place during the caliphate of Abu Bakr. [10]

► **M/J 2016**

3. (a) Write a detailed account of the battle of Yamama, and of the compilation of the Qur'an during the caliphate of Abu Bakr. [10]

► **O/N 2017**

3(a) Write a detailed account about the election and administration of Abu Bakr. [10]

► **M/J 2018, O/N 2019**

3(a) Write a detailed account of Abu Bakr's achievements as Caliph. [10]

► **O/N 2018**

4(a). Write an account of the campaign led by Abu Bakr against the tribes refusing to pay Zakat. [10]

► **O/N2020**

3(a). Write an account of how Abu Bakr led the Islamic empire when he became the first caliph. [10]

► **M/J 2021(21)**

3(a) Write an account of the false prophet Musailimah and the battle fought against him in 632. [10]

► **M/J 2021(22)**

3(a) Give an account of the election of Abu Bakr and the expedition he sent to Syria soon after becoming caliph. [10]

Unseen Topics

3 (a) Trace the expansion of the Islamic empire under the rule of the caliph 'Abu Bakr. [10]

The Islamic state under Hazrat Abu Bakr was surrounded by the two great Empires. On its northeastern side was the Border of Persian Empire while the Northern part of the peninsula was bordered by the Byzantine Empire (the Eastern Roman Empire). It consisted of Syria, Palestine and Egypt.

The Persian Empire wanted to wipe out the Muslims who in turn felt endangered by the Persian threat. Hazrat Abu Bakr also wanted to spread Islam and so taking advantage of the unrest in Persia. Muslims made raids on various part of Persian Empire. **In 632 AD**, the Kindi tribe in Hadramount broke into revolt and refused to pay taxes. Hazrat Abu Bakr directed an army to Hadramount. The apostates were killed and others surrendered. In the same year the **Battle of Kazima** took place in **Eastern Iraq**. Hazrat Abu Bakr sent an army under **Khalid Bin Waleed**. Four other columns under different commanders also proceeded to reinforce the Muslim Army. Khalid Bin waleed invited **Hurmuz**, the Persian commander to accept islam, pay Jizya or engage

in combat. He agreed to fight and set out from Uballa to Kazima. The Persians were linked in chains and because of the heavy Muslim attack, they retreated. Due to the chains they were trapped and suffered defeat.

After the Battle of chains (Kazima), some other small Skirmishes took place to **Mazar, Walaja, Ullies, Anbar, and Enat-Tamar** in which the Muslims defeated the Persians one after the other. After these Conquest, Khalid Bin waleed conquered **Hira, Damat-Ul-Jandal and Firadalso**. After the fall of Hira, thae whole of South and most of North Iraq was conquered and the Persians subdued.

Byzantines began to conspire against the Muslims in co-operation of Bedouin tribes on the Syrian border. Hazrat Abu Bakr raised a big army and divided into four corps each comprising of **7000** men. They were given under command of **Amr Bin Aas, Yazeed Bin Abu Sufyan, Shurabil Bin Hasanah and Abu Ubaidah bin Jarrah**. The first encounter of Muslims took place at **Basra** in which Muslims were victorious. Then the **Battle of Ajnadein** took place. The byzantine Emperor, Heraclius sent an army of **250,000** men against the Muslims army of **forty thousands**. Again the Romans were badly defeated.

After this success, Muslims advanced towards **Damascus** and laid siege to it. In the meantime. Hazrat Abu Bakr fell ill and died in August **634 AD**. This campaign was left incomplete

Apostasy Wars:

Campaign in Bahrain:

During the lifetime of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) **Mundhir** the ruler of the Bahrain had accepted his invitation to Islam and converted under his influence most of the people of Bahrain also accepted Islam. Mundhir died soon after the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) and his death led to anarchy and chaos the people of Bahrain apostatized except for Jarud, the leader of Bahrain, from the tribe of Banu Abdul Qais , who remained firm in the allegiance to Islam and dissuaded his tribe from apostasy . However **Munhiz** a descendant of Arab kings of Hirah took over and pledged to fight against Islam.

Al-Hadrami the Muslim envoy to Bahrain left for Madina to seek help from Hazrat Abu Bakar and returned to Bahrain with Muslim force. He had a ditch dug around his camp and waited for a suitable opportunity to overpower the enemy. One night there was considerable noise from non-Muslim camp where they were celebrating their national festival and were heavily intoxicated. Al-Hadrami ordered his forces to take up arms and cross the ditch and pounce upon the enemy. The surprise attack unnerved the rebel who fell into disarray and were subdued by the pursuing Muslim forces. Munhiz's men laid down their arms and along people of the Bahrain were admitted into the fold of Islam.

Campaign in Oman, Marah and Hadramaut

In Oman a false Prophet **Laquit bin Malik** rose to prominence and capture political power. A Muslim force under Hudaifah was sent to Oman. In battle of Daba, Laquit and ten thousand of his followers were killed. The Oman forces surrendered and people of Oman joined the fold of Islam.

In Mahrah the people had apostatised but instead of fighting against Muslims they fought among themselves for political power. The Muslim allied with minority and fought against the majority who were subsequently defeated. The people of Mahrah repented and were reconverted to Islam

In Hudramaut there was revolt led by the tribe of Ash'as. When Muslims forced defeated them. They retreated to the fortified city of Nujair. The Muslim army laid siege to the city which was finally captured in February 633.

Persians

The Battle of Chains:

khalid ibn al-Waleed was ordered by Hazrat Abu Bakar to proceed to the Persian border and four more battalions were sent to reinforce the Muslim army. Upon reaching the border Khalid sent a letter to Hurmuz the Persian commander giving him three options: accept Islam, pay jizya, or be prepared for war. Hurmuz an ambitious and confident commander accepted the third option and collected his forces to meet Muslim army at Kazima. Upon arrival the Persian army had to immediately engage in battle as Muslim army was already there, prepared to face Persians. The Persian soldiers are linked with chains to encourage them to fight with unity and to prevent any soldier from retreating this was what gave battle its name. However the chains had one drawback; in case of defeat the men could not retreat as chain acted as fetters. The Muslim attack was ferocious and Persian were left with no choice but to retreat. Here their chains became a death trap for them. Tabari also

writes about the chains restricting the Persian escape for whom this battle was humiliating defeat. Hurmuz along with thousands of his soldiers was killed and the Muslims took many others as prisoners of war.

Following on from the battle of chains the Muslims forces defeated the Persians at Mazar, Walaja and Ulleis. After the victory at Ulleis the Muslim army advanced to Hira where upon hearing of Khalid and his army, the governor with his men abandoned the city and fled to Madina. With Hira under Muslim control the whole of Central Iraq came under the rule of Caliphate.

Khalid Ibn al-Waleed now turned to Anbar, an important commercial center in Western Iraq. Walls and deep ditch protected the city. Khalid chose a narrow point to cross the ditch and then went on to slaughter the old and weak camels of the army and filled with the ditch with their carcasses. Muslim army crossed over the pile of carcasses and attacked Anbar, whose governor surrendered on the condition that the Muslim would allow them to withdraw in safety. After Anbar, another fortified town, Enat-ul-Tamar was taken by the Muslim after a few days siege and the region came under Muslim rule.

Byzantines

Fall of Bostra

Hazrat Abu Bakr in February 634, called for a jihad to confront the Byzantines who were conspiring against the Muslims with the Bedouin tribes on the Syrian border. A large army assembled in Madina response to Caliph Call. Hazrat Abu Bakr divided the army into four units each consisting of 7000 men under Amr ibn al-Aas, Yazid ibn Abu Sufyan, Shurahbil ibn al-Hasanah and Abu Ubaydah ibn al-Jarrah. These army fought successfully but when Heraclius came to know of his conflict he despatched a large force under the command of his brother Theodorous. When Hazrat Abu Bakr heard of his development he asked Khalid ibn al-Waleed who was then at Iraq border to join and lead the Syrian campaign Khalid marched from Hira with 9000 of his best men and reached Syrian in 18 days a swift march in those time across an unrelenting desert terrain. Instead of advancing to Damascus Khalid met the Muslim army under Shurahbil's command at Basra and sent word to Abu Ubaydah to join him there. When the Muslim army met the Byzantines Khalid invited his commander Romanus to fold of Islam; after discussing and understanding the different aspects of the faith Romanus accepted Islam. After this turn of events, the Byzantine army lost courage they withdraw into city and locked the gates. Romanus then guided the Muslims into the city through underground passage in the darkness of night. The Byzantine were killed in large number and the surviving ones surrendered. The Battle of Basra was the first and most significant victory of the Muslims in Syria.

Battle of Ajnadayn

The Byzantine Emperor Heraclius in reaction to the defeat of Basra mobilised a huge force against Muslims in Ajnadayn. Khalid ibn al-Waleed also ordered all the Muslim armies to assembled at Ajnadayn. The 40,000 strong Muslim drove wedges in the Byzantine army once the fighting started; their commander was killed and Byzantine army retreated from the battlefield. The Muslim pursued the fleeing army and killed a large number of them.

After their success in Ajnadayn, the Muslim army marched towards Damascus and were met by Byzantine forces a few miles away. The Muslims were once again victorious and the remaining Byzantine force fled back into city. The Muslim army laid siege to Damascus but did not proceed further as they received the sad news of Hazrat Abu Bakr passing away. Damascus was finally conquered during the Caliphate of Hazrat Umar the second Caliph.

3.(b) The Prophet called Abu Bakr 'al-Siddiq' (Testifier of the Truth). How did Abu Bakr live up to his title during his caliphate? [4]

- During his caliphate, Abu Bakr fought to uphold the finality of the Prophet (pbuh) in the wars against the false prophets;
- he refused to give in to the demands of those who wanted to be exempted from paying zakat and fought battles with them, and
- he preserved the word of God by having the Qur'an compiled.
- Abu Bakr always stood by the truth and fought to maintain it, by which he lived up to the title of 'al-Siddiq' (Testifier of the Truth) which the Prophet (pbuh) had given him when he was the first to believe the Prophet's (pbuh) account of mi'raj

(b). Why did Abu Bakr think it of great importance to defeat the false prophets? [4]

If the false prophets were not defeated by Abu Bakr, the teachings of Islam could have been corrupted; the purity of the religion would have been lost and many who called themselves Muslims in reality would be following a man made faith. The first pillar of Islam would have been challenged as the second part of the Shahada which deals with risala (prophethood) and finality of the Prophet Muhammad would be contradicted if one believed in the so called prophets after Muhammad so the existence of the false prophets was a great threat to survival of Islam. The apostasy wars confirmed that the Muslim state was one under the leadership of one Caliph.

(b). Why is Abu Bakr called the Saviour of Islam? [4]

He was called the Saviour of Islam because he fought to prevent the break-up of Islam. The false prophets and apostates threatened the uniqueness and unity of Islam and could not be allowed to continue their activities. Hence when he became Caliph he not only gave new heart to the Muslims after the Prophet (P.B.U.H) passed away but helped the community of Muslims against its many enemies. In his short term as caliph he defeated the tribes who withdrew from Islam and made them stay Muslim and he fought and won against tribes who refused to pay Zakat. He also defeated the false prophets and thus kept the unity of Islam when there was much danger. His arrangements for the first compilation of Quran for the guidance of future generations also make him the saviour of Islam.

3(b) What was the importance of this battle to future generations of Muslims?[4]

- Battle of Yamama marked the end of the false prophets and Abu Bakr could now establish the Islamic empire on a firm footing.
- Musailimah was changing the key principles of Islam and with this battle the core teachings of Islam were saved from being altered and corrupted.
- The first pillar of Islam would have been challenged as the second part of the Shahada which deals with risala (prophethood) and finality of the Prophet Muhammad would be contradicted if one believed in the so called prophets after Muhammad so the existence of the false prophets was a great threat to survival of Islam.
- Post-Yamama the Muslims were united as one and could go on to deal with other forces that were against Islam.
- The battle also led to the compilation of the Qur'an.

Hazrat Umar's (R.A) caliphate

Main Events/Summary of Caliphate:

O/N 2011

3 (a) Briefly describe the main events of the caliphate of Hazrat 'Umar . [10]

Hazrat Umar ibn al-Khattab succeeded to the caliphate in **13 AH/634 AD**. As well as the title 'Successor of the Messenger of Allah.' He also took the title of 'Commander of the faithful', '**Ameer al Mu'mineen**'. He continued the expansion of Islam begun by the Prophet (pbuh) and Hazrat Abu Bakr and under his rule, Muslim army gained control in Syria, Iraq, Persia and Egypt. A series of decisive battles brought these vast areas under Islamic rule. In the Northeast, **Persian Empire** caused threat for the Islamic state. In **October 634 A.D/14 A.H** the battles of **Namaraq and Jasn** were fought. In the battle of Jasn (Bridge) Muslims were defeated and their commander was killed. Muslims responded back in **November 634 A.D**. When they fought against the Persians at **Buwaib** under **Musanna**, Muslims were victorious in this battle and the Persians had to face heavy losses.

After this battle, Persians sent a large army. After a prolonged battle at **Al Qadisiya** in **15 AH/636 AD** the out-numbered Muslim army defeated the Persian. Muslim army advanced and captured **Mada'in and Jalulah** one after another and signed a Treaty of peace with the Persians. Despite the treaty, the Persians continued their conspiracies against Islamic state. Therefore, Muslims had to fight against them **at Nihawand** in **21 A.H./ 642 A.D**. It was the last battle against the Persians which sealed the fate of Persian Empire and the whole of Persia came under Muslim rule.

Muslims also had to fight against the **Byzantines** on the Northern borders because of their hostility against the Islamic state. The Muslim commanders i.e. **Khalid bin Waleed, Amr bin al Aas and Abu Ubaidah bin al Jarrah** defeated the Romans and captured areas of Byzantine empire, which was the Eastern province of Roman empire. Muslim army laid siege to Damascus till **635AD** and then they had to fight against them in **the battle of Fihl** which resulted in the conquest of Jordan. Then Muslims advanced and fought in the battle of **Yarmuk in Palestine** in **15 A.H/636 A.D**. In October **636 AD** Muslims recaptured Damascus under Abu Ubaidah bin al Jarrah.

Meanwhile, Amr bin Aas laid **siege to Jerusalem**, Christians offered to surrender on the condition that the Caliph himself should come to Jerusalem. This was accepted and Hazrat Umar signed an agreement that guaranteed safety and security of the people of Jerusalem. Finally, Muslim army advanced under Amr bin Aas and laid a siege and after the battle of Alexandria captured **Egypt** in **18 A.H. /639 A.D**.

Hazrat Umar introduced many administrative reforms during his caliphate. He established a Majlis-e-Shura consisting of prominent companions of the Holy Prophet. He also constituted a large body called the Majlis-e-Aam consisting of Muhajirin and Ansar and representatives of various tribes. The state was divided into provinces and each province was placed under an efficient governor called the Wali or the Ameer. The Wali was not only the ruler of the province but also the military and religious head. Hazrat Umar entrusted the Qazis with judicial functions. The Qazi was completely independent of the provincial governor. He also established a department of finance under the name of Dewan. He made garrison towns in Basra and Kufa for his soldiers. Pension was given to the retired soldiers. For implementation of Quranic teachings special steps were taken such as regulation of Salat and fasting. He also started the Islamic Hijri calendar.

Administration

M/J 2011

3 (a) Write a detailed account of the administrative measures put in place by 'Umar during his caliphate. [10]

M/J 2015

3 (a) “Umar’s caliphate is regarded as a golden era in Islamic history.’ Write an account of how ‘Umar ruled during his ten year caliphate. [10]

M/J 2017

3(a) ‘Umar made several administrative reforms during his ten year caliphate. Write an account of at least five of them and say how these reforms helped make his rule so admirable. [10]

Answer (Learn and write):

Hazrat Umar not only conquered a vast empire during the ten year of his Khilafat but also consolidated it by an effective system of administration. As an administrator, he remained a model for all rulers who followed him and his administrative reforms make his caliphate a golden period of early Islamic history. Despite being the ruler of a mighty empire he lived a very simple life. Once he said about his salary from Bait ul Maal, **“Nothing in Halal for me and for my family from Allah’s money except a dress for summer and a dress for winter and a salary equal to the income of an average Quraishi. I am no more than an ordinary Muslim amongst you.”**

- Hazrat Umar framed the constitution of the state on the basis of democracy. He established the **Majlis e Shura** consisting of prominent companions of the holy Prophet from both Muhajirin and Ansars. Hazrat Umar consulted this body in all matters. He also constituted a larger body called the **Majlis –e- Aam**, consisting of Muhajirin and Ansar and representatives of various tribes. This was called into session on special occasions.
- **Judiciary** was established under the **Qazi**. He separated executive from judiciary. In this way he assured the citizens swift and impartial justice. The judiciary was made completely independent and impartial. He was displeased when a judge showed some respect to him when he appeared in his court as a defendant.
- He took steps to give the Islamic State a **clean and efficient administration**. The State was divided into Provinces and each province was placed under an efficient **Governor called the Wali or Ameer**. The wali was not only the ruler of the province but also the military and religious head. The provinces were further divided into **districts and placed under Amils**.
- The **bait ul maal** was created under Amils. After meeting the expenditure of the State, the surplus money used to be distributed among the Muslims based on three principles: relationship with the holy Prophet; priority of conversion to Islam and military services to Islam. In this way, all Muslim men, women, slaves and children had share in the bait- ul- Maal or the public treasury. He made the government finances save from misuse and kept corruption out of government.
- **All appointments were made in consultations with the Majlis e Shura**. The appointee was given a regular order of appointment setting out his duties and emoluments. The person appointed to a high post was required to give a written undertaking to lead a simple Islamic life. He had to submit particulars of his property and assets, so that on his retirement, it may be seen whether he had amassed wealth by illegal means. Hazrat Umar kept a very strict watch on the activities of his officers. He used to receive **secret reports from officers** specially appointed for this purpose.
- Hazrat Umar set up a **department of finance the Diwan**, which was in charge of the revenue of the centre and the provinces. The function of the Diwan was to regulate the receipt and disbursement of the caliphate’s revenues which were generated from jizya, zakat, kharaj (tax levied on the land of non-Muslims) and fay (income from crown lands). A tax called ushr was also levied on the produce of land. It is said that there was so much economic prosperity during the caliphate of Hazrat Umar that there was hardly any citizen in need of zakat .

- Umar established **new towns like Basra, Musal and Kufa**. He made new highways, roads and out posts on the roads. The conquered lands were surveyed. Umar made special effort for construction of Mosques and schools. Teachers were sent to the villages to teach the Holy Quran to the villagers.
- He introduced **the Muslim era of Hijra**, the system of **old age pension** and **census of the population** of the Muslims State. Thus he laid foundation for the development of modern cities.
- Hazrat Umar maintained a **well-disciplined army** which was divided into cavalry and infantry. He was particularly concerned about welfare of his soldiers. He also forbade them to live with the settled people in cities and ordered them to live in cantonments. They kept the armed forces content and happy and they were happy to serve the caliphate.
- Umar paid special attention to the **well-being of Dhimmis**(minorities), and settled their matters in consultation with their representative. He expelled Christians and Jews communities of Najran and Khayber, when they refused to abide by his order..

Hazrat Umar stands unparalleled in every aspects of administration in the History of Islam.

Expansion of Islamic State

M/J 2009

3. (a) Trace the expansion of the Islamic empire under the rule of the caliph 'Umar. [10]

Answer(Learn and write):

Hazrat Umar bin Khattab succeeded to caliphate in **13 A.H. / 634 A.D.** He took the title of "**Amir Ul Momineen**" (Commander of the faithful). He was a brave and straightforward person. He continued the expansion of the Islamic state and during his caliphate the frontiers of Islamic state expanded greatly. The vast Ares of the Roman and Persian empires were brought under Islamic rule. Muslim armies conquered Syria, Iraq, Persia and Egypt after fighting a series of decisive battles.

In the Northeast, **Persian Empire** caused threat for the Islamic state. In **October 634 A.D/14 A.H** the battles of **Namaraq and Jasr** were fought. In the battle of Jasr (Bridge) Muslims were defeated and their commander was killed. Muslims responded back in **November 634 A.D.** When they fought against the Persians at **Buwaib** under **Musanna**, Muslims were victorious in this battle and the Persians had to face heavy losses.

After this battle, Persians sent a large army of **60,000** under their famous commander Rustam. The report of the new situation was sent to Hazrat Umar. He sent **Saad bin Abi Waqas** with an army of **30000**. After a prolonged battle at **Al Qadisiya in 15 AH/636 AD** the out-numbered Muslim army defeated the Persian troops under **Rustam** and recaptured Hira and other areas in Iraq. It was a decisive battle which broke down the strength of the Persians. After this the Muslim army advanced and captured **Mada'in and Jalulah** one after another and signed a Treaty of peace with the Persians. Despite the treaty, the Persians continued their conspiracies against Islamic state. Therefore, Muslims had to fight against them at **Nihawand in 21 A.H./ 642 A.D.** a battle took place in which **30,000 Muslims** defeated **60,000 Persians**. The Persian king Yazdgard fled from the battle field. It was the last battle against the Persians which sealed the fate of Persian Empire and the whole of Persia came under Muslim rule.

Muslims also had to fight against the **Byzantines** on the Northern borders because of their hostility against the Islamic state. The Muslim commanders i.e **Khalid bin Waleed, Amr bin al Aas and Abu Ubaidah bin al Jarrah** defeated the Romans and captured areas of Byzantine empire, which was the Eastern province of Roman empire. Muslim army laid siege to Damascus till **635AD** and then they had to fight against them in the battle of Fihl which resulted in the conquest of Jordan. Then Muslims advanced and fought in the battle of **Yarmuk in Palestine in 15 A.H/636 A.D.** An army of **40,000** Muslims defeated **2,60,000** Byzantines after a battle which lasted for **6 days**. As a

result of this battle, Muslims conquered Syria. In October **636 AD** Muslims recaptured Damascus under Abu Ubaidah bin al Jarrah.

Meanwhile, Amr bin Aas laid **siege to Jerusalem** and later Khalid bin Waleed also joined him. The Christian Patriarch **Sophronious** offered to surrender on the condition that the Caliph himself should come to Jerusalem. This was accepted and Hazrat Umar signed an agreement that guaranteed safety and security of the people of Jerusalem. Finally, Muslim army advanced under Amr bin Aas and laid a siege and after the battle of Alexandria captured **Egypt in 18 A.H. /639 A.D.**

Wars against Persians:

M/J 2016

3 (a) *The conquest of Persia was one of 'Umar's great achievements. Write an account of **any two** battles fought with the Persians during his caliphate. [10]*

Answer(Learn and write):

1. Battle of Namarraq:

During the Khilafat of Hazrat Abu Bakr, Muslims under Musanna and Khalid bin Walid conquered the kingdom of Hira. The Persians became furious and tried to recover it from the Muslims. The Persian King sent Rustam, a famous general, to fight the Muslims. Khalid bin Walid had already left for Syria and so Musana was left alone on the Persian front. Hazrat Umar sent an army under Abu Ubaid to reinforce the army of Musana. A battle was fought at Namarraq in which the Persians were defeated.

2. Battle of Jasr(Bridge):

After the defeat of the Persians in the battle of Namarraq, they again met the Muslims under the command of Bahman (634 AD). The Euphrates lay between the two armies. Against the advice of the Muslim leaders, their commander Abu Ubaid Thaqafi, decided to fight across the river.

A bridge of boats was built across the river and the Muslims crossed it. After crossing the river, Abu Ubaid ordered that the bridge should be broken so that Muslim soldiers would not think of retreating. But then, they found themselves at a disadvantage. The ground was uneven and the army could not move freely. A thick wall of war elephants shielded the Persians. The Arab horses, which had never seen the war elephants before were terrified and this led to confusion and the Muslims cavalry, got disorganized.

In the scuffle that followed, a white elephant knocked down Abu Ubaid and trampled him. One after another, the Muslim commanders were martyred. This made the Muslim army lose heart and they rushed for the bridge but the bridge had already been broken .

Musanna, who was now that the commander of the Muslim army ordered the re-building of the bridge. In the meantime, he held back the enemy with a small force asking others to cross the river. He himself was the last to cross. The Muslims suffered heavy losses. Out of a total strength of nine thousand, only three thousand could be saved. This Battle is also known as the **Battle of Bridge**.

3. Battle of Buwaib:

After the disaster at Jasr, Hazrat Umar sent messengers to all parts of Arabia inviting the Arabs to participate in war against Persians. In response this call many Muslims and Christians gathered round the standard of Islam. The Persians sent a strong force 200000 against the Muslims under the command of Mehran, who was regarded as an expert in the Arabian way of War. The Persian Army marched to Euphrates and camped on the east bank of the Euphrates River. Mehran sent a messenger to Musanna to inquire if the Muslim would like the Persians to cross

over to their side. The Muslims had a bitter experience of crossing the river in the Battle of Bridge. So they asked the Persians army to cross river. The following day, the Persians army crossed over and the two armies met at Buwaib. The Persians were several times more in numbers, but the Muslims fought desperately. A young warrior of Taghlib tribe killed Mehran. With his death, the tide of the battle was turned and the Persians began to flee in disorder. Musana, at once, captured the Bridge this prevented the Persians from crossing the river. Finding no other way to flee thousands of them were drowned while other died in large number on the battlefield. In this battle the majority of the Persians army was destroyed.

4. Battle of Qadisiya:

Following the humiliating defeat at Buwayb the Persians once again prepared for battle against the Muslims. Hazrat Umar in response organised a force of about 30000 and choose Saad bin Abi Waqas a veteran from Badr to lead them. The Muslims army camped at Qadisiya a little town among the palm groves on the very edge of the settled lands of Iraq. A contingent which had been called by the caliph from the Syrian front also reinforced the Muslim army and in 636 the battle of Qadisiya was fought between the Muslims and the Persians.

Despite its enormous importance very little is known of the course of this battle. Arab accounts begin with the recruitment and dispatch of the army from Madina, after whose arrival on the borders of Iraq a delegation of Muslim elders was sent to Yazdegird the Persian emperor inviting him to accept Islam ,pay jizya or to arbitrate for war. The arrogant emperor was contemptuous of the Arabs while the Muslim delegation remained patient and courteous but to no effect. A stand-off lasting **3 months** took place with skirmishes against border settlements in which the Muslims were successful and during which time there were desertions and defections from the Persian side. As a result of which Muslim army got increased to 30000 whereas the Persians lost their strength which came down 60000 from 120000. Finally, Rustam attacked the Muslims by crossing the river. Saad bin Abi waqas employed best strategies making the best use of his archers to overcome elephant corps and using his force to break the Persians. The battle lasted for three days, on the third and final day of this battle, the Persians decided to attack the Muslims early in the morning and to get a decisive victory. But Muslims were ready to fight back and the Persian forces started to flee from the battlefield. Rustam was caught and killed while trying to swim to safety and the Persians were routed. Sa'ad chased them **to Babal** where they sought refuge and then after a 2 month campaign Muslims captured **Mada'in** the Persian capital. The emperor and his family and nobles fled. **Two thirds** of the Persian army was killed and the Muslims lost a fifth of their men in this battle.

This was a decisive battle in the history of Islam, it shattered the strength of the Persian Empire and many people of the conquered areas accepted Islam. Following this victory the **whole territory between the Euphrates and the Tigris came under the Muslims.**

5. Battle of Jalula

The Persian King took refuge in Hulwan and asked his forces to advance. Then occupied Jalula near Mada'in. They did great preparation and converted the town into a fortress by digging trench around it. Muslims laid the siege which lasted for seven months. Finally, they had no option but to come out and fight. The fighting continued fiercely but late in afternoon Allah helped Muslims with a severe storm, Persian resistance broke down, and they dispersed in all directions. Muslims pursued and killed them in large numbers. They occupied Jalula and the residents surrendered on the usual terms of Jizya.

6. Battle of Nihawand

Between the years 638-639 Arabia was struck with a great famine and plague but the expansion of the Islamic territories continued. On the other hand the Persian ruler Yazdegird's people to incite rebellion against the Muslims and skirmishes ensued. When Hazrat Umar heard that Yazdgar was determined to recover his control of the rich

plains of Mesopotamia (Iraq) and was trying to rally support and muster troops at the city of Nihawand he sent letters to Kufa and Basra ordering that the armies should be assembled.

The Muslim armies subsequently gathered and marched on to Nihawand. One force was ordered to station itself on the borders between the provinces of Fars and Isfahan to prevent the Persians sending reinforcement from the south. The Muslim army of **30000** was much smaller than the Persian force of 60000.

The Muslim army on reaching Nihawand found the Persian army drawn up on the near side of a ravine which was later to prove fatal to many of them. They had also fortified themselves behind trenches. The Muslims tried to storm them out but without success and the disciplined Persian emerged from their fortified positions only when it suited them. After a few days, the Muslim leader met in a council of war to decide a better course of action. It was decided that the cavalry would advance and pretend to attack the trenches and then withdraw to lure the Persian from their positions. However, their commander Nouman ibn Muqarrin kept the main Muslim army in check until the day was almost over. They finally attacked the enemy, victory came quickly.

The Persians began to flee and surrender of the towns soon followed the military victory. The victory at Nihawand came to be known as fath al Futuh the victory of victories.

M/J 2013

5 (a) Give an account of the following two battles during the rule of 'Umar [10]

- Battle of Qadisiya;
- Battle of Yarmuk.

M/J 2018

3(a) Write a detailed account of two battles under the caliphate of 'Umar. [10]

Wars against Romans:

1. Siege of Damascus

Hazrat Khalid bin Waleed had laid siege to Damascus a few days before Abu Bakr's death. During Umar's Caliphate he added Damascus, Jordan and Emessa one after the other to the Muslim Empire. Damascus was known for its wealth and culture. Syrians were hoping reinforcements from Heraclius but it did not happen, instead the Muslims swam across the moat and using rope ladders scaled the walls. When Syrian panicked and threw open the gates to escape, the remaining Muslim force rushed in and occupied the city.

2. Battle of the Fihl

Battle of the Fihl 635 AD resulted in the addition province of Jordan in the Islamic Empire. The site was on the western side of Lake Tiberias where the water channel separated the Muslims from the Christians, who were waiting for reinforcements and offered negotiations hoping the Muslims would back down.

Abu Ubaidah sent Muadh ibn Jabal as his emissary. The Christians tried to impress the Muslims with their pomp and ceremony, but Muadh was not deflected. He offered the Christians an invitation to Islam or else to become dhimmis by paying Jizya, or else to settle the matter through war.

These measures being fruitless, the Roman attacked the Muslims in small groups. Khalid saw through this tactic and gradually retreated drawing the enemy forces further in; he then surrounded them and launched a furious attack. The Roman suffered heavy casualties and those who survived scattered and fled. Thus Jordan was secured and Hazrat Umar sent specific instruction on how to deal with the conquered people and their land.

3. Battle of Yarmuk:

Fought in the summer of 636 the battle of Yarmuk was a major conflict between the Byzantines and the Muslims. When the reports of the fall of Damascus, and defeat at Fihl and Hims were given to Heraclius he was determined

to recover Palestine for Christian rule. He issued orders to mobilize troops from all corners of his empire and it is believed that the Roman emperor sent an army of **260,000** men against the Muslims who were **40000**.

Khalid ibn al-Walid began to group his forces along the River Yarmuk. Hazrat Umar was in contact with the commanders and he sent them the message of advice and encouragement. Negotiations between the two armies were held in which the Romans tried to convince the Muslims and even offered Muslims large amounts of money if they left Syria and returned to Arabia. Khalid responded with reasons and declined the Roman's offer. He elaborated on the positive changes that Islam had brought about in the Arabs and invited the Romans to accept Islam or else to get protection by payment of Jizya. But when he was met with a refusal he returned to prepare his Army for the inevitable conflict.

Khalid bin Waleed addressed his men urging them to stick together and fight in union. Major battle was fought towards the end of **August 636AD** when the Muslims pretending to retreat from their positions lured the Byzantines into the rough terrain, where they were ambushed. During the battle **the Byzantines cavalry became separated from the infantry** enabling the Muslim cavalry to inflict great damage on them. Khalid had divided his cavalry into small squadrons to make them appear numerous to the enemy. The Byzantines were also unsettled by **a dust storm**. Their main army now driven west was trapped in rugged valleys with the cliffs of the Yarmuk gorge behind them. Khalid captured the old Roman bridge across the valley of Ruqqad and Muslims forces stormed the Byzantines camp at **Yaqusa**. The Byzantines were further demoralized by rumors that Christian Arabs had defected to the Muslim side.

The war strategies of the Muslim commanders paid off and **the battle lasted 6 days**. By the afternoon of the 6th day only **one third** of the Byzantine army remained, the rest had either been killed or had fled. **The Muslim loss of life was 9000** men.

The battle of Yarmuk was a great victory for the Muslims. The power of Byzantine was completely crushed and Syria fell in the hands of the Muslims. Heraclius moved his capital to Constantinople. The city of Jerusalem, which was besieged by **Amr ibn al Aa's** since the Yarmuk conflict and had withstood surrender, with the arrival of **Abu 'Ubaydah** realised the futility of their position and agreed to surrender but only to the caliph.

4. Siege and Conquest of Jerusalem, 637

Though the Muslims had been successful in securing all of Syria, the city of Jerusalem, besieged by Amr ibn al Aas since the Yarmuk conflict, had withstood surrender. It was only when Amr's army was reinforced by Abu 'Ubaydah and Khalid's forces, that the inhabitants of Jerusalem realized the futility of their position and agreed to a surrender, but on the condition that the Caliph would himself come to sign the treaty.

Jerusalem was one city whose conquest was more symbolic than of military importance and hence Hazrat Umar agreed to personally be present at the surrender of Jerusalem in 637. To make this journey he set off with one slave and a camel between them. When the Patriarch Sophronius, an Arab Christian who had risen to become one of the leading figures of the Greek Church in Jerusalem, witnessed the simplicity and humility of the Caliph he is reported to have said: 'Verily Islam has exceeded all the religions.'

The terms of the treaty signed with the leaders of Jerusalem were similar to others put in place throughout Syria. What was unique about the Muslim conquest of Jerusalem was that the new governors allowed Jews, who were banned from the city of the Byzantines, to come here to worship for the first time in over 500 years. The Qur'an holds Christian and Jewish religious in special esteem calling Jews and Christians, "The people of the book (Ahl-ul-Kitab)." While acknowledging the right of Christians and Jews in Jerusalem, Hazrat Umar ^{RA} was keen to send the message that this city also belonged to the Muslims. Jerusalem was the city to which the holy Prophet ^{pbuh} had travelled from Makkah during M'airaj, and where he led the prophets of the past in prayer, before ascending to heaven. There could be no minimizing the importance of Jerusalem in the Islamic tradition, and within mind Hazrat umer^{RA} set about the cleaning the Temple Mount, erected the first version of the al-Aqsa mosque, the third holiest site in Islam.

A deputation from Jerusalem waited on Hazrat Umar and a treaty was drawn up. According to the treaty, security of life and property were granted to all citizens of Jerusalem. The safety of churches and other religious buildings was provided for. The citizens were required to pay Jizya. Those who refused to comply were asked to leave the city.

Then the Caliph expressed his desire to be led to some place where he could offer thanksgiving prayer. He was led to a church. He refused to pray there on the ground that he would set an example for the Muslims of the following generation to forcibly convert churches into mosques. He was then led to a place where Prophet David used to pray.

5. Conquest of Egypt

Hazrat Amr ibn Aas realized the strategic importance of this region and asked the Caliph for the permission of an expedition who made him in charge of 4000 men. Amr approached the massive and well defended fort at Fustat. He requested for reinforcements and Umar sent them with four commanders. Amr handed over the operation to Zubair who captured the fort after a seven month long siege. This fort later became the garrison town of Fustat.

After Fustat, Amr laid the siege to Alexandria. There were 50000 Christian forces and Muslims were 12000. The siege lasted for a long time. Umar wrote a strong worded letter, expressing his displeasure on the pace of events. In the meantime Heraclius, the Byzantine Emperor died. The Muslims then intensified the attacks. After the battle, Alexandria was conquered and Muslims became the masters of Egypt.

3.(b) How does 'Umar's conduct at the surrender of Jerusalem set an example for Muslims? [4]

Hazrat Umar's conduct at the time of the surrender of Jerusalem sets an example for today's Muslims. He entered Jerusalem accompanied by just one servant and a camel between them which they rode in turns which shows the importance of the kind treatment of our servants and subordinates. He signed a treaty according to which the inhabitants of Jerusalem were granted complete security of their life and property. It emphasizes on people's freedom to practice their own religion and the protection given to their places of worship. The Quran says, **"Let there be no compulsion in religion."** His conduct therefore sets an example of simplicity, humility, a respect for all faiths and tolerance.

4.(b) 'Umar's unbending attitude led to his assassination'. What can Muslims learn from this? [4]

3(b) In your opinion what lesson(s) can be learnt from the martyrdom of 'Umar? [4]

Hazrat 'Umar went about conducting the affairs of the caliphate even though there was a threat to his life, he did not increase the security around him, nor did he succumb to the demands of Abu Lulu who threatened his life for not relieving him from paying a tax.

Muslims today should learn from Hazrat 'Umar's action and have complete faith in Allah and believe that only He is the giver and taker of life.

Leaders sometimes have to take unpopular decisions which could cause them difficulty but they must never opt to take the easy option rather they should do what is right; they must not shy away from their responsibilities for the sake of personal safety etc. They must not give in to unjust demands of people and work honestly at whatever they do.

3.(b) What does the way he died tell us about his character? [4]

Hazrat Umar bin al-Khattab was killed by a Persian slave Abu Lulu al-Feroz in 23AH/644AD when he was leading the morning Prayer. The reason was that Hazrat Umar refused to exempt him from the payment of a tax. This shows Hazrat Umar characteristics of total impartiality and his refusal to give concession even to those who were close to him. He was very firm about the correct observances of all regulations and never gave preferential treatment to anyone for example when his own son was found guilty of drinking wine, he punished him with 80 lashes. He was buried next to the Prophet (P.B.U.H) which shows that he was held in high esteem.

Hazrat Usman's (R.A) caliphate

Election as Caliph:

On his death bed, Hazrat Umar nominated a committee of six persons (Shura) to hold consultation and select his successor from among themselves within three days then their choice was to be confirmed through bay'a by the Muslim population.

(1) Hazrat Ali (2) Hazrat Usman (3) Zubair ibn awwam (4) Abdur Rehman bin Auf (5) Talha (6) Sa'ad bin Abi Waqas

All these persons were among the most eminent companions of Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H), whom he had given tidings of paradise in their lifetimes.

Despite long meetings the panel could not arrive at a decision, Abdur Rahman then withdrew his name and it was decided that he would make the final decision regarding the selection. Of the remaining nominees, Talha was not present at Madinah: therefore, the choice was now restricted to the remaining four members.

Abdur Rehman bin Auf consulted each one individually to get their opinion. **Sa'ad supported Hazrat Usman. While Zubair mentioned both Hazrat Usman and Hazrat Ali, Hazrat Usman voted for Hazrat Ali and Hazrat Ali voted for Hazrat Usman.** He also asked from both Usman and Ali that if elected, they would follow the Quran and Sunnah and the example of the first two caliphs. Hazrat Usman agreed to this whereas Hazrat Ali said that he would follow the Quran and Sunnah but not the first two caliphs.

Abdur Rehman asked the opinion of other prominent men as well and arrived at the conclusion that the majority of the people favoured the succession of Hazrat Usman and, thus, he was declared as the elected Khalifa. Abdur Rehman bin Auf was the first to take the Bayyat or Pledge and he was followed by Hazrat Ali and other companions and then there was a general Bayyat in Prophet's mosque. Hazrat Usman became the third Khalifa of Islam on the **4th Muharram 24 A.H/644AD**. He took the title of "**Khalifat Allah**" i.e vicegerent of Allah.

Military campaigns (Expansion of Islamic state)

During his twelve year caliphate 'Uthman, to begin with followed, in the footsteps of the first two caliphs. He did a lot for the consolidation and establishment of the military on firm grounds and went on to expand on the territory that was left to him by Umar by conquering North Africa, Barqa and Marakish completely and adjacent countries of Persia namely Afghanistan and Khurasan. Armenia and Azerbaijan also came under Muslim control and with the advancement in naval warfare. He even conquered Cyprus.

As soon as the news of Hazrat Umar's death spread, spontaneous revolts sprung up, as the conquered nations within the Muslim Empire saw his death as an opportunity to recover their lost independence.

Persian Empire:

Persia was effected by local rebellions so that from **644 to 649** the two great Muslim armies at **Kufa** and **Basra** were fighting in a series of internal campaigns.

The more distant areas in the mountain territories of **Armenia, Azerbaijan** and the Caucasus quickly repossessed their dominion. They fought off the determined counter attacks of the Muslim forces destroying at least two of their armies. Five years of campaign and counter-campaign at last re-established Muslims authority in the Persian Empire.

By 650, the Muslim armies were once more on the offensive and had pushed the frontier into Central Asia with ancient cities of **Herat, Merv, Balkh and Kabul** occupied by Muslim outposts. Two years later, Yazdegird the heir of the Persians was killed.

Byzantine (Roman) Empire

In the first year of Hazrat Usman caliphate Egypt also flared up in revolt supported by a bold counter-attack by the Byzantine Empire which dispatched a fleet of 300 ships into Alexandria's great harbour. The Greek-speaking population of the city rose in support and massacred 1000 soldiers of the Muslim garrison. Hazrat Usman had replaced **Amr ibn Aas** with his cousin **Abdullah bin Saad** as the governor of Alexandria however, he was unable to bring the situation under control.

Hazrat Usman then reinstated **Amr ibn Aas**, who once again able to enter Alexandria as a conqueror in **646**. After this victory the governorship of Alexandria was once more given to **Abdullah bin Saad**.

In the following year **647**, Hazrat Usman ordered an assault on **North Africa** in which Abdullah gained some military glory by defeating the Byzantine governor of Tunisia and returned with a massive tribute and an improved reputation.

After the African campaign, Muawiyah set about the construction of a large fleet in the dockyards of Egypt and Syria to stop Byzantines harassment from the sea during the Muslim-Byzantine wars. The Navy became operational in 649.

The first joint naval attack led by Abdullah and Muawiyah proved to be success and the **island of Cyprus** was occupied in 649. It is said that during Hazrat Usman's rule the Muslim Naval fleet comprised of 500 vessels. As a result, besides defending its borders the Muslim Empire was able to expand its influence in the Mediterranean capturing Cyprus and Crete and raiding as far away as Sicily.

Standard Compilation of Quran

- During 'Uthman's time as caliph, Islam had spread to other areas. **Hazrat Khuzafa bin Yamaan** reported to Hazrat 'Usman that people in different areas, in particular in **Armenia and Azerbaijan**, were reciting the Qur'an in a **different dialect**. He requested him to take immediate action for the removal of these differences; otherwise it might create a rift among the Muslims.
- Accordingly, Hazrat Usman acquired the copy of the Quran prepared by Zaid Bin Sabit from Hazrat Hafsa. He appointed Zaid Bin Sabit along with three other knowledgeable Muslims, **Abdur Rehman bin Harris, Abdullah bin Zubair** and **Saad bin Aas**, who assisted to make copies of the Quran from the original text. They were told to follow the dialect of the Quraish in case of differences over the language, as the Quran had been revealed in that dialect.
 - The Quran was read out loudly from the beginning to the end in the Prophet (P.B.U.H) mosque from these copies of the Quran, so that not a shadow of doubt remained in the mind of anyone that changes had been introduced in the Quran.
 - These copies were then dispatched to the capital city of every Province of the Muslims States with instructions that in future copies should be made only from the official authentic text. Hazrat Usman also ordered that if anyone had a copy with a different text, it was to be destroyed by fire. Hazrat Usman also sent teachers to these areas to teach the correct dialect to the inhabitants of these areas.
 - Hazrat Usman is Known as **Jami-al-Quran**. These means that he brought the Muslims around to a uniform reading of the Quran.

Causes of Revolt against Hazrat Usman

The first half of Hazrat Usman's Caliphate was very peaceful. During that time the Muslims attained many victories. However the later part of his caliphate was marred by terrible civil conflict, which ultimately led to the murder of the Caliph himself.

- Hazrat Usman (R.A) was very **gentle and soft hearted person**. The people who wanted to create chaos among the Muslims took advantages of his soft nature. Hazrat Umar's strict nature had kept away the none Islamic customs and elements of Persian and byzantine empires. Usman (R.A) lacked firmness despite his good leadership qualities; his leniency encouraged the evil elements in Muslim state. He sometimes

overlooked the faults of his governors and other officers in various provinces. His sympathetic nature also made the provincial governors to ignore his orders.

- **Abdullah bin Saba, a Yemenite Jew** who outwardly accepted Islam, started a campaign against Usman and succeeded in creating a rift among the Muslims. He exploited Ali's name to instigate the people against Usman. Usman (R.A) did not take timely action against him, he simply expelled him from Basra, Kufa and Syria one after another which increased the sphere of his influence; later he went to Egypt where he instigated people against Usman (R.A), and many were influenced by his propaganda .
- There was also **rivalry between the Arabs and the non-Arabs** of the newly conquered areas who still resented their defeat. Beside, Usman (R.A) on becoming the Caliph, allowed the Arabs to acquire lands in the newly conquered areas, and settle in the new provinces, this also increased hostility between the Arabs and the inhabitants of the newly conquered areas.
- To make the matter worse there were always **rivalry** amongst different tribes of the Quraish especially between the house of **the Hashimite and the Umayyad** which weakened the power of the Caliph. This rivalry had existed much before the advent of Islam, but it was suppressed during in the time of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) and the first two Caliphs. However, this rivalry again emerged during the time of Usman, the Hashimites could not tolerate the rule of the Umayyad for long, and Usman could not muster the support of the Quraish because of his inclinations towards his own relatives.

Charges / Allegations:

The People, who had once spoken highly of Hazrat Usman, brought several allegations against him afterwards which eventually led to the assassination of Hazrat Usman.

1. One of the main allegations against Hazrat Usman was that he had **appointed his inefficient relatives as governors**. This allegation was incorrect. Hazrat Umar had, already appointed Hazrat Usman's nephew **Muawiya Ibn Abi Sufiyan**, governor of Syria but now he was granted control over more territory. Other relatives of the caliph i.e **Abdullah bin Aamir, Walid bin Uqba and Abdullah bin Saad** were appointed governors of Basra and Kufa in Southern Iraq and of Egypt, and he also made his relatives his close advisors. His reason for doing this may well has been to ensure loyalty towards himself and to secure the unity of the empire. But to many Muslims, this action appeared to be favoring his own family unfairly.
2. It was also alleged that he **was too lenient** and did not keep a check on his governors. He, unlike Umar, gave the governors a free hand in running the provinces and did not interfere in their day to day affairs.
3. He decided to allocate to his governors the **wealth amassed in the campaigns(spoils)**, rather than divide it between the fighting men themselves, he was accused of favoring his own family though he may well have been trying to place funds for state purposes with the officials best able to administer them.
4. He was alleged to make **unreasonable expenditure from Bait ul Maal**. His uncle **Hakam bin Aas** was given one Lac dirham from Bait ul Maal. Similarly his cousin **Marwan bin Hakam** was given 1/5th of the spoils of war. Similarly, he was accused of favouring his relatives during the expenditure on state pastures.
5. The **daily wages** of Hazrat Abdullah bin Masood and Ubbay bin Kaab were cancelled. Some prominent companions of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) e.g. Hazrat Abu Zar Ghaffari left Madina.
6. It was alleged that Hazrat Usman **demolished the old structure of Holy Prophet's mosque** but he did this to extend the mosque and with the permission of all senior companions.
7. When **he burnt the false copies of the Quran** which had been gathered from the different parts of the empire, when he circulated the official version prepared by **Zaid Ibn Sabit**, (this has been known as the "uthmanic version"

ever since), he was condemned for destroying the Word of Allah, though he may have intended to ensure that only the correct version should be read.

8. Some people also thought that he was **surrounded by people who gave bad advice** and took advantage of his age.
9. When he **lost the Prophet's (pbuh) ring**, his adversaries took it as a divine sign that he should no longer be the caliph.

He gave a convincing reply to each of the charges in the presence of the Prophet's companions and his explanation was accepted.

Administration

Hazrat 'Uthman's caliphate started in 644 and ended in 656. His mercy, generosity and efficient administration of the Islamic empire won him the respect of his people. He proved skilful in handling the vast caliphate. As the Khalifa, **Hazrat Usman** followed the sunnah of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) and the practice followed by the first and the second caliphs.

1. He started his reign with a popular gesture by **adding 100 dirhams to the annual stipends** and at the same time began to increase the central government's control over the affairs of the garrison cities.
2. He continued the administrative arrangements made by Hazrat Umar, though he **regrouped some of the provinces and created new provinces** for the newly conquered territories. He brought about administrative changes in some areas e.g. Jordan and Palestine were united into one province Syria.
3. He continued with 'Umar's policy of gradually **splitting up the immense authority exercised by the provincial governors**, who also doubled as army commanders. He did this by creating the new post of financial administrators who exclusively looked after tax revenue. He established **a permanent secretariat** for the above task and appointed a salaried 'Inspector of Markets', which remained a key position in future Islamic states.
4. The Majlis-e-Shura or council of consultation was maintained. He started the practice of holding **periodic conference of the district authorities** in order to keep himself informed of the conditions in country. Hazrat Usman also used to hear **public complaints after Friday prayers**. He did keep a strict watch on governors and other administrators, e.g. Saad bin Abi Waqas drew money from the bait ul maal and did not return it for which he was deposed by 'Uthman. However he overlooked simple mistakes of his governors.
5. Hazrat Usman **relaxed most of the restrictions** that had been implemented by Hazrat Umar. He **allowed the Arabs to acquire agricultural lands in the conquered territories**. The Arabs purchased these lands and exchanged them with lands in Arabia.
6. Many other **Public works were carried out**, e.g. embankments were constructed to protect the houses in Madina from being swept away by periodic floods. Extension and provision for **providing clean water** to the population was undertaken. he purchased land and constructed **purposebuilt markets** whose rents were used to feed the poor; land was bought from funds of central treasury for state animals to pasture; construction of **state stables** and **guesthouses** for the use of travellers, messengers and poor pilgrims were set up; he **extended the Prophet's mosque** and built a port at Jeddah.
7. During his Khilafat for the first time a **fleet of nearly five hundred ships** was built to fight with the Greeks on the on the Mediterranean Sea.
8. The **cantonments were extended** and enlarged, more barracks were constructed for the soldiers, and stables for the cavalry were also extended.

9. He took steps for the **propagation of Islam** and said to have sent religious teachers to India to spread Islam. During his administration, the Qur'an was also copied from the Mushaf e Hafsah and sent to the four corners of the caliphate.
 10. He launched a **diligent inspection of accounts**, started to overhaul the Diwan salary rolls and asked for the accounts and provisional surpluses to be forwarded to the treasury in Madina.
- It must be noted here that all these increment reforms and building projects were to be achieved in the midst of ten years of continuous warfare on practically all frontiers of the Muslim Empire.

Events of Revolt (Rebellion in Madina)

In 656 the protesters fulfilled their plans with admirable speed and efficiency. Three columns of men apparently on their way to Makkah for the pilgrimage left the garrison cities of Kufa, Basra and Egypt. Once they reached Madina they made separate bases in their accustomed camping grounds on the dry riverbeds that surrounded the oasis. There was no violence, but the arrival of the armed men shocked the population into a renewed support of the old caliph.

The rebels sent deputations to the three most respected members of the inner council of the companions Hazrat Ali, Talha and Zubair however Abdur Rehman bin Awf was no longer alive. At first the companions rebuked the rebels for coming armed, and uncalled for, to the holy city and refused to have anything to do with them.

As the deadlock intensified, Hazrat Ali agreed to act as the intermediary and advised Hazrat Usman that the unpopular Abdullah bin Saad should be removed from the governorship of Egypt as this would be sufficiently generous compromise and would send the rebels back. This policy was also backed by Hazrat Aisha who argued for Amr to be reinstated. The rebels however, insisted the Muhammad, the youngest son of Abu Bakr be made the governor. The caliph reluctantly agreed, and the rebels prepared to march home.

Three days into their march back, the rebels force from Egypt was overtaken by an African slave. He was pursued and brought back and a single letter was found in his leather pouch with the caliph's new seal on it. The letter was opened: it requested Abdullah to arrest the ringleader and put them to death on their return.

The rebels were furious they turned around and rode hard to Madina. The rebels from Kufa and Basra also joined them. Hazrat Ali once again agreed to arbitrate. Hazrat Usman denied all knowledge of the letter but freely admitted that slave was from his household. The mystery surrounding the letter has never been solved but its effect hardened the battle lines, for the rebels now feared for their lives if they left Madina with the caliph still in place.

Hazrat Usman promised to listen to the grievance of the rebels and addressed them but he did not agree to step down from the office of caliph. He however refused to call the army to fight his fellow Muslims.

DEATH

The rebels besieged the Khalifa in his house. They did not allow food and water to reach him. Hazrat Ali deputed his sons, Hassan and Hussain and Zubair sent his son Abdullah to protect Hazrat Usman. Some companions who were successful in reaching Hazrat Usman during the siege, wanted to help him and fight the rebels or send for troops to fight them. But Hazrat Usman refused and said that he did not want to shed Muslim blood.

The siege lasted for fifty days when some of the rebels jumped into Hazrat Usman's house. It is said that they came upon him while he was reading the Quran, and that his blood was shed on its pages. As the sword pierced the caliph's forehead the first drops of his blood fell on verse 137 of sura Al-Baqarah.

The Khalifa's wife Naila tried to save her husband but she was pushed away and her fingers were cut off. This tragic event took place on Friday, 18th of Zil Hajj, 35 A.H. He was buried in Jannat ul Baqi in Madinah.

Summary/Main events of caliphate:

Hazrat Usman succeeded to the caliphate in 24 AH/644AD, chosen by the council of six persons (**Shura**) set up by Hazrat Umar as he was dying. He adopted a shorter title than his predecessors, **Khalifat Allah**, though he continued many of Hazrat Umar's policies, including the expansion of Islamic rule. **Persia, Armenia, North Africa**, and parts of the Eastern **Mediterranean** were all brought under the growing empire during his 12 years in the caliphate and the **Islamic state expanded from Morocco to Kabul**.

Hazrat Usman placed **close relatives as governors** over many of the new provinces. Hazrat Umar had, already appointed his nephew **Muawiya Ibn Abi Sufiyan**, governor of Syria but now he was granted control over more territory. Other relatives of the caliph i.e **Abdullah bin Aamir, Walid bin Uqba and Abdullah bin Saad** were appointed governors of Basra and Kufa in Southern Iraq and of Egypt, and he also made his relatives his close advisors. His reason for doing this may well have been to ensure loyalty towards himself and to secure the unity of the empire. But to many Muslims, this action appeared to be favoring his own family unfairly.

During the course of Hazrat Usman's caliphate, **criticisms** of his actions grew steadily stronger. When he decided to allocate to his governors the **wealth amassed in the campaigns**, rather than divide it between the fighting men themselves, he was accused of favoring his own family though he may well have been trying to place funds for state purposes with the officials best able to administer them. And when he **burnt the false copies of the Quran** which had been gathered from the different parts of the empire, when he circulated the official version prepared by **Zaid Ibn Sabit**, (this has been known as the "uthmanic version" ever since), he was condemned for destroying the Word of Allah, though he may have intended to ensure that only the correct version should be read. Some Muslims also thought him to be surrounded by people who gave bad advice and took advantage of his age and weakness.

He continued the administrative reforms of Hazrat Umar e.g Majlis-e- Shura was maintained. He used to hear public complaints after Friday prayer. He relaxed some of Hazrat Umar's restrictions e.g by allowing Arabs to purchase or exchange land outside Arabia. A dam was built for the supply of drinking water. For the first time a fleet of 500 ships was built to fight against the Greeks. He raised the salaries and allowances upto **25%**.

Disquiet about Hazrat Usman's policies, and his ability to rule, erupted after six years of his caliphate. First there was an uprising in Iraq, then in **Kufa, a then in Egypt**. Finally, in **35 AH/656AD**, troops from all three provinces advanced on Medina to take their complaints directly to the caliph. The force from **Egypt** arrived first and angrily besieged Hazrat Usman in his house, but when he agreed to their demands they were pacified. They began their journey home, but hearing he had tricked them, they turned back and began a second siege.

This siege lasted some time, during which some leading Muslims tried to help Hazrat Usman but were prevented by him, and eventually the Egyptian force, led by **Hazrat Abu Bakr's son Mohammad**, entered the house and murdered the Caliph. It is said that they came upon him while he was reading the Quran, and that his blood was shed on its pages, and also that his wife **Naila** was injured in the affray, while trying to protect him. His family in secrecy buried the Caliph's body.

M/J 2010

3 (a) What major events took place during the caliphate of 'Uthman? [10]

O/N 2014

3 (a) What were the causes of the revolt against 'Uthman and what charges were made against him? [10]

O/N 2016 (21)

3 (a) Give an account of:

(i) the election of the caliph 'Uthman, and

(ii) the compilation of the Qur'an that took place during his caliphate. [10]

O/N 2016 (22)

3 (a): Write in detail about the policy followed by 'Uthman as caliph in expanding and maintaining the state. [10]

M/J 2019

3(a) Outline the reasons for the unrest against 'Uthman and write an account of the rebellion in Madina that led to his martyrdom. [10]

O/N 2020

3(a) Give an account of the administration of the caliphate under 'Uthman. [10]

3.(b) How justified were the criticisms against 'Uthman for burning the copies of the Qur'an?

Give reasons for your answer. [4]

- some people did criticise 'Uthman for burning the copies of the Qur'an as they felt that it did contain the words of God
- the allegations against 'Uthman for burning the copies were unjustified as he was trying to save the Qur'an from corruption.
- A word wrongly pronounced in Arabic can change the meaning of the word totally hence it was important that only those copies were in circulation that were accurate.
- If he would not have done that, the unity of the Muslim community would be threatened due to rival interpretations and different versions of recitation. Eventually, Muslims would not have a single source of guidance and the authenticity of Quran would be compromised.

(b) Explain why 'Uthman encountered difficulties in the later years of his caliphate and was assassinated. [4]

Hazrat Usman faced several difficulties in the last 4 or 5 years of his caliphate which eventually led to his assassination. His appointment of family members in important positions of control was regarded as favouritism. The burning of the copies of the Qur'an to be replaced by the official version prepared by Zayd Ibn Thabit was seen as destroying the word of Allah. Yet another reason was that some Muslims questioned his ability to rule due to his old age and the autonomy he had given to his governors. After 'Uthman had pacified the Egyptians, they were on their way home when they got a hold of a letter supposedly from 'Uthman to the Governor of Egypt to have the leaders of the group put to death on their return. Seeking vengeance, they returned and killed him.

3.(b) Can Muslims today learn lessons from the martyrdom of 'Uthman? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

- say yes to the question
- 'Uthman being a man of firm principles stood by what he deemed to be just;
- him not wanting to shed unnecessary Muslim blood;
- him wanting to reach a negotiated settlement.

Muslims today should stand by what they believe is just and fair and not give up efforts to find peaceful solutions to disputes even if it is at their own peril.

Hazrat Ali's (R.A) Caliphate

Main events of caliphate/Summary

M/J 2009

4 . (a) Describe the main events of the caliphate of 'Ali. [10]

M/J 2013

3 (a) Which important battles were fought during the caliphate of 'Ali? Write a descriptive account of each. [10]

O/N 2013

3 (a) What were the consequences of 'Uthman's murder? [10]

M/J 2014

3 (a) 'Ali's caliphate was riddled with problems. Describe what these problems were. [10]

Answer:

- After the assassination of Hazrat Usman, the Egyptians and some prominent Companions of the Holy Prophet (pbuh) requested Hazrat Ali to accept the office of the caliph but he declined the offer. Thereafter, the people of Madinah persuaded Hazrat Ali to accept the Khilafat. Talha, Zubair and some others performed the Bayyat at Hazrat Ali's hand. On the **25th of Zil Haj 35AH/656AD**, there was a general Bayyat at the Prophet's mosque and Hazrat Ali thus became the fourth Khalifa of Islam. Since this election was supported by the rebels, it divided the community in three groups i.e supporters of Ali, the Umayyads, and the Quraish who hoped to return to the caliphates of Abu Bakr and Umar.
 - Hazrat Ali very quickly took some of the measures demanded by Hazrat Uthman's adversaries. He **replaced the governors** who had been appointed by Uthman with men who supported him, and he distributed the wealth that Hazrat Umar and Hazrat Usman had ordered to be kept aside. His lack of action against Hazrat Usman's murderers provoked strong reactions.
 - **Hazrat Aisha**, the Prophet's widow, who was in Makkah, openly denounced him, and was joined by the two companions, Talha and Zubair. They demanded that Hazrat Usman's murderers should be brought to justice. With a few hundred fighting men, they set out for Iraq in the hope of finding more supporters, and Hazrat Ali was forced to pursue them. The two sides met near **Basra** and attempted to settle their differences peacefully. But extremist supporters among them provoked a fight, and this grew into a battle around the camel which carried Hazrat Aisha. **The Battle of the Camel** took place **656AD**. **Talha and Zubair** were killed, and after a defeat, Hazrat Aisha was conducted back to Madina, with the escort due to a wife of the Prophet Muhammad pbuh. Hazrat Ali now moved his **headquarters to Kufa**, where his support was strongest.
 - Hazrat Ali's differences with **Muawiya** came to a climax when Muawiya insisted that Hazrat Usman has been killed unjustly and so his murderers should be punished. He moved against the Caliph, and the two forces met at **Siffin in 37AH/657 AD**. The fighting proved indecisive for many days; then when Muawiya's side seemed to be losing, he was advised to order his soldiers **to fix Qurans to their lances**, indicating that the outcome should be decided not by warfare, but by consulting Allah's Word. Hazrat Ali was persuaded to accept, and arrangements were made for an arbitrator from each side to decide the rights and wrongs of the case.
 - **Abu Musa al-Ashari** represented Hazrat Ali and **Amr Ibn al-Aas** represented Muawiya. It was decided that if they agreed that Hazrat Usman had acted against the teachings of the Divine Law, then his killing would be just and his assassins would go unpunished; but if he had acted in accordance with the law, then his killers would be seen as criminals and Muawiya would be right to demand their punishment.
- When the two arbitrators of Siffin first declared their decision in private, they both seemed to have agreed that Hazrat Usman had been killed unjustly and they also said that Hazrat Ali and Muawiya should both step down, and a new caliph be elected. But when they announced this in public, they differed. Abu Musa al Ashari stood by what he had said, but **Amr Ibn Aas changed** his version and declared that while Hazrat Ali should step down, Muawiyya should be confirmed as caliph. Many Muslims condemned this as a trick.

- Some people on Hazrat Ali's side violently disagreed with this decision to accept arbitration. They thought that Quran clearly gave instructions about the proper way to treat rebels (in **Surah al Hujrat 49.9**), and so it was wrong even to acknowledge that Muawiya had any claim against the ruler of the community. Their cry was **"no decision except Allah's"**. Angry at Hazrat Ali's move about three thousand or four thousand of these men separated themselves from him and rode to Al Naharwan. They became known as the **Khawarij or Kharijites, 'Seceders'** (from the verb Kharaja, 'to depart or separate'). In **37AH/658AD**, Hazrat Ali was forced to move against these rebels when they made attacks close to Kufa, and he killed many of them. But more of his forces deserted him and he was left weaker than before.
- Hazrat Ali was still regarded as caliph by his supporters, though his cause grew weaker elsewhere. Meanwhile Muawiya attacked and captured Egypt. After this a treaty of peace was signed between Muawiya and Ali. In these increasing difficulties, he was suddenly attacked in **40 AH/661 AD, by Abd al Rahman Ibn Muljam**, a kharijite who wanted revenge for the killings at Al Naharwan and he died two days later.

Election as Khalifa

After the assassination of Hazrat Usman, in the absence of any government, a state of confusion and anarchy prevailed in Madinah. After **four days**, when the rebels decided to return to their homes, they felt that it was necessary that the new Khalifa should be chosen before they left Madinah. In the connection, there were differences among the rebels. One group favored the election of Hazrat Ali, another favoured the election of Talha, while the third wanted Zubair. The Egyptians and some prominent companions of the holy prophet ^{pbuh} requested Hazrat Ali to accept the office of the Khalifa. But he declined the offer. The rebels then offered The Khilafat to Talha and Zubair but they too refused. The rebels next requested the Ansars to choose a Khalifa from amongst them. They also declined the offer, saying that in the presence of Hazrat Ali, no one else deserved to be elected as a khalifa. There was now a complete deadlock in the matter of election. The rebels, there upon, gave the ultimatum that unless the khalifa was chosen within the next twenty-four hours, they would be forced to take some drastic action. In order to resolve the issue, all the Muslim assembled in the prophet^{pbuh} mosque. The leader of the Egyptians said that the person who was to be elected as Khalifa should be learned brave, pious and should have been close to the holy prophet ^{pbuh}. He observed that Hazrat Ali was the only person who fulfilled all these qualities. Thereafter, the people of Madina persuaded Hazrat Ali to accept khalifat. Talha, Zubair and some others performed the Bayyat at Hazrat Ali's hand. On the **25th of Zil Hajj 35 A.H/656AD**, there was a general Bayyat at the prophet's ^{pbuh} mosque and Hazrat Ali became the **fourth khalifa** of Islam.

O/N 2015

3 (a) 'Ali's policy of changing the governors appointed by 'Uthman led to a lot of problems for him. Outline:

- His reasons for making these changes;
- The effects of his policy. [10]

Marking Scheme:

(i)- Ali, upon assuming the caliphate, dismissed all the governors appointed by 'Uthman despite the advice of some of his companions not to do so until he had established himself as the caliph and the political unrest of the time had settled down. Candidates, as the question asks, will need to say why 'Ali felt he had to change the previously appointed governors quickly and here they could say that one of the major charges levelled against 'Uthman was that he had appointed inefficient relatives as governors. Whether this allegation was true or false is another debate.

(ii)-The consequences of this action was however, that Mu'awiya who was the governor of Syria and a cousin of 'Uthman, refused to leave his post and accept 'Ali as the caliph until 'Uthman's assassins were punished. This demand of Mu'awiya led to unrest and the formation of different groups even within 'Ali's core supporters, as Talha and Zubayr who had initially sided

with 'Ali turned against him. The **battles of Camel and Siffin** ensued and the candidates could give a brief account of them and what their outcome meant for 'Ali. The above is a guidance of what could be expected in the answer.

Answer:

(i) Change of Governors and its reasons:

On becoming caliph, Ali felt it necessary to change the governors appointed by Hazrat Usman, in the interest of the Islamic state. Though he was advised by many of his friends not to do so. He appointed Suhail bin Hanif as the governor of Syria, Sa'ad bin Ubadah as the governor of Egypt, Ummara bin Shahab as the governor of Kufa, Usman bin Hanif as the governor of Basra and Abdullah bin Abbas as the governor of Yemen.

There were several important reasons behind this action. Firstly, one of the main allegations against Usman was that he had appointed inefficient relatives as governors, whether this allegation was true or false is another debate. Moreover, the people who had elected Ali were Usman's adversaries and they demanded for an immediate change of governors, and Ali could not refuse them. Ali also thought it important to change them in order to establish his position as caliph of the Islamic state. Lastly, it was important for him to change Usman's relatives because they would have started taking revenge on their own which could have led to further chaos and unrest.

(ii) Effects of change of Governors:

As a result of this policy Ali had to face resistance, as Muawiya bin Abu Sufyan refused to accept him as caliph and did not step down from the governorship, he also alleged Ali to be an accomplice in Usman's murder. This demand of Muawiya led to unrest and formation of different groups even within Ali's close supporters as Talha and Zubair who had initially sided with Ali turned against him. Aisha, the Prophet's widow, who was in Makkah, openly denounced him, and was joined by the two companions, Talha and Zubair. They demanded that Hazrat Usman's murderers should be brought to justice. With a few hundred fighting men, they set out for Iraq in the hope of finding more supporters, and Hazrat Ali was forced to pursue them. The two sides met near **Basra** and attempted to settle their differences peacefully. But extremist supporters among them provoked a fight, and this grew into a battle around the camel which carried Hazrat Aisha. **The Battle of the Camel** took place **656AD**. **Talha and Zubair** were killed, and after a defeat, Aisha was conducted back to Madina, with her brother Muhammad bin Abu Bakr. Ali now moved his **headquarters to Kufa**, where his support was strongest.

Ali's differences with **Muawiya** came to a climax when Muawiya insisted that Usman had been killed unjustly and so his murderers should be punished. He moved against the Caliph, and the two forces met at **Siffin in 37AH/657 AD**. The fighting proved indecisive for many days; then when Muawiya's side seemed to be losing, he was advised by Amr bin Aas to order his soldiers **to fix Qurans to their lances**, indicating that the outcome should be decided not by warfare, but by consulting Allah's Word. Ali was persuaded to accept, and arrangements were made for an arbitrator from each side to decide the rights and wrongs of the case.

Abu Musa Ashari represented Hazrat Ali and **Amr bin Aas** represented Muawiya. It was decided that if they agreed that Usman had acted against the teachings of the Divine Law, then his killing would be just and his assassins would go unpunished; but if he had acted in accordance with the law, then his killers would be seen as criminals and Muawiya would be right to demand their punishment.

O/N 2019

5(a) Give a detailed account of the following events: [10]

- the opposition faced by 'Ali when he became caliph and
- the Battle of Camel

Answer:

Early Opposition :

Hazrat Ali R.A however, was to face some determined opposition right from the start of his Caliphate. Hazrat Aisha R.A on hearing the news of Hazrat Ali R.A being acclaimed as the fourth Caliph of Islam, whilst she was on her way back to Madina from the annual pilgrimage, turned her caravan back and return to Makkah from where she voiced her opposition to him. Hazrat Ali R.A was accused of manipulating the political strife which led to Hazrat Usman's R.A murder. The fact that he was reluctant arbitrator, that he had remained behind in Madina, instead of going for the annual pilgrimage, in order to protect Hazrat Usman R.A through an arbitrated peace, and that he sent his son Hassan R.A to guard Hazrat Usman's R.A door, while doing which he was wounded, was not taken into consideration.

Battle of Camel (Jamal)

M/J 2016

5 (a) Write an account of the events that resulted from the opposition of Talha and Zubayr to 'Ali. [10]

Answer:

After Ali had assumed office, the rebels left for their home towns. But even then there was no peace in the city of Madinah. The Umayyads who had become quite powerful in Syria raised the cry of revenge for the blood of Usman. Many people in Makkah and Madinah also joined in this cry for revenge. They requested the new khalifa to punish the assassins of Usman. Ali, realizing that the assassination of Usman was not the work of a few individuals who could be easily punished and also keeping in view the political situation in the country, refused to comply with their request. He told them that he would take necessary steps against these assassins after restoring peace in the Islamic world. This provided an opportunity to the mischief-mongers and the hypocrites to create trouble and instigate people against Ali.

In the meantime when **Talha and Zubair**, who were the first to acknowledge Ali as the khalifa, saw that he was talking no positive steps to apprehend Usman's assassins and punish them, became enraged. They approached Hazrat Aisha who was herself deeply grieved at Usman's murder. They raised an army and persuaded her to join them in demanding revenge for the late khalifa's murder.

Ali sent his son Hassan to Kufa, from where he was successful in raising an army of ten thousand men. The two armies met near Basra. Ali who had a very high regard for Hazrat Aisha did not wish to fight and sent one of the holy prophet's ^{pbuh} companions to assure her that he really wanted to punish the murderers of Usman: the delay was due to non-availability of evidence. Aisha wanted to prevent bloodshed and agreed to negotiate and thus hostilities were suspended.

However the mischief-maker from both the armies got alarmed at negotiations because peace meant their own doom. So during the night there were attacks on the forces of both sides and the battle started. Hazrat Aisha mounted a camel to lead the army. In the fierce fighting that took place, thousands of Muslims were killed on both sides. Later, Talha left the battlefield but he was followed and killed by the mischief-makers while offering prayer. Zubair was killed by a mischief maker. The battle came to an end in favour of Ali after the camel on which Aisha was riding was wounded and brought down.

Thereafter there was reconciliation between Ali and Aisha. He treated her with respect and honour and sent her to Madinah escorted by her brother, Muhammad Bin Abu Bakr.

In Madinah, she led a retired life and never took part in politics again. As a result of the victory at Basra, Ali's Khilafat came to be acknowledged by the entire Muslim world except Syria. This battle was **the first civil war** between Muslims. Unfortunately, it sets an example for the Muslims to fight among themselves over secular matters.

Battle of Siffin

M/J 2019

3(a) Mu'awiya was opposed to 'Ali's caliphate. Give reasons for his opposition and write an account of the Battle of Siffin which resulted from this opposition. [10]

Answer:

After his election as khalifa, Ali deposed Muawiya from the governorship of Syria. Muawiya, however, refused to vacate the office. Under his influence, no one in Syria took the oath of allegiance to the new khalifa. In order to undermine the authority of Ali, Muawiya started a campaign to instigate the people against him. He raised a cry for a revenge for the blood of Hazrat

Usman and displayed the blood-stained cloths of Usman and the fingers of Usman's wife **Naila** in the mosque at Damascus. He went so far as to accuse Ali of being an accomplice in the murder of Usman.

He said that the election of Ali was illegal as it was held under the pressure of rebels who had assassinated the 3rd Caliph. When Talha and Zubair were killed in the battle of Camel at Basra, Muawiya presented them as martyrs who had laid down their lives in seeking revenge for the blood of Usman. He also criticized Ali for the ill-treatment of Hazrat Aisha.

As a result, not only Syria, but Iraq and Iran also were won over by this propaganda. After the election of Ali, within a year, Muawiya gained enough strength to take up offensive against the khalifa. Ali did not wish that Muslims should fight among themselves. so he wrote to Muawiya that since the people who had elected Abu Bakr, Umar and Usman had accepted him as khalifa, Muawiya and his followers must also accept him as such. Otherwise they should be ready to face the consequences meaning a war. Muawiya's reply was that Ali must first hand over Usman's assassins to him before further negotiations.

When war between Ali and Muawiya became inevitable, preparations for a battle were made by both the sides. The khalifa managed to raise any army of eighty to ninety thousand. Muawiya also with a large army of 50000 proceeded against him. Both the armies met at Siffin. The two armies that camped at Siffin were the largest armies so far assembled in the history of Islam. For several months, the rival soldiers remained facing each other. Except occasional skirmishes, no decisive battle took place. Ali did not want to shed Muslim blood in vain. So he sent messengers to Muawiya asking him to submit in the interest of the unity of Islam. Muawiya in reply demanded that the assassins of Usman should be punished first. Thereafter, all negotiations for peace broke down and both the sides got ready for war.

The main battle began on the 8th of safar 37 A.H. On the fourth day, the position of Muawiya army began worsening in order to avoid crushing defeat. Muawiya on the advice of Amr bin Aas, ordered the soldiers in the front ranks to fasten the Quran to their lances as a sign that war should cease now. They cried out **'Let the word of Allah decided between us and you. Who will defend the border towns of Syria if we are slain and who will protect the people of Iraq after u are gone? Let the Book of Allah judge between you and us'**

Ali wanted his men not to fall into this track, but to fight till the end. But his exhortations had no effect and many officer of the army refused to fight. Some even said that if war was not stopped immediately they would fight against Ali. He was compelled to recall his forces. Thereafter fighting stopped.

After the cessation of hostilities it was decided that the matter be referred to arbitration. Abu Musa Ashari was appointed Arbitrate on behalf of Ali and Amr Bin Aas on behalf of Muwaiya. They were to settle the dispute in accordance the holy Quran and sunnah and announce their decision by the month of Ramzan. In the meantime, all hostilities were to cease. After the signing of this agreement Ali left Siffian for kufa. Ali left the battlefield of Saffin with a heavy heart. There were heavy casualties on the both the sides and he mourned the dearth of so many Muslims. He had lost some of his best supporters. He felt distressed the only one generation after the death of holy Prophet pbuh. The Muslim nation had lost its unity and its Islamic character. The battle of saffin led to the birth of the first sect among the Muslim that came to be known as the kharijites.

M/J 2017

4(a) Write about the following events that took place during the caliphate of 'Ali: [10]

The battle of Siffin;

The emergence of Kharijites;

and The arbitration after Siffin.

O/N 2018

3(a) How did the arbitration following the Battle of Siffin lead to the emergence of the Kharijites? [10]

Arbitration

Two arbitrators were selected. Ali's forces who were mostly from Kufa and Basra, called for **Abu Musa Ashari** to be their arbitrator. Ali argued that Abu Musa was neutral and was not among his supporters; however, he gave in and

agreed. Muawiya on the other hand chose **Amr ibn al-Aas** who was a heroic figure and a respected governor. He skillfully commanded one of Muawiya's divisions throughout the four-day battle of Siffin and, in return of his support, had Muawiya's secret assurance for being resorted as the governor of Egypt.

Two days after the fighting had stopped at Siffin, Amr rode across the battlefield and entered Ali's camp to work out the details of the arbitration. The draft at the end read that both parties agreed to bind themselves by Allah's word. For Ali this truce was a disaster as he had led his army as the Commander of the faithful and now the troops were heading back not as victors or the heroic army of Allah under the command of chief Caliph, since wording of the truce made them feel like a group in a civil war.

Result of Arbitration:

However, in January 658, when the two arbitrators, formally met at **Daumat-ul-jandal**, a place between Kufa and Damascus. Amr convinced Abu Musa that they should both denounce their leaders as Caliphs and asked Abu Musa, on account of his seniority in age to be the first to make the announcement, which he did. Amr on the other hand backtracked and declared Muawiyah as the new Caliph. The peace conference broke up and the Kharjis, deeply upset with the disastrous outcome of the arbitration, despite having made their peace with Hazrat Ali, left their homes in Kufa and Basra, and set up their own community in Nehrwan.

Emergence of Kharijites

The term Kharijites literally means separatists or outgoers. These people had taken part in the revolt against Usman and were involved in his murder. When Muawiya raised the cry for revenge for the blood of Usman, they allied themselves with Ali and fought on his side in the Battles of Camel and Siffin. When the troops of Muawiya asked for cease-fire they responded to the call and forced Ali to suspend hostilities although victory for his forces was near.

In order to support their stand they maintained that they stood for the establishment of the Kingdom of Allah on earth. They held that they alone were true believers and they had the right to kill unbelievers. They considered Abu Bakr and Umar as the only lawful Khalifas and declared others as usurpers.

After arbitration, the army from Kufa mainly the radical supporters of Ali, withdrew from his camp and joined like-minded men from Basra. These people came to be known as **the Kharjis (seceders or those who separate)**. They bitterly opposed the idea of arbitration and argued for **'No judgement but Allah's'**. They were treated by Ali with compassion; he reminded them of how he had stormed and pleaded with his soldiers to continue the fight to finish, but it was their wish to support the Syrians that frustrated his leadership. Most of the Kharjis left the battle field and returned to their homes. To confirm this accord, the Holy Prophet's (P.B.U.H) announcement at Ghadir Khumm, in the last year of his life, asking his followers to swear to Ali to be a friend of whoever he befriends and an enemy of whoever he takes as an enemy.

Battle of Nehrwan

By March 658, Hazrat Ali R.A was determined once again to lead the army of Kufa and Basra to settle the dispute of Muawiya's usurpation of power. He persuaded the Kharjis to join him and succeeded in getting half of the 4000 Kharjis back in his ranks. These were the moderates. The inner hard core became more militant with the exodus of the moderates, and started sending raiding parties into the surrounding countryside, battling anyone who disagreed with their position. Hazrat Ali R.A decided to deal with them before confronting Muawiya R.A. In mid-May (some sources put the month as July) the two armies clashed at Nahrwan. Hazrat Ali's army was ten times the size of Kharjis who fought and fell with the battle cry 'Paradise' 'Paradise on their lips. With their deaths, some of the spirit in the Caliph's army also died as the heroes of the battle of Camel and Siffin also lay among the dead. Hazrat Ali's troops insisted on going back to garrison cities before they could contemplate the invasion of Syria. Hazrat Ali was left with no choice and when later, he issued summons for war, the response was so muted that he had to abandon any thought of an offensive campaign that year.

The two oaths and Hazrat Ali's R.A martyrdom

In year 660, a year of two oaths: first, A Muslim army from the Syrian garrison toured the Arabian Peninsula, forcing the inhabitants of Makkah and Madina and the people of Yemen to swear loyalty to Muawiya at the point of the sword. This was

speedily followed by a counter march by the men from the garrison of Kufa who though unable to intercept Muawiya's army supervised another oath of allegiance to the legitimate Caliph, Hazrat Ali. Eventually, the Islamic state was split as Muawiya established his rule over Syria, Egypt, and Palestine whereas Hazrat Ali R.A as Caliph ruled Iraq, Arabia, Persia and Central Asia. The incident of the two oaths of loyalty being imposed upon the Muslims disgusted many believers and also aroused an angry reaction from three Kharijis, who at the conclusion of Hajj that year, met and vowed that they would act against this. In 661AD, on the fortieth anniversary of the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) migration to Madina, they would strike simultaneously and free Islam by removing Hazrat Ali R.A Muawiya and Amr ibn al-Aas. The attacks were planned for Ramadan in the three great mosques of Fustat, Damascus and Kufa where they were assured that Amr did not lead the prayers, but the mosque's Imam was martyred by one powerful blow of the assassin's sword. In Damascus Muawiya's alert bodyguard observed unusual movement among the crowd and saved Muawiya R.A as he was in prayer. The Fourth Caliph of Islam Hazrat Ali R.A however, suffered a mortal blow by **Abdur Rehman ibn Muljim**'s sword while in prayer at the mosque of Kufa, and died two days later at the age of 63. He is buried in Najaf, in Iraq.

Administration

The whole period of Hazrat Ali's R.A Khilafat passed in civil wars, so he had no time or chance to pay proper attention to administration or conquest. He however, deserves credit for whatever he was able to achieve during his short Khilafat. Hazrat Ali administered the state on the lines laid down by the previous Khalifas without making any amendments to the rule and regulations. For example, when the Jews who had been banished from Hijaz to Najran by Hazrat Umar wanted to come back, he did not allow them and said, "Whose decision can be better than Umar".

The division of the provinces remained the same as during the time of Hazrat Umar, with few expectations. First, the capital was changed from Madinah to Kufa. Secondly, the officers and governors were changed. Hazrat Ali paid special attention to army requirements. Many cantonments and fortresses were built during his Khilafat. He was very strict in safeguarding the state treasury. Hazrat Ali kept a strict watch on his officers who administered justice. He would check the goods to be sold and their price in the market. He was very particular in taking care of non-Muslims.

4(b) What in your opinion was the most serious consequence of the outcome of the arbitration during the rest of 'Ali's reign? [4]

- the failure of the arbitration led to a weakening of 'Ali's position;
- a series of events unfolded after the arbitration e.g. 'Ali was preparing to fight the Syrians the Kharijites fought him which demoralised his army even more so that they refused to proceed to Syria which made Mu'awiya even more bold leading to his takeover of Egypt.
- The fall of Egypt led to frequent rebellions.
- whilst on the other hand Mu'awiya's strengthened which led to the empire being divided between 'Ali and Mu'awiya.

Caliphs as Role models

O/N 2012

3 (a) Write about how the four Rightly Guided Caliphs are role models for leaders today.

O/N 2013

3 (a) Write about how the four Rightly Guided Caliphs ruled during their caliphates in accordance with Islamic values. [10]

O/N 2017

4(a) Outline the characteristics of the caliphates of all four Rightly Guided Caliphs which make them an example of leadership for Muslim rulers. [10]

Answer:

- The caliphs were chosen by Shura and **general consensus** of the Muslims. They did not think of themselves above a common man. It immediately established democracy and proves that there is no place for dictatorship in Muslim countries. Abu Bakr was elected by the consensus of the majority of Muslims first at Saqifabani Saida and later in Masjid Nabwi. After being elected he addressed the people in these words:
“ O people! I have been elected as your Trustee, although I am no better than anyone of you. help me, If I am right. If I am misguided, set me right. Obey me as long as I obey Allah and His Prophet; When I disobey Him and His Prophet, then obey me not. The weakest among you is powerful in my eyes, until I do not get him his due. The most powerful among you is the weakest in my eyes, until I do not make him pay due rights to others”.
- Before his death, he nominated ‘Umar and as there was no opposition to him he was elected. Before his death, Umar(R.A) appointed a panel of six men to select a Caliph from amongst themselves. Uthman was elected by this panel after a general Bai’t(Pledge of loyalty) took place in the mosque. Ali (R.A) was approached by the rebels to be the Caliph. At first he declined but later when he accepted on persuasion of the companions, he decided to put the matter before the Muslims in the Mosque of the Prophet and was elected by them. These examples go to show that leadership or caliphate is not a hereditary concept in Islam. And if it wasn’t practised by the Rightly Guided Caliphs, surely there is no place for it in today’s democratic world.
- The Caliph was the head of the state and **followed the Qur’an and Sunnah** of the Prophet (SAW) strictly, in case both the Quran and Sunnah were silent he referred to the consent of eminent companions and he also given his own verdict based on the Quran and Sunnah. The Caliph had to perform some religious duties like leading the congregational prayers; the Caliph was commander in-chief of the Muslim army.
- The **Caliphs consulted Majlis Shura** in all affairs of the State. Majlis Shura was the council of advisors. It consisted of eminent companions of the Prophet Muhammad (SAW). Everybody in the council was free to express his opinion.
- Every Muslim was **free to express his opinion** and criticize the Caliph. During the reign of Umar(R.A). Once an old lady asked him how come he made a shirt from a piece of cloth from the Baitul-ul- Mal , while the piece was not long enough for others to make a shirt out of it, Umar (R.A) replied that his son gave him his share.

Once, Caliph ‘Umar thought of fixing the upper limit of the amount of dower as had received complaints from young men who were asked to pay huge amounts of dower to the women for marriage. He was stopped to do so by a woman, who said, “ **O ‘Umar who are you to put restrictions on our right which Allah has granted to us? Have you not read verse 20 of Surah an-Nisaa.**”(Bakhari) Instead of getting annoyed, the Caliph thanked God that there were such people in Ummah who would correct him if he went wrong.

- The **Caliph was available to everyone at all time**. Umar (R.A) forbade the governors to keep watchmen at their houses so that everybody could see them freely and could put his problems before them. **Hazrat Usman** used to hear public complaints after Friday prayer. **Hazrat Ali** would roam the streets of Kufa to know the condition of his people.
- **Bait-ul- Maal or the treasury was a public property** and not a personal property of the Caliph. They considered it as trust of the Muslims and never spent a single dirham on themselves. Abu Bakr, Umar and Ali (R.A) only took the amount of salary from the Bait-ul-mal which was sufficient for the common man. Uthman never took anything from Baitul-mal. Umar said, “Nothing in Halal for me and for my family from Allah’s money except a dress from summer and a dress for winter and a salary equal to the income of an average Quraishi. I am no more than an ordinary Muslim amongst you.” Abu Bakr (R.A) asked his wife at the time of his death to sell his property and pay back the money he took from Bait-ul-maal as his salary.
- **The judiciary was independent**. The Caliph did not consider himself above ordinary person. The Qadi was free to give decision. Once a woman brought a claim against the Caliph Umar . When ‘Umar appeared on trial before the judge,

the judge stood up as a sign of respect toward him. 'Umar reprimanded him, saying, "This is the first act of injustice you did to these women!"

During his Caliphate, 'Ali (R.A) lost his armor and he saw a Jew selling the armor in the market, he did not take the armor, but took the case to the court. He brought his son Hassan as a witness in support of this case. The judge rejected the complaint as he did not consider the evidence of any relative as reliable. Whenever Ali (R.A) appeared before the Qadi, he did not allow the Qadi to pay undue respect to him and asked him to treat him as a common man.

- **No one was above law** all were treated alike. During the caliphate of Umar(R.A), a famous chief of Syria from a royal rank embraced Islam and while he was performing circumambulation around the Ka'bah , the hem of his mantle fell and came under the feet of another circumambulator. Jabalah at once slapped him on the face. The victim retaliated and Jabalah complained to the caliph. Upon hearing the complaint, the caliph Umar said, 'you have received the punishment of what you have done.' Jabalah was amazed at the reply and said 'I belong to high class family, if anyone acts rudely against us, he is punished with death. The Caliph Umar replied that it was an un Islamic practice. Islam equalizes all ranks and everyone is equal before law. Jabala furiously replied, "If Islam is a system in which there is no distinction between high and common people, I abjure it."
- During the caliphate of Umar (R.A) "a Syrian cultivator complained that the army had trampled down his crops, and the caliph at once ordered for the payment of the ten thousand dirhams to him as compensation out of the Bait-ul-mal."
- The **rights of life, honour and property of Muslims and the Zimmis were considered to be the same.** During the Khilafat of Hazrat Ali, a Muslim killed a Zimmi. Hazrat Ali ordered the Muslim to be killed, but the brother of the murdered person pardoned him. Hazrat Abu Bakr and Hazrat Usman fixed the blood money of a Zimmi equal to that of a Muslim. The religious freedom which these people enjoyed can be judged from an event that took place During the Khilafat of Hazrat Umar who invited his slave to accept Islam and quoted the Quranic verse: **"Let there be no compulsion in religion."** (2:256)

The poor and disabled Zimmis were not only exempt from paying Jizya (a tax taken from non-Muslim living in a Muslim State) but a stipend was fixed for them from the state treasury.

Hadiths 09-20

9. مَا أَكَلَ أَحَدٌ طَعَامًا قَطُّ خَيْرًا مِنْ أَنْ يَأْكُلَ مِنْ عَمَلٍ يَدِهِ.

No one eats better food than that which he eats out of the work of his hand.

(a) Main Teachings : [2] marks

- Great emphasis is placed not only on lawful earnings in Islam but also on the dignity of labour. All kinds of lawful works and hard labour are respected in Islamic community. it is not only a duty but also a rewarding act .
- Through this Hadith the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) encourages Muslims to earn lawfully and through their own hard work.
- This Hadith not only strongly discourages reliance on others such as begging and also condemns all other unlawful means of earning.
- Respect is not earned by how much one earns but how he earns it. Earnings that come through honest hard work and blessed by Allah and no job is considered too lowly in Islam. Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **“One who earns his livelihood by hard work is a friend of Allah.”**

(b) Action: [2] marks

- The teachings of this Hadith can be implemented by Muslims today by earning an honest living and staying away from all sorts of corruption such as bribery, gambling, usury etc.
- Self-sufficiency is good for individual and society. Living within one's means and being grateful to God for His provision is the way to act upon the Hadith.
- All the Prophets earned their living by hard work and many of them worked as shepherds.
- Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) never looked down on any job. When he arrived in Madina as its leader he worked on the construction of the mosque. During the battle of Khandaq he participated in the digging the trench. Seeing him do same number of shifts as every other man encouraged the Muslims to redouble their efforts. This action of the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) is a lesson to Muslims today, not to look down on any honest effort and by showing respect to honest and hardworking people especially the poor, for example the domestic staff at school, guards, drivers etc

10. السَّاعِي عَلَى الْأَرْمَلَةِ وَالْمِسْكِينِ كَالْمُجَاهِدِ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ، أَوْ الْقَائِمِ اللَّيْلَ الصَّائِمِ النَّهَارَ.

One who manages the affairs of the widow and the poor man is like the one who exerts himself in the way of Allah, or the one who stands for prayer in the night or fasts in the day.

(a) Main teachings: [2] marks

- Caring for and fulfilling the needs of the less fortunate in society is compared to *worship* in this hadith and the reward for doing this are comparable to performing *jihad* in the way of God.
- This Hadith clearly explains the importance of human rights are as importance as rights of Allah. Islam is a religion promotes social justice and lays great stress on the welfare of the community at large.
- This Hadith encourages the believers to fulfill the needs of all those individuals who are vulnerable in society and would struggle without help. The two categories mention specifically in the Hadith is the widows and the poor but the teachings can be applied to all vulnerable people in the community.
- It also made clear that worship is not restricted to just prayers and fasting but cover every good deed. Helping these in need or distress is comparable to worshipping Allah. Believer who are mindful of the needs of other are said to be as if they were engaged in constant worship of Allah. The Holy

Prophet (P.B.U.H) once said to his wife, “O Aisha love the poor and let them come to you for help. Allah will then surely take you near Him on the day of Judgment”

(b) Action: [2] marks

- The way to fulfill the instructions given in the Hadith is to live one's life in the world with consciousness of the needs and plight of fellow beings.
- Allah wants believers to worship Him by not just fulfilling the obligations of prayers and fasting but also by being generous helpful and considerate towards His creations.
- Muslims should also constantly endeavour to better the society they live in. They can do this by providing resources for the poor by helping in the establishment of social housing for the homeless providing healthcare to those who do not have access to it and supporting the widows and orphans etc. so that no one is left behind and all get a fair chance in life.
- Even small tasks to assist another are considered as Ibadah in Islam and are rewarded. It has been said that Hazrat Abu bakr used to milk the goats of an old widow who lived at a distance from Madina to help her with her chores.

11. أَنَا وَكَافِلُ الْيَتِيمِ فِي الْجَنَّةِ هَكَذَا. وَقَالَ بِأَصْبَعَيْهِ السَّبَّابَةِ وَالْوُسْطَى.

'I and the man who brings up an orphan will be in paradise like this.' And he pointed with his two fingers, the index finger and the middle finger.

(a) Main Teachings (2 Marks)

- In this hadith Prophet (P.B.U.H) has promised a great reward to those who care for and look after orphans.
- Those Muslims who follow the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) recommendation of caring for orphans will find themselves close to him in paradise.
- Prophet (P.B.U.H) being an orphan himself, was not only sensitive to the plight of orphans but shows great sensitivity and continuously reminded his Ummah to take special care of them.
- Allah too has instructed Muslims to treat orphans with humility and kindness, **"Treat not the orphan with harshness."** (93:9). Orphans are the responsibility of the entire Muslim community and their care is a moral duty of all Muslims for which the Almighty will reward them.

(b) Action (2 marks)

- A Muslim can provide food, shelter, and financial assistance to orphans. If the orphan's father was in debt then the lender can exonerate that debt, or another Muslim can pay it off on behalf of the orphan.
- In the case of orphans where they have been left with an inheritance, their assets should be protected and returned to them when they attain maturity.
- When it comes to orphan girls, a Muslim should make arrangements for their marriages with best matching persons and should generously donate towards their dowries.
- Once the Prophet (P.B.U.H) found an orphan who was crying and he consoled him by asking, **"Would you not like Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) to be your father and Aisha to be your mother?"**

12. بَعَثَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ (صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ) أَبَا مُوسَى وَمُعَاذَ بْنَ جَبَلٍ إِلَى الْيَمَنِ، وَبَعَثَ كُلَّ وَاحِدٍ مِنْهُمَا عَلَى مِخْلَافٍ. ثُمَّ قَالَ: 'يَسْرًا وَلَا تُعْسِرُوا وَبَشِيرًا وَلَا تُنْفَرُوا.'

The Messenger of Allah (may Allah bless him and give him peace) sent Abu Musa and Mu'adh ibn Jabal to Yaman, and he sent each of them to govern a part. Then he said: 'Be gentle and do not be hard, and cause rejoicing and do not alienate.'

(a) Main Teachings: [2 marks]

- This Hadith specifically signifies the responsibilities of Muslim rulers. They should devote their energies to the general welfare and prosperity of their subjects.
- They should treat the people with kindness, gentleness, and justice to win their hearts.
- The Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) two emissaries to cooperate with the people they were sent to ruler over, and not to be dictators over them, and to govern with kindness.
- This Hadith carries the broader instruction to impart religious instruction to the people with gentleness so that they are more inclined towards the faith and gain religious knowledge. Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) said, **“The best rulers are those whom you love, and they love you.”**

(b) Action [2] marks

- All those in a position of authority should remember the ultimate authority lies with Allah alone and their governance should be treated as a trust from Him.
- Muslim governments, in particular, should always be fair in their actions and should base their authority on Islamic principles and kindness and tolerance of other faiths.
- Even when religious instruction is being given it should not be done in a manner where it becomes overwhelming for the individual.
- It has been reported that the man once complained to the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) that Muadh ibn Jabal recited long surahs in prayers which caused the plaintiff hardship as he did manual work all day and by night, he was tired. Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) then asked Muadh to recite short surahs when leading the prayers, and said to him thrice, **“O Muadh you are putting the people to trials.”**

13. **إِنَّمَا مَثَلُ صَاحِبِ الْقُرْآنِ كَمَثَلِ صَاحِبِ الْإِبِلِ الْمُعَقَّلَةِ: إِنْ عَاهَدَ عَلَيْهَا أَمْسَكَهَا، وَإِنْ أَطْلَقَهَا ذَهَبَتْ.**

He who studies the Qur'an is like the owner of tethered camels. If he attends to them he will keep hold of them, but if he lets them loose they will go away.

(a) Teaching [2 Marks]

- This Hadith emphasizes for Muslims the importance of reading the Quran and understanding its meanings.
- This book for guidance is the primary source of Islamic teachings and should never be neglected. In order to get true benefit from it, a Muslim required to establish a strong relationship with the Quran by reciting it, memorizing it, and above all understanding its teachings and living by them.
- The link with tethered camels has been made in this Hadith to show that just as the desert Bedouin tied the fore feet of his camel to stop it from straying, the Quran keeps Muslims from going astray.
- Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) said, **“Keep on reciting the Quran, for, by Him in whose hand my life is, the Quran runs away (is forgotten) faster than camels that are released from their tying ropes”**

(b) Action: [2] Marks

- To keep their faith strong and to stay on the path of righteousness, Muslims must continually keep the teachings of the Quran fresh in their mind by reading a small portion of it every day, and by understanding its teachings and putting them into practice.
- The Quran by daily reading keeps Muslims from losing their bearings and benefits them in their daily lives, bringing them abundant blessing and spiritual development.
- Prophet pbuh used to recite the Quran every year during the month of Ramadan. He also encouraged his companions for learning and teaching the Quran.
- In the month of Ramadan Tarawih prayers should be performed for the recitation of Quran . Regular recitation of Quran keeps one close to Allah, as the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) said, **“Allah does not listen so attentively, as He listens to the recitation of the holy Quran.”**

14. رَحِمَ اللَّهُ رَجُلًا سَمَحًا إِذَا بَاعَ، وَإِذَا اشْتَرَى، وَإِذَا اقْتَضَى.

May God show mercy to a man who is kindly when he sells, when he buys, and when he demands his money back.

(a) Teachings 2 marks

- This hadith teaches us manners of conduct in business transactions. This Hadith clearly shows that Allah wants His servants to act kindly and show mercy in all aspects of their life, including all business and financial dealings.
- The teaching of the Hadith focuses on principles under which trade i.e. buying and selling, should be conducted.
- The guidance this Hadith gives is that honesty, fairness, and kindness should be the guiding principles of every business transaction. The Quran too gives clear instruction to Muslims on how trade should be conducted: **"Give full measure when you measure and weight with a balance that is straight."** (17:35).
- Mercy shown to fellow beings is rewarded by Allah Himself. Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) supplicated for the welfare of the one who was considerate and sympathetic towards the borrower, and who carried out his dealings with justice and fairness.

(b) Action: [2] Marks

- Conducting all trade and financial dealings fairly and honestly, showing respite to a debtor when asking for one's money back, ensuring that there's no delay in the repayment of debts and not selling substandard products not keeping unfair margins of profit, and conducting legitimate business are some of the ways in which a Muslim can put into practice the teachings of this Hadith.
- Good conduct is incumbent on Muslim in all walks of life as well in trade and financial dealings. As Allah looks favorably upon those who conduct their affairs honestly and show respite to others when they need it.
- Prophet pbuh was very honest and truthful, and dedicated while trading he would not hide defects of trade articles. Prophet Muhammad conducted business in Syria with such prudence and sense of duty that he returned from the trade expedition with an amount of profit larger than usual. Hazrat Khadija married him due to his honesty and trustworthiness.
It is said about Hazrat Usman that he used give more in measure and weights when selling commodities, and even paid more than the asking price of the commodity he bought, saying that Allah not only fulfilled his needs but gave him more than he needed.

15. لَا يَرْحَمُ اللَّهُ مَنْ لَا يَرْحَمُ النَّاسَ.

God will not show mercy to him who does not show mercy to others.

(a) Main teaching: [2] marks

- Rahman and Raheem, the most merciful and the most beneficent are, amongst others, two of the most quoted attributes of Allah. The first example of His mercy was forgiving the sin of Hazrat Adam and his wife.
- The teaching of this hadith for Muslims is to develop the traits of kindness and mercy in their personalities, to show compassion to all living things in this world, and to forgive the mistakes of others and overlook their minor faults. Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **"He who is devoid of mercy is devoid of all good."**
- The rights of fellow Muslims have been stressed upon by both Allah and His Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H). A Muslim's treatment by Allah depends on how he treats others.

- Allah will reward Muslims for Showing compassion and mercy to His creation. That those who do not practice mercy simply deprive themselves of Allah's mercy is the clear teaching given by the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H).

(b) Action: [2] Marks

- Muslims can practise the teaching of this Hadith in their daily lives by doing small acts of kindness every day. Helping a blind man cross the road, feeding a hungry person, giving directions to a traveller, forgiving the mistake of a fellow being are all examples of how mercy can be practised..
- All Muslims are part of one community and should profess brotherhood towards each other and all humankind, which will be looked upon favorably by Allah.
- The Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) showed mercy even to his enemies; when the believers asked him to curse the people of Tai'f, he instead prayed for them that one day they might accept Islam as their faith. Yet another example of his mercy is that at the conquest of Makkah, he issued a general pardon to all those who had persecuted and tortured him and the Muslims for ten years.
- Keeping these examples in mind, it becomes incumbent on Muslims to follow the Sunnah of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) and show forgiveness to those who wrong them.

16. **الْمُؤْمِنُونَ كَرَجُلٍ وَاحِدٍ، إِنْ اِسْتَكَى عَيْنُهُ اِسْتَكَى كُلُّهُ، وَإِنْ اِسْتَكَى رَأْسُهُ اِسْتَكَى كُلُّهُ.**

The believers are like a single man; if his eye is affected he is affected, and if his head is affected he is all affected.

(a) Main Teachings (2 Marks)

- This Hadith of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) focuses on the concepts of brotherhood in Islam. It teaches Muslims about community relations and how they should behave towards other fellow believers.
- Muslims are joined in a fraternity by their common faith. Just as the head (brain) is the command center and vital to humans, brotherhood is essential to Muslims. Islam stands for universal brotherhood of all Muslims and wants to see them as a solid structure. The Quran calls upon the believers, it is essential that Muslims make peace when there is some dispute between them. The Quran says, **"And hold fast by the rope of Allah altogether and be not divided"**.
- Every Muslim's blood, property, and honour are sacred to their fellow Muslims; they should feel each other's pain and support each other in time of stress.

(b) Action [2] marks

- Muslims should always be aware of the sufferings of others around them, be it their friends, family, community, or other Muslims around the world.
- The best example of brotherhood was seen at the time of the Prophet's Muhammad (P.B.U.H) migration Makkah to Madina when the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) declared the Ansar and the Muhajireen as brothers. The Ansar were extremely generous to their brothers; not only were they willing to share their possessions with them but also accepted that the Muhajireen could inherit from them.
- Even today, when Muslims of one country or region are in distress or oppressed their pain is felt by the entire Ummah and it becomes obligatory to help them in whichever way they can.
- For example Muslims of Kashmir, Syria, Palestine and Iraq etc. Afghan Muhajireen who have fled wars in Afghanistan took refuge in Pakistan. Many Afghan born and raised in Pakistan and identify as Pakistanis and refer to Pakistan as their home. Afghan refugees in Pakistan are helped officially and by other aid agencies.

الْحَيَاءُ لَا يَأْتِي إِلَّا بِخَيْرٍ.

Modesty produces nothing but good.

(a) Main Teachings [2] marks

- Islam stresses the virtue of modesty as it is a principle that helps create a morally pious and respectful society. Modesty, in this context is both of body and mind.

- By being modest, a believer does not seek to promote his/her own positions or rights, but rather considered himself/herself as a part of a greater entity i.e. the society and the country and works towards creating a peaceful community.
- Modesty is also in terms of not being involved in anti-social and illegal acts, such as usurping other's rights. It is modesty that makes a person feel ashamed when he does something wrong. Hence, a person who has no modesty is not affected by people's reaction to whatever he/she may do.
- In a Muslims community people are always encouraged to be kind and generous morally and materially. The Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) made it a condition of faith. Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) said, **"Modesty and faith are both companions; when one of them is absent the other follow it "**

(b) Action [2] Marks

- Every religion have distinctive quality and the distinctive quality of Islam is modesty. In the absence of modesty no one can practice Islam correctly. Modesty, can be practiced by taking the moderate/middle path. A Muslim's speech, dress, manner, and attitude towards life should not be loud, extravagant, and ostentatious rather a Muslim must remain humble and simple.
- Prophet Muhammad was very modest and shy. He never spoke loudly or in an unseemingly manner. When he heard anything undesirable in the assembly; he did not say anything out of respect for the people, but the colour of his face showed his feelings and the companions would become cautious
- It could be said that concern for others springs from modesty and eliminates many social problems. Modesty is also a shield against immorality, lowering one's gaze in the presence of the opposite gender is an act of modesty, which helps to keep Muslims on the righteous path.
- A modest person is a humble person and by practicing modesty in one's daily life one acknowledges Allah as his Master and Creator and appreciates that everything one possesses is from Allah. This belief helps one to stay away from everything that displeases Allah.

18. لَا يَدْخُلُ النَّارَ أَحَدٌ فِي قَلْبِهِ مِثْقَالُ حَبَّةٍ مِنْ خَرْدَلٍ مِنْ إِيْمَانٍ، وَلَا يَدْخُلُ الْجَنَّةَ أَحَدٌ فِي قَلْبِهِ مِثْقَالُ حَبَّةٍ مِنْ خَرْدَلٍ مِنْ كِبَرٍ.

He who has in his heart as much faith as a grain of mustard seed will not enter hell, and he who has in his heart as much pride as a grain of mustard seed will not enter paradise.

(a) Main Teachings [2] Marks

- We learn from this hadith that faith is the basic requirement for salvation with God because it takes away God's wrath. We come to know that true faith develops a sense of humility and make us submissive to God's command.
- Pride is the worst attribute of a man; arrogance means rejecting the truth and looking down on people.
- Anyone that Allah has blessed with beauty, wealth, authority, or even piety should remain humble to Him and thank Him for His gifts, and not be proud as pride and arrogance are linked with Shaytan (Iblis) and it was for this sin he was expelled from paradise.
- A Hadith of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) says, **"Allah, the most high, says, pride is My cloak and greatness My robe, and who competes with Me in respect of either, I shall cast him into hellfire"**

(b) Action [2] Marks

- A Muslim must remain firm in his faith, and should stay free from any kind of arrogance. Muslims should actively resist giving place to pride in their hearts and should follow the example of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) who never placed himself on a pedestal.
- He remained an example of humanity when he was granted prophethood, when he became the leader of Madina, and even after the Conquest of Makkah.
- The Holy Quran also informs us that Iblis refused to obey the command of Allah to bow before Adam, because of his pride and was thus thrown out of heaven. The Quran says, **"He(satan) refused (to obey) and was arrogant. He was of those who reject."**
- Thus Muslims should be watchful and make sure that there is no place in their hearts or minds for pride and arrogance no matter how much success, wealth and popularity they achieve in this world.

The world is the believer's prison and the unbeliever's paradise.

(a) Main Teachings [2] Marks

This saying of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) instructs Muslims that in this world have to live their lives according to Allah's law and thereby, follow the limitations imposed by Islam as to what is permissible and what is not. The teachings of this Hadith is that disbelievers may be granted by Allah all that they desire in this world, but may get nothing in the Hereafter. They may be compensated for their good deeds and be given the opportunity to enjoy this world fully but may get nothing beyond that. A believer on the other hand may or may not be blessed with much in this world but even on the lowest level of Paradise will be granted all that his/her heart desires.

It is to gain this reward that, just as a prisoner does not make the prison his home, the believer never sees this world as his home, but as a temporary dwelling full of trials until he reaches his final destination in Jannah. Prophet Muhammad said, **"This world is cultivating ground for hereafter."**

(b) Action [2] Marks

By following the path, prescribed by Allah and being mindful of the attractions of this world, Muslims can live a life that will lead them to paradise. The Quraish in order to dissuade Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) from his mission had offered him great wealth, marriage to the most beautiful woman in the land, and were even ready to practice his faith if he would follow theirs, but he refused it all. He continued to follow the path prescribed Allah and to preach the message of Tauheed, the Oneness of Allah. Muslim must follow Prophet's example by practicing honesty and by rejecting all types of temptations and bribes. Acquisition of wealth and worldly possessions should not be the main aim of their lives rather they should strive for the eternal rewards of the Hereafter. The Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) said, **"Live in this world as if you were a stranger or a wayfarer."** A passerby or wayfarer does not make strange place his/her home as the real destination is a better place Paradise.

إِنَّ اللَّهَ لَا يَنْظُرُ إِلَى صُورِكُمْ وَلَا أَمْوَالِكُمْ، وَلَكِنْ يَنْظُرُ إِلَى قُلُوبِكُمْ وَأَعْمَالِكُمْ.

God does not look at your forms and your possessions, but he looks at your hearts and your deeds.

Main Teachings: [2] Marks

In this Hadith the Muslims are told that Allah does not look at the worldly status of His servants, if they are powerful or weak, nor at their looks or lineage and neither does He consider their wealth and position. The Only connection between Allah and His servant is through righteousness; A true believer will therefore, never be proud of his wealth, beauty, children etc. An important understanding to be taken from the second part of the Hadith **'but he looks at your hearts and deeds'** is that firstly, if one happens to be righteous and has taqwa then this too is blessing from Allah for which one need to be thankful to Him.

Secondly, all acts without sincerity are meaningless. Hence, it must be remembered that Allah will reward deeds based on what is in the heart, and, on Day of Judgment, the hidden intentions will be judged along with the outwards deeds. The Prophet said, **"Every action is based on the intention (behind it) and everyone shall have what he intended."**

(b) Action [2] Marks

Purity of heart and good intentions should be the basis of every action that Muslim undertakes. A Muslim's actions must be based on seeking Allah's pleasure, therefore, when charity is given it is not the amount that is all important but the gesture and intention behind it. Yet another example that can be given here could be the appointment of Hazrat Bilal as the first muezzin of Islam. He was given this high status because of his strong faith and love of religion, and not on any other account. In today's world too, a Muslim's actions must be based on sincerity and the believer must not engage in false praise or flattery of those in government or other influential people for the sake of gaining privileges or concessions.

Themes of Hadith

M/J 2012

2 (a) According to the teachings of the set Hadiths you have studied, outline the ways in which Muslims should treat one another. [10]

O/N 2014

2 (a) Outline the main teachings of the set Hadiths about the conduct of Muslims in communal life. [10]

O/N 2016

2 (a) Giving references from the set Hadiths you have studied, outline the Prophet's teachings about care in the community. [10]

O/N 2017

2(a) Write an account of how the Hadiths of the Prophet stress upon the unity of the Islamic community. Use at least four set Hadiths from the syllabus to develop your answer. [10]

Marking scheme:

From the set hadiths in the syllabus there are many that focus on the care that a Muslim must show in the community towards others and especially the vulnerable people in the community, like widows and orphans etc. Candidates need to refer to relevant hadiths e.g. hadiths 2, 3, 5, 6, 11, 15 etc. that they have studied from the syllabus and reflect on the general principles deduced from them about relationship with others and communal life.

Answer: [Learn and write]

The Prophet pbuh described the **Umma**, the Muslim community as being like

'a single body-if his eye is affected he is affected, and if his head is affected he is all affected.'

This shows that the community has to be supportive of itself, and that if there is problem in one part of it, this will be felt throughout the rest. It means that the individual Muslim has to keep the interests of the community central, and is not to be too focused on his own wants and needs.

The Ahadith of the Prophet shed a lot of light on the importance of Muslim community life. The first Islamic community was knitted in such a way that these teachings were inculcated in the core of social structure.

The prophet pbuh also instructed us to show concern for others and to safeguard others from the mischief of our tongues and hands. On one occasion he said, ***"None of you truly believes until he desires for his brother what he desires for himself."***

It teaches us that we must behave towards our fellow Muslims in the same way in that we behave towards ourselves. Because it is only by acting sincerely towards others we prove that we are true believers

Similarly, Prophet (pbuh) emphasized on showing concern for others and on helping them by all possible means and declared it as charity (sadaqah).

"Every person's every joint must perform a charity every day the sun comes up; to act justly between two people is a charity, to help a man with his mount, lifting him onto it or hoisting up his belongings onto it is a charity; every step you take to prayers is a charity; and removing a harmful thing from the road is a charity."

So Muslims are required to play a positive role as a part of the community by helping others and by settling their disputes.

Prophet pbuh also said, ***“Whosoever of you sees an evil action, let him change it with his hand, and if he is not able to do so then with his tongue, and if he is not able to do so then with his heart, and that is the weakest of faith.”***

In this hadith the Prophet pbuh emphasized upon forbidding the community from digressing from the path of Allah. He prescribed upon all Muslims to stop evil actions by all possible means.

A sense of responsibility and provision of justice is embedded into the minds of the Muslims as they follow the doctrines of Islam. *“The Messenger of Allah (may Allah bless him and give him peace) sent Abu Musa and Mu’adh ibn Jabal to Yaman, and he sent each of them to govern a part. Then he said: ‘Be gentle and do not be hard, and cause rejoicing and do not alienate.’”*

The Prophet pbuh also taught Muslims to show mercy to others and stop from usurping the rights of others. He said,

“God will not show mercy to him who does not show mercy to others.”

This shows that in Islamic community life, Muslims think out of their selves and care about other Muslims. Therefore, a good Muslim is the one who fulfils the social duties.

O/N 2011

2 (a) Outline the main teachings of the Hadiths you have studied, from the passages set for special study, about the responsibilities of individual Muslims. [10]

O/N 2019

2 (a) From the set Hadiths you have studied outline the Prophet’s teachings on the individual conduct of Muslims. [10]

Marking Scheme

Some of the Hadiths that candidates can refer to are Hadiths 1,4,6, 7,8,9,13 etc. which refer to the obligations of a Muslim concerning the observance of the Pillars of Islam, of how to deal with evil when confronted with it, of striving in the way of God, the dignity of labour and the importance of work etc.

Good answers will quote and describe the Hadiths.

Answer: (Learn and write)

The Prophet’s pbuh character is a perfect role model for all Muslims in their individual and personal conduct.

His ahadith give us teachings about our responsibilities as individuals

In the first place he teaches us to be sincere in our beliefs and practices.

The Prophet pbuh said,

“Religion is sincerity.’ We said: ‘To whom?’ The Prophet said: ‘To Allah, his Book, his Messenger, the leaders of the Muslims and to their common people.”

Here, he taught us that the belief in the basic doctrines of Islam goes hand in hand with good community life. Being sincere to the rulers and to be of gentle nature to each other is as important as belief in Allah, Quran and Prophet pbuh.

The Prophet pbuh said, ***“He who studies the Quran is like the owner of tethered camels, if he attends to them he will keep hold of them, but if he lets them loose they will go away.”***

This means that we must put Allah before everything else that we do and we must recite the Holy Quran regularly in order to implement its teachings in our lives. If we do this, we will be able to fulfill all the main requirements of Islam.

Modesty is an important feature of Islam as it plays a vital role in character building. It holds a key to piety and good deeds. Faith and modesty are so closely related to each other that either both will be present in an individual and community or none of the two would be present. Modesty has been particularly stressed upon as part of faith because it reflects a state of mental piety. Therefore, Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **“Modesty produces nothing but good”**

Prophet (P.B.U.H) emphasized upon individual Muslims to perform obligatory acts of worship i.e salat and fasting, and to live their lives following Islamic values in order to attain God’s pleasure and enter paradise. **“A man asked the messenger of Allah: do you think that if I perform the obligatory prayers, fast in Ramdan, treat as lawful that which is lawful and treat as forbidden that which is forbidden and do not anything further. I shall enter paradise”** The Prophet (P.B.U.H) said **“yes”**

Prophet’s ahadith also contain teachings about taking our responsibility ourselves. He also taught us about generosity and hospitality. His teachings encourage us to spend our wealth on the poor and the needy and to exert ourselves in the way of Allah. He also emphasizes upon hard work and earning by lawful means. He is reported to have said, **“No one eats better food than that which he eats out of the work of his own hand.”** It means that we should become self-sufficient and should not depend upon others unnecessarily.

The Prophet pbuh also forbade his followers from being materialistic or self-centered. Instead he told them to remember and to strive for the eternal rewards of hereafter. He said, **“The world is a believer’s prison and a non-believer’s paradise.”**

It teaches us that a true believer always takes this worldly life as a time of trial and therefore does not indulge in this world too much.

In this way Prophet’s (pbuh) ahadith give us guidance about our individual conduct and help us to become good Muslims.

The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was not merely a Messenger of Allah, he was also a guide and teacher. The life of Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) is an example for Muslims to follow in every sphere of life. He provided teachings regarding every aspect of their community as well as individual life.

Challenging Question:

M/J 2013(42)

2 (a) From the set Hadiths outline the Prophet’s teachings about the conduct of the individual in the community. [10]

Marking Scheme:

There is scope in this answer for candidates to refer to Hadiths from both the themes; individual conduct and life in the community. Marks should be given where there are clear references to relevant Hadiths and where some attempt has been made to understand and express the teachings of Hadiths about the conduct of the individual in the community.

Good answers will quote and describe Hadiths and say how the Prophet’s teachings give Muslims the knowledge of how to deal with others with care and humanity, how they tell a Muslim about the right way of dealing with widows, orphans and the vulnerable in life, the importance of earning an honest living through the work of one’s own hands etc. Answers that show clear knowledge of the teachings of the Prophet are the ones that will get to the top levels.

Themes of Quran

Allah in Himself

The passages set for special study which represent the fundamental Quranic theme of 'God in Himself', give us the perfect knowledge about God's personality, Oneness and attributes. In the first place these passages shed light on the concept of Tawhid. It is the first and the main principle of Islamic faith. It means that Allah is the Supreme Being, Creator, Sustainer and Master of the Universe.

Surah Baqarah (2:255) also known as the Verse of Throne (**Ayat al Kursi**) clearly mentions Tauhid (Oneness of God) **"Allah, there is no god but He the Living, the self-subsisting, Eternal."**

It tells us that Allah is a personality but His nature is sublime and far beyond our limited conception. He is the ultimate reality and free from all limitations of time and space. **"No slumber can seize him nor sleep..."**

Throne (Kursi) is a symbol of authority. This tells us that He is the King ruling over all that exists. In everything is the working of God's power, will and authority. **Quran says: "then He established himself on the throne" (10:3, 13:2)**

Surah Anaam 6. 101-103

These verses of surah Anaam speak of the absolute unity and Authority of Allah over the entire universe, being the only Creator and Protector of everything. Therefore, He alone is to be worshipped. Allah creates on His own without any help which shows that not only the Creation, but the plan and means of creation are all on account of His Will. Quran says **"To Him is due primal origin of the heavens and the earth."** Since everything is creation of Allah, the question of His having a son does not arise. Allah, unlike humans, is free from all human attributes and far superior to be in need to have children or spouse. As mentioned in surah Ikhlas,

"He does not beget nor is He begotten" It further states that human vision does not comprehend Him, but He comprehends everything of the universe and nothing remains hidden from Him. Nothing is conceived from Him. He watches us all the time and knows our intentions, Ayat ul kursi States, **"He knows what is before or after or behind them"** Allah's nature is so subtle and far beyond our limited conception so as to be invisible to the physical eye and to be imperceptible to the senses. His presence can only be felt through the manifestation of His creation and His total control over it

Surah Fussilat 41.37

This passage speaks of the cosmic sign of the universe as the great signs of Allah's lordship, authority, wisdom and power. These signs are not to be worshipped. Instead, by pondering over them one can understand the reality of Allah's Greatness and creative power. People have repeatedly been told in the Quran that natural objects on earth and sky are creation of Allah with no power or authority. Night and day are not conflicting power but are both creations of Allah. Allah is the sole cause and the source of all that exists and whatever exists is a sign of His creative power. The objectives in this verse is to express the glory of Allah and His exclusive worthiness for worship in the minds of the human beings. This verse invites people to look over the wondrous creation of Allah and believe in Him. Quran says, **"Behold! In the creation of the heavens and earth and the alternation of night and day there are indeed signs for men of understanding"**

The cycle of the night and day clearly points to the fact that sun and moon are not the objects of divine power, but are helpless and powerless objects. They are moving according to the law of Almighty Allah. So Allah alone should be worshipped and not the things which he has created which are actually subservient to His commands. Thus these passage reflect that Allah is unique in His attributes and power. He alone is worthy of worship and praise

Surah ash Shura 42. 4-5

This passage highlights Allah's total authority and ownership. All that is in the heaven and on the earth is the exclusive property of Allah and He has full authority and controls to deal with it in any manner He wants. He is the Master and Owner of the earth and heavens and everything contained in them, in any form whatsoever, and no one else has any part or share in His ownership, His attributes and His Power. It is said in Quran **"His are all things in the heavens and on earth"** Allah's glory and praise is so majestic that even the magnificent heavens tremble before His Might and Splendour above them and are almost ready to burst asunder by His glory. The angels, who are noble and pure beings, celebrate the glory of Allah. They look after the safety of all beings on earth and pray to Allah for their forgiveness. They reflect on one side on Allah's glory and praise and on the other, to His forgiveness and mercy.

As all humans beings are weak and are liable to err and sin, Allah has willed upon Himself the law of grace and mercy. Allah is forgiving and Merciful is clear from the fact that people persist in transgressing His commands and rejecting His message, yet He mercifully goes on giving them respite so that they may realize their mistakes and come to the right path. The Quran says, **"He has inscribed for Himself (the rule of) Mercy"**

Surah Ikhlas 112

The name of this sura is Ikhlas meaning "Purity of faith" which is core matter because faith in the absolute unity of Allah is the foundation of Islam. Allah is one, without any hint of plurality, He has no one to share in His lordship, neither in His essence or His attributes. He is the only one to whom worship is due, all other things or beings are His creatures and in no way resemble Him are comparable to Him in rank, attributes work or power. The Quran says, **"And your God is one God."** Allah is Eternal and Immortal without beginning or end, not limited by time or place or circumstances. He is absolute, no sustained or dependent on any other person or thing whereas all others are dependent on Him for beginning as well as their continued existence.

This sura negates the concept of polytheism and destroys all assumptions of family relations of Allah when it is said **"He begets not nor is He begotten."** And there remains no room for confusion in this regard. The Quran says, **"No son did Allah beget, nor is there any god along with Him."**

The fact that Allah is matchless and unique in every respect beyond the range of human imagination explains why any attempt at depicting Him by means of figures or symbols must be denial of truth. The Quran says **"He said: O my People! Worship Allah! You have no other god but Him"**

2(b) In your opinion, why should Muslims try to understand God's attributes? Give reason(s) for your answer. [4]

It is extremely important for Muslims to understand God's personality and attributes because now a days many Muslims are becoming detached from God. Learning about God's attributes allows them to have an understanding of Him which increases their understanding of the world around them, or their faith, etc. Because God is beyond humankind's knowledge/perception, understanding Him through what He says about Himself in the Qur'an allows humans to know why God is important to them in their lives.

God's relationship with Created world

The Holy Quran is replete with descriptions of Allah's relationship with the created world. These passages are about God's relationship with creation, but each talk about that relationship in a distinctive way. They all allow humankind to see the link between them and God. It is not just about God giving human beings things for their sustenance, but humans need to give thanks in return and live their life remembering Him, which can be done in different ways.

- **Surah al Fatiha(1)** mentions God as the creator and controller of all that is in the heavens and the earth. He is the most compassionate and forgiving and only He can guide humans to the path of His obedience. He deserves all praise and worship that can be done in many ways, prayer, following the sunnah, making dua, etc. **"Praise be to Allah, the Cherisher and Sustainer of the Worlds."** This surah also emphasizes upon worshipping God alone and to turn to Him for help and guidance. Asking for

help is important which is why this is used as a prayer. It says “**You alone we worship and your aid we seek.**”

- verses of **Surah al Baqarah[2:21-22]** mention God as the Cherisher and Sustainer of all that exists. These verses speak of God’s favours upon us for our sustenance which includes the creation of man himself, heavens and the earth, rain and growth of fruits. It says “**Who has made the earth your couch and heavens your canopy; and sent down rain from the heavens.....**”. They should therefore look after their environment and protect the things that God has provided for them. It also reminds Muslims of their duty to worship God alone and to avoid shirk, which is the greatest sin in Islam. God wants humans to acknowledge that He is the one who provides them with this, and not anyone else, and so they should not seek to praise others for what they have been given by God. It says “**Then do not set up rivals with Allah when you know.**”
- **Surah Al Alaq (96:1-5)** shows the link between humankind and God by emphasizing the creation of humans, and that He then gave knowledge to humans, the tool for their learning. They in return should seek knowledge by reading and writing whenever they can as well as teaching it.

“**Read in the name of your Lord and Cherisher, who created.**”(96:1). This passage also dignifies God as the greatest teacher who teaches all forms of knowledge to mankind and made them superior over all other creatures. “**He, who taught by the pen, taught man what he did not know.**”

- **Surah al Zilzaal (99)** tells us about God as the master of the Day of Judgement. It tells us that everything in the system of the universe is subservient to God, as on the Day of Judgement the earth will start shaking in obedience to His command. This shows that the earth is created for humankind’s benefit and that they will be judged at the end of time according to how they lived their lives on it. “**Then shall anyone who has done an atom’s weight of good, see it and anyone who has done an atom’s weight of evil shall see it.**”

That could be related to how well they followed God and His Messenger (pbuh), how they fulfilled their obligations, or how they looked after the earth which was created for their benefit. They have a responsibility for their actions, so although God provides for humans, they have to do good to show God that they are grateful

- **Surah Naas (114)** speaks of God as the safest refuge from all kinds of evil because He is the most powerful. “**Say! I seek refuge with the Lord of mankind.**”

It warns humans against secret whispers of evil by Satan within their hearts, who whisper evil/bad ideas to humans, and then disappear and leave them on their own. “**From the mischief of the whisperer who withdraws.**”

Since God is all powerful and provider of all necessities and protection therefore, only **he can protect Muslims** from all evils especially the internal ones i.e Satan and jinns. “**From jinn and from mankind**” It is one of the surahs of protections.

God’s Messengers

Adam (2.30–37): Adam was the first human to be created by God. God had told the angels He would place a representative on earth, and the angels asked why, if he will only make mischief unlike the angels who only glorify God. When God spoke to Adam, he gave him knowledge about Himself through the things he was taught the names of, and the lessons he learnt in obedience to God. God gives knowledge to whom He wills. “**And He taught Adam the names of all things.**” It shows the superiority of humans over angels due to what they know, and so it stresses the importance of gaining knowledge. God also told Adam that he and his wife should live in the Garden but they were not to touch a specific tree. “**But do not approach this tree, or you will run into harm and transgression.**” Satan, who was jealous of Adam and had refused to bow to him, came to tempt Adam and his wife into eating from the tree. He is from the mischief makers who whisper evil into the minds/hearts of humans. God sent Adam and his wife to live on earth. Adam realised his mistake and through this event turned to God for forgiveness. And God, because He is the most merciful, turned towards Adam, meaning He

forgave Him. . Through these events Adam learnt about God's creation, His Knowledge and His forgiveness.

This passage tells Muslims about the favours God gives his prophets. He gives them knowledge for guidance, and He forgives when people turn to Him in repentance.

Ibrahim (6:75-79) was a native of Mesopotamia, presently southern Iraq. He lived amongst the idolaters. His father Azar was an idol maker. Most of the people of his time worshiped the sun, the moon, and the stars and prayed to them. He was given knowledge of God through the law and order of the heavens and the earth. One night he went out in search of God to the mountains. He looked to the stars and the moon and the sun, which people at his time worshipped. God inspired him to realise that the things in creation that do not last cannot be the things to be worshipped as God does not change.

"Unless my Lord guides me, I will surely be of those who go astray."

Ibrahim was gifted with exceptional wisdom Through which he understood the concept of Oneness of God despite he was born in the people who were polytheists. It describes the stages of Ibrahim's spiritual enlightenment until he declared the unity of Allah to his people and forbade them from associating partners with Allah (shirk). **"And never shall I give partners to Allah."**

Through these events he turned himself to believe in God and did not associate partners with Him. God showed Ibrahim His Unity, and His control over creation.

"How should I fear (the beings) you associate with Allah when you fear not to give partners to Allah.." (6:81)

It also show that all the Messengers conveyed the same message of oneness of Allah (Tauheed)

Jesus (5.110) was the son of Maryam (Mary). His birth was a Miracle. He was born to Maryam without a father by Allah's command. He spoke as an infant and defended his mother. He was given special miracles which helped him understand God's personality and His ultimate power. God asked Jesus to recount the blessings that God had given him and his mother (Maryam), showing that God gives his prophets favours to help them in their lives. God then gives a list of the things He has given Jesus, and the benefits of those favours: He was given the holy spirit which allowed him to speak to the people as a child and when he was older. He was also taught the Law and the Gospel to teach the people how to live their lives in accordance to God's laws. He was also able to give life to the dead and heal the sick, by the will of God. **"And you heal those born blind, and the lepers by my leave ,and behold you bring forth the dead by my leave." (5 :110)**

He also protected Jesus from the unbelievers who accused Jesus of magic and did not believe His powers were a sign of God's majesty. **"That they said (in boast) "We killed Christ Jesus the son of Mary the Apostle of Allah;" But they killed him not, nor crucified him but so Allah raised him up unto Himself; and Allah is Exalted in Power, Wise."** This all showed Jesus the favours he was given by God which allowed him to believe in Him and follow Him.

The Prophet Muhammad faced hardships like the other prophets, but God reminds him that He gave him blessings in this life and the next.

God revealed **Surah Kauthar(108)** to console and give hope to the Prophet (P.B.U.H) under the increasing difficulties in Makkah by promising that he would be given abundant blessings in this worldly life and in the hereafter. **"To you have we granted abundance"**. It is interpreted as fountain in heaven, his spiritual progeny (Muslims) and his daughter Fatima, who gave him two grandsons Hassan and Hussain. Prophet (P.B.U.H) was instructed to remain loyal to his faith by continuing to live as God taught him. **"So pray to your Lord and sacrifice"**. It also warned that it would not be the Prophet (P.B.U.H) but his enemies that would be cut off. **"He who hates you, he will be cut off"**.

Surah Duha (93) reassured him that **"your lord has not forsaken you, nor is He displeased"**. It also gave him the glad tiding of successful future life by saying, **"and the hereafter will be better for you than the present ."** which reffered to his successful future life in Madina. It reminded the prophet (pbuh) of God's support for him throughout his life **"did he not find you an orphan and give you shelter ; And he found you wondering and he gave you guidance ; And he found you in need and he made you independent"**

After the revelation of these surah the Prophet (P.B.U.H) continued his mission with renewed hope, strength and devotion.

In this way these passages of Quran strengthen our belief in all the messengers which is an article of faith in Islam. They also show God's special concern for his chosen people and how they were helped throughout their lives.

2(b) In your opinion, why should Muslims try to understand God's attributes? Give reason(s) for your answer. [4]

It is extremely important for Muslims to understand God's personality and attributes because now a days many Muslims are becoming detached from God. Learning about God's attributes allows them to have an understanding of Him which increases their understanding of the world around them, or their faith, etc.

Because God is beyond humankind's knowledge/perception, understanding Him through what He says about Himself in the Qur'an allows humans to know why God is important to them in their lives.

2. (b) As God's "representative (khalifa) on Earth" say how men and women can serve God, giving examples.[4]

Muslims can serve God on earth by understanding and fulfilling their obligation to Him, primarily through praying and fulfilling the five pillars, and by not disobeying His commands.

They should be grateful to Him for what He has given them, food, shelter, clothing, and thank Him. This can be done by praying, reciting Qur'an, being generous to others, helping those in need, e.g. by feeding the poor, giving gifts and charity.

They should also look after the provisions God has given them, whether it be the food and the environment it grows in, the knowledge He gives for guidance or the people who are in a person's life for their help and wellbeing, e.g. by not wasting food or eating too much, by learning something and teaching others, by respecting teachers and colleagues.

2(b) 'God gave humankind guidance and teachings.' Why does the Qur'an lay emphasis on the need to gain knowledge? [4]

Having given guidance (through the Qur'an and sunnah, etc.), God wants knowledge to be used to learn about life and to live lives in a good way. Without learning, humans would not know about their rights and responsibilities or about their potential as human beings.

In order to respond to what God wants or what is of benefit to themselves or others, they have to learn how to respond. God is full of mercy and love, He is guiding people so they benefit in this life and in the next. The most beneficial knowledge would be that which helps a person fulfil their rights towards God, fellow humans, and to develop themselves.

• 2(b) 'Undergoing hardships brings a person closer to God.' Agree or disagree with this statement, giving reasons for your answer. [4]

• Candidates could agree and say, e.g. that all prophets were tested which allowed them to get closer to God, likewise humankind now can get closer to their Lord through their hardships, as long as they reflect and understand that God is testing them. Also, by remaining patient and steadfast, and not leaving their worship, they will gain rewards and understanding. Prophets were tested and remained steadfast, so Muslims should also expect to be tested and they should also remain steadfast.

• They could say they don't agree, e.g. because not everyone goes through the same hardships, that people are different so they may react differently to hardships so they may not necessarily know they are being tested, but remaining true to prayer, fasting and the Five Pillars is more important and more likely to get a person closer to God.

2(b) How might Muslims use the Qur'an to have a closer connection with God?[4]

- the Qur'an is the word of God, so it gives Muslims a connection to God.
- It contains guidance from God, so it lets them know what God wants and expects from them.
- There is a communication with God through the Qur'an, whether it is through reciting it or using certain passages as supplications.
- Reading it, memorising it, teaching it to others all have benefits and may allow Muslims to increase their connection to God.

- **2.(b) 'The Qur'an teaches that humans should be responsible towards the environment.' Give reasons to agree or disagree with this statement. [4]**
- Agree with the statement.
- God has made various things for the benefit of humans – the earth, the rain/water, food and drink, and that the earth will have a voice to say what humans have done whilst living on it. This will be their good deeds and bad deeds, but also how they have looked after all these provisions. Humans are therefore not just encouraged to pray and fast and worship God, but also to do good actions, including those relating to looking after the soil from which their crops grow, the water which helps them grow, etc

10. Sura 114

قُلْ أَعُوذُ بِرَبِّ النَّاسِ، مَلِكِ النَّاسِ، إِلَهِ النَّاسِ،
 مِنْ شَرِّ الْوَسْوَاسِ الْخَنَّاسِ
 الَّذِي يُوَسْوِسُ فِي صُدُورِ النَّاسِ
 مِنَ الْجِنَّةِ وَالنَّاسِ

1. Say: I seek refuge with the Lord of mankind, 2. The King of mankind, 3. The God of Mankind, 4. From the mischief of the whisperer who withdraws, 5. Who whispers into the hearts of mankind, 6. Among jinns and among mankind.

(a) Main Theme: [2] marks

- Surah Naas, a makkan surah, concludes the Quran. It describes the theme of God's relationship with the created world. This surah was also revealed with Surah Falaq in Madina to protect the Prophet (pbuh) from the evil effects of black magic.
- This *Surah* describes three Attributes of Allah *the All-Mighty*. He gives sustenance to mankind, He is Sovereign and He is Worthy of worship. All things are created by Him, possessed by Him, and subservient to Him.
- It warns Muslims against secret whispers of evil by Satan within their hearts, who whispers evil/bad ideas to humans, and then disappears and leave them on their own.
- Since God is all powerful and provider of all necessities and protection therefore, only **He can protect human beings** from all evils especially the internal ones i.e Satan and jinns. It is one of the surahs of protections(quls').
- Allah created everything so controls everything, even mischief makers. **The refuge must be sought with Allah** from all evils, Satan, jinns and men. Quran says, **"If suggestion from Satan assails your mind, seek refuge with Allah."**

(b) Importance: [2] Marks

- Through these verses Muslims get to know **the kind of evils/mischief** they have to be wary of. This means they should be aware of what is happening to them so they can recognise the signs of mischief. Praying and doing good deeds strengthens reliance on God.
- Prophet Muhammad (PBUH) used these 2 Surahs (Falaq and Naas) as a means of shield from Jinns and to ward off the attacks and effects of evil eye or black magic. Hence, a Muslim should get into the habit of reciting this chapter every day.
- God is the King so it is Him who people should seek refuge with and **should not look to others** for refuge as it leads to Shirk.
- Evil leads humans astray when they fall victim to satanic guiles. So as long as they put themselves in **God's protection** and have trust in Him evil cannot really affect them.

Articles of Faith

Tauheed, the belief in Oneness of Allah

M/J 2013

4 (a) Outline the Muslim teaching about the belief in the oneness of God (tawhid). [10]

M/J 2016

5 (a) Muslims believe that God alone is Lord, that He alone should be worshipped and that His names and attributes are unique to Him. Outline Muslim beliefs in the oneness of God. [10]

- It is mentioned in the Imaan-e-Mufasssal, which is: **"I believe in Allah, in His angels, in His books, in His messengers, in the last day and in the fact that everything good or bad is decided by Allah, the Almighty, and in life after death".**

It is an article of faith without which a Muslim's faith is incomplete.

At the heart of Islam lies belief in Allah as the only deity worthy of worship by his creation. The essence of Islam is bearing witness to the phrase, **'There is no god but Allah'**. The testimony to this belief, called **tauheed**, is the axis around which Islam revolves. Tauheed requires belief in Allah's existence which is reflected in His creation.

- There is a harmonious and systematic arrangement in the universe; in the solar system, the night and day follow fixed schedule; the Sun, the Moon, and the planets rotate within their set orbits Allah says, **"It is not permitted for the sun to catch-up with the moon nor can night outstrip day each (just) swims along in (its own) orbit (according to law)." (36:40)**
- Allah's presence can be perceived by His answer to our prayers, the miracles gave some of his Prophets, and the teachings in the revealed books.
- In fact, every human is born with an instinctive belief in Allah. The Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) said, **"Every child is born in a state of fitrah (a natural belief in Allah) then his parents make him a Jew, a Christian, or a Magian."**
- Belief in Allah, In Islam, consists of following aspects:

1. Belief in Allah's Lordship

- Belief in the supremacy of Allah means that both heaven and earth, and all that lies beyond them, unknown to humans, belongs to Allah. He alone is the most supreme the exclusive lord and master of all His creation. He created them out of non-existence and they are dependent upon Him for their conversation and continuation and He alone has the power to bring them all to an end or bring them to life again.
- Furthermore, He did not create the universe without purpose and leave it to run is own course. In fact, His power is what sustains this universe and all known and unknown life within it. **'Say (O Muhammad P.B.U.H), Who provides for you from the sky and the earth? or who has power over hearing and sight? And who brings out the living from the dead and bring out the dead from the living? And who rules and regulates all affairs? They will say: Allah. 'Say. Will you not then bow (show piety) before Allah?' (10:31)**
- Belief in Allah as the supreme Lord also means to acknowledge Him as the Supreme lawgiver, the absolute judge and legislators, who alone distinguishes right from wrong. Just as the physical world submits to His supremacy, human beings must submit to the moral and religious teaching of their Lord.
- In other words, Allah alone has the authority to make law, determine acts of worship, decide morals, and set standards of human interaction and behavior.

2. Allah alone is entitled to be worshiped

- In Islam, Allah's right to be worshipped cannot be questioned. Allah has the exclusive right to be worshipped inwardly, and outwardly, by one's heart, body and soul.
- No one should be worshipped other than Him and no one can be worshipped along with Him. He has no partners and no associates in worship. Worship for Him alone. The Quran says, **"And your God is the one and only Allah; there is no God but He, most gracious, most merciful."** (2:163)
- The central messages of all Prophets and messengers sent by Allah, such as Hazrat Ibrahim, Hazrat Ishaq, Hazrat Ismail, Hazrat Musa, Hazrat Isa and Hazrat Muhammad (P.B.U.H), is to urge humanity to surrender to Allah's will and His Worship. The Quran says, **"And we never sent any messenger before you (O Muhammad (P.B.U.H) without having revealed to him that there is no God but I, therefore worship and serve Me (alone)."** (21:25)

3. Allah's names and attributes

- As only Allah is perfect, no one else should be named or qualified with names or qualifications of Allah. Muslims must believe in all the qualities of Allah stated in the Quran and as mentioned by His Prophet (P.B.U.H); this belief forms an integral part of faith.
- Attributing any of Allah's qualities to another deity or human is known as shirk and this is an unforgivable sin in Islam as it goes against the primary belief in Tauheed. The Quran says, **"There is nothing like Him, and He sees and hears all things."** (Quran 42:11)
- The names of Allah indicate His majesty, power and perfection. His attributes are unique and all-encompassing: He stands in need of none as He is perfect. **"And the most beautiful names belong to Allah, so call on Him by them."** (7:180)
- Muslim start their day and tasks with the name of Allah and remind themselves of His compassion and mercy every time they eat, drink, or do anything of importance. Forgiveness too is an important dimension of human relationship with Allah. Human beings are weak and prone to sin, but Allah in His mercy is willing to forgive those who repent.

Shirk

M/J 2017

4(a) Associating partners (shirk) is opposed to believing in the oneness of God (tawhid) and can be divided into three main categories. Write about each category. [10]

There is no issue upon which Islam is so strict as the one of *Tauheed* (monotheism). Therefore, *shirk* is considered the **greatest** violation with which the Lord of the heavens and the earth is defied.

1. Shirk in the Lordship of God would constitute assigning partners to God or saying that there is more than one Creator or that there are more gods than one. It could also be committed by declaring God to be the father or son of someone. An example is Christians who believe that Allah is God the Father, God the Son, and God the Holy Spirit, all at the same time. Quran rejects it by saying, **'He does not beget, nor is He begotten.'**

This is the most unforgivable sin and should never be committed as God has said in several places in the Qur'an e.g. **'Allah forgives not that partners should be set up with Him, but He forgives anything else to whom He pleases.'** (AlNisa 4:48)

This category also includes Atheism (the belief that human beings have no Lord).

Pharaoh denied the existence of Allah and claimed his own self to be the Lord over Moses and the people of Egypt. He announced to people: **"I am your Lord, Most High."** (Quran 79:24). Also, the idea that nature itself is God, or that God dwells within His creation is also *shirk*.

2. Shirk in the worship of God can be committed by praying invoking or asking for help from any other than God and by offering sacrifice or slaughtering in the name of any other than God. Muslims should therefore only ask God for the fulfillment of their wishes or needs as that power lies only with him. Only He should be invoked. **"You alone we worship and your aid we seek."**

Example of this *shirk* is held by people who pray to the dead. They believe the souls of the saints and other people can meddle in the affairs of mortal men, that somehow the departed souls can cause change in the life of men and women by answering their prayers or in other ways. The truth is that the dead have no power over the lives of the living; they cannot answer anyone's prayers, nor protect them, nor grant their wishes.

3. Shirk in God's attributes means to ascribe qualities which are unique to God to some other being. It means to believe that some being other than God has the power to create, or make something perish or has the same knowledge as God or the same divine power. It can be further classified into two types:

- (i) Humanizing Allah by giving Him attributes similar to humans is *shirk*. Depictions of God in paintings and sculpture are of this type. Christianity, the major religion of the West, views God in human terms, as Jesus is considered God incarnate by them. On the contrary, the Muslim tradition has been clear on this point because of the Quran's clear teachings,

"There is nothing like Him, and He sees and hears all things." (Quran 42:11)

- (ii) Another form of this type of *shirk* is when human beings are deified by giving them divine names or qualities. For example, the Christians raise Mary, the mother of Jesus, to a divine status by giving her some of Allah's attributes, such as the Merciful. They also call Mary the mother of God, 'God' being a reference to her son Jesus.

Importance of Tauheed

M/J 2017

3(a) Belief in the oneness of God (tawhid) is a fundamental aspect of faith. State how tawhid benefits Muslims in their everyday life. [10]

- It is mentioned in the Imaan-e-Mufasssal, which is: **"I believe in Allah, in His angels, in His books, in His messengers, in the last day and in the fact that everything good or bad is decided by Allah, the Almighty, and in life after death".**

It is an article of faith without which a Muslim's faith is incomplete.

The Belief of Tawheed is the profound base of Islam, yet it is the core of all the Divine messages. There is One God Who has created everything, and He is the Lord of everything, to Him creations and matter recur, and to Him are all destinies, He is The Lord in heaven and earth, and it is only Him Who deserves to be worshiped.

Allah says in the Qur'an: "And I did not create the jinn and mankind except to worship Me."

The benefits of tawhid in the life of a Muslim are several.

- It liberates human from all kind of slavery, except for being slave to One God, Who has created and honored mankind.
- The faithful believer doesn't fear but Allah, and because of that, he is secured when people are frightened, calm when people are worried, and tranquil when people are confused.
- This belief makes man virtuous and upright. He has the conviction that there is no other means of success and salvation for him except purity of soul and righteousness of behavior. He has perfect faith in God Who is above all need, is related to none and is absolutely just. This belief creates in him the consciousness that, unless he lives rightly and acts justly, he cannot succeed. No influence or underhand activity can save him from ruin.
- A Muslim surrenders completely to the will of God and becomes obedient to Him.
- This belief produces in man the highest degree of self-respect and self esteem. The believer knows that Allah alone is the Possessor of all power, and that none besides Him can benefit or harm a person, or provide for his needs, or give and take away life or wield authority or influence. This conviction makes him indifferent to, and independent and fearless of, all powers other than those of God. He never bows his head in homage to any of God's creatures, nor does he stretch out his hand before anyone else. He is not overawed

by anybody's greatness. This attitude of mind cannot be produced by any other belief. For it is necessary that those who associate other beings with God, or who deny God, should bow in homage to some creatures, regard them able to benefit or harm them, fear them and place their hopes in them.

- This belief also generates a sense of modesty and humbleness. It makes him unostentatious and unpretending. A believer never becomes proud, haughty or arrogant because he knows that whatever he possesses has been given to him by God, and that God can take away just as He can give. In contrast to this, an unbeliever, when he achieves some worldly merit, becomes proud and conceited because he believes that his merit is due to his own worth.
- Tawheed is all about freeing mind from delusions and myths, freeing conscious from giving up and humiliation, and freeing life from the domination of people.
- it stimulates unity and brotherhood and broadens the outlook of a believer as they realise that God's love and sympathy is not confined to any one group of people but to His entire creation.
- Tawhid also gives a Muslim courage as they know that only God is the giver or taker of life so in turn this belief makes them brave.
- It also creates an attitude of peace and contentment and frees one from jealousy and envy and greed.

Belief in angels

M/J 2010

4 (a) What are Muslim beliefs about angels? [10]

- It is mentioned in the Imaan-e-Mufasssal, which is: **"I believe in Allah, in His angels, in His books, in His messengers, in the last day and in the fact that everything good or bad is decided by Allah, the Almighty, and in life after death".**

It is an article of faith without which a Muslim's faith is incomplete.

- It is the second article of faith.
- Angels are special creation of Allah and are made of light(Nur). They are solely created to worship Allah and praise Him.
- They are not Allah's daughters or objects of worship.
- The angels are a link between man and God, Allah says, **"Whoever is an enemy to Allah and His angels and apostles to Gabriel and Michael Lo! Allah is an enemy to those who reject."**(Baqarah 2:98)
- They are entrusted with specific function. They have been bestowed with the necessary qualities and power to carry out their duties, but they do not have a free will. they worship and glorify Allah, sing His praises and prostrate before Him, Allah says, **"Those who are near to your Lord disdain not to do Him worship: They celebrate His praises and bow down before Him."** (Al-A'raf 7:206)
- Angels play a significant role in the everyday lives of human beings e.g. according to Muslim belief they breathe life into the foetus a few months after conception with the permission of God; an angel then writes the answer to four questions in this human being's book of deeds: Will it be male or female? Will this person be happy or sad? How long will his/her life be and will the person perform good or bad deeds.
- They strengthen the hearts of righteous believers. In the battle of Badr the angels strengthened the heart of the believers and helped them. They cast terror into the hearts of the non believers. They ask Allah's forgiveness for the believers and send blessings on them.
- They act as messengers of Allah, but they do not descend without His permission, **"Therein come down the angels and the Spirit by Allah's permission on every errand."** (Al-Qadr:97:4)
"He does send down His angels with the inspiration of His command to such of His servants as He pleases."[al Nahl16:2]
- Angels are heavenly beings not visible to ordinary mortals and belong to the category of unseen. They do not need sleep or other human requirements and never get tired.

- Angels prostrated before Adam when Allah commanded them to do so. Angels also appeared to the prophet Ibrahim in human form to give him glad tidings of a son. An angel was sent to the prophet Zakariyah and to Maryam to give them tidings of a son..

The most prominent angels are:

- Angel Gabriel** is the one who brought the message of Allah to Muhammad (p.b.u.h.) and all the other prophets.
- Angel Izrael** is the angel of death who takes away the life.
- Angel Mikael** provides the provisions to the people; he is also responsible to cause the rainfall.
- Angel Israfeel** is the angel who will blow the trumpet, 'Soor' on the Day of Judgment when directed. The first trumpet will be blown to announce the end of the world and the second trumpet will be sounded to bring all the dead to life again to face Allah's judgment.

These four angels are regarded amongst the highest ranking for the importance of their duties.

- KiramannKatibin** record every deed of a person, Allah says, *"But verily over you (are appointed angels) to protect you, kind and honorable writing down (your deeds)."* (Al-Infitar 82:10)
- Munkar and Nakir** question the dead in the grave, the Prophet (p.b.u.h.) said, *"When a faithful believer is made to sit in his grave, then (the angels) come to him and he testifies that none has the right to be worshipped but Allah and Muhammad is Allah's Apostle"* (Sahih Bukhari)
- Rizwan** the gatekeeper of Paradise; **Malik** the gatekeeper of Hell.

Belief in divine books

O/N 2010

4 (a) Write a descriptive account of the Muslim belief in revealed books. [10]

- It is mentioned in the Imaan-e-Mufasssal, which is: **"I believe in Allah, in His angels, in His books, in His messengers, in the last day and in the fact that everything good or bad is decided by Allah, the Almighty, and in life after death"**.

It is an article of faith without which a Muslim's faith is incomplete.

It is the **third article** of faith.

- All divine teachings are contained in the books of Allah. They are source of guidance for the mankind.
- They all brought the same teachings. All Divine books invited people to worship of Allah, they contained belief in prophethood, the day of judgement and the concept of reward and punishment, and they also contained a code of morality and justice, but were not comprehensive enough to contain a complete code of life.
- The Quran does not mention all the prophets nor all the books, however it mentions that revelations were sent to Nuh, Ibrahim, Isma'il, Is-haq, Yaqub, Musa and Isa (peace be upon them), Allah says,
"Say (O Muslims): We believe in Allah and that which is revealed unto us and that which was revealed unto Abraham, and Ismael, and Is-haq, and Jacob, and the tribes, and that which Moses and Jesus received, and that which the prophets received from their Lord. We make no distinction between any of them, and unto him we have surrendered." (Al-Baqarah 2:136)
- None of the revealed Books except the Qur'an exists in its original form today. The Suhaf of Ibrahim was lost. Some of the books were changed and modified such as Torah and Injil. God's words have been blended with those of man, thus it is difficult to establish the authenticity of various parts of these Books. The languages of these books are dead languages. They were revealed to a particular nation for a particular period of time.

The revealed books mentioned in the Qur'an are:-

1. The Torah was revealed to Musa for the guidance of Bani Israel.

It contained Allah's command, light admonition, mercy, and a clear explanation of things.

The original book was changed ;its followers distorted it and perverted words of Allah and changed its meaning. Allah says,

"They change the words from their(right)places and forget agood part of the message that was sent."(Al-Maidah 5:13)

2. The Zabur was revealed to Daud. It was also lost and corrupted.

3.The Injil(bible)was sent to Isa (p.b.u.h)The Christians distorted Bible and introduced the doctrine of "trinity" and redemption through crucifixion, although Isa (peace be upon him)had clearly told his followers that Allah was his Lord and their lord and that they should worship Allah alone. According to the Quran Injil confirms the Torah.The prophet (P.B.U.H) is mentioned in both the Injil and the Torah. Allah says,"And remember Jesus the son of Mary said:

"O children of Israel I am the apostle of Allah (sent)to you confirming the Law(which came)before me and giving glad Tidings of an Apostle to come after me whose name shall be Ahmad." (As-Saff 61:6)

4.The Quranwas revealed to Muhammad(P.B.U.H). Itis the last and the most perfect Book of Allah.It is a comprehensive book.It deals with every aspect of human life,e.g.sociol, economic, legal, moral and political etc.

The Qu'ran is the only book which is unchanged, Allah promised to safeguard it,

"We have, without; doubt revealed the reminder and we will guard it(from corruption)"(Al Hija 15:9)

The Qur'an is a universal book, sent to the entire mankind for all ages. God says, **'This day I have perfected your religion for you and completed my favours upon you and chosen for you Islam as your religion'. (Al Maidah 5:3).**

Belief in prophets

O/N 2013

4 (a) Give an account of Muslim belief in prophets and the messages they preached. [10]

O/N 2016

4 (a) Belief in all the prophets is one of the articles of faith in Islam. Write about this Muslim belief in detail [10]

- It is mentioned in the Imaan-e-Mufasssal, which is: **"I believe in Allah, in His angels, in His books, in His messengers, in the last day and in the fact that everything good or bad is decided by Allah, the Almighty, and in life after death".**

It is an article of faith without which a Muslim's faith is incomplete.

- **It** is the fourth article of Muslim faith.
- All the messengers were chosen by God.
- They were sent throughout history for the guidance of mankind and they acted as a link between God and mankind.
- All the messengers were human but sinless which means that they never disobeyed God. They were all men and many of them got married and had children. They did not have any physical relation with God. The Holy Quran condemns the Christian belief that Prophet Isa was the son of the God.
- All the messengers conveyed the same teachings that are belief in oneness of Allah and in the life hereafter but with the exception of Quran all previous messages were either lost or corrupted.

- They were sent to particular communities and then messages were only for the guidance of those communities for example, Prophet Musa and Prophet Isa were sent for the guidance of Bani Israel.
- Some of these messengers were given the miracles as a sign of their divinity for example Prophet Musa was given the miracle of the staff which turned into a snake. Similarly, Prophet Isa could cure the blind and even brought forth the dead. All the messengers were to be obeyed as the Quran says, **"We did not send any messenger but to be obeyed in accordance to God's will."** [Ch4:V64]
- According to Muslim belief the line of prophets started from Hazrat Adam. According to a Prophet's hadith, the line numbered 1, 24,000 approximately. The Quran mentions only 25 of them by name. major individuals include Hazrat Ibrahim (Suhuf), Hazrat Musa (Torah), Hazrat Daud (Zaboor), and Hazrat Isa (Injil) and Prophet Muhammad pbuh (the Holy Quran).
- Muslims believe that all the messengers were morally perfect which means that they were honest upright and truthful and they did not make any addition or omission in Divine revelations.
- All the messengers should be respected equally because they are equal in status. The Quran says, **"And We make no distinction between one and other of His messengers."** [Ch2:V285]
- Prophet Muhammad pbuh was the last in the line of prophetic messengers, therefore, he is also known as "Seal of the Prophets". The Holy Quran says, **"Muhammad is not the father of any of your men but the Messenger of Allah and the seal of prophets."** [Ch33:V40]. Prophet pbuh himself said, "I am the seal of prophets and there will be no prophet after me." His message was the same as the previous ones but it was sent for all mankind and for all times to come. (Universal and Eternal). God himself has taken the responsibility of protecting His message from any change or corruption. God says, **"This is a Glorious Quran in a Tablet preserved."** [Ch85:V21-22]

Allah's Predestination and Decree

• M/J 2011

4 (a) What does the statement 'There is no ability or power except through Allah' tell you about Muslim belief in Allah's predestination and decree? [10]

O/N 2017 (21)

5(a) Write an account about the relationship between belief in God's divine decree and human responsibility. [10]

- **The fifth article** of Islamic faith is **belief in divine decree** which means that everything good or bad, all moments of happiness or sorrow, pleasure or pain, come from God. It is mentioned in the Imaan-e-Mufasssal, which is: **"I believe in Allah, in His angels, in His books, in His messengers, in the last day and in the fact that everything good or bad is decided by Allah, the Almighty, and in life after death".**

It is an article of faith without which a Muslim's faith is incomplete.

- The Arabic word for destiny '**Qadr**' implies **'the measuring of something or fixing a limit to it'**. The word Qadr has the same root as word '**Qadir**' one of Allah's names meaning **"All powerful"**. Quran says,

"Verily, We have created all things in measure and proportion."

- This belief highlights God's Omnipotence and Omniscience and states that Allah is the most powerful and the Supreme Being and nothing can take place without His will. Quran says,

"To Him belongs whatever is in the heavens and whatever is on earth".

- Muslims also believe in Allah's Supreme knowledge of past, present and future. **"He knows what is before and after and behind them "**.
- He holds the Supreme power to decide the outcome of events before they occur. This is defined as Allah's predestination **"He has the Power to dispose off all affairs"** (Al Anaam).

- for example, birth of Hazrat Isa was predestined and Allah sent jibrail to Maryam R.A to give her glad tidings of the birth of a son. This is mentioned in the Quran as follows, **"it is the matter already decreed"**. (19:19-21).

Another example showing Allah's predestination is that the victory of Muslims in the battle of Badr (2AH/624AD) was predestined as the Quran says: **"A matter already enacted"** (8:45).

Day of Judgment and its events which will take place in future have already been decided by Allah. **"And when the earth is flattened out, and casts forth what is within it and becomes (clean) empty"** (84:3,4)

- Similarly, Allah has already decided the birth, death, shape or appearance, amount of livelihood of every human being on earth which is recorded in **the Preserved Tablet (al-Lauh al-Mahfuz)**. Everything in the universe is the outcome of planning and will of the Creator. He has created it with infinite wisdom and with a definite purpose. He not only maintains it but is also directing it to its destined end.
- Human knowledge is limited and so humans should act upon Allah's will. Allah created humans with certain powers which he could exercise under certain limitations and thus these powers produce good or evil. Freewill is given to humankind i.e., they can choose between right and wrong. Moreover, this is what for which Allah will question us on the Last day. Allah has shown the path of right and wrong and then left upon humans to opt for their way and made them responsible for their actions.
- Once Hazrat Ali was travelling, on his way he asked a Bedouin to take care of horse and saddle as he wanted to perform Salat and thought he would give the Bedouin 50 dirham for this. When Ali returned, he found out that the Bedouin had stolen his saddle. He then headed to the market to buy a new saddle. On one of the shop he found his own saddle and questioned about it. The shopkeeper told that a Bedouin had sold this saddle to him in fifty dirhams. Hazrat Ali smiled and said that how unlucky was the Bedouin who turned his Halal (lawful) into Haram (Unlawful) out of his free will. This event shows that Man is not a helpless creature borne along by destiny. Rather, each person is responsible for his acts. Man is bound to obey the moral law; and he will receive merited punishment or reward as he violates or observes that law. However, if such is so, man must have within his power the ability to break or keep the law. God would not hold us responsible for something unless we were capable of doing it: **"God does not burden any human being with more than he is well able to bear"**. (Quran 2:286)

Belief in Resurrection and Last Day

M/J 2015

4(a) What do Muslims believe about the Day of Resurrection and Judgment? [10]

M/J 2018

4(a) Write in detail about Muslim belief in Life after Death and the Day of Judgement. [10]

- It is mentioned in the Imaan-e-Mufasssal, which is: **"I believe in Allah, in His angels, in His books, in His messengers, in the last day and in the fact that everything good or bad is decided by Allah, the Almighty, and in life after death"**.

It is an article of faith without which a Muslim's faith is incomplete.

- Belief in Resurrection and the Last Day is the sixth article of faith. Every Muslim must believe in the life after death, all life will come to an end one day. Mankind will be resurrected and will be presented in the court of Allah with the record of his deeds. He will be given an account of all his deeds.
- According to Muslim belief, upon death a person enters an intermediate phase, the waiting period between death and resurrection called barzakh. In barzakh starts the lesser judgment where the dead will be questioned by angels about their religion, prophets, and their lord, Allah. depending on how one fares in this lesser judgment, one's grave can be reflection of Paradise or Hell. The soul rest in

Barzakh where they will remain till the resurrection, Allah says, **"Before them is partition (Burzakh) till the day they are raised up (Al Muminun 23:100)**

The Day of Judgment can be divided into three stages.

- Life will come to an end at appointed day. Everything of this universe shall be destroyed. The day is called **Qayamah**. Qayamah will be the day of clamour and noise, people will be running in confusion and bewilderment, Allah says, **"(it is) a Day whereon Man will be like moths Scattered about. And the mountains will be like carded wool" (Al Qariah 101:4-5)**. Mothers will forget their children every one will be concerned about his own self, Allah says, **"When the deafening blast is sounded that day man shall flee from his brother, his mother, and his father" (Abas 80:33-35)**.

The sun will be folded up, the stars will lose their lights and scatter away. The earth will be rent asunder. The mountains will set in motion and they will be blown away. **"One day we shall remove the mountains and you will see the earth as a level (20:100)**. The ocean will boil over the burst forth. All the people will die, Allah says, "Every soul must taste of death" (Al Anbiya 21:35).

- The second trumpet will be blown and there will be **resurrection** not only of men but also of angels and Jinn. **"Then will a second one be sounded when behold they will be standing and looking on! And the earth will shine with the glory of its Lord: the Record (of deeds) will be placed (open)" (68-69)**.

A new world will emerge with a new sky. All human beings who had lived on this earth since its inception will come back to life, this is called **HASHR**. **"You were lifeless and He gave you life and He will cause you to die and will bring you again to life" (2:28)**

- Men will be presented in the court of Allah with the record of their deeds and they will be judged according to their deeds. Allah says, **"And the book of (Deeds) will be placed (before you) and you will see the sinful in great terror because of what is (recorded) therein" (Al Kahf 18:49)** Scales will be set up and the deeds will be weighted. Furthermore, the Quran tells us that those who have done good deed will be handed their record in their right hands, and those who have sinned will receive the records in their left hands." **"Those who are given their record in their right hands will read it (with pleasure)" (17:71)**.
"And he that will be given his record in his left hand will say Ah! Would that my record had not been given to me." (69:25)

- As-Sirat** will be laid across Hell and Muhammad (P.B.U.H) shall be the first amongst the Apostles to cross it with the followers. Those who emerge successful in this judgment will go to paradise Allah says, **"Then he whose Scales are heavy shall be in state of bliss and he whose scales are light shall have a deep pit for his dwelling." (Al Qariah 101:9-10)**

Paradise and hell are described in the Quran and Hadith with concrete and material thing of this world. This is to give an idea to human mind about the intensity of pleasure in paradise and severity of the punishment in Hell.

Questions from Past Papers

O/N 2012

3 (a) Give an account of Muslim belief in the following: [10]

- (i) angels; and
- (ii) prophets.

O/N 2015

5 (a) Belief in prophets and the revealed books are essential to Islam. Write an account of these two articles of faith. [10]

4.(b) Discuss the importance of Jibra'il in comparison to other angels. [4]

Angels have particular jobs to do which are assigned to them by God. Jibrail is the arch angel who had the all important duty of bringing the word of Allah to his chosen messengers. He was sent by Allah to announce the birth of Hazrat Issa to Hazrat Maryam , to deliver the Quran to Prophet Muhammad and also to conduct him on the Miraj. He had been in direct interaction with mankind as compared to any other angel and appeared in human form on many occasions. The Quran refers to him as “The Holy Spirit” at several places e.g surah Maryam, surah al Qadr etc.

5.(b) All revealed books were sent by God. What in your opinion makes the Qur’an unique?[4]

- Qur’an is different from other revealed books as it is the only book revealed to all humanity for all times.
- God Himself has promised to protect its message.
- the language of the Qur’an is very much alive today and spoken by millions unlike those of the other revealed books.
- its message is universal and eternal

4.(b) How is the message brought by these prophets important for Muslims today? [4]

- the message brought by all the prophets was of belief in the one God; good conduct and belief in resurrection and the Day of Judgment.
- This message is important to Muslims today just as it was important to Muslims of the past ages and will be to those of the future because it reiterates tawhid and accountability which if a person bears in mind will lead to good conduct and prosperity in this world and the next.
- It teaches Muslims tolerance for other revealed faiths and makes them realise that Islam is a continuation and culmination of the other revealed faiths.
- The unity of the message will foster better relations between Muslims and other believers etc.

3(b) Give reasons to support the statement that without tawhid there is no faith. [4]

- belief in the oneness of God is the first article of Islam and all forms of ibadah revolve around it.
- because Muslims believe in the one God they offer salat five times a day to glorify Him and seek His aid;
- they fast in the month of Ramadan, give zakat and perform hajj which are all actions to glorify God, to follow His commands, to please Him and to seek His mercy.
- If the belief in tawhid was absent there would be no need to act upon the Pillars of faith or the teachings of Islam as they are all done to please the one God.

5(b) Why has God repeatedly warned Muslims against committing shirk? [4]

All three kinds of shirk should never be committed . **The severity of shirk** can be understood through the following :

Shirk makes the Creator like His creation, Therefore, Allah declares *shirk* to be the greatest wrong,

“Indeed to ascribe partners (unto Him) is a tremendous wrong.” (Quran 31:13)

Allah has forbidden Paradise to those who do not repent from committing *shirk*, condemning him to Hell for eternity,

“Surely whoever associates (others) with Allah, Allah has forbidden to him Paradise and his abode is the Fire.” (Quran 5:72)

All the good works a person may have done are lost, become worthless, and are rendered vain if a person dies unrepentant of *shirk*,

“And certainly, it has been revealed to you and to those before you: if you should associate (anything) with Allah, your work would surely become worthless, and you would surely be among the losers.” (Quran 39:65)

4.(b) Why is the belief in resurrection important to Muslims in their daily living? [4]

Belief in the Hereafter, resurrection the Day of Judgment and accountability before Allah is at the heart of Islam as this stress the purpose of human creation. This belief shows the direct relation between a person's conduct on earth and the life beyond i.e the present life is a preparation for the next, which will be one of rewards and punishments, depending on one's conduct on earth.

Rejection of this belief makes all other beliefs meaningless. If a person does not believe in accountability to his Creator for all his deeds, there is nothing to stop him from wrongdoing. It is fear of accountability that keeps a person in check; faith in life after death urges people to do right and stay away from sin. In this world, we sometimes see the pious suffer whilst the impious live enjoyable lives. What needs to be remembered is that all shall be judged one day and justice will be meted out. The acceptance or rejection of life after death is perhaps the greatest factor in determining the course of an individual's life.

5(b) How does this belief in God's divine decree affect the day to day life of Muslims? [4]

- Belief in divine decree strengthens one's belief in God.
- A person realises that God alone controls everything, so he trusts and relies on Him.
- Even though a person tries his best, at the same time he relies on God for the final outcome.
- His hard work or intelligence does not make him arrogant, for God is the source of all that comes his way.
- Finally, a person attains peace of mind in the realisation that God is the Wise and His actions are dictated by wisdom.
- Things don't happen without a purpose. If something reached him, he realises it could never have escaped him.
- If something misses him, he realises it was never meant to be. A person achieves an inner peace, and is inwardly at rest with this realisation.

Fasting (Saum)

Method:

O/N 2010

3 (a) What are the daily observances of the Ramadan fast? [10]

M/J 2012

5 (a) Outline the features of the Ramadan fast, and identify which Muslims are exempted from fasting during this month. [10]

Answer (Learn and write):

- **Fasting** during the month of Ramadan is obligatory on all Muslim adults, male and female. The Quran says, “**O you who believe ! Fasting is prescribed to you, as it was prescribed to those before you, so that you may learn self restraint.**” [2:183]
- The hours of fasting are from first light (before dawn) until sunset.
- It is desirable to have a meal before keeping a fast till dawn which is referred as **Sehri**.
- Muslims should make an intention for the fast i.e. “**I intend to keep tomorrow’s fast of Ramadan.**”
- With this, a person is subject to all restrictions and prohibitions associated with a fast till the setting of the sun. Muslims must abstain from food, drink etc. during daylight hours. They should also refrain from smoking, sexual intercourse, medicines etc. This is known as **Imsak**.
- They should live their lives as normal, making no concessions to lack of food. Muslims should be particularly pious and visit mosques regularly. The Holy Prophet (PBUH) said, “**When the month of Ramadan comes, the doors of Heaves are opened and the doors of Hell are closed and the devils are chained.**”
- Muslims break their fast with a meal at sunset in the evening reciting the prayer, “**O Allah! I fasted for you and I believe in you and I put my trust in you and with the sustenance you have given me, I now break the fast.**” This is known as **Iftar**. Many Muslims follow the Holy Prophet (PBUH)’s example of taking a drink and eating a date and then pray. They follow this with a meal often eaten with friends.
- Muslims should try to be present at recitations of the Holy Quran in the **tarawih prayers** during the course of the month.
- On the **Night of Power** they should attend mosques and spend the night in prayer. It is one of the last 5 odd nights of Ramadan and the reward for praying in it is better than the worship of one thousand months. Many Muslims believe it to be the 27th night.
- Some Muslims withdraw to mosques for the last ten days of Ramadan which is called **Itikaf** and dedicate their time to prayer and worship. The fasts of Ramadan continue until new moon of **Shawal**.
- The sick people, travellers, very old people and females who are in a state of menstruation or period of childbirth are exempt from fasting as long as such conditions last. However, they must make up the fast for an equal number of days within the next year which is known as **Qaza**.
- If the breaking of the fast before sunset is intentional than a person has to pay the **Kaffara** in which he has to fast for continuous 60 days in addition to Qaza, but in case of an illness, feed 60 people twice a day.

Exemption from Fasting

- Children under the age of puberty and discretion.
- Insane people who are unaccountable for their actions: no compensation or any other substitute is enjoined on these two categories of people.

- Men and women who are too old or feeble to undertake the obligations of fasting are exempt. However, they have to give fidya, which is feeding a poor person twice a day or to give grain or its equivalent in cash to needy.
- Sick people whose health is likely to deteriorate by fasting; they may postpone the fast for as long as they are ill and then make up for it at a later date, a day for a day.
- They travelers may be exempt during their travel but should make up for the missed fasts later on.
- Pregnant women/breastfeeding may also not fast if their health or the infant's health would be at risk by doing so. They too need to make up for the missed fasts later on.
- Women, at the time of their mensuration or confinement due to childbirth must postpone the fasts and make up for them by fasting afterwards.

Benefits / importance of Fasting

O/N 2014 (21)

5 (a) What are the moral, spiritual and other benefits of fasting in Ramadan? [10]

O/N 2016 (21)

4 (a) What are the benefits to individuals and the community of fasting in the month of Ramadan? [10]

M/J 2021 (21)

4(a) Fasting in Ramadan benefits Muslims in many ways. Write about the major benefits of fasting in Ramadan.[10]

Answer:

Fasting has been the universal religious institution. It was made obligatory on the followers of other religions too. It has numerous merits and benefits for the individuals and the community.

- The believer renounces food, drink, and abstains from all other enjoyments willingly in obedience to the command of Allah, to seek His pleasure. It helps in building up a man's moral character as it teaches him self control and self restrain. As Muslims fast, they should control own temper, they should remain calm and refrain from harming others, verbally or physically. They should refrain from backbiting, stealing, cheating , gossip, lies, obscenity, vulgarity and physical, mental and spiritual sins. Abu Huraira reported the Prophet (p.b.u.h) said, **"Whoever does not give up forged speech and evil actions, Allah is not in need of his leaving his food and drink."**
- Fasting ensures the harmony and unity of society. Fasting raises awareness of the situation of poor people who live in our society. Fasting teaches the rich, who eat good, nutritious food and never suffer from hunger, what hunger is. When they stay hungry and thirsty for a specific period they begin to think about the poor and feel empathy for them. The sense of empathy makes it easier for them to make friends and socialize. On the other hand, because of the kindness and compassion of the rich, the poor are less likely to feel envy and hatred toward those who are better off. Thus, a change of attitude on both sides can occur. The enmity between both social strata can be brought to an end in this way with peace and security prevailing in society. Fasting brings the rich closer to the poor and links them in a bond of responsibility and respect for each other. Ramadan is also a time of generosity. People are more generous, more cordial, and more ready than at other times of the year to do good and charitable work. Muslims often invite one another, friends and guests, Muslims and non-Muslims, in particular neighbors, regardless of creed, to share the evening meal and exchange gifts and best wishes.
- Abstention from food and drink for a full month is beneficial for a person's health as it gives rest to stomach, the whole system is cleansed of undesirable material, and the body gets rid of fat, cholesterol and other toxic matters.

- Fasting brings a man closer to Allah, Allah says, **“Fasting is like a shield, and he who fasts has two joys: a joy when he breaks his fast and a joy when he meets his Lord.”** (Hadis Qudsi) Believers are ordered to observe fast to be near Allah and gain **“Taqwa”**. Fasting strengthens the spiritual powers of the believer; it protects man from all kinds of temptations. The reward of all good deeds are multiplied by ten times to seven hundred times, the Prophet (p.b.u.h) said, **“Allah said, “All the deeds of Adam’s sons (people) are for them, except fasting which is for me, and I will give the reward for it. The reward of good deeds is multiplied ten times to seven hundred times.”**

“Fasting is a shield and protection from the fire and from committing sins.”

“By Him in Whose Hands my soul is, the unpleasant smell coming out from the mouth of a fasting person is better in the sight of Allah than the smell of musk.” (Agreed)

- The previous sins of a person are forgiven, the Holy Prophet (p.b.u.h) said, **“Whoever established prayers on the night of the Qadr out of sincere faith and hoping for a reward from Allah, then all his previous sins will be forgiven, and whoever fasts in the month of Ramadan out of sincere faith, and hoping for a reward from Allah, then all his previous sins will be forgiven.”**

He also said, **“When the month of Ramadan starts, the gates of the heaven are opened and the gates of hell are closed and the devil are chained.”** (Trimidhi)

- Fasting brings economic benefits for the Muslim community. During the month of Ramadan the rich people spend generously on the poor to seek the blessing of Allah. These enable the poor to fulfill their needs. The old and the permanently sick people also feed the poor and the needy generously during the month of Ramadan, Allah says. **“For those who can do it (with hardship) is a ransom the feeding of one that is indigent. But he that will give more of his own free, it is better for him.”** (Al-Baqarah 2:184) The Prophet (p.b.u.h) said; **“During Ramadan, the provisions of the believers are increased.”**

M/J 2019

5(a) Describe how Muslims observe the fast of Ramadan and how this month should be spent. [10]

O/N 2020

5(a) Describe how the fast in the month of Ramadan should be observed by Muslims? [10]

Answer:

Method of Fasting (Repeated)

Rules of Fasting

- Avoiding anything of haram or makruh: This to be conscious of keeping your mind and body clean, by avoiding wasting time useless pursuits, by being conscious of eating only halal foods at sehri and iftar and to keep one’s tongue free of all verbal sins like gossiping and swearing.
- violence and danger: Display of danger, aggression and violence is forbidden during the month of Ramzan, especially when one is fasting. One should show patience and forbearance towards others and control one’s temper and tongue.
- Reading the Quran: More time should be spent in the recitation of the Quran, trying to complete the whole Quran at least once during this month. Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **“Everything has a best season and the best season of the Quran is Ramzan.”**
- Prayer supplication and remembrance, of Allah: Being punctual regarding salat, making an effort to attend tarawih prayers, and spending as much time as possible in worship is recommended. One should also, whilst fasting, keep busy in the dhikr of Allah, practice taubah and seek Allah’s forgiveness. Praying during the nights

of Qadr for oneself and others are activities that Muslims should observe during the fast and in the month of Ramadan. In Sura Baqarah Allah states: **“And when my servants ask you concerning Me, then surely I am very near; I answer the prayer of the supplicant when he calls upon Me, so they should answer My call and believe in Me That they may walk the right way.”(2:186)**

- Zakat, charity, generosity: Be very charitable and generous, help the needy and the poor, participate in social and community welfare projects etc.
- Good relation and behavior: maintain cordial relations with all. Forget your quarrels and reconcile your difference in this month; do not be involved in backbiting anything that is wrong. Be good to all.
- Reflection: Ramadan is the month of reflection think, reflect, and plan to improve your moral and spiritual conduct. Think how you can be a better Muslim, and convert those thoughts into actions. Think how you can contribute to the betterment of the Ummah and the world at large.

4(b) Explain why the Night of Power (Layla-tul-Qadr) is so important for Muslims.[4]

- the Night of Power is considered to be a night of immense blessings for it was on this night that the last of God's books, the Qur'an, was revealed to the Prophet (pbuh).
- The Qur'an itself mentions the immense blessings of this night. This is a night of reading, understanding and reflecting upon the teachings given in the Qur'an.
- The reward of worship on this night is more than the reward for worshipping for a thousand months. Hence Muslims have special arrangements for extra prayers on this night.
- The Prophet (pbuh) has said that those who spend Layla-tul-Qadr in prayer out of faith and in the hope of reward, will have his previous sins forgiven.
- It is believed, as stated in the Qur'an in Sura al Qadr, that the angels and the Spirit descend to earth by God's permission and that peace prevails until the rise of dawn.

It is for these reasons that Muslims consider the Night of Power to be the most important night of Ramadan and indeed of the year.

(b) Explain why the Ramadan fast is important to Muslims? [4]

The Ramadan fast is a basic pillar of Islam. It increases self control and shows obedience to Allah. More thoughtful answers will go on to say that it also helps Muslims to remember the poor in the community, it promotes equality and makes the more fortunate ones in society realise the plight of the less fortunate ones thus fostering fellowship amongst the believers. A point which could be made in answer to this part of the question could be that it is regarded as a gift which the believer gives to Allah.

Zakat (Almsgiving)

Method:

O/N 2013(21)

4 (a) Outline the practice of almsgiving (zakat) in Islam. [10]

Answer:

The word Zakat is derived from 'Zaka' which means to increase or to bless. Another meaning of the word as used in the Quran carries the sense of purification. The amount of payment and distribution of Zakat was defined at Madinah in the second year of the Hijrat.

The payment of Zakat is compulsory on every adult, free Muslim who owns property to the extent of the prescribed rate called **Nisab**, provided such property has remained in his ownership and possession **uninterruptedly for full one year**.

Zakat is payable on cash, gold and silver, jewellery, crops, animals, minerals, agricultural lands and all kinds of commercial goods.

- On cash, gold and silver: Zakat is paid at a rate of 2 ½%. For example, on such possessions valued as worth \$100000, the zakat payable will be \$2500, which is 2.5 percent or one-fortieth of their value. A person who possesses **612.36 grams** of silver or **87.48 grams** gold is liable to pay Zakat.
- Produce from Mines: Owners of mines have to pay one-fifth of the produce of mines. This is called **Khums**.
- On the produce of agricultural lands is called **Ushr** is to be found in the Quran. It is levied at the rate of **one-tenth** of the agricultural produce of lands benefiting by rain or some natural spring; and **one twentieth** of the produce of artificially irrigated lands.
- On all articles of trade exceeding **200 dirhams**.
- For every forty sheep or goats- one goat; On thirty to forty cattle, one calf of one year, on every forty cattle, a two year old calf. On every five camels, one goat or sheep.
- **Sadaqah-ul-Fitr** is an obligatory charity given on the completion of the month of Ramazan.

The Holy Quran tell us how the Zakat money is to be distributed. It says:

“ Alms are for the poor and the needy and those employed to administer the (funds); for those whose hearts have been (recently) reconciled (to the Truth); for those in bondage and in debt; in the cause of Allah; and for the wayfarer...” (9:60)

- The poor and the needy in this category are those people who may have some funds but not enough to meet the threshold for nisab.
- The destitute: these are the people who have no funds and are living on the very basic necessities of life.
- Zakat collectors: people appointed by the government to collect and distribute zakat.
- Muslims converts in this category are the new converts to Islam, who are genuinely poor and are given zakat to help them get on their feet.
- Prisoners of war or slaves: so that they may be able to use zakat funds to buy their freedom.
- People in debt: those who may have incurred debts, to meet their needs but cannot pay them back are eligible for zakat.
- Travellers: Muslims, who in the middle of their journey are out of funds are eligible for zakat donations.
- Others: zakat funds can also be spent on people and organization that are engaged in services to Islam.

It must be remembered that zakat is applicable only on the rightful. i.e. halal, earnings. zakat cannot be used to purify wealth that is wrongly and illegally earned, i.e. through haram means.

Zakat cannot be paid to

- Non-Muslim
- To one's husband/wife, parents, children, grandparents, grandchildren, the descendants of the Prophet (P.B.U.H), and to those who meet the threshold of nisabi.e the minimum amount that a Muslim must have before being obliged to pay zakat.
- To workers, servants, etc. as wages of their services.
- zakat funds also cannot be used for burial expenses or to pay off the debt of the deceased, as it is imperative according to Sharia that the recipient of zakat should be made owner of it.

Benefits/ importance of Zakat:

M/J 2015 (22)

5.(b) How do you think observing the Pillar of giving alms (zakah) benefits the giver? [4]

M/J 2017 (21)

5(a) Alms-giving (zakat) is an act of worship which benefits the community of Muslims. Write in detail about its benefits to the giver, the receiver and to society as a whole. [10]

Zakat is the 4th pillar of Islam and it was made obligatory on rich Muslims in the 2nd year of hijra. The word zakat is mentioned 32 times in the Quran. It has the following benefits for the giver, the receiver and the society as a whole.

Giver

- zakat purifies the heart of the giver of love of wealth and greed and strengthens the giver's bonds with God as they give from their wealth to earn God's pleasure and mercy. The giver is also fulfilling one of the Pillars of Islam. Zakat is a blessing to the giver as by this act their wealth is multiplied.
- Quran says, **'The parable of those who spend their substance in the way of Allah is that of a grain of corn, it grows seven ears and each ear has a hundred grains.'** (Al Baqarah 2:261) Moreover, zakat expiates the sins of a person.
- Payment of zakat provides open handedness, generosity, and sympathy in a Muslim towards the needy person. Allah says: **"Take the charity (Zakat) from their wealth in order to purify and cleanse them by way of it."** [9: 103]
- On one hand it indicates a person's sincerity of faith, while on the other hand it shows his commitment to sacrifice something which he covets (material wealth) in the way of Allah (SWT). It is abiding by one of the pillars of Islam, upon which rests an individual's prosperity in this worldly life and the Hereafter

Receiver

- it is not only a blessing for the receiver but helps them to meet their needs, it fosters good will and brotherhood in the hearts of the poor and promotes equality.
- *Zakat* is a source of power for the needy. In addition to providing the financially stricken poor with desperately needed capital, *zakat* also injects in them a dynamic energy, instilling in them the confidence to provide for their own.

Social

- People come closer together like a single family in which those who have the means show compassion to those who cannot fulfill their needs. It removes the grudges and ill feelings found in the hearts of the poor and destitute.
- It prevents extreme financial disparity and associated social evils and crimes.
- It leads to an equal distribution of wealth in the society and prevents its accumulation in the hands of a few.
- Paying Zakat allows wealth to be distributed equally in a society. It eradicates begging because everyone is getting their rights.(Social)
- Zakat also stimulates investment and discourages hoarding in the community, if people do not invest their wealth it will gradually be consumed by zakat, therefore it is an effective way of keeping wealth in circulation. Prophet said, **'If anyone of you is a guardian of an orphan who owns property, he must trade with (invest) it and not leave it till sadaqa (zakat) consumes it'** (tirmidhi).

Pilgrimage(Hajj)

Method

O/N 2009

5 (a) Describe the main events of the annual pilgrimage (hajj). [10]

M/J 2013

3 (a) Outline the main observances of the annual pilgrimage (Hajj). [10]

O/N 2020

5(a) Write about the rituals that take place on the first three days of the annual pilgrimage (hajj). [10]

The fifth pillar is the Pilgrimage to Makka and its vicinity during a fixed time of the twelfth month of the Muslim calendar, Dhu al-hajja. To perform the Hajj is a very difficult and strenuous form of worship, though Muslims should attempt to go once in their lifetime, if they have the means.

"Pilgrimage thereto is a duty people owe to Allah- those who can afford the journey." [3:97]

Pilgrims arrive in Makka by the **7th day of Dhu al-Hijja**, they purify themselves and **on 8th** the men put on the **Ihram**. It is the preparation, entering into a purified state at prescribed stations, Meeqat, by shedding ordinary clothes and putting on to seamless cloths, one around the waist and one over one shoulder. Women do not use these cloths but wear simple modest cloths to cover their bodies, except for their face and hands.

After entering the state of Ihram, the pilgrims start reciting the, Talbiah. At the great mosque of Kaaba, Masjid al Haraam , they perform the **Tawaaf Qudoom**. It is **anticlockwise circumambulation of the Kaaba seven times**, at the beginning of the Hajj.

The Pilgrims proceed to the **plain of Mina**, where they spend the night in prayer.

On the **9th day** they leave Mina for **Arafat**, where they recite the Quran and pray at the **Jabal al-Rahma**. This is known as **wuquf (stay)** in which they spend time by reciting appropriate passages from the Quran. This is the climax of the Hajj when Muslims believe that the misdeeds of their lives, until this time, are forgiven. **Zuhr and Asr** prayers of 9th of **Dhu al-hajja** are performed together in this plain. The **Hajj sermon** is also delivered here.

At sunset, the pilgrims leave **Arafaat for Muzdalifa**, where they will spend the night in worship and gather 49 pebbles for the next day. Magrib and Isha prayers are performed together in this plain.

At dawn of **10th of Dhu al-hajja**, they proceed to Mina where they perform **Ramy (stonning)**, by throwing the pebbles at the **Jamarat al Aqba**. The stone pillar symbolizes Satan. Talbiah is stopped before performing Ramy.

The animal **sacrifice**, Udhiya, on the tenth day of Dhu al-Hijja , the **Id al-Adha** is performed at Mina. Men usually have their heads shaved at this time.

"The sacrificial camels, We have made for you as among the symbols from Allah: in them is much good for you. Then pronounce the name of Allah over them as they are lined up for sacrifice. When they are down on their sides after slaughter, eat from them and feed others." [22:36]

After this, the pilgrims go to the Kaaba to perform the obligatory tawaf known as **Tawaf Ifadah** or **Tawaf Ziara**. Then they perform **two rakat near the Station of Ibrahim**.

Then they carry out the **Sa'yi** between the hills of **Safa and Marwa** by running between the hills **seven times**.

"Behold! Safa and Marwa are among the symbols of Allah. So if those who visit the house in the season or at other times, should compass them round, it is no sin in them. And if anyone obeys his own impulse to good , be sure that Allah is He who recognizes and knows." [2:158]

Ramy is carried out on the **eleventh and the twelfth days** as well. On the twelfth day, pilgrims return to the Kaaba for the **final Tawaaf (wida)**.

} M/J 2016

4 (a) 'And complete the hajj or umra in the service of God' (al-Baqara 2:196). What observances does a pilgrim complete in the performance of umra and how is umra different to hajj? [10]

Method of Umrah:

'Umrah in Islamic terminology, means paying a visit to Ka'bah, performing Tawaaf (circumambulation) around it, walking between Safaa and Marwah seven times. A performer of 'Umrah puts off his Ihraam by having his hair shaved or cut. 'Umrah can be performed along with Hajj and in other days as well.

1. When the one who wants to perform 'Umrah arrives at **the Meeqaat**, it is recommended for him (both man and woman) to take a bath if convenient, including menstruating women and those experiencing postnatal bleeding. The man perfumes his head and beard but not his Ihraam garments. There is no harm in what remains of it after Ihraam. There is nothing wrong if it is not possible to take a bath at Meeqaat.

2. Men are to change into their clothing of Ihraam while the women only need to make their intention at that time in the clothing they are already wearing. There is no specific clothing designated for women, except that they are prohibited from wearing the Niqaab (face-veil) and gloves. As for men, they must assume their Ihraam at the Meeqaat by wearing two pieces of fabric called the Izaar and the Ridaa'. The Ridaa' covers the top half of the body, while the Izaar covers the lower half. No other clothing is allowed to be worn in addition to these.

Then the pilgrim makes the intention at the Meeqaat to begin the rites of 'Umrah by entering the state of Ihraam. The intention must be made in the heart. After the intention **Talbiyyah** is recited.

Upon arriving at the sacred mosque in Makkah (Al-Masjid Al-Haraam), you should enter with your right foot

3. Upon **arriving at the Ka'bah**, stop reciting the Talbiyyah, then approach the Black Stone, touch it with your right hand and kiss it. If this isn't possible, you should face the Black Stone and point to it. When touching the Stone, the following is said: (In the name of Allah, Allah is the Greatest) or "*Allahu Akbar*" (Allah is the Greatest).

If this is difficult for you, then go on performing **tawaaf** without touching it.

4. When you complete seven circuits of Tawaaf, approach **MaqaamIbraaheem** recite this verse (which means): "**And take you (people) the Maqaam (place) of Ibraheem as a place of Prayer...**" [Quran: 2:125]

Then pray two short Rak'ahs, as close as conveniently possible, behind MaqaamIbraheem. Upon completing the two Rak'ahs, return to the Black Stone and touch it, if convenient

5. The next stage is to go to **Safaa**. Upon approaching the foot of Safaa, the following verse is recited (which means): "**Verily, As-Safaa and Al-Marwah are from the symbols of Allah.**" [Quran; 2:158]

Then descend and go towards **Marwah**, There are no particular supplications to be recited between Safaa and Marwah. Seven circuits are to be completed ending the last one on Marwah.

6. Then one is to have his **hair cut** although shaving it is better. Women should shorten their hair by a finger-tips length from the end. The rights of 'Umrah have now been completed.

The main differences between Hajj and Umra

- Hajj is one of the five pillars of Islam and is an obligatory act of worship for those of good health and can afford the journey whereas Umra is not an obligatory act.
- Hajj can only be performed during prescribed month and dates i.e. Zil Hajj (7th – 12th) whereas Umra can be performed at any time of the year.
- Wuquf Arafat is one of the most important components of Hajj without which Hajj is void. However, there is no Wuquf Arafat in Umra.

- Similarly there is no WuqufMuzdailfa (spending the night at Muzdailfa) in Umra or combining Maghrib and Isha prayers.
- In Hajj, Talbiah is stopped on the 10th of Zil Hajj after the stoning of the devil (Rami) whereas Talbiah is stopped while starting the Tawaf in Umra.
- In Hajj, a person has to go and stay in Mina, perform Rami at the Jamarat while there is no stay at Mina or Rami in Umra.
- In Hajj, the pilgrim gives a sacrifice on 10thZil Hajj while no sacrifice is offered in Umra.

Benefits/Importance of Pilgrimage

} M/J 2014

4 (a) How do Muslim individuals and the Muslim community benefit from the annual pilgrimage (hajj)? [10]

- Hajj is **fifth pillar** of Islam. It became obligatory in the **ninth year of Hijrah**. Hajj is an act of Ibadah which is obligatory on every Muslim who can afford it once in his lifetime. Hajj literally means the intension of going on Pilgrimage. It is an all embracing act of worship in which a Muslims visits the Ka'bah in the month of Dhul-Hajj and performs him prescribed rites Allah says, **"Pilgrimage there to is a duty man owe to Allah, those who can afford the journey."**
- 1. Hajj is a form of Ibadah which **covers all aspects of human life**. It trains a Muslim to sacrifice his wealth his time his physical and mental energies and his comfort in the way Allah.
- 2. **Allah forgive sins** of those who perform pilgrimage and does not care for those who die without performing it, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) said,
"He who is not prevented from performing the Pilgrimage by an obvious necessity, a tyrannical ruler, or a disease which confines him at home, and dies without having performed the Pilgrimage may die if he wishes to be Jew or Christian." (Trimidhi)
 The Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **"An Accepted Pilgrimage has no reward except paradise."** (Agreed).
 In another tradition, the Prophet(P.B.U.H) said, **"the person who came on Pilgrimage to the house of Allah, than neither committed an indecent sexual acts, nor indulged in any disobedience of Allah, He will return home as (pure of sin) as he was on the day his mother bore him."** (Agreed)
- 3. One of the most important benefit of Hajj is that **it demonstrates equality and brotherhood** among the Muslims. People of all nationalities, all colors, races and the ranks from all over the world assemble at one place and interact with each other. They come before their creator in extreme humility, wearing two white sheets without any distinction between the high and the low, the king or the servant, gather at the same place and utter the same words,
- 4. Hajj is **a great spiritual experience**. It brings the pilgrim closer to Allah, and he feels that the entire barrier between him and his Creator are removed. In the plain of Arafat on this great occasion hundreds and thousands of people assemble and proclaim together (here I am O Lord! Here I am) and they feel that nothing stands between them and Allah.
- 5. **Trading is allowed** during Pilgrimage. Allah says, **"it is no crime in you, if you seek of the bounty of your Lord (during Pilgrimage)" (Al- Baqrah 2:198)** Pilgrim may buy and sell and thus he can meet expanse of his journey.
- 6. Pilgrimage has other **economic benefits** for Muslims. People have the opportunity to discuss their economic problem; and the get the chance to devise plans and strategies that may benefits the Muslims on individual level and evolve common economic strategies that are beneficial to the entire Muslim world.
- 7. The Muslims assemble every year in Makkah; this annual meeting provides **the Muslims leaders** an opportunity to discuss their common problems and formulate a common policy that can be pursued by all Muslim countries in the United Nations Organizations, the Security Council or other such world forums. It also provides them with opportunity to discuss and agree on many topics of common interest.

} O/N 2014

4 (a) 'Pilgrimage to the House is a duty people owe to Allah, those who can afford the journey.' (Al 'Imran 3:97)

(i) For whom is the annual pilgrimage (hajj) compulsory and which Muslims are exempt from it?

(ii) What things are forbidden to pilgrims while in the state of ihram? [10]

(i) Obligation and exemption:

- Pilgrimage to Makkah once in a lifetime is obligatory on every adult, sane, free Muslim, who can afford to undertake a journey to Makkah. Allah says, **"Pilgrimage thereto is a duty, men owe to Allah those who can afford the journey."** (Al-Imran 3:97)
- It is obligatory on those who have sufficient money to pay for their return journey to Makkah and meet expenses of their stay and also have ample funds to provide for their dependents back at home until their return Allah says, **"And take a provision (with you) for the journey"** (Al-Baqarah 2:197)
- Pilgrimage is only obligatory on those who are physically fit to undertake the journey. Hajj is not binding on people who are sick or very old, and cannot endure the hardship of long journey.
- Journeys must be safe danger to life or possessions due to war, epidemic or highway robberies free a person from obligation of Pilgrimage.
- A woman is not allowed to go to Pilgrimage without mahram. In case, she cannot find a mahram to accompany her, it is not obligatory for her to perform Pilgrimage. Ibn Abbas reported, the Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **"women should not travel except with a mahram, and no man may visit her except in the presence of mahram"**, a man got up and said **"O Allah's apostle! I intend to go with such and such an army and my wife wants to perform Hajj"** the Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, (to him), **"Go along with her (to Hajj)"** (Sahih Bukhari)

(ii) prohibitions of Ihram

There are a number of other rules connected with Hajj, such a **prohibition** against using perfume, killing any creature, uprooting or damaging plants, doing anything dishonest, To use abusive or foul language, To hunt or kill an animal; however, harmful or dangerous animals can be killed, carrying weapons, covering the head for men, covering the face and hands for women, wearing shoes over the ankles, cutting hair or clipping nails, and having sexual relations. These restrictions ensure that the pilgrims are focused on what they are doing and concentrating on Allah. Throughout the Hajj they also offer prayers to Allah while making their observances

Specific Acts by name:

} O/N 2017

Q4 (a): Outline the various kinds of circumambulations (tawaf) around the Ka'ba required during the annual pilgrimage (hajj) and describe the conditions for performing them. [10]

1. Tawaf and its conditions

Tawaf is the circumambulation of the Ka'ba seven times in anticlock wise direction and there are different kinds of tawaf which are performed during hajj.

The different kinds of tawaf and the conditions for performing them are:

Tawaf-e-Qudoom: is the tawaf of arrival for hajj. It is performed on entering the sacred mosque.

Tawaf-e-Ziara (Tawaf Ifadah) is an obligatory act of pilgrimage and if it is not performed the pilgrimage becomes void. It takes place after the first stoning of the jamarat and it is permissible to perform it from 10th and 12th Zil Hajj.

Tawaf-e-Wida (the farewell tawaf), this tawaf is wajib and is performed before the pilgrims depart for their homes. It is done after completing the actions of hajj and when one has decided to leave Mecca. It is obligatory for all pilgrims except women who are menstruating or bleeding following childbirth, and the one who fails to do it must sacrifice an animal of the type that is valid as an udhiyah.

Tawaf-e-Nafl It is not required during annual pilgrimage but is however performed by pilgrims to gain extra rewards

Conditions:

Each of these tawafs must include seven circuits, men are encouraged to perform the first three circuits at a hurried pace, followed by the remaining four at a slower pace. Each time they reach the Black Stone, they should kiss it if possible or raise their hands in salutation saying Allahu Akbar. After which the pilgrim offers two rak'ah behind Maqaam Ibrahim, if possible; if the pilgrim cannot do that then he/she may offer the prayer in any other part of the mosque. Pilgrims should before starting their tawaf make intention (niyyat) and be in the state of wudu. According to some scholars wudu is fard (compulsory) and it is mustahab (recommended) according to other scholars. If you perform wudu then there is no difference of opinion.

Except for the specific supplication between the last stretch of each tawaf of the Ka'ba, i.e. between 'Rukne Yamani' and 'Hajar Aswad', there are no specific or particular duas which one needs to recite during the tawaf. It is sunna to recite this supplication during the last stretch of each tawaf:

Sura Baqarah 2:201 – 'O our Lord, give us the good in the world, and give us the good in the Hereafter, and save us from the torment of the Hell Fire'

M/J 2011

5 (a) What beliefs and practices are involved in:

- (i) stoning the Jamarat
- (ii) performing sa'y
- (iii) assembling at Arafat [10]

O/N 2018

5(a) Write a detailed account of the following: [10]

- *ihram*;
- *tawaf* ; and
- *sa'i*

O/N 2019

4(a) Describe any three of the following elements of pilgrimage (hajj): [10]

- *ihram* (garments worn for pilgrimage)
- *sa'i* (running between the hills of Safa and Marwa)
- *rami* (stoning the Jamarat)
- *Qurbani* (sacrifice).

2. **Sayi** is walking briskly seven times between Safa and Marwa hills. Sayi is commenced from Safa and ends at Marwa. The commandment about Sayi is contained in the Quran: **“Behold! Safa and Marwa are among the symbols of Allah. So if those who visit the house in the season or at other times, should compass them round.....” (2:158)**

The pilgrim should first climb on the Safa hill. It is not necessary to climb to the top of the hill. He should climb to such a height only as would afford a view of the Kaaba. After descending from Safa, the pilgrim should move towards Marwa and, thereafter, walk briskly between the two hills. Only men are required to walk briskly. Women may walk at their normal pace. Hazrat Hajra, wife of Hazrat Ibrahim, ran several times between these two hills in search of water for her infant son, Ismail. Sayi is performed in memory of this act. This ritual shows respect for maternal love and gratitude to Allah.

3. Head Shaving or Shortening Hair

After Sayi pilgrims may shave their head or shorten hair and then may come out of Ihram. The women only cut a lock of the hair.

The practice of shaving or clipping hair is affirmed by the Quran and the Sunnah of the Prophet (P.B.U.H), Allah says **“Truly did Allah fulfill the vision for his Messenger, you shall enter the Sacred Mosque if Allah wills, with minds secure, heads shaved, hair cut short and without fear.” (Al-Fat-h 48:27)**. A person may shorten his hair or shave his head, but shaving carries more reward. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) blessed those who shaved three times more than those who just shorten their hair. Abu Hurairah reported, **“Allah’s Apostle said, o Allah! Forgive those who get their heads shaved, the people asked. “Also those who get their hair cut short?” the Prophet said “O Allah Forgive those who have their heads shaved.” The people said, “Also those who get their hair cut short?” The prophet (invoke Allah for those who have their heads shaved and) at the third time said, “also (forgive) those who get their hair cut short.”**

4. Rami at Jamarat

The three stone pillars situated in Mina are called Jamarat. One nearest to Makkah is called Jamarat-al-Uqba, the second which is near the mosque of Mina is called Jamarat-al-Wusta. At a little distance from this place is the Jamarat-al-Sughra. It is reported that Satan tried to deceive and mislead Hazrat Ibrahim at these three places and Hazrat Ibrahim stoned the devil. In memory of this, the devil is symbolically stoned at Mina during Hajj. It is to show that we reject the devil and obey no one but Allah.

The act of stoning the devil is called Rami. The approved method of doing Rami is to stand about five or six feet from the stone pillar, hold the pebble with the thumb and forefinger of the right hand and throw each pebble one after other and while doing so, the following is to be recited, **“In the name of Allah, the most Gracious, the most Merciful. Allah is great.”** The pebbles should fall as close to the pillar as possible.

5. The Ka’ba

was built by Adam, and later restored by Ibrahim and Isma’il, and again in the time of the Prophet.

- It was the first sanctuary in which God was worshipped.
- It is the focus of Muslim prayer from all parts of the world.
- It is the first point in Makka that most pilgrims make for.
- During pilgrimage Muslims circumambulate it seven times.
- They try to kiss the Black Stone as they pass it following the Prophet’s example.

6. Ihram

is the state of purity which Muslims enter when beginning the pilgrimage.

- The chief sign is for men two pieces of white cloth worn around them.
- For women it is normal clothes covering the whole body except face and hands.
- It removes signs of distinction and makes all pilgrims appear equal.
- In the state of ihram the pilgrim comes under particular restrictions of conduct, such as no cutting of hair or nails.

Kinds of Ihram

Ihram is of three kinds.

- Qiran (Combining both Umrah and Hajj)
- Tamatt'u (combining both Hajj and Umrah with a break in between)
- Ifrad (Hajj only)

All these three kinds are legitimate. Aishah reported, **"We left (Madinah) with Allah's Messenger (P.B.U.H) to perform the farewell Hajj. Some of us declared Ihram to perform Umrah while other declared their intentions to perform both Hajj and Umrah. Yet others declared their Ihram to perform Hajj only. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) declared Ihram for Hajj only. As for those who intended Umrah they terminated their Ihram as soon as they finished the rituals of Umrah. Those who intended to combine Hajj with Umrah or those who intended to perform Hajj only they did not terminate their Ihram until the Slaughtering Day (Yawm un-Nahr), the 10th of Dhul-Hijjah"** (agreed)

7. Talbiyah

Talbiyah is the proclamation of following words

"I respond to your call o Allah! I respond to your call and I am obedient to your orders, you have no partner, I respond to your call. All the praises and blessings are for you, all the sovereignty is for you, and You have no partners with you"

As soon as the pilgrim enters the state of Ihram he must proclaim Talbiyah loudly. The pilgrim proclaims Talbiyah throughout his journey when he rides his conveyance and sets out for his journey; meets a group or a person early in the morning and after every prescribed prayer. Jabir reported that the Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **"Whosoever makes intention to perform Hajj and pronounces Talbiyah all day until sunset, Allah the Almighty will forgive his sins, and he will be free of sin as he was the day his mother gave birth to him"** (Ibn-Majah)

8. **'Arafat** is the plain outside Makka where all pilgrims gather during the annual pilgrimage.

- Here they perform the wuquf, standing between noon and dusk in order to obtain God's forgiveness.
- This is the high point of the pilgrimage, without which it is not valid.
- Adam and his wife were reunited here after being expelled from the garden.
- The last judgement will take place here.

9. Sacrifice ('Id al-Adha)

The practice of sacrifice is commemorated annually as a rite of the Hajj on the tenth of Dhul-Hajj on Eid al-Adha in Memory of the great Sacrifice of Ibrahim and Ismail. The Prophet Ibrahim had a dream ordering him to sacrifice his son, when he narrated his dream to Ismail he immediately offered to comply with the command of Allah, Allah says, **"And when (his son) was old enough to work with him (Abraham) said o my dear son I have seen in a dream that I must sacrifice you. So look what do you think? He said o my father! Do that what you are commanded. Allah willing you shall find me of the steadfast."** (As-Saffat 37:102)

Sacrifice is offered after rammi on jamarattulaqabah. A sacrificial animal may be a camel, a cow or a lamb. A camel must be at least five years old, a cow two years old and a goat a year old at least. The animal should be healthy and free from all physical defects.

Muslims all over the world offer the sacrifice and celebrated Eid ul Adha on that day. Allah's Messenger (P.B.U.H) said, **"On the day of sacrifice no one does a deed more pleasing to Allah than the shedding of blood. The sacrifice will come on the day of Resurrection with its horns, its hair and its hooves, and the blood find acceptance with Allah before it falls on the ground, so be glad about it."** (Trimidhi).

The sacrifice is offered after the Eid prayer by Muslims other than the Pilgrims it may be offered for three days the Prophet said, **"All the Tashriq days are days of slaughtering."** (Ahmad) One may keep a part of the sacrifice meat, distribute a part and give in charity the third part

10. Maqam-e- Ibrahim.

Maqam-e-e Ibrahim also known as The station of Ibrahim is the large stone block on which Hazrat Ibrahim stood while building the upper walls of Holy Ka'bah . It is believed that this rock was sent from Heaven to Hazrat Ibrahim along with three other rocks one of which is the Sacred Black Stone, also Known as hajr-e-Aswad. The second one is the rock of the children of Israel and the third one is the Maqam-e- Ibrahim.

The block was moved further when the construction of one part was completed and in this way all the upper portion of Ka'bah was constructed. When the construction was completed the block was left there on eastern side of the Holy Ka'bah.

One of the Miracle of Hazrat Ibrahim which many of us might be unaware of is that when he stood on that rock it became soft and his feet dived into the rock which resulted in making the impression of his feet on the rock. After several hundred years those impression are still on that rock.

Saeed bin Jubair R.A reported tha the Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **“The stone is the station of Ibrahim Allah made it soft and made it a mercy. Ibrahim would stand on it and Ismail would hand to stone up to him.”**

During the Khilafat of Hazrat Umar R.A he got it moved from the eastern side of Holy Ka'bah to the front of Ka'bah just close to the door of the sanctuary. It was done so that the Muslim may not face any difficulty while performing Tawaf as it used to come in their way. The present place where it is located now is the place where Hazrat Ibrahim offered two rakah prayers after finishing the construction of Ka'bah. During Tawaf at the time of Hajj and Umarah it is desirable if the Muslims offer two rakah prayers behind Maqam-e-Ibrahim. A person may offer prayer from a distance so that no trouble is caused to other Muslims performing Tawaf. It is mandatory to offer Prayer after finishing Tawaf or will Tawaf will not be accepted Allah said in Holy Quran Surah Al Baqarah **“Remember We made the house a place of assembly for men and a place of safety; and take ye the station of Abraham as a place of prayer and we covenanted with Abraham and Ismail that they should sanctify. May house for those who compass it round or use it, as a retreat, or bow, or prostrate themselves (therein in prayer).” [2:125]**

11. Hajr-e-Aswad

Mounted in silver and set in the southeastern corner of the Ka'bah is the sacred Black Stone. Hajr-e- Aswad received by Hazrat Ismail from the angel Jibrail during the rebuilding of the Ancient House. According to traditions, this stone was milky white; it has become black because of the sins of people. This holy stone was touched or kissed by Hazrat Ibrahim and by the holy prophet (P.B.U.H). Its kissing is symbolic of pure love of Allah and our resolve to obey Him in all matters. The act of kissing the Hajr-e-Aswad is called istilam. The palms of both hands are placed on it, with the face between the two palms, And the stone is kissed in such a way that no sound is produced. If it is not possible to kiss the stone in this manner it may merely be touched with the right hand and the hand kissed or if that is not possible one may rise the palms of hand towards the Hajr-e-Aswad and kiss the palms.

Mutaf

It is the place inside Masjid-e-Haram and around the Ka'bah on which Tawaf is performed.

Al Multazim

It is a place of holding this is the portion of wall of Ka'bah between its door and Hajr-e-Aswad. Here the pilgrim prays to Allah for forgiveness.

Mina

It is a plain, which lies between Arafat and Makkah. The path way into this plain passes through Hill called Aqabah which is famous in the history of Islam as the place where Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) took the two pledges from the Ansars of Madinah.

Muzdalifah

It is plain between Mina and Arafat about six miles from Makkah and three miles from Mina. In the Holy Quran this place is called the sacred Monument and Muslim are specially asked to remember Allah at this place **“When ye pour down from Arafat celebrate the praises of Allah at the Sacred Monument” (2:198)**

Ramal

This is the memory of an incident that took place when the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) and his companions came to Makkah from Madinah for performing Ummrah. The unbelievers of Makkah taunted them and said that the climate of Madinah had made them so weak that they could not perform Tawaf properly. When the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) heard this he ordered his companions to expand their chests and walk briskly moving their shoulders. Walking in this fashion is called Ramal. This is done in the first three circuits the normal gait being resumed in the remaining for circuits. There is no Ramal for women.

(b) In what ways are the prophet Ibrahim and his family important to the annual pilgrimage? [4]

- The Qur'an says Ibrahim built or rebuilt the ka'ba
- His family lived in Makka
- Hajar ran between Marwa and Safa searching for water (sa'y)
- Isma'il uncovered the well of Zamzam by scraping his heel on the earth
- Ibrahim rejected the devil three times when taking his son for sacrifice (rami)
- An animal was provided for Ibrahim to sacrifice in place of his son (sacrifice)

(b). Give reasons to show how pilgrimage brings an individual Muslim closer to Allah. [4]

- This is a way of showing dedication to Islam, by performing one of the Pillars.
- Pilgrimage is a source of seeking forgiveness from Allah.
- Pilgrim feels that he is standing in the presence of Allah and recites Talbiah (Here I am at your service).
- Remembrance of Allah with extreme concentration and humbleness brings an individual closer to Allah.
- Pilgrim endures hardships in the way of Allah and gets trained to make sacrifice for Him.
- Pilgrim leaves his home, his country, his business and his relatives and come to perform pilgrimage to seek the pleasure of Allah.
- Pilgrim follows the footprints of Hazrat Ibrahim and Holy Prophet (PBUH).
- During pilgrimage, a pilgrim rejects evil and materialism.

4. (b) Explain how the outward actions performed during umra improve a pilgrim's inner spirituality. [4]

- fulfilling the different observances of umra helps a pilgrim to develop their inner spirituality in a number of ways.
- upon donning the ihram a pilgrim is reminded of the equality of all men before God and this makes him/her feel humbled.
- The recitation of the talbiya focusses the mind of the pilgrims on the fact that they have come in response to the call of their Creator, that they are obedient to him and acknowledge that no one is worthy of worship besides God.
- With the tawaf, each pilgrim is glorifying God, praising him, seeking forgiveness and acknowledging his greatness and superiority.
- Just to look upon the Ka'ba is a spiritual experience of immense magnitude for every Muslim.
- the two rakah at the station of Ibrahim, the sa'y and the shaving/cutting of hair at the end of the umra improve the inner spirituality of the pilgrim.

5(b) What is the significance of the Black Stone (*Hajr al Aswad*) to Muslims? [4]

- some believe it's a meteor that fell from the sky, whilst others believe that an angel brought the stone to Hazrat Ibrahim when he was building the Ka'ba.
- Throughout history because of natural disasters the Ka'ba has been destroyed and rebuilt many times but the *Hajr al Aswad* has always remained as a reminder of the origin of the Ka'ba.
- it is significant also because it is the only part remaining from the original structure that was built by Ibrahim.
- one is identifying with Ibrahim, when one touches it or raises one's hand towards it, who is the spiritual father of monotheism and that by touching it and kissing it a Muslim is following the *Sunna* of the Prophet.

- **4(b) Why in your opinion is it desirable that the pilgrims should visit Madina after the performance of hajj or umra? [4]**
- it is desirable for Muslims to visit Madina as it is a sacred city and is significant in the history of Islam as Islam flourished and spread from Madina,
- it was the city chosen by the Prophet (pbuh) to live in even after the conquest of Mecca
- The Prophet (pbuh) sanctified Madina just as Ibrahim sanctified Mecca.
- Prophet (pbuh) is buried in Madina and a Hadith states that the Prophet (pbuh) said: **'who makes pilgrimage and then visits my grave after my death is like one who visits me in my life.'** Hence making it desirable for Muslims to visit it.
- **5(b) In your opinion should hajj be performed as many times as possible in a Muslim's life? Give reasons for your answer. [4]**
- • The Prophet (pbuh) performed hajj once in his lifetime so following his Sunna Muslims should also perform hajj once in their lifetime.
- • hajj should not be performed more than once in a lifetime so that those who have not performed it get a chance to fulfil this Pillar.
- • if a Muslim has performed hajj once he could sponsor the hajj of one who cannot afford the journey so they can experience it and fulfil this Pillar.
- • some Muslims may want to perform hajj more than once to be able to repent for their sins and to seek God's forgiveness. They may want to perform a hajj e badal for a deceased loved one who had not performed hajj in their lifetime.

Jihad

M/J 2014

5 (a) Write an account of:

(i) The Prophet's teachings about armed warfare (jihad).

(ii) Under what circumstances is jihad thought to be compulsory? [10]

(i)

As the head of the Islamic state and the commander of Muslim army The Prophet laid down a set of rules about conduct during armed warfare (jihad). Some of these rules are:

- Muslims should not be the first to initiate fighting.
- Civilians are not to be harmed.
- Fruit-bearing trees are not to be cut down.
- Animals whose meat can be eaten should not be killed.
- Places of worship of any faith should not be demolished.
- Asylum should be granted to surrendering soldiers... **"And if anyone of the pagans seeks your protection then grant him protection, so that he may hear the Word of Allah, and then escort him to where he can be secure, because they are men without knowledge."**(9:6)
- The treatment of prisoners of war is also clearly stated in the Quran, Prisoners of war under Muslims are to eat, drink and dress the same way as Muslim soldiers eat drink and dress. Even under the unfortunate event of shortage of food, it is the prisoners who are to be fed first, before the Muslim soldiers guarding them.
- The fallen and the dead should not be mutilated or disfigured.
- The treaties should be respected and fulfilled.
- Ambassadors should not be killed or mistreated.
- No unjustifiable aggression should be inflicted on weaker nations.
- The Prophet (p.b.u.h) gave the following instructions to the troops he sent to Byzantine, **"In avenging the injuries inflicted upon us, molest not the harmless inmates of domestic seclusion, spare the weak of the female sex, injure not the infants at the breast or those who are ill in bed, abstain from demolishing the dwelling of the unresisting inhabitants, destroy not the means of their subsistence, nor their fruit trees and touch not the trees."** (At-Tabarani)

(ii) Conditions under which Jihad becomes Obligatory

- Jihad becomes obligatory when not only the ideology and beliefs of Muslims are threatened, but also when their homes, lives, property and everything else is in danger. Muslims are commanded to fight those who fight against them in these words, Allah says, **"Fight in the cause of Allah those who fight you but do not transgress limits, for Allah loves not transgressors."** (Al-Baqarah 2:190)

Whenever a Muslim state is attacked by any other state it becomes a religious duty of every Muslim of the state to fight against the invaders. If the Muslim state under attack is not strong enough to defend itself then it becomes the religious duty of other neighboring states to help. If they are unsuccessful, then it becomes the duty of all Muslim states of the world to help her. The best example of this in modern time is that of Afghanistan when it was attacked in 1980 by the Soviet Union, all Muslim countries rushed to help it.

- Fighting is to be continued till peace is restored and oppression comes to an end, Allah says, **"And fight them on until there is no more tumult or oppression and there prevails justice and faith in Allah, but if they cease let there be no hostility except to those who practice oppression."** (Al-Baqarah 2:191)

- Muslims should never be the first to attack any innocent or peaceful people. Peaceful co-existence between non-Muslims and Muslims is urged, **“(However, the treaties are) not dissolved with those pagans with whom you have entered into alliance and who have not subsequently failed you nor aided anyone against you. So fulfill your engagements with them to end of their terms: for Allah loves the righteous.”** (At-Taubah 9:4)
- Muslim states must maintain their treaties and friendly relations with non-Muslims states as long as they continue to respect the rights and agreements, Allah says, **“But if they violate their oaths after their covenant and taunt you for your faith fight you the chiefs of unfaith: for their oaths are nothing to them, that thus they may be restrained.”** (At-Taubah 9:12) When these conditions cease to exist and peaceful life returns to the state, they are required to cease their war operation.

O/N 2015

5 (a) Describe the meaning of the term jihad and say how Muslims can practice jihad in their everyday lives. [10] .

Jihad is an Arabic term, and its meaning is “to strive or work hard for something”. Jihad is basically the name given to every activity and movement in the way of Allah (SWT). It means to strive to make justice superior and dominant. In other words, jihad has to do with action in Islam; it is the power of Islam to act. Therefore, the meaning of the word “jihad” is not “war.” To fight for the sake of Allah (SWT) is also a kind of jihad but, in general terms, this word includes any kind of activity and action to make the religion of Allah goes everywhere in the world or spreading of religion Islam for Almighty Allah.

There are different kinds of jihad They are:

jihad of the self (jihad bin- nafs); Jihad of the tongue (jihad bil- lisan); jihad by the hand (jihad bil- yad) and jihad by the sword (jihad bis-saif).

1. **Jihad against one's self:** Jihad bil Nafs is concerned with fighting against “evil” (un-Islamic) desires and the devil in the attempt to escape his inducement to evil. We can say this is the “internal” jihad or **Jihad against satan.**

we should fulfill Allah's commands with the patience and have proper faith in Almighty Allah no matter what situation we are facing, always put strong faith in Almighty Allah. Shaytaan will try to break our faith but we have to stick against him

2. ***Jihad bil-lisan (jihad of the tongue)*** *is speaking and upholding the truth, speaking out against what is wrong and immoral, and spreading the word of Allah and the teaching of Islam*

It means to teach people the truth and good. God almighty addresses in the Quran, “Invite all to the way of thy Lord with wisdom and beautiful preaching and argue with them in ways that are best and most gracious.” The Quran is gouge for spiritual social and individual life of human being until the Day of Judgment. The duty of presenting the teachings of the Quran to humanity was given to Muslims. The Quran says, **“You are the best of people evolved for mankind enjoining what is right, forbidding what is wrong and believing in Allah”** The Prophet also said that,

A man asked: “What kind of jihad is better?” The Prophet (SAW) replied: **“A word of truth spoken in front of an oppressive ruler.”**

3. ***Jihad by the pen/Knowledge:*** *Jihad by the pen/knowledge or jihad bilqalam/ilm is a form of jihad involving scholarly research of Islam in understanding the message of Islam, for aiding the separate as well as defense of Islam, the publishing written article clearing misconceptions and correcting lies against Islam. The messenger of Allah once stated that the ink of the scholar is holier than the blood of a martyr.*
4. ***Jihad by the hand:*** *Jihad by hand or jihad bil yad is a jihad of action rather than words. At certain areas it overlaps with zakat (charity) and hajj (pilgrimage). Some of its examples include giving charity to the poor and needy, performing hajj or Umarah, helping those who need help, saving people's lives etc. These are more of physical deeds instead of words, “A person whose feet*

become dust-ridden because of (striving) in the way of Allah will never be touched by the flames of Hell"

5. **Jihad bis-saif (jihad by the sword)** referring to **qital fi sabilillah**(armed fighting in the way of Allah), is the most common usage-a term that has been exploited and misused as 'holy war'. In terms of **physical combat**, the Qur'an uses the word **Qital** which is restricted and limited by particular conditions ,i.e. when all other worldly options have been explored and exhausted and the very existence of Islam and Muslims is threatened.

"And why should you not fight in the cause of Allah and of those who, being weak, are ill-treated (and oppressed) men, woman and children, whose cry is: 'Our Lord! rescue us from this town, whose people are oppressors; and raise for us from thee one who will help.' (Al NISA, 4:75)

In order to better understand the Qur'anic principles in this context, there are several significant precedents to consider. The early Muslims living in Makka as a minority were not allowed to respond to Makkan oppression by taking military action until specific permission was divinely given. They endured oppression for many years and, despite their impatient urgings, the Prophet would not allow them to respond with violence. At one point, he allowed a group of his most oppressed followers to migrate and seek sanctuary with al-Najashi, the Christian king of Abyssinia.

According to the Qur'an, if the enemy ceased hostilities and sought peace, Muslims were to seek peace as well.

"If your enemy inclines towards peace, then you should seek peace and trust in Allah. Verily, He is the All-Hearer, the All-Knower." (ANFAL 8.61)

Moreover, the Qur'an instructs Muslims not to haughtily turn away unbelievers who seek to make to peace with them, and reminds Muslims that:

"If Allah would have willed, He would have given the unbelievers power over you [Muslims]. Therefore, if they [the unbelievers] withdraw from you and refuse to fight you, and instead, send you guarantees of peace, know that Allah has not given you a licence [to fight them]." (Al-NISA 4.90)

5. (b) 'The Prophet's teachings about armed warfare (jihad) are not relevant today'.

Do you agree? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

- disagree with the statement.
- the teachings of the Prophet regarding armed warfare are just as relevant today as they were in the Prophet's time and that we must have respect for life and the environment .
- use jihad as a last resort and when engaged in it make sure that the code of conduct set by the Prophet is followed.
- importance of these teachings can be understood from the fact that they are included in the Universal charter of human rights by the United Nations.

5.(b) Why do you think jihad of the self (jihad bil-nafs) is greater than armed jihad (jihad bis-saif)? [4]

- It is most important because it is the struggle to resist temptation to evil and to overcome one's own weakness and failings on daily basis which many a time is harder to do.
- Islamic ethical teachings indicate that one who succeed in this struggle that rise above the level of angels and the one who fails in it may even be grouped in the followers of satan.
- When divine powers succeed again evil a person emerges as virtues and blessed

Pillars of Islam

Regular Daily Prayer (Salat)

M/J 2015

3 (a) Give an account of the conditions required for ablution (wudu) and the method of performing it. [10]

Answer (Learn and write:)

Conditions of wudu:

Ablution or wuzu in prescribed manner is necessary for a person who intends to say his prayers as the Quran says, **“O you who believe! when you prepare for prayer, wash your faces and your hands (and arms) to the elbows, rub your heads (with water) and (wash) your feet to the ankles” (5:6)**

- Making the intention or **niyat** of Wuzu, **“I intend to perform the Wuzu for securing Allah’s good pleasure and in compliance with His command”** .
- If possible, one should sit facing the Qiblah.
- The water to be used for Wuzu should be absolutely clean.
- The wuzu should be in continuous process, without any break or interval. No part should be allowed to dry up before the other is washed.
- each part being washed and cleaned in the prescribed order,
- Washing should start from the right side then left.
- No part should remain dry.
- It is recommended to brush ones teeth or use miswak before or after wudu.

Method of wudu:

The approved method of performing wuzu is

- to wash both hands upto the wrists thrice, the wet fingers should be passed in between each other. If there are any bangles on the wrists or ring on the fingers, as in the case of females they should be moved around so that the skin under them does not remain dry.
- After this rinse the mouth thrice.
- Next some water should be taken in the right hand and sniffed into the nostrils thrice and then blown out. The left hand should be used for cleaning nose.
- Then the whole face should be washed with both hands, thrice from the forehead down to the lower portion of the chin and from the lobe of one ear to the other.
- Thereafter, first the right arm and then the left arm up to the elbows should be washed thrice.
- After washing the arms wipe the head with wet hands and perform Masah from front to back, and pass the back of wet hands over the nape of the neck. Clear the inner side of ears with forefingers and outer with thumbs.
- Finally wash the feet right and the left upto the ankles.

M/J 2021(22)

5(a) Write about the different types of purification before the performance of salat:

- wudu
- tayammum; and
- ghusl.[10]

Answer:

Tayammum (Dry Ablution)

In the case of water not being available for the performance of wudu or a person being bed-ridden due to illness, Tayammum (dry ablution) should be done. Regarding tayammum the Quran says, **“If you are ill or on a journey...And you find no water, then take for yourselves clean sand or earth and rub therewith your faces and hands. Allah does not wish to place you in a difficulty, but to make you clean.” (5:6)**

From the ayat above, Muslim come to know the permission for tayammum is given by Allah in case of non-availability of water, or on grounds of illness.

However, it must be noted that as soon as the restrictive reason for not doing wudu is removed tayammum becomes void.

This approved traditional **method** of performing tayammum is

- to recite Tasmiah
- and then to make the intention to perform tayammum.
- After this both hands should be struck on some clean and pure earth or sand or stone.
- Next, the excessive sand should be blown off.
- Then both hands are rubbed on the face in such a way that no part of the face which has to be washed by wudu, is left out.
- In the case of males with beards, it is desirable to pass the fingers through the beard.
- Then both hands should be struck again on the clean earth or sand and, after blowing off the excess dust, they should be passed over first the right and then the left arm upto the elbows. This completes the tayammum.
- A dry stone free of dust, a brick or an earthen pot may also be used for this purpose.
- The acts which nullify wudu also nullify tayammum.

Ghusl:

It is reported on the authority of Aa'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her, who said that the Messenger of Allah ﷺ when performing Ghusl from Janaabah (ritual impurity), used to wash his hands, then wash his private parts with his left hand. After that he performed Wudhoo' like that for prayer. Next, he took some water and ran his fingers in the roots of his hair until he used three handfuls of water on his head. He would then go on pouring water on the rest of his body and wash his legs. [Muslim]

- The person taking a bath should first of all wash both hands up to the wrists, and then wash the private parts. The hands and private parts should be washed irrespective of whether there is any impurity on them or not. Both these have to be washed under all conditions. Thereafter, any impurity found on the rest of the body should be washed. Then make Wudhoo'
- After performing Wudhoo', pour water on the head three times. Thereafter pour water over the right and left shoulders three times each in such a way that water reaches the entire body.
- Whilst pouring water over the body the first time, rub the body well so that water reaches everywhere properly and no place remains dry.

- The above method of Ghusl is according to the Sunnah. Some of the items explained above are Fardh (obligatory) without which Ghusl will not be complete and the person will remain impure. Some other items are Sunnah (recommended but not obligatory). Observing them entails reward, and by not carrying them out, Ghusl will still be complete.

The Fardh acts are only three:

1. To gargle the mouth in such a way that water reaches everywhere.
2. To wash the nose up to the soft bone.
3. To pour water over the entire body.

Conditions/Preparations of Prayers

M/J 2010

5 (a) What are the conditions of prayer (salat) that must be fulfilled before performing them. [10]

M/J 2012

4 (a) Give a detailed account of how Muslims prepare for prayer. [10]

O/N 2017 (22)

5(a) Prayers (salat), whether obligatory or voluntary, require preparation. Write an account of how a Muslim prepares for it? [10]

Answer(Learn and write)

Before a person can say his regular prayers, the following conditions must be fulfilled; otherwise the prayers would be void:

- The body of the person must be clean. Salat requires purification through ablution (wuzu) or by taking bath. Wuzu includes washing of hand, mouth, nostrils, face, arms, across the head, back of the neck, and the feet. Quran says, **“O you who believe! When you prepare for prayer wash your faces and hands to the elbows; rub your heads and wash your feet to the ankles.” [5:6]**
- Permission for resorting to Tayammum is granted on the grounds of illness, travelling and the non-availability of water. It can be performed instead of wuzu (ablution).
- The clothes worn must be clean and free from all impurities. The Quran says, **“He loves those who keep themselves pure and clean” (2:222)**. The Holy Prophet said, **“Surely Allah does not accept prayers without purification.”**
- The place where the prayers are to be said must be clean and free from all impurities. Prayers should preferably be performed in the mosques because it carries 27 times more reward for men.
- The ‘SATAR’ (those parts of body which should be kept covered) must be properly covered. For a male, the Satar consists of the portion of the body from the navel to the knees. For a female, her entire body with the exception of her face, hands and feet is Satar.
- It must be the time for the particular prayer to be offered otherwise it can be performed as Qaza.
- The prescribed timing for **farz** prayers are, **Fajr**: this is an early morning prayer, **Zuhr** late afternoon prayer, **Asr** late afternoon prayer, **Maghrib** evening prayer and **Isha** early night prayer.
- It is prohibited to pray when the sun is in the Meridian or is rising or setting and this prohibition applies to both fard and nafl prayers. The Quran says, **“Prayers have indeed been enjoined on believers at fixed times.” [4:103]**

- The Qiblah (direction of the Kaabah) must be faced while saying the prayer. The Quran says, **“Turn then your face in the direction of the sacred mosque, wherever you are, turn your faces in that direction.” [2:150]**w
- Intention or niyat must be declared for saying the kind of prayer i.e., Farz, Sunnat etc., of the particular prayer time i.e., Fajr, Zuhr etc. that one of offering.

Spiritual and individual importance of Prayer

O/N 2014

4 (a) The Prophet said, ‘Between a person and disbelief is discarding prayer.’ What benefits do Muslims find in regular prayer (salat)? [10]

M/J 2016

4 (a) Outline the main teachings in the Qur’an and Prophetic Hadiths about prayer (salat) as the foundation of Islam. [10]

Answer (Learn and write)

Prayer is the second pillar of Islam. Prayer was the first act of worship that that was made obligatory by Allah. It is the first act that the person will be held accountable for on the day of judgment, the Messenger of Allah Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **“The first act that the slave will be accountable for on the day of judgment will be the prayer.”**

The word salat occurs **67 times** in the Quran. It is obligatory on every adult, sane Muslim males or females whether he is at home or traveling, in peace or war, healthy or sick. However, women are exempted from offering salat during the menstruation period.

It is not obligatory for child to pray, however it is obligatory for the parents to order him to pray when he is seven years old.

- Prayers instill self discipline in an individual. A Muslim pray five time a day at the fixed times. He learns to be punctual at every prayer or he will be late and miss the congregation. This is repeated five times a day which instills habit of regularly Allah says. **“prayer at fixed hours has been enjoined upon the believers (An- Nisa 4:103)**
- Salat makes a person clean and pure both physically and spiritually. When a person prays regularly he keeps his body clean by making ablution before every prayer while salat itself keeps him spiritually pure the Prophet (P.B.U.H) asked his companions, **“Do you believe that dirt can remain on a person bathing five times a day in a stream running in front of his door? The companions replied that no dirt can remain on his body. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) remarked so exactly similar is the effect of the prayer offered five times a day. With the grace of Allah it washes away all sins. Ablution washes out physical dirt while prayers wipe out spiritual.” (Agreed)**
- A Muslim completely submits himself to Allah. He stands in humility in the presence of Allah with both hands folded; he bows Kneels and prostrate. He shows his utter dependence on Allah. **“Successful indeed are the believers who are humble in their prayers.” (Al-Muminun 23:1)**
- Prayer develops piety and fear of Allah in a person and restrains him from evil, Allah says, **“Established regular prayers for it restrains from shameful and unjust deeds” (Al-Ankabut 29:45)**
- Prayer develops patience, endurance, contentment, and perseverance in a person. Allah says, **“Therefore, be patient with what they say and celebrate the praises of your Lord before the rising of the sun and before its setting.” (Ta-Ha 20:130)**

Benefits of congregational Prayer

} O/N 2012

5 (a) What is the purpose of prayers in congregation? [10]

Answer (Learn and write)

Congregational prayer has a great reward, the messenger of Allah (p.b.u.h) said, **“Prayer in congregational is better than the prayer of a man by himself by twenty-seven times.”** (Agreed)

Muslims are enjoined to pray congregational prayers in a mosque. Only Fard are to be said in congregation. The other rakats are said singly. One person with Imam will constitute a congregation even if the other person is a child or a woman.

If the congregation is of two people then the follower will be on the right side, if a third person joins the prayer, the imam will move forward, and if women form a congregation, then the woman who leads stands in the middle if they are in odd numbers, if the number of women is even then more women will be on the right hand side.

The best person to lead the prayers is one who is well acquainted with the Qur'an and Hadiths. Before the congregation starts rows are straightened and the gaps are filled. The worshippers should stand shoulder to shoulder, the iqama is said and after making the intention the prayer is read. Women are allowed to join the congregation but their prayer in their houses is better. Men are excused from congregation, only in case of rain, extreme weather, or illness.

This was the Practice of the Holy Prophet (p.b.u.h) and his immediate successors who always led the congregational prayers of the believers five times a day in the mosque at Madinah.

- Islam lays special stress on prayer in congregation. The Quran says: **“And bow down your heads with those who bow down (in worship).”(2:43)**

The Holy Prophet (p.b.u.h) is reported to have said:

“ If there are three persons in a village or even in a desert and they do not pray together, the devil would surely over take them. So always pray Salat in congregation, for a wolf only injures a solitary sheep.”(Abu Daud)

- Congregational prayer serves as **a strong force in uniting the believers**. The gathering of all people living in a locality five times daily in the Mosque helps in the **establishment of healthy social relations** between different sections of the Muslim community. This gathering becomes larger in the weekly Friday service and still larger in the two Eid gatherings. This reaches its climax on the occasion of the annual pilgrimage when Muslims from all parts of the world assemble in Makkah.
- Congregational **prayer levels social differences and promotes an atmosphere of equality and brotherhood**. In the mosque, a king may stand shoulder to shoulder with his poorest subjects and the white man with the black. Congregational prayer leads to the realization among the worshipers that **all men are equal before Allah**.
- These lessons of **equality, fraternity and brotherhood**, when put into practice, serve as a foundation for the **unification of the human race**. However much Islam may have preached the equality of mankind and the brotherhood of Muslims, it would have been purposeless without being put into practice through the institution of congregational prayer.

Friday Prayer

O/N 2016

5 (a) Describe the particular features of Friday congregational prayers (Jum'a) and the main features of the Friday sermon. [10]

Answer (Learn and write)

Friday (jummah) means to congregate, gather or get together. All Muslim men in a community should try to gather for this prayer. In some communities women are also encouraged to attend. It is obligatory on every Muslim male.

Quran says,

“O ye who believe! When the call is proclaimed on Friday (the day of assembly) hasten earnestly to the remembrance of Allah, and leave off business (and traffic) that is best for you if ye but knew.”

Prophet pbuh said, **“performing Friday prayer is obligatory on every Muslim adult male.”**

- There are **special preparations** for this prayer. Muslims should try to take bath and put on fresh clothes and should attain purification by ablution or by taking a bath. The Quran says, **“O you who believe! When you prepare for prayer, wash your faces and hands to the elbows; rub your heads; and wash your feet to the ankles.”**
- There are **two azans** for congregational prayers. Muslims should try to reach the mosque on the first *azan*. On reaching the mosque, they should offer *Tahayyat-ul-Masjid* prayers and then four *pre-farz Sunnats*. The second *azan* is called before the sermon.
- The Imam then **preaches two sermons**, which are compulsory to hear. These sermons always consist of advice based on the Holy Quran and Hadith about living a Muslim life. In non Arab countries an additional sermon is delivered in the native language.
- People should not speak, pray or use mobiles during the sermon, and listen attentively. Even the recitation of Quran is not allowed during the sermons.
- After the Sermons, **iqamat** is called and people arrange themselves in rows.
- Friday prayer **takes place of Zuhr prayer** therefore, The *farz* are prayed in two *rakats*, not four.
- This *farz* prayer **can't be prayed alone or after the set time**. Muslims should say the prayer together behind the Imam.
- If someone is unable to perform this prayer in congregation within the prescribed time then he must offer the Qaza for Zuhr prayer.
- Some people are exempt from Friday prayers, e.g. travellers, the sick, women and children.

The Friday sermons include:

- Glorification and praise of God, confirming the aspect of tawhid
- Praise and blessings on the Prophet (pbuh) as the greatest example to follow and sending peace and blessings on him
- Reflection /reinforcement of the Quranic verses that have been selected for the particular sermon
- Referring to an authentic hadith to elaborate the topic and demonstrate the implementation of the injunction by the Prophet (pbuh)
- The imam reminds the whole congregation about their duties towards God and their fellow beings, he warns the people against the consequence of doing evil and reminds them of the hereafter
- Prays for the welfare of the community.

Eid Prayers

M/J 2013

4 (a) Describe how and why Muslims celebrate Eid al-Fitr and Eid al-Adha. [10]

M/J 2017

5(a) Write about the preparations made for the two 'Id prayers and say how the prayers are performed. [10]

Answer (Learn and write)

- The two main festivals in Islam are Eid-ul Fitr and Eid-ul-Azha. Eid means recurring happiness or festivals. **Eid-ul-Fitr** is celebrated on the **1st of Shawwal** which follows Ramazan or the month of Fasting. **Eid-ul-Azha** falls on the **tenth day of Zil Hajj** and follows the completion of Hajj.
- The prayers of two Eids were prescribed in the first year after migration. It is a sunnah Mu'akkadah as the Prophet (P.B.U.H) performed these prayers and he ordered the men and women to go out to attend them. These are congregational prayers and cannot be said individually. Eid prayers are not a substitute for the obligatory Fajr prayer and there is no Qaza for Eid prayer.
- It is preferred to take a bath, perfume oneself and put on one's best clothes on the occasion for both 'Id's. It is *sunna* to eat an odd number of dates before going for *salah* on 'id ul fitr whilst for 'id ul adha eating is delayed till after the 'Id prayers and then the believer may eat of his sacrifice, if he has sacrificed an animal. 'Id prayers can be performed in the mosque but it is preferred to perform it in a place outside the city or in an open ground. The Prophet (pbuh) would pray the two 'Id prayers on the outskirts of Madina, in fact he only offered 'Id prayers once in his mosque when it was raining.
- The time for Eid prayer is anytime after sunrise but before noon. Usually, Eid-ul-Azha prayers are held a little earlier than the Eid-ul-Fitr prayers. No Azaan or Iqamat is required
- Eid is a day of thanksgiving during which Muslims assemble in a brotherly and joyful atmosphere to offer their thanks to Allah for helping them to fulfill their spiritual obligations.
- Both Eids are the days of rejoicing and celebration. The Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **The days of Tashriq (the days in which the Eid is celebrated) are days of eating and drinking and of remembering Allah, the Exalted"**
- Eid ul Adha is celebrated in the memory of great sacrifice of the Prophet Ibrahim and Ismail. The Prophet Ibrahim had a dream in which Allah commanded him to sacrifice his son.
- It is desirable to congratulate each other on Eid, Jabir ibn Abdullah reported, **"When the companions of the Prophet (P.B.U.H) met each other on the day of Eid they would say to each other, 'taqqabbal minna wa minka' (may Allah) accept it from us and you"**
- The Eid day starts with congregational prayer in the morning. During the prayer, the Muslims remember and glorify Allah's name, and ask for His forgiveness and for strength of faith.

The method of prayer for Eid-ul-Fitr and Eid-ul-Azha is the same. The prayer consists of two Raka'at with the Imam reciting in each, Surah Fatihah and another passage from the Quran in an audible voice.

- The intention for prayer is in these words:

"I intend to offer two Raka'at Wajib of Eid-ul-Fitr/Eid-ul-Azha (as the case may be) with six additional Takbirs, behind this Imam and I am fasting Holy Ka'abah."

When the Imam recites Takbir-e-Tahrima, Allahu-Akbar in a loud voice, the Muqtadis (followers) should also say the Takbir in a low voice, and fold their hands as in other prayers. After reciting Sana, the Imam raises both hands upto the ears and says, the Takbir i.e., Allahu Akbar in a loud voice. The Muqtadis also raise their hands upto the ears and say the Takbir in a low voice. The Imam and the Muqtadis should then lower their hands and keep them hanging by their sides. They should repeat this twice. After the third Takbir, the hands to be folded in the usual manner. They shall now recite Tasmiyah, Surah Fatihah and some other Surah. After this, the first Rakat should be completed in the usual manner.

In the second Rakat, the Imam recite Tasmiyah, Surah Fatihah and some other Surah. After this, the Imam raises his hands and recites the Takbir in a loud voice. The Muqtadis also raise their hands and say the Takbir in low voice. They should now bring their hands down and keep them hanging by their sides. The hands should be raised and lowered and the Takbir said more two times. Both the Imam and the Muqtadis now say one more Takbir without raising their hands and bow down for Ruku. The second Rakat should be completed in the usual manner. After the two Raka'at of prayer are over, the Imam delivers the Khutba in two parts, with a short break in between. The Khutba is Sunnat and should be heard attentively.

In the sermon of Eid-ul-Fitr, the Imam must draw the attention of the audience to **Sadaqah-ul-Fitr**. This is a charity, which is obligatory on every Muslim who can afford it. This charity is more rewarding and preferable if it is distributed before the prayers, so that the poor may also be able to celebrate the day in a festive and cheerful spirit.

In the sermon of Eid-ul-Azha, the Imam should draw attention to the **duty of sacrifice**, which is to be observed by every Muslim with means. It is preferable to Slaughter the animal of sacrifice on Eid day after prayers. The sacrifice of an animal on second or third day of Eid is also acceptable.

Private Prayer (Dua)

4(a) Write about the following:

- The benefits of private prayer (du'a) in a Muslim's life.
- The times when God is thought most likely to accept du'a. [10]

Answer (Learn and write)

- **Invocation (du'ā')** is a prayer of supplication or request. Muslims regard this as a profound act of worship. Prophet Muhammad pbuh said, "**Dua is the very essence of worship.**" The word dua in Arabic means calling. It is the act of remembering Allah and calling out to Him.
- Aside from the obligatory five daily prayers, Muslims are encouraged to call upon Allah for forgiveness, guidance, and strength throughout their lives.
- Dua is a way to keep in touch with Allah and thanks to Dua, we are getting closer to our Lord. Thus, Dua is a source of rapprochement of the supplicant to Allah the Almighty.
- It is considered a way by which we can change our situation by asking the help of Almighty Allah. Dua can change destiny so try Dua in all situations because with Dua, you will always get closer to Almighty Allah.
- Dua is essentially a submission to the Creator and a demonstration of a person's need for Allah. Allah says in the Holy Qur'an: "**When my servants ask you about me, (tell them), I am really close to them, I listen to the prayer of each supplicant when he invokes me.**" (2: 186).
- These personal supplications or prayers (dua) can be made in their own words and in any language.
- One can pray privately for one's own affairs, to protect, guide, help, bless a relative, friend or even the entire Ummah.

- Allah is not a distant or remote Being, uncaring or indifferent to the calls of His Creation. In fact, He is Rahman and Raheem, and One who answers the sincere and true prayers of His believers.
- The Prophet (P.B.U.H) is reported to have said, **“Allah does not turn away, empty-handed, the one who calls upon Him in prayer.”**
- Muslims can call upon and supplicate their Creator wherever and however they may be, but it is recommended that one supplicating in earnest, it is better to be in a state of wudu, facing the qiblah, and, ideally, while in sujood (prostration), in humility before Allah.
- Muslims may recite dua before, during and or after formal prayer, or may recite them at various times throughout the day. Prophet Muhammad (SAW) said: **“Whoever desires that Allah respond to his Duas under adverse and difficult conditions, he should make Dua abundant in the days of ease and comfort.”**

There are few specific moments in life, when a Muslim’s dua is especially accepted. These opportune moments of the acceptance of dua are given below:

- While travelling.
- While sick or visiting the sick.
- Late at night (last third of the night).
- While prostrating (sujood)
- Between the Azaan and the iqamat.
- While experiencing injustice or oppression.
- On the Day of Arafat.
- During Ramadan/or during nafl fasts.

Times of Prayer:

- **Fajr** is an early morning prayer. The time of this prayer commences after the break of dawn and ends just before sunrise. It is makruh or undesirable to say prayers when the sun is rising. No nafl prayer is to be said till the sun has risen well.
- **Zuhr** is an Early afternoon prayer. The time of this prayer commences when the sun begins to decline and the shadows of things cease to decrease. It ends when the shadows of everything become equal to twice the size of its shadows at noon or mid-day. No prayer is to be said or the Quran recited at the time of the decline of the sun.
- **Asr** is a Late afternoon prayer. The time of this prayer commences immediately after the end of the time for Zuhr prayers and ends before sunset.
- **Magrib** is an evening prayer. The time of this prayer commences immediately after sunset and ends on the fading of twilight. No prayer is to be said or the Quran recited at the time of the setting of the sun.
- **Isha** is an early night prayer. The time of this prayer commences after the fading of twilight and ends before dawn but it is desirable to say this prayer before midnight.

Method of Prayer:

The approved traditional method of Prayer is to stand straight with the face towards the kaabah and with hands hanging down the sides of the body, the worshipper makes the intention (Niyat) for the (Farz/sunnah/Nafil) prayer that is to be offered. He then raises his hands to his ears and recites **“Takbir-e-Tahrima”** that is “Allah is the Greatest”. In this standing position which is known as **“Qiyam”** he first recites **Sana**, then he recites **Ta’awuz**. **“I betake myself to Allah for refuge from the accursed Satan”.**

and then the **Tasmiyah**.e“ **In the name of Allah, the Beneficent, the Merciful.**”then after reciting surah al **Fatiha** some other surah or at least three verses are recited, which is known as **Qirat**.

- The Qiyam is followed by **Ruku**. In this posture, while standing, bows forward and places both his hands on his knees and recites Tasbih-e-Rukui.e, “**Glory to my Lord, the Great**” at least three times. After this he recites **Tasmi and Tahmid** while standing straight. He stands erect for a short while which is known as “**Qaumah**”.
- The worshipper then bends down for **Sajdah** or Prostration while reciting Tabir. In this position the Tasbih-e-Sajdah.e,
“**Glory to my Lord , the Most High**” is recited at least three times.
- After performing two prostrations, he stands to perform the **second Rakat** in the same way, except that the **Sana is not recited** in the position of Qiyam.

After the second Rakat, he assumes the sitting position known as **Qa’adah**. In which he first recites Tahiyya and Tashhaud and then the Durud and a prescribed prayer. After this, he ends his prayer with **Taslim**. For this, he turns his face to the right and looking over the right shoulder, he says:“**Peace be upon you and the mercy of Allah.**”Then turning his face to the left looking over the left shoulder, he repeats the same words.

Delayed Prayer – Qaza

The believers are enjoined to offer their prayers at the appointed times. Failing to do so is a sin unless there is a reasonable excuse for delay. With the exception of prayers missed by woman in childbirth or menstruation and any Muslim who is insane or is unconscious for some time, every Muslim must offer the delayed obligatory prayer. These prayers have to be offered as soon as possible except at time at time when prostration is forbidden. In the Niyat, the word Qaza should be added.

If several prayers have been missed in a day, then the Qaza should be offered in proper order. For example if prayers have been missed beginning from Fajr then FajrQaza should be offer first, then Zuhr and Asr and so on. If the missed prayers are too numerous to remember or if the time available is not enough for both missed and present prayers, then the present prayer should be offered first. The missed prayer should be offer later.

Qaza can be offered for only the Farz and Witr prayers. Except for the pre-FarzSunnats of Fajr for which Qaza may be offered before sunset the same day, no Qaza of other Sunnats is to be offered.

If Zuhr, Asr or Isha prayers become Qaza While travelling, one should, when he returns home, offer the Qaza of these as if he was still a traveler that is, two Raka’ateach.If however, the prayers become Qaza before a journey, he should offer the full four Raka’at of the three prayers.

(b) How do the prayers (salat) help keep the community united. [4]

- Muslims perform the prayers at the same time.
- In mosques they congregate together and can meet.
- Even when praying alone they know others are praying with them.
- All have a sense of performing the same task. All the Muslims, rich and poor, white and black, stand together, shoulder to shoulder, before Allah in congregational prayer and perform the same acts together. This gives a sense of togetherness.
- All are reminded of their membership of one community.
- Communal prayers give opportunity to help each other and solve problems.

(No marks for descriptions of prayers)

5(b) What in your opinion is the importance of celebrating the two ‘Ids? [4]

- every religion has its own days of festival and that the two ‘Ids are Muslim festivals, which are days of rejoicing and celebration and remembrance of God for them.

- They mark two important events in the Islamic calendar, the completion of fasting during the month of Ramadan and the completion of hajj for the pilgrims and for the rest of the Muslim world it is a reminder of Ibrahim's willingness to sacrifice his beloved son in the way of God and as a symbolic gesture Muslims sacrifice an animal for the sake of God thus reminding themselves that no sacrifice is too great in the way of God.
- both 'Ids are practical examples of brotherhood in which all Muslims irrespective of creed or colour participate and thus it brings the community together.
- The two 'Ids give the Muslim community an opportunity to join in celebration, I'd fairs and parties strengthen ties of unity and eradicate differences, the rich give zakat and the meat of the animal they sacrifice on the two 'Ids respectively thus the poor in the community are helped and able to enjoy the two festivals.

(b) Explain the importance to the community of Muslims of mosques. [4]

(b) 'A mosque is a focal point in the lives of Muslims.' Discuss. [4]

The call for prayers are given from the minarets of mosques

- They are centres especially dedicated for collective worship.
- They enable the community to meet together which encourages healthy social relations and promotes brotherhood.
- They provide facilities for education and joint learning.
- By their appearance they remind the community that it is united.
- Their presence symbolises the community's unity and strength.
- Muslims sometimes withdraw to mosques for the conclusion of Ramadan
- There is a greater reward for praying in the mosque. It serves as an educational centre for Muslims and is also a place of retreat etc.

. Friday prayers, Eid prayers and funeral prayers can all be held in mosques.

(b) Explain the main differences between regular daily prayer (salat) and personal prayer (du'a'). [4]

- Regular prayer is always performed according to the pattern set by Qur'an and Sunna.
- It is obligatory, whereas personal prayers are voluntary.
- It has set timings, whereas du'a' prayers can be performed at any time.
- It is directed towards the Ka'ba,
- It consists of set formulas and actions, but du'a' prayers are not necessarily said according to a pattern.
- It is always in Arabic, but Du'a' prayers can be offered in any language.
- For regular prayers you need purification, but it is not obligatory for du'a' prayers.
- Regular prayer is worship to God but du'a' prayers comprise requests for oneself or others.
- They (personal prayers) are free, in that anyone or anything can be mentioned.
- They often consist of prayers spoken by the Prophet.

5.(b) Why is it beneficial for Muslims to pray salat five times a day? [4]

- By praying five times a day Muslims become God conscious and are therefore less likely to commit sins;
- it teaches them punctuality, cleanliness, fosters humility and brotherhood and is a lesson in living righteously.
- A Muslim completely submits himself to Allah. He stands in humility in the presence of Allah with both hands folded; he bows Kneels and prostrate. He shows his utter dependence on Allah. **“Successful indeed are the believers who are humble in their prayers.” (Al-Muminun 23:1)**
- Prayer develops piety and fear of Allah in a person and restrains him from evil, Allah says, **“Established regular prayers for it restrains from shameful and unjust deeds” (Al-Ankabut 29:45)** Prayer develops patience, endurance, contentment, and perseverance in a person.

3.(b) Why is ablution (wudu) given so much importance in your view? [4]

- Purity is given utmost importance in Islam.

- God has repeatedly enjoined people to purify themselves in Al-Baqarah 2:222 God says, '**Allah loves those who repent and purify themselves**'. The Prophet said '**purity is half of faith**'.
- Another reason that can be put forward is that the Prophet said that wudu removes the sins of a person .
- purifying oneself allows one to focus on God when in prayer. Candidates could discuss one or more reasons to answer this question.

3.(b) In your opinion why are congregational prayers considered to be beneficial to Muslims? [4]

(b) Why should meeting for congregational prayers be more advantageous than performing prayer alone? [4]

- The Prophet (pbuh) has said: '**Prayer in congregation is better than the prayer of a man by himself by twenty seven times**' (Agreed).
- it is in the sunna of the Prophet (pbuh) to pray in congregation,
- it promotes brotherhood, equality and unity amongst Muslims.
- It gives Muslims a chance to meet other Muslims and perhaps be able to help those who are in need, etc. and hence has a lot of social importance.
- On a more personal level it could be said that it requires more effort to leave what one is doing to get to the mosque in time for the salat.

5(b) In your opinion, what is the most important benefit of salat in the lives of Muslims? [4]

- the most important benefit of salat is that by having specific times of prayer believers remember God five times a day at least and remain aware of the importance of faith in daily life;
- Muslims start their day by purifying themselves and standing before their Lord. Another important benefit of salat is that it is a constant reminder to Muslims about the presence of God.
- It strengthens their dependence and faith in God and puts daily life in perspective of the hereafter and the final judgment.

General Questions

O/N 2015 (22)

3.(a) Describe the particular features of congregational prayers, both daily and on Fridays (Jum'a prayers). [10]

M/J 2016 (21)

4 (a) (i) Outline the main teachings in the Qur'an and Prophetic Hadiths about prayer (salat) as the foundation of Islam.

(ii) Describe how Muslims prepare themselves for prayer. [10]

O/N 2019 (22)

4(a) Write about the following:

- the conditions that should be met before Muslims start prayer (salat), and
- the importance of prayer (salat) in the life of Muslims. [10]

M/J 2020 (22)

5(a) How do Muslims prepare themselves for Friday (Jum'a) prayers and what are the special features of this prayer? [10]

Shahadah

There is no god but Allah and Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah”

There is no god but Allah is the first part of Shahadah. It deals with the unity of Allah. We confess with our heart that Allah is the lord the Master and Creator of all things the heaven and earth and everything there in. He is the sustainer, the provider, the organizer and the planner of all its affairs. It is he who gives life and takes the life away. **“Verily your Allah is one! Lord of heavens and of the earth and all between them and Lord of every point at the rising of the sun!” (Saffat 37:4-5)**

Allah is the only one worthy of worship. **“Your Lord has decreed that you worship none but Him” (Isra 17:1).** We pray to Allah we seek His help at the time of difficulty, **“You and we worship and your aid we seek” (Al-Fatiha 1:5).** We swear by His name, Offer, sacrifice to Him. We abide by His commands and refrain from everything He had forbidden.

We also testify that all the names and attributes which Allah has named Himself or the Prophet (P.B.U.H) has named or qualified Him belong to Allah alone without changing their meanings or likening them to others. He sees and hears everything. He is omnipotent; he knows everything; the hidden and the manifest. He is omnipotent; all powerful and, nothing is like Him, Allah says, **“There is nothing whatever like unto Him and He is the One that hears and sees (all things).” (Ash-Shura 42:11)’**

The second part of the declaration **“Muhammad is His slave and apostle”** shows its inseparable relation to the first. The holy Prophet’s (P.B.U.H) name is the name most closely associated with that of Allah. This sentence is also a constant theme of the Holy Quran. After acknowledging Allah as our Master and Sovereign, it is necessary to know what are His commandments, what will please Him and what will incur his displeasure. For this purpose, Allah appointed Hazrat Muhammad as His messenger and sent the Quran through him.

He is the model for every Muslim without whom we would have no idea of how to conform to the truth laid down by the first part of the declaration. To believe in him as a messenger of Allah means to accept His authority as the representative of the Supreme Ruler and to follow his example. **“He who obeys the messenger obeys Allah.”**

He is the link between the Creator and the creatures, therefore, to deny the second part of the declaration would be to cut off all connections with the first. The declaration that Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) is Allah’s messenger is a proclamation of belief in the complete and final guidance that he brought for all humanity. It is also a statement of intension to follow that guidance faithfully. **“Indeed ! you have in the messenger of Allah a beautiful pattern of conduct.”**

This declaration prepares human beings to reflect upon Hazrat Muhammad (P.B.U.H) teachings and encourages them to follow his path. The Holy Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) summed up all the previous revelation, therefore, to follow him is to follow the teachings of all the Prophets. He is a symbol of the message of Allah, of the Religion which was preached by all the Prophets.

The religion he was given to preach was Islam in the form of a complete system covering all aspects of material and spiritual life of mankind. He led his life according to the commandments of Allah, and showed the Muslims, the way to lead their lives. So, when we recite this second part of the declaration i.e. **“Muhammad (P.B.U.H) His slave and apostle”** we undertake who follow the law and system shown by him

Importance of *shahada*

- **There is no God but Allah, and Muhammad is his messenger.** These are the words (*Kalimah*) by which one declares his/her intention to become a Muslim. A newly reverted Muslim has to understand the meaning of this simple phrase and live and act in accordance to its principles to be guaranteed admission into heaven. Mere words are easily uttered, but Allah considers what is in one's heart and measures one's deeds to judge between his creatures
- The words of the Shahadah are few but extremely significant. With those words a person acknowledges Allah as the Creator and Sustainer of all, and affirms the prophethood of Prophet Muhammad (P.B.H.U) and thus steps away from disbelief and ignorance to knowledge, light and guidance.
- Muslims, whether they are born into the faith or accept Islam later, in life by reciting the Shahadah become a part of the Ummah, bonded together by their common faith, irrespective of race or background.
- The significance of Shahadah is highlighted by the fact that it is repeated in every prayer.
- When believers say '**I bear witness that there is no Allah but Allah**' it means that they reject obedience and servitude to anyone or anything except Allah, that they fear no one except Him and seek only His pleasure. This belief makes a Muslim strong and independent as well as courageous, knowing that everything one experience is from Allah.
- With the second part of the Shahadah '**Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah**' believers acknowledges the Prophet's (P.B.U.H) status and hence his right to be respected and obeyed, knowing that he is 'Insaan e Kamil' the perfect human the best of creation.
- Knowledge of what the Shahadah is testifying is very important. For when one testifies or bears witness to something, one must know what it is that he\she is witness too. Testimony to something about which one has no knowledge is unacceptable.
- Acceptance of the Shahadah means that a believer accepts all its implications to i.e believing completely in whatever is stated in the Quran or stated by the Prophet (P.B.U.H) without choosing or rejecting anything given therein.
- Submission to the Shahadah implies submission to Allah's command by one's action. Infact this is one of the meanings of the word Islam itself, the submission to the will and commands of Allah
- Sincerity to the Shahadah means to testify solely for faith in Allah and not for any other reason. One of the sign of being a Muslim for the sake of Allah is that a believer does whatever Allah asks, regardless of what anybody else desires or wants from them.
- Adherence to the Shahadah is being true to Islam and its beliefs, and fulfilling all its obligations till death.
- For Muslims, the shahadah or Kalima and faith are the most important belief as it sums up what one must believe to be a Muslim. The first pillar of Islam is the fundamental and basic need of human beings as a Muslim. Prophet Muhammad (SAW) said: "**I have been ordered to fight against people until they testify that there is no god but Allah and the Muhammad is the Messenger of Allah.**" (Sahi Bukhari). The above saying clearly indicates that we must have faith in both parts of the first pillar of Islam.

Circumstances of Surahs

Surah Ikhlas(112) was revealed in Makkah after the event of open preaching of Islam, When Prophet (P.B.U.H) invited them to the worships of Allah alone and forbade them from Idols worship. According to Hazrat Abdullah bin Masud the Quraish asked the Prophet (P.B.U.H) “tell us of the ancestry of your Lord” There upon this Surah was revealed.

The content of the Surah clearly established God’s oneness (Tauheed) by declaring the rejection of shirk which the pagans did by worshipping 360 idols placed in the Kaabah. ‘Say! He is Allah, the one and only”.

Surah also said that God does not have a beginning or end unlike the idols that were worshiped by the pagans at that time. “Allah the eternal absolute” It announced that God does not have any physical relations with anyone. The pagans believed that angels were God’s daughter. Simultaneously it negated the idea of trinity (father, son, Holy Spirit) which the Christians believed in.

“He begets not, nor is he begotten” The pagans believed and worshiped the idols they could see, therefore this Surah negated that God had any physical or human characteristics and said that God is beyond human comprehension because He is unique in His personality, attributes and actions. “And there is none like him”. As the Prophet was preaching his message, many people would ask about his God, and this sura would be recited as an answer, giving a short and comprehensive insight into Islam’s belief in God.

Surah Al kauthar (108) was revealed in Makkah after the mount of Safa incident of often preaching of Islam, when Prophet (P.B.U.H) was going through a period of difficulty with the Quraish. Both his sons Al Qasim and Abdullah had died and Quraish used this as an opportunity to mock the Prophet (P.B.U.H) in order to discourage him from preaching Islam. After his second son Abdullah’s death his uncle and worst enemy Abu Lahab called him “Abtar” (cut off from his root) meaning that he had no male descendants to carry his name and they thought that his ménage would die when he passed away. God revealed this Surah to console and give hope to the Prophet (P.B.U.H) under these increasing difficulties by promising that he would be given abundant blessings in this worldly life and in the hereafter.” To you have we granted abundance”. Prophet (P.B.U.H) was instructed to remain loyal to his faith by continuing to line as God thought him. “So pray to your Lord and sacrifice”. It also wanted the Prophet (P.B.U.H) enemies specially Abu Lahab of Allah wrath and said that it would not be the Prophet (P.B.U.H) but his enemies that would be cut off. “He who hates you, he will be cut off.”

Surah Duha (93) was revealed in Makkah when the prophet ^{pbuh} was preaching his message openly and the Makkans had become his enemies. It was revealed after an interval of 11 months between the revelations, due to which pagans mocked at him. Specially Abu Lahb’s wife Umm e jamil remarked, **“Muhammad! your Lord has forsaken you”**. This surah reassured him that **“your lord has not forsaken you, nor is He displeased”**. It also gave him the glad tiding of successful future life by saying, **“and the hereafter will be better for you than the present .”** which referred to his successful future life in Madina. It reminded the prophet ^(pbuh) of God’s support for him throughout his life **“did he not find you an orphan and give you shelter ; And he found you wondering and he gave you guidance ; And he found you in need and he made you independent”** .

Lastly it instructed him to continue to live as God taught him by helping the poor and the needy and by expressing gratitude for God favours upon him. After the revelation of this surah, the prophet ^{saw} was comforted and he continued to preach Islam to the Makkans.

Surah Nas (114) is one of those few surahs of Quran which were revealed on more than one occasions. Firstly it was revealed in Makkah after the open preaching of Islam when the prophet (saw) forbade the Makkans from idol worship. They threatened the prophet (saw) of the wrath of their false gods and cursed him. This Surah was revealed to condemn their claims by their declaring that Prophet (pbuh) was in divine protection therefore, Satan or his followers could not harm him, **“say, I seek refuge with the Lord of mankind ,King of mankind, God of mankind from Jinn and from mankind”**.

Later this surah was revealed in Madina together with surah Falaq when charms and black magic were practiced on the lock of prophet's hair by two Jew sisters of Labit bin Aasam by tying 11 knots. As the result of that prophet (saw) had headache and at time thought of doing something that he had not done. Allah revealed the surahs to cure the evil effects of black magic. Prophet (saw) called Hazrat Ali and told him about the well, where lock of his hair was thrown and guided him how to undo the black magic by untying each knot by reciting one verse from there surahs. Hazrat Ali did likewise thus the prophet (pbuh) was cured from black magic. These surahs together are known as a "Muazzatain" or protection seeker as they invoked Allah's protections against all types of evils.

UNSEEN TOPICS

The Translation and Interpretation of the Quran

The Quran was revealed to Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) in Arabic. Theologically, it is the Arabic version that is considered the true Quran, the direct word of Allah, and is read in prayer. No translation is considered to be the Quran, or word of Allah as such, nor has the same status as the original Arabic version. Muslims considered translations as the renderings of the meanings of the Quran.

When it comes to the interpretation (tafseer) of Quran, it must be said that the two most important and reliable sources of interpretation are the Quran itself and the Sunnah of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H).

The Quran is regarded as the most authoritative source of its interpretation as one part of the Quran often explain another. Furthermore, in certain verses of the Quran can allude to something briefly in one place and then elaborate upon it elsewhere. By referring to the relevant passages one can have a clear understanding of the verses and the themes of the Quran. After the Quran, it is the Sunnah of the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) which is considered as the most important source of understanding and interpreting the Quran as the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) not only conveyed Allah's messages to all but also explained the passages and verses to the believers. In fact, it could be said that his Sunnah is the living embodiment of the Quran.

Sometimes, the Quran alludes to events without giving details regarding the circumstances in which certain passages of verses were revealed, which makes interpretation more difficult. Those who heard the Quran at the time of its revelation were fully aware of the circumstances. They not only witnessed the revelation of the Quran but also understood it perfectly and were therefore in a good position to explain it to others. However, later generations of Muslim had to rely on the body of literature explaining the circumstances of the revelations (asbab al-nazul) which identify their background and refer to the names and detail of what actually happened. Strict rules were followed in the pursuit of this task.

Interpretation are further complicated by the concise style of the Quran which if read out of context can be misinterpreted. war In Islam, as regulated by the Quran and Hadith, has been subjected to many distortions by Western scholars and even some Muslims writers. These are either due to misconceptions about terminology or above all, using quotations taken out of context. An example of famously misinterpreted verse often quoted out of context is the **"verse of sword' But when the forbidden months are past then fight and slay the pagans wherever you find them.... 'and continues; but if they repent, and establish regular prayers and practice charity, then open the way for them: for Allah is Oft-forgiving, most merciful."** (9:5)

The bitter enmity of the polytheists and their persecution of the Muslims grew so deep that the former were determined to convert the Muslims back to paganism or finish them out. **"Nor will they cease fighting you until they turn you back from your faith if they can" (2:217)**. It was these hardened polytheists in Arabia, who would accept nothing but the expulsion of the Muslims or their reversion to paganism and who repeatedly broke their treaties, hence the Muslims were ordered to treat them in the same way to fight them and expel them.

The Quran itself predicted in Surah al-Imran (3:7) that some people will deliberately misinterpret certain verses. it is therefore of great importance that the scholar or mufassir interpreting the verses of Allah is the pious Muslim, who has thorough command of the Arabic language and its grammar and sound knowledge of tafseer, the science of interpretation. The mufassir's knowledge and understanding of the Quran and Sunnah also needs to be unquestionable and his/her credentials must be recognized by others scholar.

Scholars sometimes differ in their understanding of certain passages or verses of the Quran, depending on their different persuasions. Take the example of sura al-kauthar: **"To you we have granted abundance (al-kauthar).**

Therefore, to your Lord turn in prayer and sacrifice. For the one who hates you he will be cut off" (108)

The turn al-kauthar in the first verse is related to verb kathara, which means to multiply, to increase and is often translated has abundance. Many Muslims interpret it to mean the abundant good that Allah had bestowed upon the

Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) such as guidance, the Quran, prophethood and river of Kauthar in paradise.

According to Hadith, when the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) was made to ascend to heavens he said: **“I came upon a river the bank of which were made of tents of hollow pearls. I asked Gibraeel what is this river? he replied, this is al-Kauthar.”**

Shia Muslims interpret the abundance mentioned in the surah to refer to the Prophet’s Muhammad (P.B.U.H) daughter Hazrat Fatimah R.A from whom come the abundance of his descendants the Imams.

Superiority of the Quran to Early Scriptures

The Quran in the message of Allah it requires a belief not only in its own truth but also in the truth of the previous scriptures revealed to other Prophet Allah says “And who believe in the Revelation sent to you and sent before your time and (in their hearts) has the assurance of the Hereafter” (Al Baqra 2:4) The origin of the Quran and the other divine books is the same: they are all from Allah.

The Quran accepts the truth of all divine books sent down to the other Prophets and verifies was before it. The Quran also guards the original teachings of the earlier books those teachings had undergone alterations, it points and correct some of the errors that had crept in to the earlier revealed books and reveals what some of the people of the books consult, or passed off as part of their revealed books Allah says “And we have revealed to you, the book: with the truth very verifying what is before it of the book and a guardian over it” (Al- Maidah 5:48)

The Quran is superior to other books in many respects:

- The Quran exists in its original form as revealed to the Prophet Muhammad (P.B.U.H) over 1400 years ago. God had promised to protect it from all kind of corruption at all times, **“we have, without, doubt revealed the reminder and we will guard it (from corruption)”..(Al-Hijr 15:9).** The other old books do not exist in their original forms. They are modified, corrupted and changed by their followers. The old Books are a mixture and divine words and words of men; the Quran is free from all kind of adulteration.
- Arabic, the language of Quran is a living language, spoken, and understood by millions of people all over the world, while the languages of the other books are dead languages. **“We have sent it down as an Arabic Quran in order that you may learn wisdom.” (12:2)**
- The Quran is a universal book addressed to all people of all ages. **“We have explained in this Quran for the benefit of mankind.” (Az-Zumar 39:2).** While the other old books, were revealed to particular nations for a particular periods.
- The Quran is the last and perfect Book of Allah. It is a comprehensive Book. It deals with every aspects of human life social. Economic, legal, moral etc. Allah says **“This day I have perfected your religion for you completed My favors upon you and chosen for you Islam as your religion” (Al-Maidah 5:3).** The earlier books contained only a code of morality and justice but none was comprehensive to contain a complete code of life.
- There is proof about the Authenticity of the Quranic text and even of the places and occasions when they were revealed but there is no historical evidence to the authenticity of the old Books.

2.b) “The Qur’an is not as relevant to Muslims now as it was 1400 years ago.” Give two reasons to agree or disagree with this statement.

- I strongly disagree with this statement as Quran is meant for the guidance of all mankind and its teachings will never be outdated or irrelevant.
- These teachings are universal and eternal i.e for mankind and for all ages and disciplines. For example, the following command about honesty in business dealings is for all mankind till the day of judgement , **“Give full measure when you measure and weigh with the balance that is straight.”**
- Moreover, It helps Muslim to understand the duties to their Creator and therefore, it’s a link between God and Muslims. It guides Muslims in beliefs and practices and guarantees successful in this world and in the Hereafter. For example, the pillars of Islam i.e prayer, fasting, zakat etc are primarily the rights of Allah but at the same time these acts of worship develop a sense of responsibility and brotherhood being a part of Muslim community.

2.(b) ‘The Qur’an teaches that humans should be responsible towards the environment.’ Give reasons to agree or disagree with this statement. [4]

Agree with the statement.

God has made various things for the benefit of humans – the earth, the rain/water, food and drink, and that the earth will have a voice to say what humans have done whilst living on it. This will be their good deeds and bad deeds, but also how they have looked after all these provisions. Humans are therefore not just encouraged to pray and fast and worship God, but also to do good actions, including those relating to looking after the soil from which their crops grow, the water which helps them grow, etc

2(b) In your opinion, why should Muslims try to understand God's attributes? Give reason(s) for your answer. [4]

It is extremely important for Muslims to understand God's personality and attributes because now a days many Muslims are becoming detached from God. Learning about God's attributes allows them to have an understanding of Him which increases their understanding of the world around them, or their faith, etc. Because God is beyond humankind's knowledge/perception, understanding Him through what He says about Himself in the Qur'an allows humans to know why God is important to them in their lives.

2(b) 'Undergoing hardships brings a person closer to God.' Agree or disagree with this statement, giving reasons for your answer. [4]

Candidates could agree and say, e.g. that all prophets were tested which allowed them to get closer to God, likewise humankind now can get closer to their Lord through their hardships, as long as they reflect and understand that God is testing them. Also, by remaining patient and steadfast, and not leaving their worship, they will gain rewards and understanding. Prophets were tested and remained steadfast, so Muslims should also expect to be tested and they should also remain steadfast.

They could say they don't agree, e.g. because not everyone goes through the same hardships, that people are different so they may react differently to hardships so they may not necessarily know they are being tested, but remaining true to prayer, fasting and the Five Pillars is more important and more likely to get a person closer to God.

2(b) 'God gave humankind guidance and teachings.' Why does the Qur'an lay emphasis on the need to gain knowledge?[10]

Having given guidance (through the Qur'an and sunnah, etc.), God wants knowledge to be used to learn about life and to live lives in a good way. Without learning, humans would not know about their rights and responsibilities or about their potential as human beings. In order to respond to what God wants or what is of benefit to themselves or others, they have to learn how to respond. God is full of mercy and love, He is guiding people so they benefit in this life and in the next. The most beneficial knowledge would be that which helps a person fulfil their rights towards God, fellow humans, and to develop themselves.

2(b) The Qur'an was revealed in parts over a number of years. Why was this important? [4]

God says in the Qur'an that had He sent the Qur'an upon a mountain it would have come apart (59.21). So had it been revealed as a whole to Muhammad (pbuh) it would have been too heavy for him to carry the burden. God was taking care of the Prophet (pbuh) and his followers by revealing it in parts, as it was sent to strengthen hearts (25.32), which could be done due to the partial revelations. God also sent it in this way to allow the Prophet (pbuh) and the early Muslims to ponder over its meanings and have time to implement the teachings in their lives. It was also sent in parts in response to the needs of different situations and times.

2(b) What can Muslims today learn from the first revelation about the importance of reading and understanding the Qur'an? [4]

The first word, Iqra, is a command to read or learn. The Qur'an is the final revelation from God, and in it contains the guidance for humankind for all time. It is an opportunity for Muslims to know what it is that God wants from them so they can act on what will be pleasing to God. For this it would be important to learn the meaning of the Qur'an although there is also reward in reading it without knowing the meaning. Reading it with understanding could lead a person so have a deeper connection with God.

2(b) How might Muslims use the Qur'an to have a closer connection with God?[4]

- the Qur'an is the word of God, so it gives Muslims a connection to God.
- It contains guidance from God, so it lets them know what God wants and expects from them.
- There is a communication with God through the Qur'an, whether it is through reciting it or using certain passages as supplications.
- Reading it, memorising it, teaching it to others all have benefits and may allow Muslims to increase their connection to God.

2 (b) What does the Prophet's first experience of revelation tell us about the nature of prophethood in Islam. [4]

- The Prophet's first experience of revelation in the cave of Hira helps us to understand the concept of prophethood in Islam.
- It shows that Allah chose prophets according to His own will which means that it was predestined and could not be attained by personal efforts.
- It was given without warning and often through miraculous events at the time of calling which caused confusion and fear. For example, Prophet Muhammad got afraid when he was squeezed by angel Jibrael. Similarly, Hazrat Musa got confused when God addressed him for the first time.
- This fear and confusion shows that the prophets were chosen from mankind.
- This event also shows that Jibrael acted as a link between God and Prophets.

2.(b) 'By using the principle of analogy (qiyas) the basic laws of Islam can be applied at any time and in any case.' Do you agree? [4]

- agree with this statement.
- new rulings can be formed for any new circumstance, based on their basic similarity with the basic laws of the Qur'an and sunna. In this way the divine laws revealed in the Qur'an and sunna remain unchanged without becoming outdated.
- The fundamental laws were made by God who created man and knows what's best for him at all times. For changing aspects of human life, the Qur'an and sunna provide basic principles which may be applied by analogy whenever the need arises
- e.g. the issue of drugs could be cited, cocaine was not present in the Prophet's (pbuh) time so is its use allowed? The Prophet (pbuh) had said, **'Every intoxicant is khamr, and every khamr is haram'** so every intoxicant is unlawful is a conclusion that could be derived at by the use of analogy.

2.(b) Why do you think the Prophet practised and encouraged the use of ijma'? [4]

- The use of ijma' in legal thinking is based on a number of verses in the Qur'an **"You are the best of people evolved for mankind, enjoining what is right forbidding what is wrong and believing in Allah."** [3:110] Verses like this indicate that the community has been given authority because it is upright and follows the guidance of Allah and the example of the Prophet (pbuh).
- The Holy Prophet (pbuh) also referred to the importance of following the community, when he said, **"My community will never agree upon an error."** The Holy Prophet to have said, **"Gather together the righteous from among my community and decide the matter by their counsel and do not decide it by any man's opinion."**
- Therefore, from very early times it has been accepted that the agreed view of the community is binding upon Muslims in legal and more general matters.
- ijma' was encouraged as it was safeguarded by the agreement of leading Muslims/experts who could say whether or not a principle was in harmony with the Qur'an and sunna.

2(b) 'Truly, My mercy overcomes My wrath'. This is a Hadith Qudsi. What is special about Hadiths of this kind? [4]

- Hadith Qudsi is the divine hadith they are the reports of what Allah said, but they are not words of Allah.
- The meanings of this hadith were revealed to the Prophet (P.b.U.H) and he put them in his own words.
- The Hadith qudsi differs from the Quran as the Quran is the words of Allah unlike the Hadith Qudsi.
- For this reason Hadith Qudsi is not a part of Quran.
- Some of Hadith Qudsi are **"Pride is my cloak and greatness my robe, and he who competes with Me in respect of either of them I shall cast him into Hell-Fire."** And **"Spend on charity, O son of Adam and I shall spend on you."**

ISLAMIYAT

Paper 01

ISLAMIYAT 2058/01

Marks: 28

Time: 50 minutes

Paper 1

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

If you have been given an Answer Booklet, follow the instructions on the front cover of the Booklet.

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name on all the work you hand in.

Write in dark blue or black pen.

Do not use staples, paper clips, highlighters, glue or correction fluid.

All answers must be in continuous prose.

At the end of the examination, fasten all your work securely together.

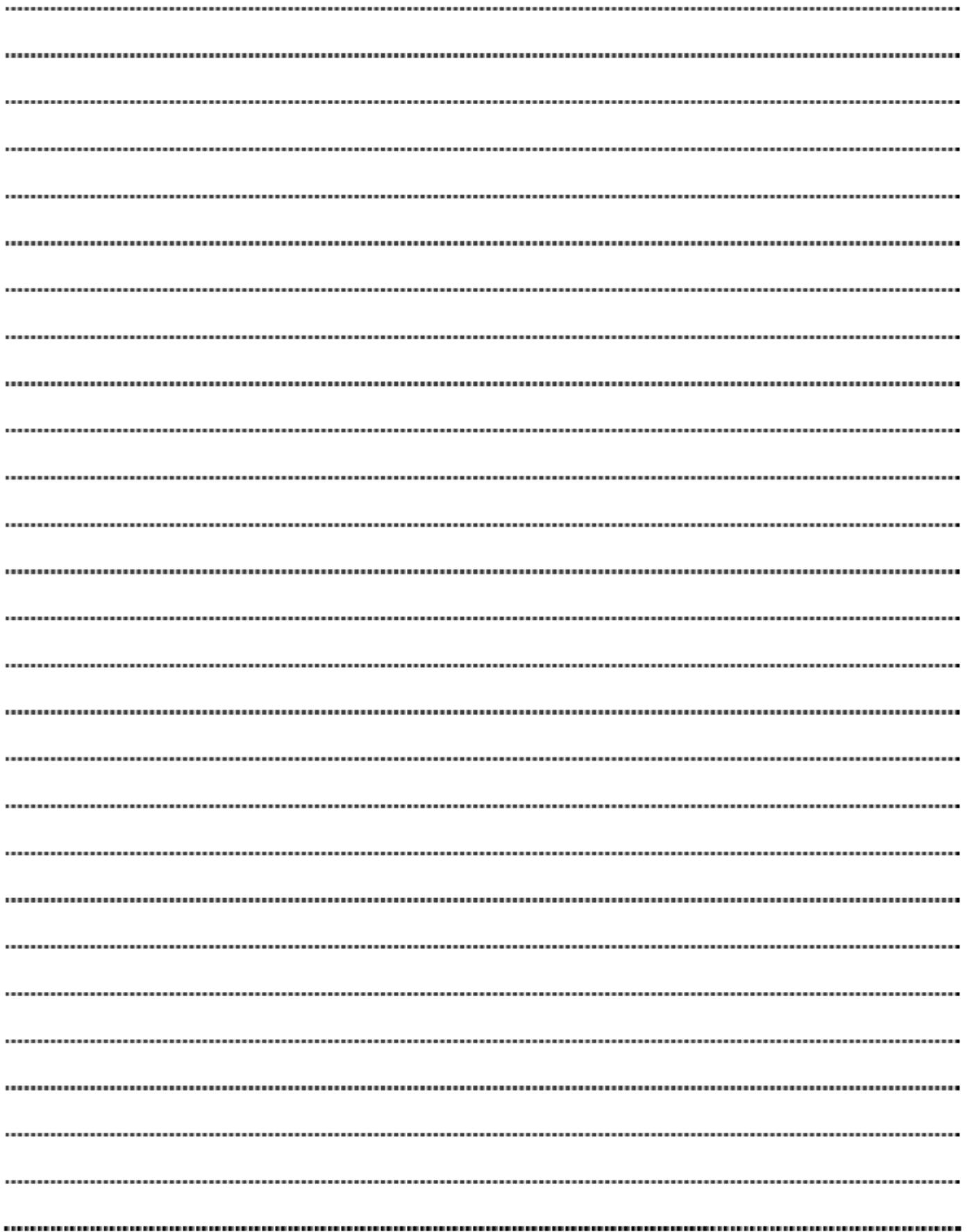
The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

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**2. (a) Write about the events of the first year following the Prophet's arrival in Madina.
[10]**

2. (b) What lesson can Muslims learn from the brotherhood that was created in Madina? [4]

[illegible]

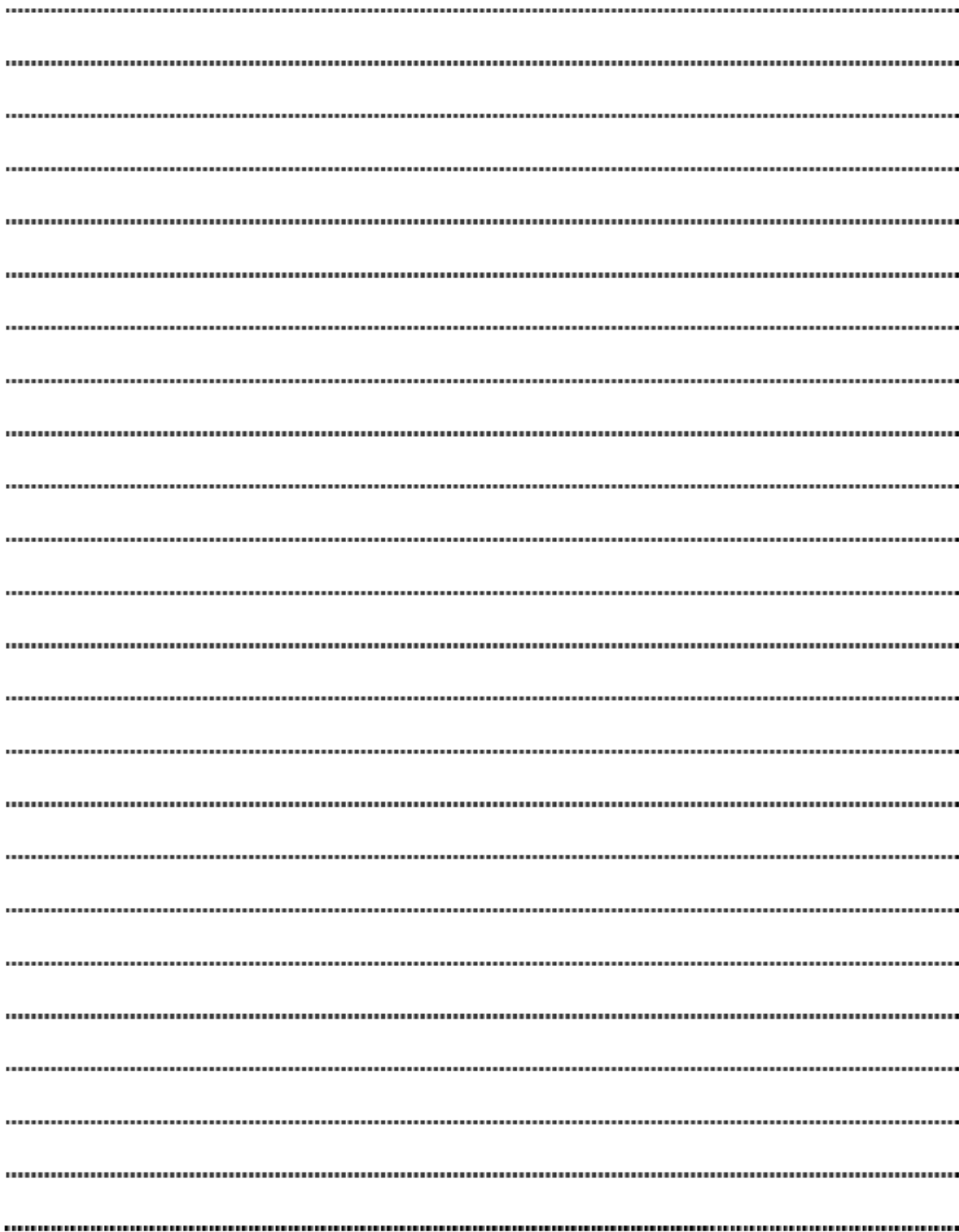


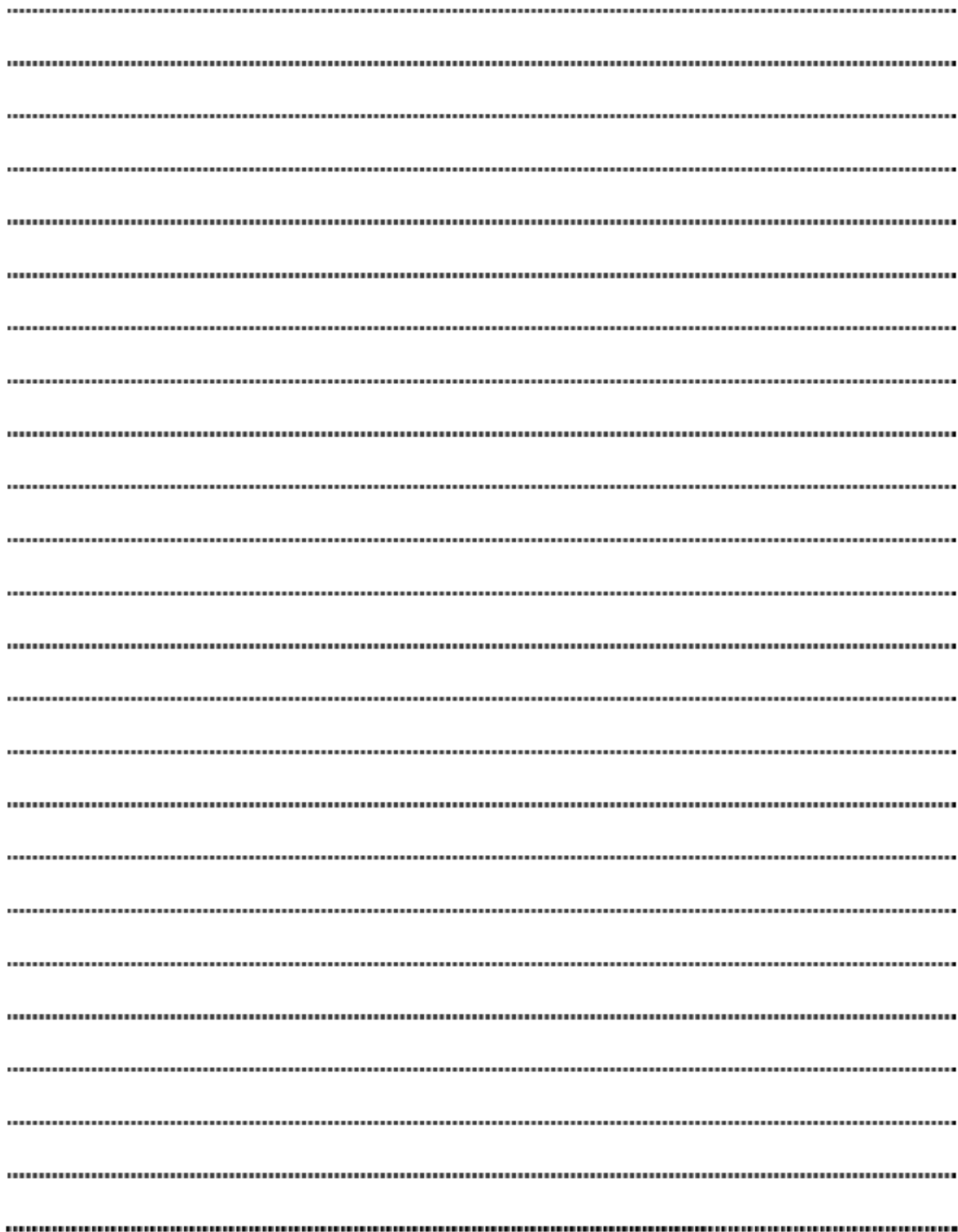
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3. (a) Write about the events surrounding the Treaty of Hudaibiyya and the main terms in it. [10]

3. (b) From this event, what can Muslims learn about the importance of keeping their words? [4]

[illegible]





There is a mosque

(8/11/2021)

Islamiyat Test #2

Monday

Q2. (a) The Prophet (pbuh) migrated to Madinah in AD, marking it as first year of Hijrah. When the Prophet (pbuh) arrived, the people had just gone back into their homes and the first person to meet the Prophet was a Jew, hence fulfilling the prophecy contained in the Taurat. The people greeted the Prophet enthusiastically and Ansar girls sang in happiness. Everyone wanted the Prophet (pbuh) to stay with them, and so grabbed the halter of his camel Qaswa, but the Prophet (pbuh) said: "Let it go its own way, it is under orders." The camel then sat at the place which now marks the door of the Masjid-e-Nabawi and belonged to two orphan boys; Sahil and Suhail. The Prophet (pbuh) bought the land from them and built the ~~first mosque~~ Masjid-e-Nabawi there.

The holy Prophet (pbuh) himself worked with his companions to finish the mosque and it became known as the 'mosque of the Prophet' or 'Masjid-e-Nabawi'. While the mosque was being constructed, the Prophet stayed in the house of Abu Ayub al-Ansari.

"There is a mosque whose foundation was laid ^{from} ~~on piety~~ from the very first day on piety; it is more worthy of thy standing forth for prayer (therein); in it are men who love to be purified and Allah loveth those who make themselves pure."

Those who adopted

After this, the Muslims had to come up with a way to call the people to congregational prayer. Some suggestions were ringing bells like the Christians, blowing horns like the Jews, beating drums or kindling fires like fire worshippers. The Prophet (pbuh) rejected these ideas because they resembled the unbelievers. Hazrat Umar (r.a) suggested that the people be called to prayer by a human voice. The Prophet (pbuh) waited for a better idea or guidance from Allah. One day, Abdullah bin Zaid came to the Prophet and told him of a dream he had in which a man in green garments had told him the words of the Adhan to call Muslims to prayer and recited them. Finding the words beautiful and meaningful, the Prophet instructed Abdullah bin Zaid to teach Hazrat Bilal (r.a) the words of the Adhan.

Hence, Hazrat Bilal became the first muezzin of Islam. He had a loud and beautiful voice.

There were two categories of Muslims in Madinah; the Muhajir (immigrants) and Ansar (the helpers). The Prophet (pbuh) told the Ansar that the Muhajir were in need of help, thus creating brotherhood.

"Those who ^{believed and} adopted exile, and fought for the faith, with their possessions and their persons, in the way of Allah, as well as the people who gave them asylum and aid, these

are all friends and protector one of another." Even the enmity between the tribes of Aus and Chazraj was forgotten.

The Jews formed majority of the population in Madinah. There were three main tribes of the Jews; Banu ~~Quraiza~~^{Qainuga} Banu Nazir and Banu Quraiza and they were settled in the suburbs of Madinah in their strong fortresses. Once the Prophet was settled, he called upon the Muslim and Jewish tribes for consultation and an agreement with 47 clauses called the 'Charter of Madinah' was drawn up. It allowed religious freedom for the Jews without any interference from the Muslims and guaranteed protection of their lives and property. It made the Muslims and Jews allies of each other who could not commit aggression against one another. In case of an attack on Madinah, both the Muslims and Jews would defend it. It established the Prophet as the head of the State of Madinah and the Prophet (pbuh) decided to settle the Jews' disputes according to Taurat.

The city's name was changed from Yasnib to Madinah - bul - Nabi.

(b) Brotherhood between Muslims is established on faith as seen by this: "The believers are but brothers." Hence, this faith also unifies the

Allah did indeed

Allah was indeed

Muslims. Muslims should help one another when they can like financially, fighting against injustice for them etc. We should help those who are living where we are and are refugees for e.g. Syrians and Palestinians. Also, an example could be of Abhinandan, who was an Indian pilot, who was helped and delivered safely back to India by Pakistan. It helps us to understand their situation. We ^{in B.A.H} should not hold grudges and forgive.

Q3. (a) The prophet (pbuh) had a dream in which he performed Umrah at the Ka'abah. "Allah did indeed fulfill the vision for His Messenger; you shall enter the Sacred mosque, if Allah wills, with minds secure and without fear."

Hence, the prophet (pbuh) set out with 1400 unarmed companions. ~~who~~ The Makkans did not allow the Muslims to enter and so the Muslims stayed at a place called 'Hudaybiyah' near Makkah.

The Muslims sent two messengers, one after another to request the Quraysh to let them into Makkah for Umrah in the state of ihram, meaning they were prohibited from fighting. Both the messengers were detained, so Hazrat Usman (r.a) was sent too. When he too did not return, rumor spread that Hazrat Usman (r.a) had been killed.

At this, the prophet gathered the Muslims under a tree to take a pledge to lay down their

lines for Allah and avenge the death of Hazrat Usman (r.a). This pledge is known as 'Bait-e-Rizwan.' "Allah indeed was pleased when you swore allegiance to Him, under the tree, and... and He knew what was in their hearts..."

The Quraysh being apprehended, sent all three messengers back. However, this experience also ^{influenced} forced them to negotiate a peace treaty with the Muslims. Suhail bin Amir was sent for this purpose.

An agreement was drawn up which stated a few terms. That year, the Muslims would not be allowed to perform umrah, but they could come next year and do it, with only a three-day stay in Makkah. There would be no fighting for ten years. Any Makkah who went to Madinah without permission ~~for~~ from his grandfather would be sent back, but anyone from Madinah who went to Makkah would not be returned. ^{Muslims in Madinah} ~~Makkah~~ would be allowed to visit Makkah and ^{the} Makkans could visit Syria and Madinah without having their caravans attacked by the Muslims. Also, the Arab tribes in that area could either join the Quraysh or the Muslims, but the allies could not fight against each other.

Most of these terms angered the Muslims as they were against their interests. Hazrat Umar (r.a) spoke out against it, but was reasoned by the Prophet (ﷺ) and Abu Bakr (r.a).

- Politicians
- Verbal

Hazrat Ali (r.a) wrote the treaty. When the Prophet told him to write in the name of Allah or His Messenger, the Prophet, Suhail bin Amr objected and had Ali (r.a) write in the name of God, or Abdullah which angered the Muslims once again.

Just then, one of Suhail bin Amr's son, Abu Jandal came to the Muslims seeking refuge, but the Prophet (pbuh) sent him back, keeping to the terms of the treaty and told him to be patient. After this treaty, the Prophet instructed the Muslims to sacrifice their animals and shave their heads.

The Prophet (pbuh)'s decision was confirmed by the following revelation: "Verily we have granted thee a manifest victory."

After this, the tribe of Banu Bakr joined Quraysh while Banu Khuz'a'a joined the Muslims.

(b) The Prophet (pbuh) sent Abu Jandal back, while keeping to the terms of the treaty. Even though it wasn't written, the fact that the objective had been spoken verbally matters. Hence, Muslims should not go against their word verbally too, and for example, politicians should not go back on their word either in terms of implementing policies etc. Fulfillment of promises also guarantees honesty in them, and is something rewarded by Allah, which is good for us. It was also encouraged by the Prophet (pbuh).

ISLAMIYAT

Paper 01

ISLAMIYAT 2058/01

Marks: 28

Paper 1

55minutes

READ THESE INSTRUCTIONS FIRST

If you have been given an Answer Booklet, follow the instructions on the front cover of the Booklet.

Write your Centre number, candidate number and name on all the work you hand in.

Write in dark blue or black pen.

Do not use staples, paper clips, highlighters, glue or correction fluid.

All answers must be in continuous prose.

At the end of the examination, fasten all your work securely together.

The number of marks is given in brackets [] at the end of each question or part question.

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You must answer **Question 1**, **Question 2** and **two** other questions.

1 Choose any **two** of the following passages from the Qur'an, and:

(a) briefly describe the main theme(s) in each passage. [4]

(b) briefly explain the importance of these themes in a Muslims life today. [4]

(i)

3. Sura 41.37

وَمِنْ آيَاتِهِ اللَّيْلُ وَالنَّهَارُ وَالشَّمْسُ وَالْقَمَرُ لَا تَسْجُدُوا لِلشَّمْسِ وَلَا لِلْقَمَرِ وَاسْجُدُوا لِلَّهِ الَّذِي خَلَقَهُنَّ إِن كُنتُمْ إِلَيْهِ تَعْبُدُونَ

37. Among His signs are the night and the day, and the sun and the moon. Adore not the sun and the moon, but adore Allah, who created them, if it is Him you wish to serve.

(ii)

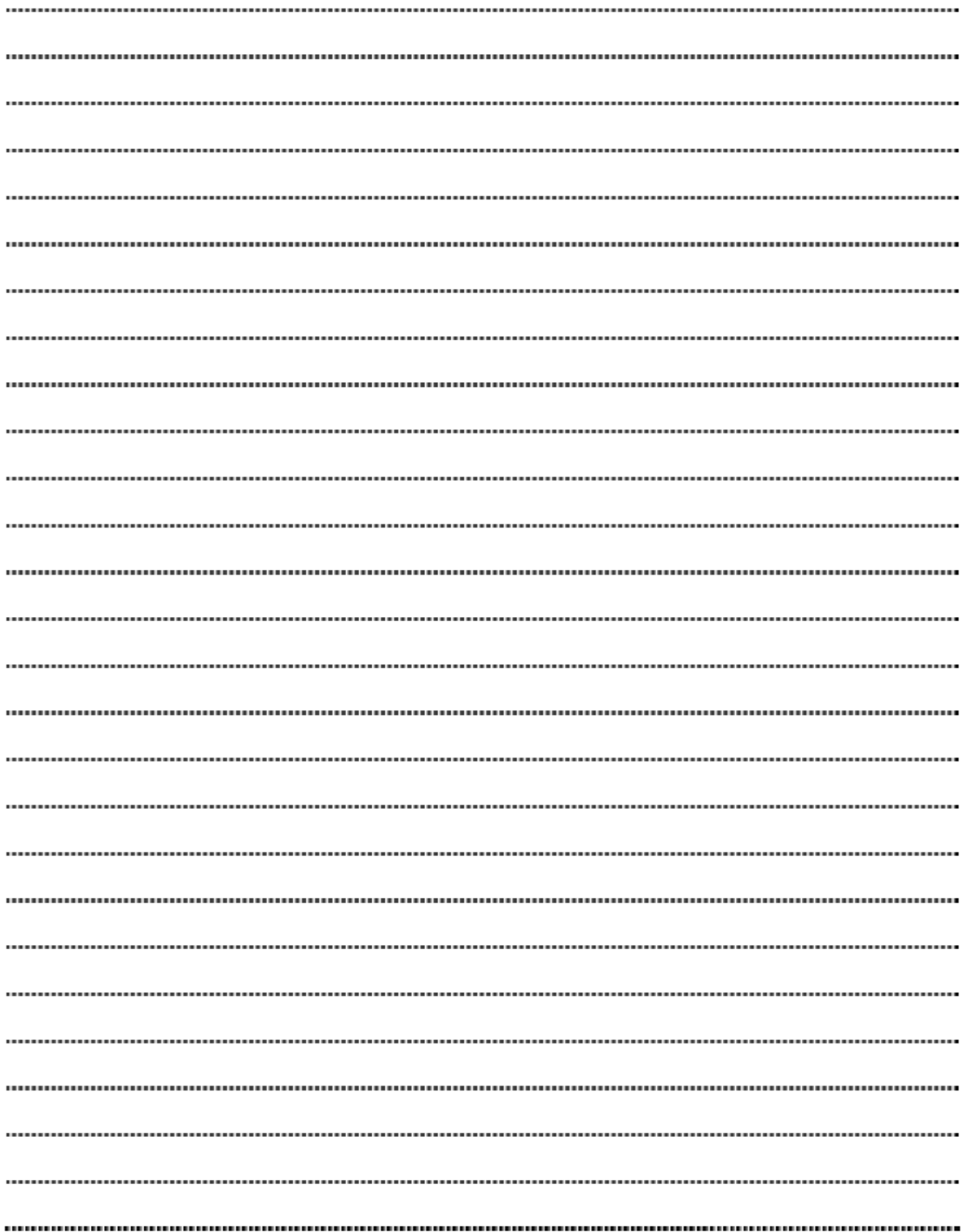
4. Sura 42.4-5

لَهُ مَا فِي السَّمَاوَاتِ وَمَا فِي الْأَرْضِ وَهُوَ الْعَلِيُّ الْعَظِيمُ
تَكَادُ السَّمَاوَاتُ يَتَّقَطِرْنَ مِنْ فَوْقِهِنَّ وَالْمَلَائِكَةُ يُسَبِّحُونَ بِحَمْدِ رَبِّهِمْ وَيَسْتَغْفِرُونَ لِمَنْ فِي الْأَرْضِ أَلَا إِنَّ اللَّهَ هُوَ الْغَفُورُ الرَّحِيمُ

4. To Him belongs all that is in the heavens and on earth: and He is most high, most great. 5. The heavens are almost rent asunder from above them, and the angels celebrate the praises of their Lord, and pray for forgiveness for beings on earth: Behold! Verily Allah is He, the oft-forgiving, the most merciful.

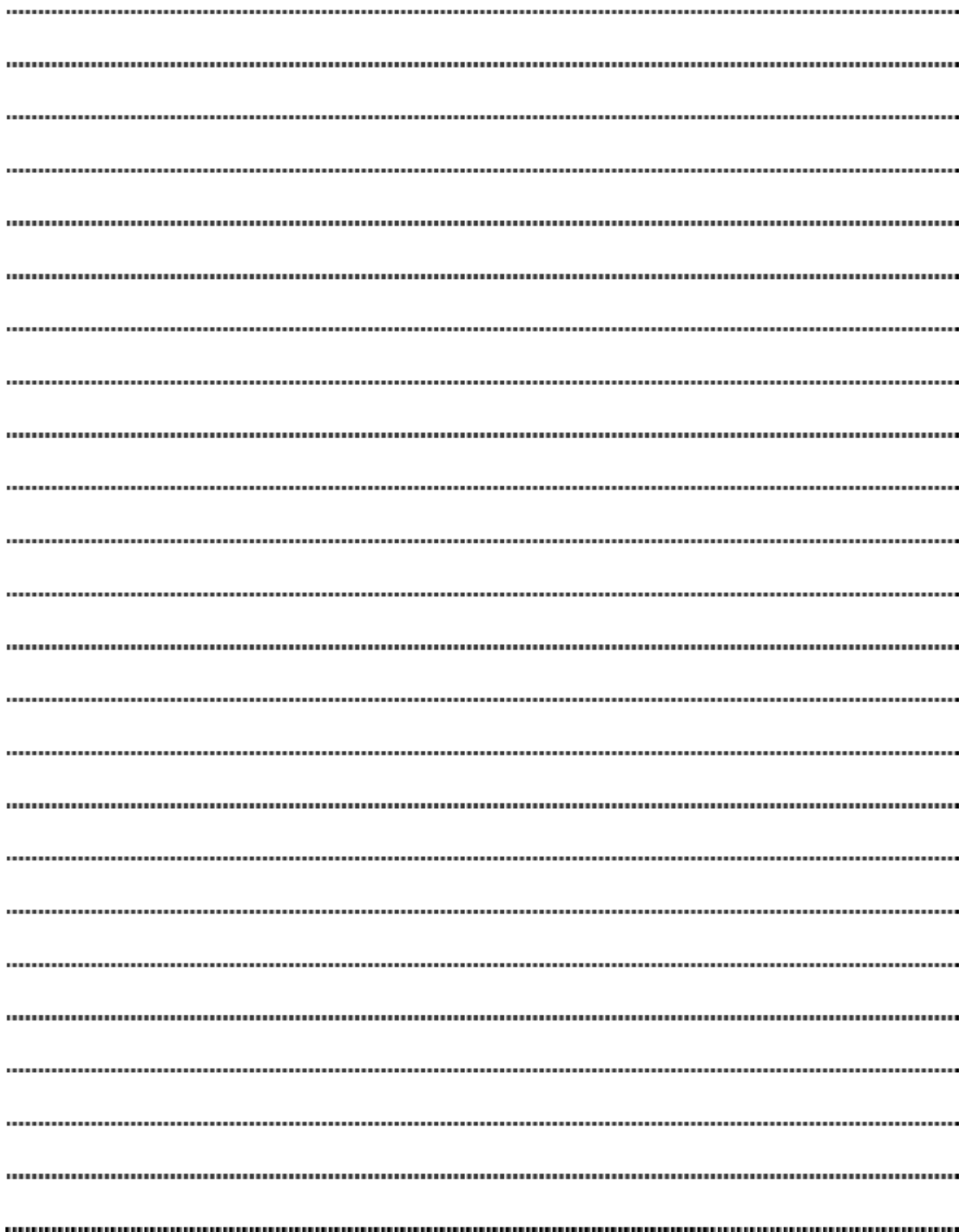
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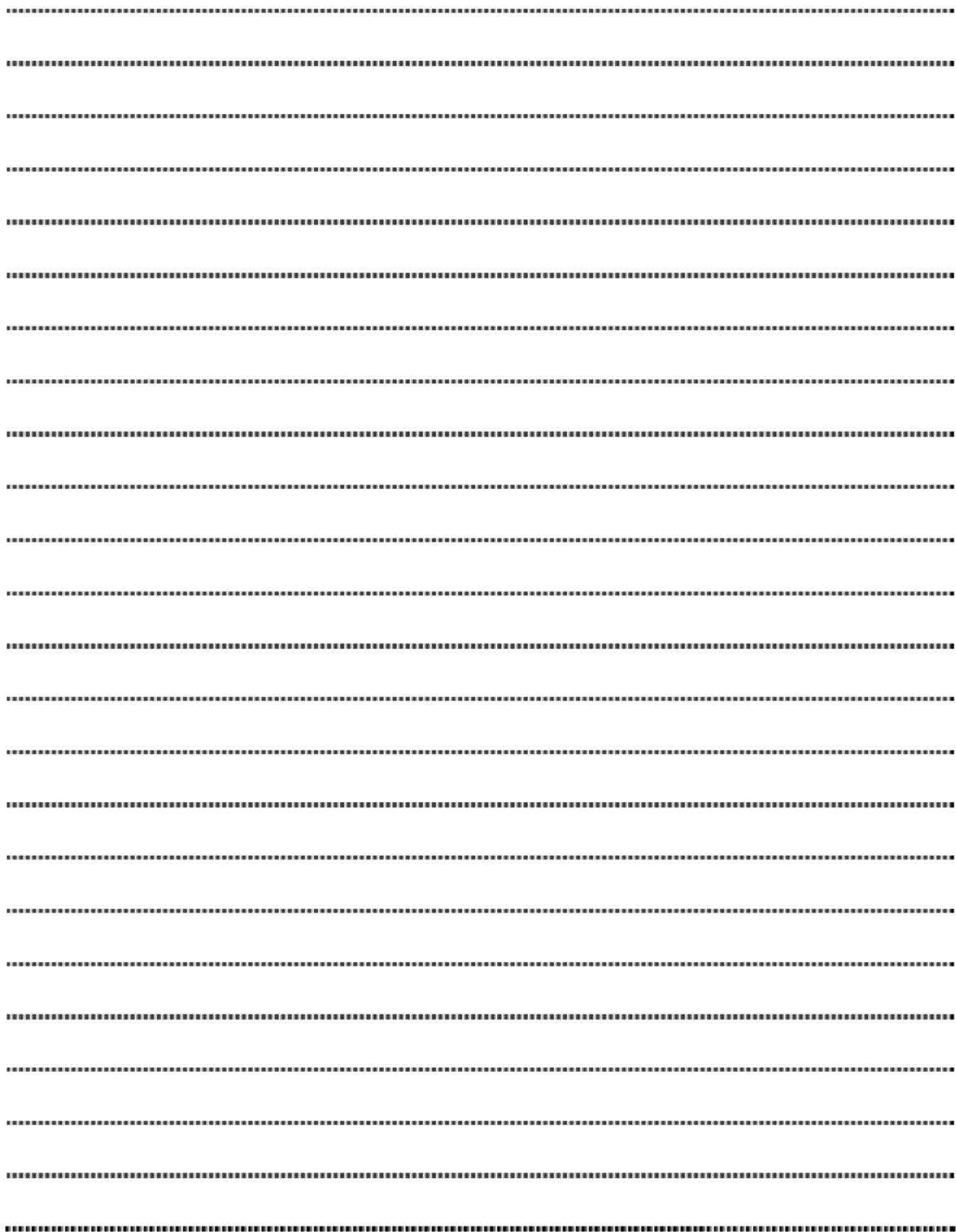
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Final DAY (Paper 01)

Bilal bin Rabah :

- Bilal Ibn Rabah R.a was a slave from Abyssinia.
- He was one of the seven early converts. He suffered a lot for accepting Islam. His master **Umayyah bin Khalaf** used to torture him; He would make Bilal R.A lie down on burning sand and would place a heavy stone on his chest. He told Bilal to denounce Islam or he would be left there to die. Bilal in reply would say “**Ahad Ahad!**” (Allah, the One).
- Once Abu Bakr was passing by while he was being tortured, Abu Bakr bought him and set him free.
- After migration to Madinah, the Prophet (pbuh) chose Bilal to deliver **Adhan** to call the Muslims for prayers, as he had a high pitched and resonant voice. Hence, Bilal came to be known as the **Mudhin of Prophet (pbuh)**.
- He participated in all the battles fought during the life of the Prophet (pbuh). He killed his master Umayyah ibn Khalaf in the Battle of Badr. After the conquest of Makkah, he deliver Adhan on the roof of Ka;bah.
- Bilal gave Adhan for the first time after the death of the Prophet (pbuh) on the request of the Caliph Umar when a treaty was made with the Jews.
- Bilal was very pious person. He settled in Syria and married there. Once he dreamt that the Prophet (pbuh) was calling him, he wept bitterly and left for Madinah. Hassan bin Ali, the Prophet’s grandson comforted him and asked him to give Adhan. On hearing Bilal giving Adhan everyone was greatly moved as it reminded them of the time of the Prophet (pbuh) and tears rolled out of their eyes. He died at the age of 60 and was buried in Damascus.

Abu Sufyan:

- Abu Sufyan was born in 560 AD. He was the chief of the clan of the **Banu Abd-Shams** from Banu Umayya; he was a very powerful and respected man of Quraish. He was one of the Prophet (pbuh)’s bitterest enemies. Abu Sufyan was married to Hind bint Utba. Abu Sufyan’s daughter Ramlah R.a was married to the Prophet (pbuh).
- In 624 AD Abu Sufyan was coming back from Syria with his caravan and asked the Quraish to escort him. As a result the battle of Badr took place. After the battle of Badr Abu Sufyan became the chief of the Quraish. And led the Quraish in the battle of Uhad in 625 and the battle of trench in 627AD against the Muslims.
- When the Prophet (pbuh) sent a letter to Heraclius inviting him to Islam, Abu Sufyan at the time was in Jerusalem for Business purpose. Heraclius called Abu Sufyan and asked him about the Prophet (pbuh) character’s. Abu Sufyan attested to the fact that the Prophet (pbuh) was truthful and never broke promise.
- In 8 AH the Quraish broke the treaty of Hudaibiya, however they soon realized their mistake and Abu Sufyan came to Madinah to have the Treaty restored, but he was unsuccessful.
- At the time of the conquest of the Makkah Abu Sufyan came to spy and was taken as a prisoner, but was saved by the intercession of Abbas R.A. The Prophet (pbuh) invited him to Islam at that time Abu Sufyan accepted that the Meccan gods had proved powerless and accepted Islam. Before entering Makkah the Prophet (pbuh) honored Abu Sufyan by announcing that whose enters the house of Abu Sufyan would be safe.
- Abu Sufyan fought by the side of the Prophet (pbuh) in the battle of Hunain. He lost an eye during the siege of Taif. Abu Sufyan also fought in the battle of Yarmuk and died at the age of ninety in 650 AD in Madinah.

Hamza ibn Abd al-Muttalib

- He was related to the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) in many ways. He was the Prophet’s (P.B.U.H) uncle and also the son of his maternal aunt as well as his foster brother. He was two years older than the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H). Hazrat Hamza was very fond of wrestling and hunting and excellent in the arts of

swordsmanship and archery. He was so involved in and attached to his pastimes that he hardly took any notice of the spread of Islam.

- In 6th year of prophethood, One day he was returning from a hunt he was informed that if he had come earlier he would have seen the condition of his nephew Mohammad (P.B.U.H) who was preaching his religion in the Ka'abah, when Abu Jahl abused him. Hazrat Hamza was enraged on hearing this. He rushed to the Ka'abah where Abu Jahl was sitting with his companions. He pounced upon Abu Jahl and struck him with his bow on the head with great force. Then he declared his acceptance of Islam. Those were the days when Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) would preach Islam secretly.
- With the acceptance of Islam by Hazrat Hamza the situation changed and the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) was able to preach Islam openly. After his acceptance of Islam, he gave up hunting and wrestling and devoted his time and energy to the cause of Islam.
- Hazrat Hamza migrated to Madinah with other Muslims in 622AD.
- **In the second year of hijrat**, Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) sent thirty men to check the caravan of the non-believers of Makkah under the command of Hazrat Hamza. He had thus, the honour of being entrusted with the **banner of Islam for the first time** in Islamic history
- During the battle of Badr he killed many unbelievers including their great warriors. In the Battle of Uhad, the unbelievers deputed Wahshi, a slave of Hinda, Abu Sufyan's wife to kill Hazrat Hamza in return of his freedom and a handsome reward.
- **Wahshi** hid himself behind a rock and as soon as Hazrat Hamza came within range threw his weapons at him. It was such a deadly weapon that as it struck Hazrat Hamza succumbed to his injury. Hinda whose father was killed in the Battle of Badr by Hazrat Hamza, cut out of the liver from his dead body and tried to chew it. Then she cut off the nose and ears of the dead body and made a necklace of them. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) led the funeral prayers for all the martyrs of Uhad, including Hazrat Hamza and gave him the title of '**Chief of the Martyrs**'.

Khalid bin Walid

- He was from a family who opposed the Prophet in Makka, and although he did not take part in the Battle of Badr, he played a vital role in the Battle of Uhud against the Muslims, turning the Muslim victory to defeat.
- He converted to Islam after the Treaty of Hudaibiya. In 629, Khalid set out for Madina. On the way he met 'Amr ibn al-'As and 'Uthman ibn Talha, who were also going to Madina to convert to Islam.
- After conversion he took part in the Battle of Mu'ta. It was the first battle between the Romans and the Muslims. He reported that the fighting was so intense, that he used nine swords, which broke in the battle. Khalid took over after Zayd ibn Haritha, then Ja'far ibn Abi Talib, then Abdullah ibn Rawaha were killed. It was because of him that the Muslims returned safely. For this the Holy Prophet^{PBUH} gave him the title of **Saif Allah** – The Sword of Allah.
- He subsequently took part in the Conquest of Makka, Battle of Hunain and the Battle of Tabuk. During the conquest of Makkah he was appointed as leader of one of the four squadrons into which the Holy Prophet^{PBUH} divided his army.
- He was at the farewell pilgrimage of the Prophet, and is said to have collected three hair from the Prophet there, which gave him victory in his battles.
- Hazrat Abu Bakr and Hazrat Umar placed similar reliance on him and made him commander of their armies in the wars against the Romans and the Persians. He died in 642 in Syria.

Zaid Ibn Harith

- Zayd ibn harith (RA) belonged to an influential family, he was kidnapped when he was young and sold as a slave. A nephew of Khadijah bought him in Syria and he gave him to his aunt Khadijah (RA), who gave Zayd to the Prophet (S.A.W).
- When the Prophet (S.A.W) invited people to Islam, Zayd was amongst the first four people to accept Islam.

- When his family came to know about his whereabouts, his father and uncle came to the Prophet (SAW) and offered to buy Zayd (RA). The Prophet (S.A.W) gave Zayd the choice to go with his father or stay with him. However, Zayd (RA) refused to go back to his family and preferred slavery to freedom. The Prophet (S.A.W) adopted Zayd (RA) as his son and hence he came to be known as Zayd ibn Mohammad.
- Zayd (RA) came to be called by the name of his father after a revelation came which commanded that adopted sons must be called after their fathers.
- Zayd (RA) was married to Umm Aiman, the slave girl of the Prophet (S.A.W) whom he had set free. They had a son named Usamah ibn Zayd .
- He accompanied the Prophet during visit to Taif and got injured while protecting the Prophet (pbuh).
- Zayd migrated to Madinah, later the Prophet sent him to Makkah to bring his wife Sawdah and daughters umm-Kulthoom and Fatimah to Madinah.
- He accompanied the Prophet in all his battles namely the battle of Badr, Uhud and Trench. He was also present when the Treaty of Hudaibiyah was concluded.
- The Prophet married his cousin Zaynab bint Jahsh to Zayd bin Harith (RA). However, the marriage was not successful and Zayd (RA) divorced Zaynab after one year.
- Zayd bin Harith was martyred in 8th A.H in the battle of Mautah.

Jafar bin Abu Talib

- Hazrat Jafar was the son of Abu Talib and elder brother of Hazrat Ali. He along with his wife embraced Islam in its early stages.
- He was among the second batch of emigrants to Abyssinia. They were pursued by the unbelievers of Makkah who requested Najashi king of Abyssinia to hand over the emigrants to them. The King summoned the Muslims to his court and asked them about their religion. The Muslims had selected Hazrat Jafar as their spokesman. He delivered a speech in which he explained the principles of Islam and what the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) taught them. He also recited portion of Surah Maryam. After hearing it, Najashi said, **"By God this and the Gospel are the lights of one candle"** thereafter, Najashi dismissed the unbelievers in his court and assured the Muslims that they may reside peacefully in his country.
- He went back to Madina in 7 A.H. When Khyber was conquered, the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) gave him a piece of land near Masjid al Nabwi and kept him close to himself.
- The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) sent an army to Muta in Syria in 8 A.H. Hazrat Jafar was included in the army. Hazrat Zaid bin Harith was the commander of the army. In case of his death, he was to be succeeded by Hazrat Jafar. Hazrat Jafar was martyred in the battle. He received ninety wounds on his body and lost both his hands. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) said, **"Allah has granted him two wings in place of his two hands so that he flies about in paradise wherever he likes"** He is called **Jafar Tayyar** Jafar the flier.
- Hazrat Jafar took great care of the poor and needy. Hence, he was known as **Abul Masakeen**. He resembled the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) in features and habits. The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) himself said **"You resemble me in features and manners"**

Salman al-Farsi

- Hazrat Salman R.A the Persian, was born in Persia to a wealthy man who was overprotective of his son, never allowing him out of his mansion. Hazrat Salman belonged to the Zoroastrian faith and was assigned the duty of keeping the ceremonial fire burning in the family home.
- Out of curiosity to see the outside world, he left home and happened to come upon a group of Christians singing during their worship. Fascinated by the vibrancy of his faith, he converted to Christianity and settled in Isfahan. Yet his quest for religious knowledge took him to Syria, where he heard from some priests about the coming of a new prophet in Arabia, and also the signs that would distinguish this prophet. He made his way to Arabia and en route was captured and sold in slavery.

- When the Prophet (P.B.U.H) arrived Yathrib and Salman-Al-Farsi heard accounts of him, he was keenly interested and attended one of his gatherings. Each sign he had been told about was present in the Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) and thus Hazrat Salman accepted Islam.
- The Prophet (P.B.U.H) secured him his freedom, and he served the cause of Islam well. It was his advice to encircle Madina with a trench to protect the city that saved the oasis from the Makkan attack at the time of the war by the tribes that had united against Islam, the Prophet (P.B.U.H), and the Muslims. This came to be known as the Battle of Khandaq (Trench) and also as Battle of Ahzab (Trench).
- Hazrat Salman was one of the top officers who conquered the Persian Empire in the Caliphate of Hazrat Umar R.A and, upon his death was buried there.

Mu'adh bin Jabal

- He was a boy in Yathrib when the Prophet (P.B.U.H) sent Musab bin Umair to preach Islam to the people of the oasis after the first pledge of Aqabah. Hazrat Mu'adh R.A accepted the new faith and in the following year, he travelled with the seventy or so Muslims of Yathrib to make the second pledge of Aqabah.
- On returning to Madina, he started a youth association to convince idol worshippers to give up their practices. Several influential people of the city accepted Islam on account of his efforts.
- After the Prophet (P.B.U.H) migrated to Madina, Hazrat Mu'adh became one of his close companions and learned the Quran so well that Prophet (P.B.U.H) declared him to be one of the four who should be sought out for learning the Quran.
- The Holy Prophet (P.B.U.H) also mentioned him as an expert in issues related to law, and later, he was sent by the Prophet (P.B.U.H) as an ambassador to Yemen.
- According to a Hadith of the Prophet pbuh, Mu'adh will be the leader of Muslim scholars on the day of Judgement.
- The Holy Prophet is reported to have said about him. "The most learned of my Ummah about the lawful and the unlawful is Mu'az bin Jabal." (Tirmizi)
- Mu'az bin Jabal returned from Yemen during the Khilafat of Hazrat Abu Bakr and accompanied Usamah bin Zaid on the expedition to Syria.
- He died of Plague in 18 A.H. while he was in Syria.

4. (b) Did the role of Abu Talib help strengthen the early Muslim community? Give reasons for your answer. [4]

- Yes it did for example because he allowed the boycotted Muslims to stay at Shib-e-Abi talib, which gave them a place to stay in a time of difficulty;
- he supported prophet at all times, which in turn supported the followers of the Prophet and this would have helped them carry on in their mission;
- when the Quraish offered the Prophet bribes and the Prophet refused, Abu Talib said he would not ask him again which again helped strengthen the support given to the Prophet and his community.
- Physical protection that he gave to the Prophet helped the Islamic flourish otherwise Makkan would have killed him in very beginning.

5.(b) In your opinion, can Muslims today learn anything from Abu Sufyan's involvement with the Prophet? [4]

- Muslims can learn that no matter how fierce a person is against Islam, they can change and become friends to Islam. Therefore, Muslims should not treat non-Muslims in a bad way, as they can be part of their community in the future. The example of the Prophet is to treat people well no matter how they treat you. Muslims can also learn that a new Muslims' sins are wiped clean so their past should not be held against them. So Muslims now should not look down on new Muslims no matter what their background.

(b) To what extent do 'Ali and Zayd's relationships with the Prophet provide models for family relations today? [4]

These stories can tell Muslims that it is not just immediate relations that are important, and that Muslims should look after other family members as well. 'Ali was not his son but the Prophet looked after him like he was, and so if there is a need in your family, then it is encouraged to help family members by treating their children the same as you would your own, rather than giving your own children better things than other relatives. Adoption is also important in Islam and candidates could write that adopted children are to be given the same treatment in the family as other children. Although God later changed the inheritance of adopted children, their treatment within the family should be like your own children.

5. (b) What can be learnt from Bilal's role in the Islamic community? [4]

- Bilal's life can provide Muslims with valuable lessons.
- His ethnic background was not a hindrance in his status as a companion of the Prophet, and so racial equality should be practised amongst Muslims of all communities. The Prophet pbuh said, ***"All mankind is from Adam and an Arab has no superiority over a non-Arab, nor has a non-Arab over the Arab. Similarly, no white has superiority over the black; nor have a black over white; except by piety and good action.....you are all the children of Adam, and Adam was made of mud."***
- His background of being a slave did not prevent the deep friendship between him and the Prophet, and so all men should be treated equally despite their class.
- Due to the beauty of his voice the Prophet favoured him as muezzin, and that it is the purity of one's heart that God looks at.

Position of Women in Islam

As Wives:

- Both the Quran and Sunnah have laid great emphasis on men to be kind and gentle with their wives. Wives are equal to their husbands. They are partners with their husbands in family life. They are primarily responsible for the home.
- They have financial independence The Holy Quran says, ***"Men are the protectors and maintainers of women because Allah has given the one more (strength) than the other and because they support them from their means."*** [4:34] This verse makes it clear that husbands have to provide sustenance to their wives, clothe them and house them.
- Abu Hurairah relates that the Holy Prophet pbuh said, ***"The best amongst you is he who is most kind to his wife."***(Tirmizi).
- In case of more than one wife, man is enjoined to treat all of them equally. He said on the occasion of Farewell pilgrimage, ***"O people! You have rights over your wives and your wives have right over you. Treat your wives with kindness."***
- Similarly she is given right to seek divorce (Khula).
- It is the duty of the husband to pay dower (Mehr) to his wife at the time of marriage. Allah says, ***"And give the women (on marriage) their dower as a free gift."*** (an-Nisa 4:4)
- Woman can keep her property acquired before marriage and she has no legal obligation to spend on her family out of her personal wealth. It is the duty of a man to fulfill her material and financial needs.
- Both husband and wife must decide family matters with mutual consultation.
- The Prophet (p.b.u.h) loved his wives. Khadijah was his first wife; His love for her was so great that he did not marry again during her lifetime. He never rebuked his wives for any of their shortcomings. During his last illness, when he became very sick he ask his wives for permission before staying in 'Aishah (R.A) house. He helped his wives in their daily chores.

As Mothers:

- A woman's position as a mother is unique in Muslim society. They have the main responsibility for bringing up children. They are the first teachers of faith and proper conduct.
- The Holy Quran and the Holy Prophet pbuh have given special importance to the mother and stressed upon the children to be more considerate, submissive, grateful and obedient to her in comparison to the father. They deserve respect from their children because of what they have done for them.
- Abu Hurairah relates that once a person asked the Holy Prophet :***"O Messenger of Allah, who is the most deserving person to get good treatment from me?"*** He replied, ***"Your mother."*** When he asked this question

this for the fourth time, the Holy Prophet said: "Your father." This hadith indicates that the status of the mother is greater than that of the father (agreed upon).

- A companion of the Holy Prophet once asked his permission to take part in Jihad. The Prophet asked him if his mother was alive. On getting the answer in affirmative, the Prophet asked him to go home and serve her as **"heaven was under her feet"**(Ahmad, Nasai). This means that to respect, obey and serve the mother is the key to heaven. In doing so, we shall be able to please Allah and the Holy Prophet.
- The Prophet (pbuh) did not spend a lot of time with his mother yet he had great love for her and always remembered her. In the last year of his life, on his way perform the farewell pilgrimage, the Prophet (pbuh) stopped at Abwa at the grave of his mother and wept there by remembering her.

As daughters:

- According to the teachings of Islam, daughters are to be treated with love and care. They should always be allowed freedom in legitimate choices.
- They have a right to their parents' legacy. In this connection, the holy Prophet is reported to have said, **"If one brings up three daughters, teaches them good manners, and treats them kindly, till they no longer need his help, Allah will make paradise obligatory for him."** A companion asked, "what if he has two?". He replied, "and he too." The reporter of this hadith said that if people had inquired about one, the Prophet would have said the same thing .
- Daughters should be cared for as carefully as sons. Abdullah Ibn Abbas related that the Holy Prophet said, **"If anyone has a baby daughter and does not bury her alive, nor ignores her, nor prefers his sons to her, Allah will bring him into paradise."**
- Prophet pbuh had great affection for his daughters, especially his love for **Hazrat Fatima** is a model of fatherly love for daughters. He is reported to have said, "Fatima is a part of me, whoever hurts her hurts me, whoever holds malice against her, holds malice against me". When she visited him in his last illness, he gave her his own chair to sit.

(b) What do these teachings tell us about the relationship between men and women? [4]

- The Islamic society is governed by a sense of both individual and collective responsibility to Allah who has defined the limits for human behavior. There are certain principles to govern the interaction of sexes. Free social mixing between men and women is not permitted unless it is for some serious reason or purpose.
- When mixing does take place, both men and women are to exercise proper decorum in the way they speak and behave.
- Women are advised not to display themselves in public and not entertain or talk unnecessarily to men who are not their close relatives.
- A Muslim man and woman are not permitted to be alone together unless they are close relatives (Mahram).
- Both Muslim men and women should observe modesty. The Quran says, **"Say to the believing men that they should lower their gaze and guard their modesty.....and say to the believing women that they should lower their gaze and guard their modesty...." (24:30-31)**
- In marriage, husbands and wives must try their best to live with love and affection and show respect and kindness to each other even in disputes. Where family matters are concerned, decisions must be taken with mutual consultation and not force.

To my fellow classmates, I wish you nothing but great luck and hope to see us all ace our CIES.
May all of our efforts be worth it.